# THE OMNI-COMPASS OPERATOR'S MANUAL

*How to Embed, Wire, Tune and Run Omni-Compass on Your Stack*

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**The Omni-Compass Operator's Manual**
How to Embed, Wire, Tune and Run Omni-Compass on Your Stack
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# The Problem and the Answer

**What the whole industry faces.** Every computing system in service, from one server to a cloud region, from a GPU to a building's chillers, a grid feeder or a robot cell, is run by a stack of native controllers: the Kubernetes autoscalers and scheduler, the cloud's node pools, the GPU's power and clock firmware, the database's cache and connection pools, the building's cooling loops, the battery's management system, the servo's loop. Each was designed and tuned alone, against its own setpoint, with margins sized for the worst case it might meet. Three costs follow, on every stack:

1. **Capacity held idle.** Worst-case margins stay in place through the common case. Machines, power caps, caches and cooling run far inside their limits, and the room between the operating point and the limit is paid for and seldom used.
2. **Late reaction.** Reactive loops act on averaged, lagging signals and wait out deliberate cooldowns, so queues and response-time tails form before capacity arrives.
3. **Loops at cross purposes.** The loops share power, cooling, connections and memory. One loop's correction is another loop's disturbance, and no loop sees the whole.

Demand for computing, above all for AI and the cloud, is growing faster than the power, cooling and hardware that can be built for it. The usual answer is to add: more machines, more power, more people watching thresholds. Replacing the native controllers is not an answer most operators will take: they are proven, often certified, and the people on call know them.

**What Omni-Compass does about it.** Omni-Compass is a supervisory governor. It sits on top of those native controllers and never replaces them. It plugs into each setting a native controller already exposes, through a two-way plug (one wire in, the reading; one wire out, the setting), takes a snapshot of every setting before its first write, and governs the whole stack as one body, the organism: every muscle driven as far as its own limit and never past it, and, on the engine that stands, never below native; where it cannot bring a muscle a GAIN, that muscle stays native. It acts before a line is crossed instead of after, reads back every write, puts every give-back to its own trial, records every decision with its reason, walks every setting home if it stops (the lease) and stops at once on the kill switch. Its first rule is do no harm, judged at the organism: never less work or health than native (`DISCLOSURES.md`, section 3). The aim is the one headline: more work, faster, on fewer machines, with less energy, from the hardware and the controllers already in place; in a cloud, the same work for a smaller bill.

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**Where the proof is.** This book shows how to wire, tune, run and check Omni-Compass. The mechanism, the mathematics and every result, each a paired comparison of native and Omni-Compass on top of native run three times, every row kept, LOSS included, are in the Owner's Manual and in `results/`. The only number that applies to your system is the one your own paired runs produce.

**What is not claimed.** No new physics, no new model of computation, and no promise for any system Omni-Compass was not run on. It does not make a system immune to failure, delay or drift: it keeps each muscle inside its own limits and shows, row by row, what it did against native. A result on another system is that system's own, from its own paired runs; where it differs, the first presumption is the wiring (`DISCLOSURES.md`, section 4).

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# Foreword

I built Omni-Compass to sit on top of what already exists. Kubernetes, the GPU driver, the building controller, the battery inverter, the robot's servo loop: those are muscles, and they are good muscles. What none of them has is one governor that reads all of them at once, holds each of them inside its safe range, and puts every setting back exactly where it found it when it stops. That governor is Omni-Compass, and this book is how you put it in.

**Every machine already has a controller.** Kubernetes has its autoscaler. A graphics card has its firmware. A building has its thermostat loop, a battery has its charge controller, a power grid has its tap changers, and a robot has its servo. Engineers spent decades making these controllers safe, and they are. But each one was built to watch one thing and to protect that one thing. None of them sees the whole body. None of them knows that the cooling loop is holding back the processor, or that the autoscaler is adding machines the database cannot feed. So each one plays it safe in the middle of its range, because playing it safe is its whole job. The headroom between the middle and the edge is paid for every hour and almost never used.

**That gap is what you are wiring it to close.** Omni-Compass is a **supervisory governor**: one governor over the muscles you already run. It never replaces them and it never competes with them. It reads them, it decides, and it writes one setting at a time through a two-way plug: one wire in, one wire out. Before it writes anything, it takes a snapshot. When it stops, every setting goes back to that snapshot.

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**The rule I will not bend: do no harm.** Its real goal is the organism you wire it onto: to strengthen it and keep it healthy, working at the best state its own muscles can carry, turning what is fed into it (its work, its data, its energy) into the most and best output it can make. Harm is the organism turning out less than its native controllers make it turn out, or made less healthy: a muscle pushed past its own limit, a service over its own line, anything made to fail. Omni-Compass never does either, and it pushes a muscle only as far as that muscle itself can go (`DISCLOSURES.md`, Chapter 4). The engine that stands keeps the rule in its strictest form: where it cannot bring a muscle a gain, that muscle stays native, and before a slow setting moves, the governor tries the step on that muscle and keeps it only if the muscle's own work costs no more for it. A step that costs more is undone.

**The max is the factory setting.** Omni-Compass ships tuned the way I tuned it: every muscle runs up to its own limit, read live from the system, never past it and never below what native gives. The energy it takes to do more work is **power given**, shown beside the work, the speed and the wear it bought. It is never called a loss. Anyone can turn the dial down from the max, retune a muscle, or add one; nobody has to.

**One pedal.** I wanted it to drive like an electric car. Push the pedal for more, lift off for less. Lift off all the way and the settings drift back toward native. Reset hands everything back. If the governor ever crashes, its lease runs out and the plug walks every setting home, step by step. The kill switch is separate and instant, and it exists for security, not for daily driving.

**What this book holds.** This is the manual for the people who wire it: what the governor is from the outside, how to tune it, how the plug and the wires work, how to wire it onto each kind of stack one level at a time, how to run it, how to switch it off, and how to check on your own system, with your own paired runs, what it does there. It is the book you keep in the glove box. When the software changes, this manual changes in the same commit.

**How I want it judged.** On your own receipts. Every paired run has exactly two arms: native, and Omni-Compass on top of native. Run it three separate times under rules you wrote down first, show every row, losses included, and read each row as one word, **GAIN**, **EVEN** or **LOSS**, by what the gauge is for. Where a receipt reads LOSS, look at the wiring first; this book tells you where.

**Where to begin.** Read the front matter first. It tells you what you are looking at before it asks you to touch anything. Then wire it one level at a time, watch it before you let it write, and judge it by your own receipts.

**AJ Dubra** Founder, The Omni-Compass LLC

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# Preface

I wrote this book for the engineers who put Omni-Compass into a running system: how to embed it, how to wire it to every muscle of a stacked, clustered system or to any one muscle, how to tune it, how to run it, how to switch it off, and how to check on their own system, with their own paired runs, what it does there. It is the manual for the glove box, not a description of how the engine is built.

The book is in six parts, after the front matter.

| You are | Read |
|---|---|
| CTO, architect, head of platform | the front matter, Part One, the eight levels in Part Three, then Part Five |
| The engineer wiring it | everything, in order. Do not skip the wire check or the watch level |
| Platform engineer for one stack | Part Two, the chapter of Part Three for your stack, and Part Four |
| Data-center, facility or energy operator | the Quick Reference card, Part One, Part Three (levels five to seven, the processor and the data center under the servers), Part Four |
| Site reliability engineer, on call | the Quick Reference card, Part Four (the switches and the log), the troubleshooting appendix |
| Security and compliance | Part Four, the Disclosures, the license in the back matter |
| Procurement and counsel | the Disclosures, Part Six, the license and its questions and answers in the back matter |

**Part One, the governor from the outside,** says what Omni-Compass is as an installer meets it, how the muscles of a stack become one body, and how it is tuned: the factory tune, the dial, each muscle's own card and the settings an operator writes. **Part Two, the harness,** is the universal plug, the adapters, the wire check and the rules every wire obeys. **Part Three** wires it onto a stack one level at a time and then stack by stack. **Part Four** is operating it: the OFF switch, the rules, the log, maintenance and security. **Part Five** is checking it on your own system: paired runs and receipts, evidence classes, the engine version and the three-run rule. **Part Six** is the license and how to verify a copy. The back matter holds the glossary, every command, the files an installation touches, the gauges, troubleshooting, and every muscle with its wiring and its own card.

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**Conventions.** `Code` is a command, file or switch exactly as typed. "Native" means a system as it runs today, without Omni-Compass. "Muscle" means any machine, service or controller Omni-Compass can read and set. "Knob" or "lever" is one setting on a muscle. "The band" is a service reading's safe range. A step that writes to a system is marked **WRITES**. Every number in a receipt carries its evidence class: S for a model (modelled), L for live software, P for a physical meter.

**The standards every page of this manual keeps.** An installation wired by this manual should meet, and its receipts should show, the following discipline throughout:

1. **Two arms, always.** Every paired run compares native against omni, the same system with Omni-Compass on top, on the same machines, with the same work at the same moments. Omni-Compass is never run standalone and never compared as a competitor to the controller it sits on.
2. **Written down, then run.** The arms, the knob, its cover, the gauges, their aims and the readings are written down before the first counted run. Rules are fixed on one tuning case that is shown and never counted, then applied unchanged to the cases that are counted. A change made after a result has been seen is written down with its time and reason, and the receipt that carries the result says so.
3. **Three separate runs, one rule.** A result is run three times (A, B and C) on the same engine version, and every judged row reads exactly one of: GAIN in all three runs, LOSS in all three runs, no difference beyond the noise, or the runs disagree (chapter 13). Nobody outside The Omni-Compass LLC has reviewed or approved the published results, and every three-run table says so.
4. **Every row, losses included.** A row that went against Omni-Compass is in the receipt beside the rows that went for it. When Omni-Compass loses, the first suspect is the wiring, then native's setup, then the scoring; when that is fixed, the run is repeated and the loss stays in the record.
5. **Nothing read across engine versions.** Each engine version is fingerprinted (`python3 tools/omni_version.py`). A receipt names the version it ran on and is never read against a receipt of another.
6. **Do no harm.** The organism is never left turning out less than native, nor less healthy, and every muscle works only as far as its own limit (`DISCLOSURES.md`, section 3). On the engine that stands, Omni-Compass moves a slow knob only where a paired trial on the muscle itself shows the muscle never behind for it (section 1.2). Where it cannot bring a knob a gain, that knob stays native, and the receipt says "nothing for Omni to move".

# Prelude: A Night on the Cluster

This is a story, not a result. It follows one night on one cluster to show, in plain order, what each part of this book does. The shop, the times and the settings are made up for the story. A measured result belongs to a receipt, and chapter 11 says how to make one on your own system.

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**9:00 p.m. The shop is quiet.** An online store runs on Kubernetes. Its native controllers are the ones almost everybody uses. The Horizontal Pod Autoscaler watches the average processor load and adds copies of the web service (pods) when that load passes its target. The cluster autoscaler adds machines when the pods no longer fit. A careful engineer picked their settings months ago, for the worst day she could imagine, and she picked them well. Tonight the cluster runs on its floor of two machines, and every customer gets an answer in a blink.

**A week earlier, Omni-Compass went on in watch mode.** For seven days it read every gauge and wrote nothing. It learned how fast each pod starts, how the response time moves when the load moves, and where each setting's safe band lies. Then the team ran the wire check: every reading came from the place it claimed, every lever moved the thing it claimed, and every write was read back. Only then did they turn it to govern. Every setting it would touch was saved in a snapshot first.

**9:40 p.m. The sale starts.** In two minutes the requests double. The native autoscaler does exactly what it was built to do, but it is built to wait: it needs the average load to climb, then it needs a decision, then each new pod needs time to start. While it waits, customers wait. With Omni-Compass on top, the compass sees the response time slide toward the edge of its band and into the cushion. It pushes. It raises the autoscaler's floor of pods, a setting the autoscaler already respects, so new pods start before the average catches up. It does not fight the autoscaler and it does not go around it. It moves one setting, through the plug, and reads it back.

**10:15 p.m. The database starts to strain.** More web pods mean more connections to the database, and the database has a limit of its own. A controller that watches only the web service would keep adding pods and make the jam grow. Omni-Compass sees the whole body. One body, one brain: before it takes the next step for the web service, it checks what that step would do to every other part. The step that would push the database past its own cushion is refused. Nothing is pushed into a loss to buy a gain somewhere else. The web service holds where the database can still keep up, and the queue drains instead of growing.

**11:30 p.m. The rush fades.** The pedal lifts. Omni-Compass does not drop everything at once, because a sudden drop is how systems stumble. It eases each setting back toward native along a smooth curve. The extra machines go away as the work goes away. The energy the cluster used during the rush shows up in the report as power given, beside the work it bought and the minutes customers did not spend waiting.

**1:00 a.m. Idle.** The pedal is lifted all the way. The cluster sits on its floor of two machines again, exactly where the engineer left it. Omni-Compass keeps reading every second. Staying native is its live decision, made again each second, not a verdict from some earlier run.

**3:12 a.m. Something breaks.** An upgrade restarts the machine that runs the governor, and Omni-Compass stops in the middle of its work. Nobody is awake. Nothing bad happens. The governor's lease runs out, and the plug walks every setting back to its snapshot, step by step. The native controllers keep running as they always have, because they never stopped. When the governor comes back, it starts from what it reads, not from what it remembers.

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**7:00 a.m. The morning report.** On a live system, the proof does not come from a feeling that the night went well. It comes from paired runs: the same work, run once on native and once with Omni-Compass on top, and compared gauge by gauge. Every gauge gets one word. Time waited that fell reads **GAIN**. Work done that rose reads **GAIN**. A difference inside the noise reads **EVEN**, and the report says so plainly. A gauge that moved the wrong way reads **LOSS**, and it stays in the report until its cause is found and fixed. The energy spent on extra work reads **power given**, never a loss.

**What the night shows.** Every part of that night is a chapter of this book:

- the band, the cushions, the line and the factory tune are in chapter 4;
- the plug, the snapshot and the wire check are in chapter 5;
- one body, one brain, and blind means hold, are in chapter 6;
- the watch mode and the levels are in chapter 7, and the cluster's own wiring in section 8.1;
- the lease and the kill switch are in chapter 9;
- the paired runs and the three words are in chapters 11 to 13.

Read the rest of the front matter before you touch a wire. It tells you what you are looking at and how to read what it tells you.

# Introduction: The Idea and What This Manual Covers

**The problem.** Stated in brief at the front of this book ("The Problem and the Answer"); here in engineering terms. Production systems are governed by many local feedback loops: horizontal autoscalers, firmware power and clock governors, building-management loops, battery-management systems, connection pools, servo controllers. Each loop is tuned in isolation, against its own setpoint, with margins sized for a worst-case disturbance. Three costs follow, and every operator pays them:

- **Reaction latency.** Reactive loops act on lagging, averaged signals. A Kubernetes Horizontal Pod Autoscaler recomputes its desired replicas from averaged utilization on a sync period (15 seconds by default) and damps its decisions with stabilization windows; new pods then need time to schedule and start. Queues form before capacity arrives.
- **Static over-provisioning.** Worst-case margins persist through the far more common nominal regime. The operating point sits well inside the safe region, and the headroom between it and the constraint boundary is paid for and rarely used.

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- **Uncoordinated coupling.** Loops share resources: power, cooling, connections, memory, network. One loop's correction is another loop's disturbance. More web replicas saturate the database's connections; more cooling pushes a power feed toward its limit.

Operators close these gaps by hand, with fixed settings and runbooks. That is safe, and it leaves the region between the nominal operating point and the safe boundary unused nearly all of the time.

**The idea.** Close one supervisory loop around the native loops. Omni-Compass treats each setting a native controller already exposes (a replica floor, a power cap, a clock ceiling, a temperature setpoint, a pool size) as an actuator and each native telemetry stream as a measurement, and governs the whole body from above. Seen from the outside, every decision period runs the same five steps, and those five steps are all an installation has to provide for:

1. **Sense.** It reads each muscle's own gauges through the plug: utilization, response-time percentiles, queue depth, temperature, power, state of charge.
2. **Place.** It places each reading in its band, from calm to the line, with a 5% cushion at each edge, so that every muscle's state is read on the same scale whatever its units.
3. **Decide.** It chooses at most one bounded step per actuator, smooth and never hammering, clipped to the actuator's cover, the hard range nothing can leave.
4. **Actuate.** It writes the step through the plug, idempotently, and reads the value back to confirm the write landed.
5. **Verify.** It compares the muscle with and without the step in a paired trial on the muscle itself, judged on the muscle's own cost per unit of work, and checks every coupled muscle against its own cushion. A step that fails either test is undone.

The installation supplies the wires (sense and actuate) and the settings (the band, the line, the cover and the tune); the governor does the rest. Nothing in an installation re-implements the decision, and nothing in this manual asks the installer to.

**What Omni-Compass is not.**

- It is **not a replacement** for your controllers. Native keeps running underneath, always. Omni-Compass only moves settings that native already exposes and respects.
- It is **not a black box**. Every decision is written to a log, with the reading that caused it and the setting it changed (chapter 9).
- It is **not a one-time tuning script**. It decides again every second, and staying native is one of its decisions.
- It is **not a cost-cutter first**. It gives power where the power buys work or speed, and it shows that power beside what it bought.

**The promise, in three parts.**

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1. **Do no harm.** The organism is never left turning out less than native, nor less healthy, and no muscle is pushed past its own limit. On the engine that stands, a step stays only where the muscle loses nothing for it, measured on the muscle itself; where Omni-Compass cannot bring a gain, the muscle stays native.
2. **Everything comes back.** Every setting is saved before the first write and restored when Omni-Compass stops. If the governor crashes, its lease runs out and the settings walk home on their own. A separate kill switch stops everything at once.
3. **Every claim is checked.** Each paired run compares two arms, native and Omni-Compass on top of native, on the same machines with the same work, three separate times. Each reading is one word, GAIN, EVEN or LOSS, decided by what the gauge is for, and each carries its evidence class: **P** for a physical meter, **L** for live software, **S** for our own models. A model is never shown as proof of hardware.

**What it governs.** The catalog names 1,107 muscles in 70 families, the settings that operators everywhere already turn by hand: machine pools and replicas, power caps and clock limits, cache sizes and connection pools, cooling setpoints and battery reserves, robot speeds and drone-swarm settings, and many more. Appendix E lists every one: what it is, what Omni-Compass reads from it, what it moves, and the factory setting it runs on; and for each of the 70 families how to wire it on your own stack (native controller, wire out, wire in, restore, run live or modelled). Chapter 2 shows how the muscles of one stack are grouped into one body.

**What you need before you wire it.**

- **A license for any use beyond evaluation.** Production use requires a signed, paid Omni-Compass Enterprise License.
- **Read access first.** Omni-Compass starts in watch mode: it reads and computes, and writes nothing.
- **The wire check.** Every reading must come from where it claims, every lever must move what it claims, and every write must read back. Nothing writes until the check passes.
- **Your own service line.** The response time or other limit your service must meet comes from your own service objectives, not from ours.
- **Paired runs on your own system.** The only number that applies to your system is the one your own paired runs produce, on your own receipt.

**What this manual covers, and what it does not.** It covers how to embed, wire, tune, run and check Omni-Compass on a stacked, clustered system or on any one muscle, the way a vehicle's manual covers its controls, its settings, its service and its warning lights. It does not cover how the engine is built, and it carries no benchmark results: those are kept with the code, each in its own table with its evidence class.

**How to read what follows.** Next comes the Quick Reference card, the page to keep beside the system. Part One describes the governor from the outside and how to tune it; Part Two, the plug and the rules its wires obey; Part Three, the wiring, level by level and stack by stack; Part Four, operating it; Part Five, checking it on your own system. Read in that order, nothing in the wiring chapters should surprise you.

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# The key: GAIN, EVEN and LOSS

Every judged reading in Omni-Compass is one of three words: **GAIN**, **EVEN** or **LOSS**. Better, same and worse are not used anywhere. The word is decided by what the gauge is for, never by the plus or minus sign of its number: who sets the aim differs from one system to the next, and each gauge's aim is written in its preregistration before the runs.

| Word | What each letter stands for | Its sense in underwriting | What it means in a table |
|---|---|---|---|
| **GAIN** | **G** Growth (asset appreciation); **A** Advantage (risk reduction); **I** Improvement (margin expansion); **N** Net-positive (profitable outcome) | surplus and positive variance | the gauge moved toward its declared aim against native: more work done, a shorter wait, fewer misses or failures, or a resource cut |
| **EVEN** | **E** Equalized (zero variance); **V** Verified baseline (expected norm); **E** Equilibrium (balanced risk); **N** Neutral (no net change) | the break-even baseline: equilibrium | native and Omni could not be told apart: the same, or no difference beyond the noise; a knob native already runs at the top of its range is EVEN, at its limit on native |
| **LOSS** | **L** Leakage (capital drain); **O** Off-track (adverse selection); **S** Setback (claim liability); **S** Subpar (negative variance) | actuarial deficit and exposure | the gauge moved away from its declared aim: less work done, a longer wait, more misses or failures |

How the sign of a number becomes a word:

- **Time waited, missed or failed** (a response time, time over the line, failed requests): a fall is GAIN, a rise is LOSS.
- **Work done** (work inside the line, throughput, a hit rate): a rise is GAIN, a fall is LOSS.
- **A resource spent or held** (energy, the power drawn and its peaks and swings, machines, memory, processor time, a bill, wear on a part): a fall is a **cut**, and a cut is GAIN. A rise is **power given**: what Omni put in to buy the work and the speed shown beside it. Power given is always shown and never hidden, and it is never called a loss (the founder's order of 12 October 2026: the max rides every muscle's edge; it never shaves). A peak is power held, so a peak that rose is power given, in a data centre and in a building alike (17 October).

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- **Work bought with each unit of a resource** (work per energy): a rise is a cut in what each unit of work took, a GAIN; a fall is power given, because it falls when more power is given for the same work.
- So a minus can read GAIN (a response time cut 65%, a bill cut 30%) and a plus can read LOSS (failed requests up).
- **The floor, and every change above it** (the founder's orders of 20 and 24 October 2026): a change of half of one percent (0.5%) or more either way is a change, and reads **GAIN** or **LOSS** (or **power given**) by what the gauge is for; EVEN is kept for a change under 0.5%. The change is the mean of the three runs' changes, each in percent of native. Where every run moved the same way with its 95% interval clear of zero, the word reads **in all three of our runs**; otherwise it reads **by the mean of our three runs** and says in how many of the three runs it stood beyond the noise, so a reader sees how firmly it stands. Where runs moved 0.5% or more in opposite directions, the reading is **the runs disagree**. A mean under 0.5% reads **EVEN, under the floor**, with its size.
- **The sign beside a word** (the same order): the number next to a word carries the word's sign, never the gauge's raw direction, so that no one mistakes which way a number went: GAIN +, LOSS −, EVEN =. A bill cut 3% reads GAIN +3%, failed requests up 2% read LOSS −2%, and a change inside the noise reads EVEN =0.3%.

Some preregistrations name their outcome with a label written before the runs (for example SUPERIOR WITHIN GUARDRAILS in the card protocol). The label stays as it was frozen, and every table shows it with its word first: TOWARD ITS AIMS reads GAIN; BOTH WAYS reads GAIN AND LOSS; AWAY FROM ITS AIMS reads LOSS; SAME AS NATIVE reads EVEN (the same as native); AT ITS LIMIT ON NATIVE reads EVEN (at its limit on native); SUPERIOR WITHIN GUARDRAILS reads GAIN (within the guardrails); ENERGY IMPROVEMENT WITH SERVICE TRADEOFF reads GAIN AND LOSS (energy cut, service traded for it); SERVICE IMPROVEMENT WITH ENERGY TRADEOFF reads GAIN, power given (service GAIN, energy given for it); NONINFERIOR / INCONCLUSIVE reads EVEN (inside the noise, within the guardrails); NOT ESTABLISHED reads EVEN (not established: inside the noise, a guardrail crossed on the mean). A run that breaks its own validity checks reads INVALID and carries no word.

Every reading is one of these. **GAIN, LOSS or power given in all three of our runs**: A, B and C moved the same way, every 95% interval clear of zero. **GAIN, LOSS or power given by the mean of our three runs**: the runs' mean moved 0.5% or more, with the count of runs that stood beyond the noise beside it. **EVEN, under the floor**: the mean moved less than 0.5%. **EVEN, the same**: no change at all. **The runs disagree**: runs moved 0.5% or more in opposite directions, so the test is unstable there and is looked into. **Shown, not judged**: a gauge declared in advance as shown only, such as the knob's own setting.

Why these three words: they are the words of underwriting and actuarial work, where every outcome is graded as surplus, break-even or deficit, and each letter spells out the same rule. Omni-Compass is there to add (GAIN), never to take (LOSS), and to hand a muscle back to its own native setting where it cannot add (EVEN). Its first rule is do no harm, in the founder's meaning of 19 October 2026: the organism Omni-Compass governs is never left turning out less than its native controllers make it turn out, nor less healthy, and every muscle works only as far as its own limit (`DISCLOSURES.md`, section 3). So **LOSS**

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**should never appear**: where it does, the row stays in the table, its cause is found and fixed (our own wiring first, then native's setup, then the scoring) and the test is run again.

Disclosure and disclaimer: GAIN, EVEN and LOSS, and the letters behind them, are The Omni-Compass LLC's own convention for reading its own results. The underwriting senses explain the words; they are not an actuarial, financial or insurance opinion, and no outside body defined, reviewed or approved them. A reading states what our own runs measured against native under the declared aims, not a promise about any other system; every number stands beside its word, so a reader can judge it by any other convention. Run and scored by The Omni-Compass LLC's own code. No outside party has reviewed or approved these results. Preregistered means the rules were written down in our own repository before the runs; nothing was filed with any outside body.

# What You Are Looking At

**What Omni-Compass is.** Omni-Compass is a supervisory governor. It is never a controller of its own and never a replacement for one: it sits on top of the controllers a system already runs (the Kubernetes autoscaler, a database's connection pool, a GPU's firmware, a building's battery controller, a power grid's tap changer, a robot's servo) and moves only the settings those controllers already expose to an operator, through one wire in (what it reads) and one wire out (what it writes). Everything the native controller does, it still does. Pull the plug and every setting walks back to where the operator left it (the lease); the kill switch returns them at once.

**What "native" means.** Native is the same stack, the same muscles, the same machines and the same work, run the way everybody runs it today: the shipped controllers at their shipped or operator settings. Every paired run has exactly two arms, native and omni, where omni is that same native stack with Omni-Compass on top. Nothing else differs between the arms, so whatever differs in the result is what Omni-Compass did.

**What a muscle and an organism are.** A muscle is one setting a native controller exposes (a pool's size, a power cap, a clock ceiling, a replica count, a battery's charge rate) together with the gauges that show what it does. An organism is a stack of muscles governed as one body: the muscles of one company's clusters, databases, caches, cards, cooling and power, read by one governor and judged together, so that no muscle is moved at another's expense. Chapter 2 sets out how a stack is grouped into one body; Appendix E lists every muscle Omni-Compass can be wired to, with what it reads and what it moves, and for every family the wiring on your own stack: the native controller that owns the muscle, where the reading is tapped, where the setting is written, how it is restored, and whether that wire has run live or on a model.

**What you see when it is hooked up.** Every paired run ends in a receipt with the same shape: the two arms side by side, every gauge of the system (the work done, the response times, the misses and failures, the machines and energy spent), the paired change with its 95% interval, and one word per gauge, GAIN, EVEN or LOSS (the key, above). A three-run table repeats the paired run three times, A, B and C, on the same engine version, and a word counts only when all three runs agree (chapter 13).

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**How to read a receipt, in order.**

1. **The engine and the evidence class.** The header names the engine version (`python3 tools/omni_version.py`) and the class (P, L or S; chapter 12). A receipt is never read across engine versions, and S is never read as proof about real equipment.
2. **The work and the service rows first**: work done, response times, time over the line, failed requests. These say what the system delivered. A GAIN here is the point of the governor; a LOSS here is the first thing to look for.
3. **Then the resource rows**: machines, energy, memory, connections. A cut is a GAIN. A rise is **power given**: what Omni-Compass put in to buy the work and speed above it. Read the two together: power given that bought nothing is a cost to find and fix, starting with the wiring.
4. **Then the noise.** EVEN, no difference beyond the noise, is a result, not a failure. The runs disagree means the test is unstable there and is looked into.
5. **Then the clock and the machine.** Where the test machine itself is the limit (its processor saturated, native alone failing a large share of requests), the receipt says so; a test machine's limit is never read as the governor's result, and the test is rebuilt so the machine no longer decides it.
6. **Every row is shown**, LOSS included. Nothing is cut from a receipt because it went against Omni-Compass.

**How the governor tells GAIN from LOSS.** The governor does not read a plus or a minus sign as good or bad. Before it moves anything, every gauge it reads is declared with its aim, and the aim decides the word: for time waited, missed or failed a fall is GAIN; for work done a rise is GAIN; for a resource spent or held a fall is a cut, and a cut is GAIN, while a rise is power given, kept only while it buys the work or the speed shown beside it. A slow knob moves only as far as a paired trial on that muscle has shown costs its own work nothing (section 1.2); a step that costs more is undone, and where no step passes the muscle stays native, which is EVEN. Inside a body, a step that would push another part past its cushion is refused, so no GAIN in one muscle is bought with a LOSS in another (chapter 6).

**Wiring it: who, what, when, where, why and how.** Read this before the wiring chapters; a governor wired without it may run and still not be the mechanism.

- **Why.** To get more work, faster, with fewer misses, from the machines and the energy already paid for, by letting one governor move the settings native controllers already expose, in the direction each gauge's aim asks, and only while no other gauge pays for it. If nothing can be gained, the purpose is met by leaving native alone.
- **What.** Two things per muscle and nothing else: one wire in (the gauges that show the muscle's state and its work, read live from the system, never typed into code) and one wire out (the one setting native already exposes to an operator, with its hard range read from the system). The governor does the arithmetic; the wiring never re-implements it.

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- **Where.** On top of the native controller, never in place of it: on the autoscaler's target and ceiling, not on the pods; on the pool's size, not on the queries; on the card's power limit, not on its firmware. Every muscle of the stack is wired into the same governor, so the body is judged as one.
- **Who.** The operator who owns the system grants each wire, decides which knobs Omni-Compass may write and which it only watches, and keeps the kill switch. The governor writes only what it was granted; the native controller keeps doing its own job.
- **When.** Watch first: the governor reads every wire and writes nothing until the wire check passes and paired runs on the operator's own system show the receipt. Then one level at a time (the eight levels, chapter 7). It reads and decides once a second, all the time; staying native is a live decision, made again every second, never a setting left on.
- **How.** The plug snapshots each setting once, at the start; the governor reads every gauge, places each muscle in its band, tries one step on one muscle at a time inside a body, keeps it only if the paired trial shows a GAIN and no LOSS, and hands every setting back to the snapshot on reset, on the lease after a crash, or at once on the kill switch. The proof is the receipt: native and Omni-Compass on the same work, every gauge, three runs, every row shown.

**What the end result is.** A system fully hooked up runs native exactly as before, with one governor reading every gauge of every muscle once a second and moving, muscle by muscle, only where a paired trial has shown a GAIN with no LOSS anywhere in the body; where it cannot help, the muscle stays native, which is EVEN, not a failure. The intended outcome, stated as the claim the receipts test: more work, faster, with fewer misses, on the same or fewer machines, with every unit of power given shown beside what it bought. Whether a given system gets there is answered only by its own receipts.

# Quick Reference: The Card for the Glove Box

Keep this page where the people who run the system can reach it, the way a driver keeps the card in the glove box. Every line is explained in the section named beside it; nothing on this page replaces those sections.

**What it is.** A supervisory governor on top of the controllers you already run. It never replaces them: it moves only settings they already accept, inside a band you set, and hands every setting back when it stops (sections 1.1 and 5.1).

**The two names.** *Native* is your system as it runs on its own. *Omni* is the same system with Omni-Compass on top. There is no third arm and no other name (section 1.1).

**The modes** (section 1.3).

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| Mode | What it does | When |
|---|---|---|
| Off (manual) | nothing; native runs alone | before installing, and whenever you choose |
| Watching | reads every gauge and logs what it would do; writes nothing | the first level of every installation (level 1) |
| Autopilot | one pedal: push for more, lift off for less, idle (lifted all the way) and reset, by its law | after the watch level has passed |
| Cruise | machines in service up to the pool's own top while a known queue waits | batch work |

**One pedal**, like an electric car's. *Push*: capacity added at once as traffic climbs, never held back. *Lift off*: capacity eased off a step at a time, handed back toward native, never below idle. *Idle*: the pedal lifted all the way, the floor of two machines in service, ready for the next burst. *Reset*: every setting handed back to where native had it, read back, and the record removed.

**The ways it stops, and what each leaves behind** (chapter 9).

| You want to, or it happens that | Do this | What is left |
|---|---|---|
| a run ends | nothing: the reset runs by itself at the end of every run | every setting at the operator's value, read back |
| stop everything at once, for any security reason | `python3 tools/omni_switch.py off` | every governor hands back and exits; none starts again until `python3 tools/omni_switch.py on` |
| stop one muscle | its kill file, or `OMNI_KILL=1` | that muscle handed back; the others run on |
| Omni-Compass dies without handing back (killed, crashed, hung) | nothing: the watchdog's lease hands back for it | every setting back at the operator's value, read back, as soon as the watchdog finds the process gone or its lease run out (chapter 9) |

**The eight levels of an installation** (section 7.3). Take them in order; go to the next only when the pass holds.

| Level | What it touches | Pass |
|---|---|---|
| 0 | nothing: `python3 verify.py` | `VERIFICATION: PASS` |

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| Level | What it touches | Pass |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | nothing: watch mode, with a read-only identity | zero writes, and readings your operators agree with |
| 2 | the pods, through your autoscalers (**WRITES**) | p95, p99 and failed requests never behind native, over paired runs (chapter 11) |
| 3 | the machines, through the release gate and the verdict (**WRITES**) | fewer machines in service, with no LOSS on any service gauge |
| 4 | the replica decision itself (an option, not a step) | as level 3 |
| 5 | a GPU box, two wires: the clock ceiling and the power limit (**WRITES**) | work per energy up or equal; no request more than 2% slower at the median, p95 or p99 |
| 6 | the processor's clock and power on bare metal (**WRITES**) | energy per unit of work down, no LOSS on any service gauge |
| 7 | site power and the supply-air setpoint (**WRITES**) | the site meter's energy down, every rack inlet inside its band, no LOSS on any service gauge (section 8.10) |

**Before any level that writes:** run the wire check (section 5.4), start in watch, and keep the master switch in reach.

**Warning signs, and the first thing to do.**

| You see | First | Then read |
|---|---|---|
| a service slower or failing more with Omni than without | `python3 tools/omni_switch.py off`: the system is native again | section 5.5, wired right or wired wrong |
| a setting at a value Omni-Compass did not write | nothing: it stops writing that lever by itself (one writer) | section 6.2 |
| a meter that is blind or late | nothing: blind means hold; it moves nothing it cannot see | section 6.3 |
| your results point the other way from the published ones | presume the wiring first, not the law | `DISCLOSURES.md`, section 4 |

**Who to call.** Licensing, pilots and the Omni-Compass Enterprise License: The Omni-Compass LLC, main office infrastructure, toll-free direct 1-888-339-9551, system route asset 1-888-DEX-YLL-1, landline 321-746-4411 registered in Florida, www.omni-compass.com. Security reports: the process in `SECURITY.md`, never a public issue.

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**What the letters of the number mean.** Read in order, DEX-YLL-1 is the way the engine runs:

| DEX | YLL | 1 |
|---|---|---|
| **Data Exchange**: the input. In software, data exchange is how one system's readings reach another. Here it is the two-way plug, one wire in and one wire out: the system's own readings come in, Omni-Compass's settings go out. | **Yield Limit Line**: the boundary. In engineering science, the yield limit is the most load a material can carry and still spring back unharmed; past it, the damage is permanent. Omni-Compass runs every muscle up to its own yield limit line, read live, and never past it. | **1**: the output. In code, 1 is true, the finished state; in science, 1 is unity, the whole. Here it is one closed loop: one body, one brain, every result read back and the next step decided from it. |

Read as one sentence: Omni-Compass takes the system in through a Data Exchange (DEX), runs every setting up to its Yield Limit Line (YLL) and never past it, and closes it all into one loop (1). Science and software people read each part on sight.

# Disclosures, Declarations and Disclaimers

This page is the one place every declaration about Omni-Compass is made. The README, the manual, the book, every guide and every report point here. Where any other page seems to say more than this page, this page governs.

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## What a result is, and what it is not

1. Every result carries its evidence class: **T** a theorem, **V** verified in code, **S** our own models (modelled), **L** live software (real Kubernetes on GitHub's machines), **P** a physical meter (a real card's own power meter). A model is a statement about the model. A software benchmark is a statement about the software and machine it ran on. Only a meter speaks for hardware.
2. The models were written by the same people who wrote the law. They show how the mechanism behaves; they are not an independent test.
3. On Kubernetes in kind every machine stays powered, so energy there is a declared model, not a meter.
4. Every comparison is paired: the same seed, load and clock with and without Omni-Compass, in an order rotated by repetition. Intervals are 95% intervals over the paired repetitions. Ratios across seeds are summarised as geometric means. Labels are assigned by code from rules written and committed before the run (`docs/GPU_PREREGISTRATION.md`, `docs/REALMS_PREREGISTRATION.md`, `docs/K8S_COMPASS_PREREGISTRATION.md`), never by hand.
5. Losses and failed runs are kept beside the wins (`docs/EVIDENCE_LEDGER.md`, `results/live/`, git history). The first real-card run, for example, saved energy (+3.6% work per energy, proven) and made the slowest answers 58.5% slower; it is published as it happened.
6. No result is a promise of a saving on any other system. No dollar figure in this repository is a measured result. Nothing here is a vendor certification, a safety certification, legal advice or investment advice.

## Do no harm, and the rule Omni-Compass keeps on every muscle

**What "do no harm" means** (the founder's words of 19 October 2026; this is its meaning everywhere in Omni-Compass, and it has no other). Omni-Compass has one goal: to strengthen the organism it governs and keep it healthy, working at the best state its own muscles can carry. Whatever is fed into the organism (its work, its data, its energy: its nutrients) passes through its muscles and comes out as its output. Omni-Compass's brain drives the organism toward the most and the best output it can make from what it is fed (the most work, done fastest, with the fewest misses and failures) while it keeps every muscle healthy.

- **Harm is judged at the organism.** Harm is the organism turning out less than its native controllers make it turn out (less work done; more time waited, missed or failed), or the organism made less healthy: a muscle pushed past its own limit, a service pushed over its own line, or anything made to fail. Omni-Compass does neither.
- **Every muscle only as far as it can go.** Omni-Compass can push a muscle only as far as that muscle itself can be pushed: its own limit, read live from the system, never past it. It finds the room each muscle already has and uses all of it. Whether its mathematics can draw a little more out of a muscle than the muscle was built to give is an open question; a measurement answers it before anything is claimed.

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- **The muscles work as one body.** Where one muscle's strength cannot be used without straining another, the brain offsets and engages the muscles together to bring the whole organism to its best state. It may use one muscle less, leave it native, or rest it, so that another can carry more, whenever the organism's whole output comes out ahead and every muscle stays healthy. Which muscles to drive and which to leave native is the brain's live decision, at every moment and in every run.
- **Reactive and proactive.** Like an immune system, the brain answers a breach at once, and it acts before a line is crossed.
- **Every row is still shown.** Each muscle's and each gauge's reading stays in every table beside the organism's, LOSS included. Nothing is cut.

**How the engine that stands keeps it.** The engine that stands keeps do no harm in its strictest form. By default it moves each muscle's settings toward more work, faster, up to the muscle's own limit and never past it (the max); on the dial anyone can tune it down toward the same work with less (the tune-down). Either way it keeps a step only where the muscle is never behind native for it: a step that costs the muscle more for each piece of work, or loses more than **2%** in any measure (work done, response time at the median, p95 or p99, time over the service line, or the machine's own cost of running Omni-Compass), is undone. A resource spent that rose is **power given**, shown beside the work, the speed and the wear it bought, never called a loss. Where no move passes that test, Omni-Compass leaves the muscle exactly as it runs alone. It takes nothing from one muscle to give to another: that form never harms the organism, but it leaves unused any gain that needs one muscle to give way to another. Letting one muscle give way so that the organism's whole output comes out ahead, judged on the organism and on every muscle's health, is the next engine version's work. It is built and proven in our own models first (the model gate), every benchmark is run again on it, and no result claims it before its runs exist.

**The factory tune: one tuned engine, and a tuning bench.** The engine in this repository is presented as The Omni-Compass LLC tuned and ships it: self-running, set at the factory. Every muscle in the catalog is wired and runs on the setting found for it (its own card where one was found on development seeds and kept under the strict rule, 364 muscles in `realms/muscle_cards_v5.csv`; the engine's own setting for every other), frozen and fingerprinted by version (`python3 tools/omni_version.py`); no setting is presented as universal. **Every published benchmark result is one engine at its one factory tune**: the engine its table names (`python3 tools/omni_version.py`), run again on each engine that stands. From omni-v17 that tune is held to a declared rule (`docs/THE_TUNE.md`, `tools/tune_study.py`): of the tunes that harm no gauge against native, the one against which no other tune tried reads GAIN on one service gauge and LOSS on none, searched on development seeds and read again on untouched ones; the claim is non-dominance among the tunes searched, never a global optimum. The live engine page and the control panel are a live tuning engine: every knob, button and monitor turns in real time (the beat, the dial, the pedal, each muscle driven or left native, up or down, in or out, minus or plus) to show the mechanism of action with native alone, with Omni-Compass on top, or both side by side; what it shows at any other setting is the engine's range, never a benchmark result. As on any engine, where the mixture, the intake, the exhaust, the firing or the pistons change what it delivers, **turning any knob of Omni-Compass can change every metric, up or**

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**down, in any direction a tuner chooses**: one engine for many vessels, tuned many ways, for many outputs. A licensee may add on, retune, upgrade or tune down any muscle or combination (the dial, the cards, the bands and the service lines are exposed); a changed tune is the licensee's own, and so are its results. The factory tune is published only where it reads no LOSS: a LOSS found in The Omni-Compass LLC's own runs is treated as a fault in the mechanism or its wiring, found and fixed before the result is published, never as a number to live with (the founder's order of 23 October 2026). The one place a LOSS is meant to be seen is the live engine, when a person turns its knobs away from the factory tune (the dial, the heartbeat, the sizes, the load) to watch the system react and the brain hold or recover: that showing is the proof that the mechanism can be broken only by leaving it, and a changed tune's readings are the licensee's own.

## The wiring declaration

**THE PUBLISHED BENCHMARKS ARE THE RECORD OF WHAT OMNI-COMPASS DID ON THE SYSTEMS, LOADS AND ENGINE THEY NAME, EACH WITH ITS EVIDENCE CLASS. WHERE A RESULT ON ANY OTHER SYSTEM DIFFERS FROM THEM, OR ANYTHING LOOKS WRONG, THE FIRST PRESUMPTION IS THE WIRING, THE SETTINGS, OR HOW OMNI-COMPASS WAS IMPLEMENTED OR READ, NOT THE LAW. CHECK THOSE FIRST (THE MANUAL'S "WIRED RIGHT OR WIRED WRONG") BEFORE DRAWING ANY CONCLUSION ABOUT OMNI-COMPASS.**

**Omni-Compass acts only through the wires it is given.** It reads the meters it is pointed at and moves the settings it is allowed to move. If a reading is the wrong one, slow, or blind; if a lever is the wrong one, already owned by another controller, or given a range (cover) that is wrong for the machine; if a band or a service line is set for a different workload; then Omni-Compass will do exactly what its law says with the wrong information, and the result will not be the published one.

Therefore:

1. **It cannot be slapped on.** Every installation goes through the levels of the manual in order (chapter 6), starting read-only, and every writing level begins with the wire check (manual, section 5.4) and a watch arm that must equal native.
2. **If your paired receipts differ from the published benchmarks in direction** (service LOSS, or no saving where one was shown), **the first presumption is wiring, not the law.** Confirm the installation with the checks in the manual's section 5.5 (*Wired right or wired wrong*) before drawing any conclusion about Omni-Compass.
3. **This has happened to us, and is published.** On the first real card (NVIDIA A10, 2026-10-02) the governor read being busy as trouble, set its power lid under the card's own working draw and allowed the clock under the card's own working clock; the card served bursts more slowly and the slowest answers were 58.5% slower. The cause was found in the card's own samples and corrected (`docs/GPU_PREREGISTRATION.md`, amendments 6 and 7). That is what a wiring fault looks like, and how it is found.

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4. Omni-Compass never writes outside a lever's cover, never fights another writer (it stops and leaves that lever alone), reads back every write, and returns every lever to the value it read before its first write when it stops or when the OFF switch is used. These protect the machine; they do not make a wrong wiring right.

## Safety and responsibility

1. Run watch mode first; run the wire check before any write; keep the master OFF switch (`python3 tools/omni_switch.py off`, the whole harness at once) in reach at every level, and use it at the first sign of anything wrong, a suspected breach included.
2. Omni-Compass is a supervisory governor. The machines' own controls (firmware, autoscalers, safety systems) stay in place and keep their own protections; Omni-Compass sets only values they already accept.
3. Do not connect Omni-Compass to safety-critical systems (vehicles, medical devices, grid protection, life safety) except as a modelled study, and never without the qualified review those systems require.
4. The software is provided "as is", without warranty of any kind, as stated in `LICENSE`. The operator is responsible for its use on their systems.

## Changes to the work and to this page

1. The software, the law's settings, the benchmarks, the results, the documents, the licensing terms and this page may change at any time, without notice. The version in the repository's `main` branch at a given commit is the version that commit describes; `RELEASE_MANIFEST.json` and `python3 verify.py` identify it.
2. Statements about work in progress, planned features, expected results and future runs are expectations, not promises. Where a result has not yet been measured, the documents say so (`docs/STATE_OF_PLAY.md`, `docs/DOSSIER.md`, section 8).
3. A signed Omni-Compass Enterprise License governs its own terms for its own term.

## Privacy and data

Omni-Compass contains no telemetry. It sends nothing to The Omni-Compass LLC or anyone else, and makes no network connection of its own except to the systems an operator points it at. Its logs and receipts stay on the operator's machines.

## Where everything is

| Question | Page |
|---|---|
| What has been measured, and how strongly | `docs/STATE_OF_PLAY.md`, `docs/DOSSIER.md`, |

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| Question | Page |
|---|---|
| | `docs/EVIDENCE_LEDGER.md` |
| The rules written before each run | `docs/GPU_PREREGISTRATION.md`, `docs/REALMS_PREREGISTRATION.md`, `docs/K8S_COMPASS_PREREGISTRATION.md` |
| How to wire it, level by level, and how to confirm it is wired right | `docs/OMNI_COMPASS_MANUAL.md` (chapters 4 and 6), the book `docs/OMNI_COMPASS_MANUAL.pdf` |
| The license, in plain answers, and third-party components | `LICENSE`, `LICENSING_FAQ.md`, `ENTERPRISE_LICENSE.md`, `NOTICE`, `THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md`, `PATENTS.md`, `TRADEMARKS.md`, `SECURITY.md`, `.github/CLA.md` |
| The muscles, what each is for and how it is wired | `docs/MUSCLE_CATALOG.md` |
| Proof the code is the code that ran | `python3 verify.py`, `RELEASE_MANIFEST.json`, `results/SEAL.json` |
| The live engine: every monitor, its feed and its knobs; the third manual, how to read and operate it | `docs/engine/OMNI_COMPASS_LIVE_ENGINE.html`, `docs/engine/monitors.json`, `docs/OMNI_COMPASS_LIVE_ENGINE_MANUAL.md` and `.pdf` (the Live Engine Manual's Appendix L, the page word for word: `docs/engine/PAGE_WORD_FOR_WORD.md`) |
| The whole organism, composed every way it is bought | `results/WHOLE_SYSTEM.md`, `tools/whole_system.py`, `docs/engine/export_whole.py`, `docs/WHOLE_SYSTEM_PREREGISTRATION.md` |
| The Python's runs that the live engine runs again | `tools/engine_runs.py`, `results/engine_runs/`, `results/heldout_seed_*/` |

## The whole organism, the cloud's back end, and the live engine

**The composition is a model of measurements.** `results/WHOLE_SYSTEM.md` (`tools/whole_system.py`) composes each layer's own measured ratio, native against Omni-Compass on top of native, into one benefit for a whole stack: the product law $R(g) = \prod_{\ell} R_{\ell}(g)$ gauge by gauge, its

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logarithm a sum with the variances added, each layer's runs A, B and C pooled by the inverse of their variances, and one index over the gauges with its 95% interval under two bounds (the gauges independent; perfectly correlated). No run here has stacked the layers: each factor is one layer's own run with the layers under it native, and the product assumes a layer's ratio does not change when the layers around it also carry Omni-Compass. That assumption is tested where the tables can test it (the governors' four ways), and the stacked run that replaces the composition is preregistered in `docs/WHOLE_SYSTEM_PREREGISTRATION.md`. Until it runs, the composition is class S of class P and L measurements, and every page that shows it says so.

**Every way a stack is bought.** The same law is read four ways (`docs/engine/export_whole.py`): on-site bare metal (the software on the owner's own racks and chips); through the cloud (the cloud's build, its bare metal at the back end and the software; and the cloud as two pieces, the back end left to the provider); in the device (Omni-Compass in the bare metal alone, the card and the machine); and as a service (the software alone, for an owner with neither bare metal of their own nor a cloud account). A piece with no measurement enters as exactly 1 and is named.

**The cloud's back end is not ours to meter.** Through the cloud, the bare metal belongs to the provider: no tenant can read its power meters or write its chips' limits, and no run here reaches it. The cloud piece's benefit is what the provider itself meters and bills, the machines counted every fifteen seconds and the bill at list price, read native against Omni-Compass on top of the cloud's own autoscaler; fewer machines held for the same work is also the provider's own benefit on its own hardware. The bare-metal piece is gauged on hardware we can meter (a card's own power meter; a processor's energy counter) and is carried to the provider's bare metal only as the same mechanism on the same kind of part, a modelled factor, never as a measurement of the provider's machines.

**The organisms.** The seven organisms of the catalog (the spine, the four realms, the four stacked, the tower), the orchestra beside them, and the whole stack composed above, counted by the founder as the eighth organism running native and the ninth with Omni-Compass on top of every piece. Every one is read native against Omni-Compass on top of native; none is a product.

**The live engine.** `docs/engine/OMNI_COMPASS_LIVE_ENGINE.html` is a monitor of the repository's records and of the engine's own mathematics running in the page. Every monitor carries its evidence class (P a physical meter, L live software, S our own models) and its state: live (the engine's port, proven equal to the Python and the C++ on every build by `docs/engine/check_live_engine.py`), a replay of a recorded run from its own files, a reading of the repository's tables, or built and awaiting its run. A monitor awaiting its run carries no invented number: its native lane shows what exists, its Omni-Compass lane stays empty, and the page names the run that fills it. The CPU host monitor plays the harness on its own modelled machine until a machine with its energy counter runs it; the GPU card monitor replays the one metered run of 2 October, made by a card controller replaced since, until its run on Lambda on the engine that stands lands. The kill switch on the page acts on what runs in the page: every Omni-Compass side follows native at once, and a recorded result changes its colour, never a value, a word or a row. The page's own seeded runs reproduce the Python's (`tools/engine_runs.py`) receipt by receipt, with one SHA-256 digest on each side; the

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500 scenarios of `benchmarks/stack_benchmark.py` are replayed from their record with every trace hash, not recomputed in the page. The wall's Grafana dashboard (`deploy/grafana/omni-compass-wall.json`) names the open-source exporters and series that would carry each monitor on a running system; the page itself reads no live system.

**The three manuals.** The Operator's Manual wires and runs Omni-Compass; the Owner's Manual holds the whole mechanism and every result; the Live Engine Manual reads the live engine top to bottom, monitor by monitor and knob by knob. Each carries this notice, the `LICENSE`, the `NOTICE` and this page, and none of them changes what a result says.

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PART ONE

# The Governor, from the Outside

*What Omni-Compass is as an installer meets it, how the muscles of a stack become one body, and how it is tuned.*

CHAPTER 1

# What Omni-Compass Is

A governor on a steam engine does not build the engine and does not turn the shaft. It watches the speed and moves the throttle so the speed stays in a band. Omni-Compass is that, for every machine you run.

It is a process on a host. It reads meters, decides, and writes only the levers it has been given. It is not the chip, not the GPU driver, not Kubernetes, not the building controller. Those keep running exactly as they do today; Omni-Compass sets the values they already accept.

Three facts about that process fix what an installation can and cannot expect of it. First, it is **one process per stack**: a controller that wakes on a fixed period, reads the stack's own gauges through the stack's own interface, decides, writes through the same interface, and reads back what the device took. It has no agent inside the pods, no kernel module and no hook in the request path, so it can add latency to nothing it does not govern. Second, every lever it may touch is **named before it starts**, read once into a snapshot, and handed back to that snapshot when it stops, is killed, or loses a sense; a lever it was not given it cannot reach, because the plug for it does not exist. Third, it has a **watching mode** in which it reads and decides and writes nothing, and every rollout begins there (chapter 7): the first thing an operator learns about Omni-Compass on their own stack is what it would have done, in a log, with the stack untouched.

What follows from those three is the shape of every receipt in Part Five. Because the native controller keeps running underneath, every paired run is the native stack against the same native stack with Omni-Compass on top, and never Omni-Compass against anything else. Because the levers are the stack's own settings, every gain is one the operator could have reached by hand, if they had been able to read every gauge every second and move every knob without ever being wrong; the claim is not a new mechanism but a steady hand on the mechanisms that exist. And because the process is small and separate, its own cost (processor time on the host, reads of the API) is recorded in every run and counted against it where it shows.

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## 1.1 Always on top of a native controller

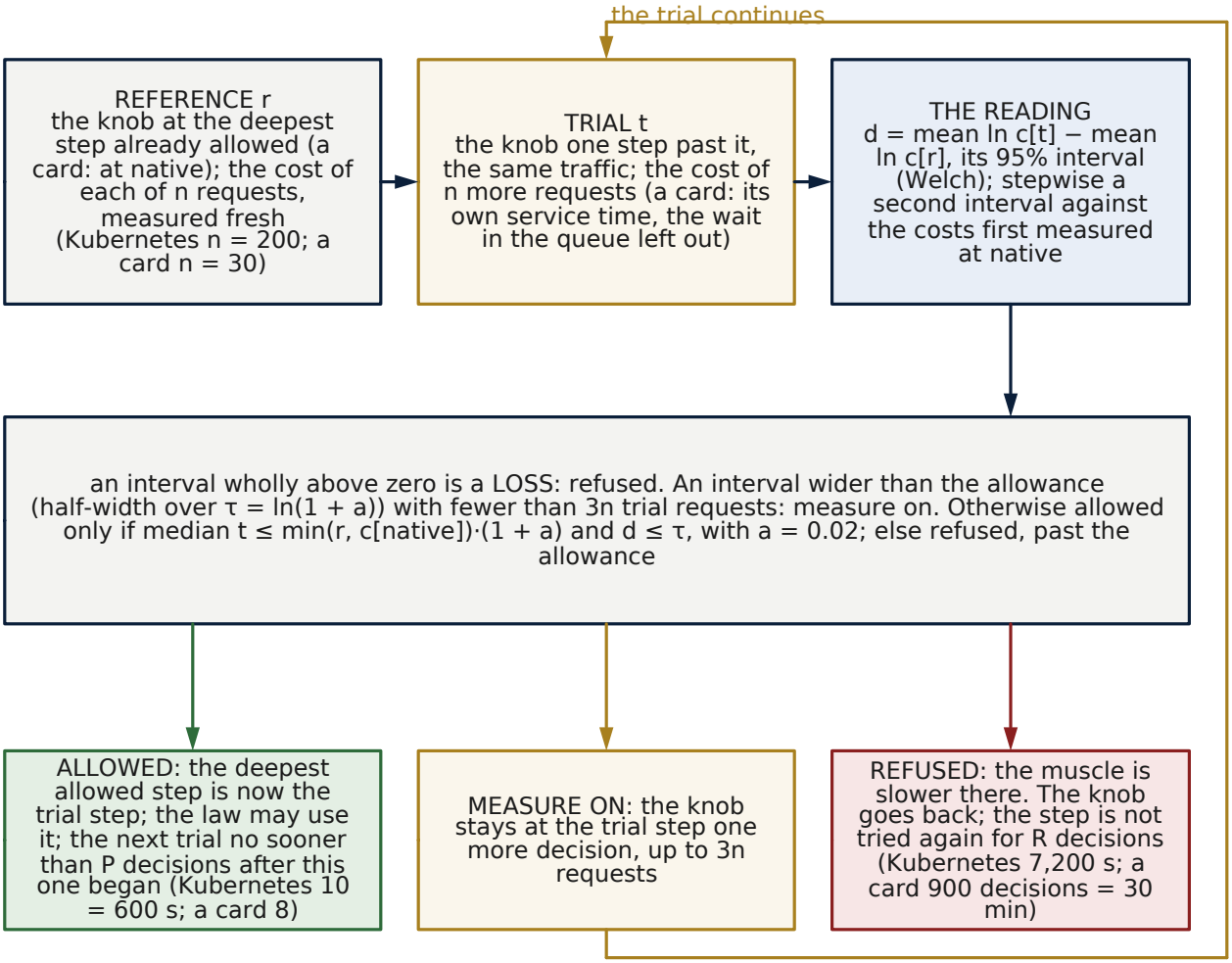
The first design decision, and the one every other follows from, is that Omni-Compass is **supervisory**. It never replaces the controller a system already has, never bypasses it, and never runs in its place. The Kubernetes Horizontal Pod Autoscaler keeps scaling pods on its own CPU target; Omni-Compass moves that target inside a range the operator allows. The cluster autoscaler keeps adding and deleting machines; Omni-Compass marks machines idle and lets the autoscaler do the deleting. The card's firmware keeps boosting the clock and enforcing its power limit; Omni-Compass sets the ceiling the boost may reach and the limit the firmware enforces. PgBouncer keeps handing connections to clients; Omni-Compass sets its pool size through the pooler's own console. Kafka's consumer group keeps rebalancing partitions on its own; Omni-Compass changes how many consumers are in the group, which is what an operator does. Redis keeps evicting by its own rule; Omni-Compass sets the ceiling that rule works under.

This fixes how an installation is judged: every paired run has exactly two arms, **native** (the system with its own controller, as shipped and as the operator set it) and **omni** (the same system with Omni-Compass on top). There is no third arm in which Omni-Compass replaces the controller, and no comparison in which Omni-Compass is a rival to it. A gain is therefore always "what the governor added on top of what the native controller already did", and a loss is always "what the governor cost on top of it".

## 1.2 Do no harm: the paired trial on the muscle

The second design decision is do no harm, and its meaning is the organism's (`DISCLOSURES.md`, section 3): the organism is never left turning out less than its native controllers make it turn out, nor less healthy, and every muscle works only as far as its own limit. The engine that stands keeps it in its strictest form: Omni-Compass must never cause a LOSS on any muscle, judged on the muscle itself, and takes nothing from one muscle to give to another. Before Omni-Compass moves a slow knob (a machine given back, a card's clock ceiling, a robot axis's speed, a drone's cruise override), it runs a **paired trial on the muscle itself**: the muscle's own cost per piece of work is measured at the deepest step already allowed and at one step past it, under the same traffic, with a set number of pieces of work on each side (two hundred response times on Kubernetes; thirty requests on a card). The step is read as a receipt reads a row, by the 95% interval of the change in cost: an interval wholly above zero is a LOSS and the step is refused; an interval wider than the 2% allowance measures on, up to three times the number; otherwise the step is allowed only if the trial's median cost and its mean change are both no more than 2% above the reference and above the cost first measured at native. A refused step is not tried again for a set time (two hours, 7,200 s, on Kubernetes, 120 decisions at the main engine's 60 s beat, 480 at a beat of 15 s; 900 decisions, thirty minutes, on a card). A trial that sees the service leave calm, or a phase that outlasts its limit (1,200 s on Kubernetes; 30 decisions on a card), is abandoned and the knob goes back, the step neither allowed nor refused. Where no step passes, the trial reads **left native**, the knob is never moved, and the receipt for that muscle says "nothing for Omni to move". Gains are not capped; the 2% allowance caps only what may be spent in the trial to look for them.

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The verdict stands over every slow knob (the machines, the clock ceiling, a cache's notch). A trial begins only while the service is calm and nothing waits; a phase that sees the service leave calm, or that takes longer than its limit (Kubernetes 1,200 s; a card 30 decisions), is abandoned and the knob goes back, the step neither allowed nor refused. The knob never passes the deepest allowed step, so steps cannot add up past the allowance. On the max, the Kubernetes machine count never gives back a machine the cluster had on its own.

**Figure 1.** Block diagram: the verdict's paired trial around a slow knob, read GAIN, EVEN or LOSS. The reference r is the cost of n requests at the deepest step already allowed (on a card, at native; n = 200 on Kubernetes, 30 on a card); the trial t is the cost of n more one step past it under the same traffic. The reading is the 95% interval of d = mean ln c[t] − mean ln c[r], stepwise also against the costs first measured at native: an interval wholly above zero is a LOSS and the step is refused; an interval wider than τ = ln(1 + a) measures on, up to 3n; otherwise the step is allowed only if median t ≤ min(r, c[native])·(1 + a) and d ≤ τ, with a = 0.02.

A refused step is not tried again for R (7,200 s on Kubernetes, 480 decisions at the 15 s heartbeat; 900 decisions on a card, 30 min). Steps cannot add up beyond the allowance, because every step is judged against the native cost too.

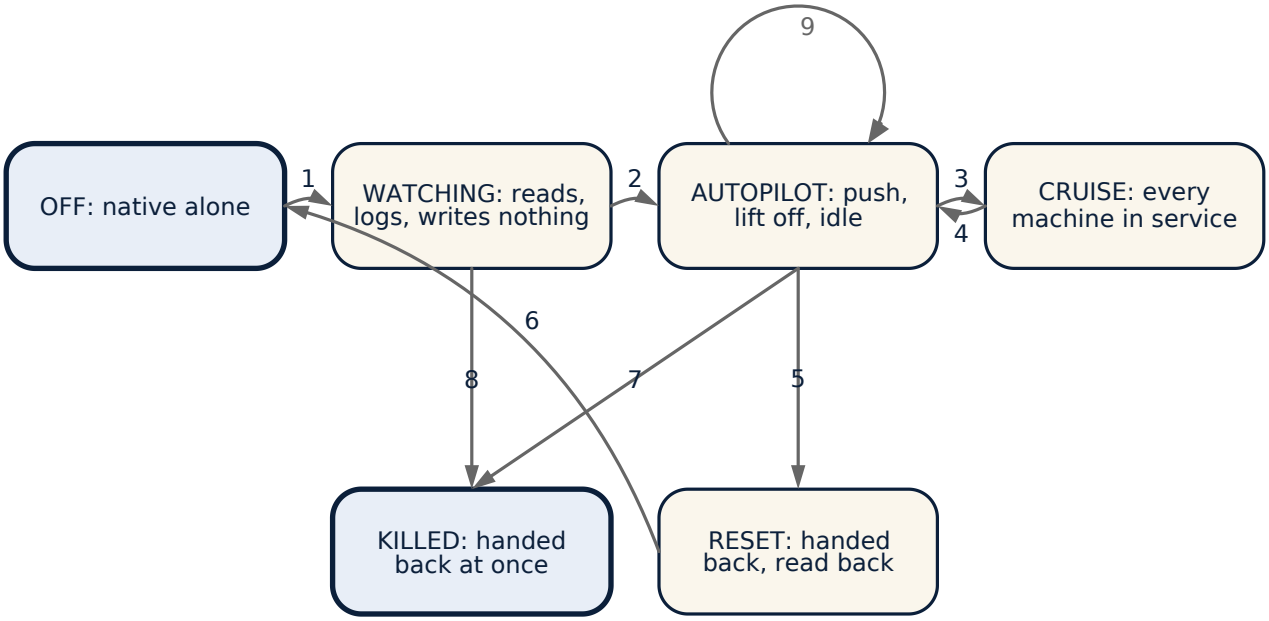
For an installation this has two consequences. A knob the operator grants is not a knob Omni-Compass will move: it is a knob Omni-Compass may move once the muscle itself has shown the step costs it nothing. And a

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muscle that never passes a trial is not a fault: it is the right answer for that muscle on that stack, and it costs nothing.

## 1.3 The pedals, the modes and the two switches

Omni-Compass drives a system the way a self-driving car drives itself: it feels, gauges and adjusts, with nobody in the seat. The vocabulary is used the same way everywhere in this manual:




1 level 1 · 2 the wire check passed; level 2 and up · 3 pods waited 2 decisions · 4 the line empty 2 decisions · 5 the reset file: the end of a run · 6 exit 0 · 7 the kill switch, from any mode · 8 the kill switch · 9 idle at once when demand is at zero

**Figure 2.** State machine: the governor's modes. OFF is native alone; WATCHING reads and logs and writes nothing; AUTOPILOT pushes, lifts off and idles; CRUISE holds every machine in service while pods have waited two decisions; RESET hands every setting back and reads it back at the end of a run; KILLED hands everything back at once, from any mode, on the kill switch. The numbered transitions are read in the key under the diagram.

- **Off (manual).** Omni-Compass is not driving; native runs alone. This is the native arm of every paired run.
- **Watching.** Omni-Compass reads every gauge and logs the decision it would take, and writes nothing. Any difference between a watching arm and native is the cost of its being there (its processor time, its reads) plus noise, never a decision; a watching arm that writes anything fails its run. Watching is the first level of every rollout (chapter 7).
- **Autopilot.** One pedal: **push** (traffic climbs and capacity is added at once, never held back), **lift off** (traffic falls and capacity is eased off a step at a time, handed back toward native, never below idle), **idle** (the

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pedal lifted all the way: calm traffic, the engine at its floor of two machines in service, ready for the next burst), **reset** (every setting the governor ever wrote is handed back to where native had it, read back, and the record removed; every paired run's omni arm ends with a reset and checks it).

- **Cruise.** For work that comes as a pile: when pods have waited for a place for two decisions in a row, machines go into service up to the pool's own top (read live: every machine of a fixed pool at once, a growing pool a step a decision) and stay there, without second-guessing, until the line has been empty for two decisions. In cruise the governor also stops its five-second floor reads, because every machine is already in service and the reads would only cost processor time on the machines the queue is using.
- **Idle at once.** When the work is done and demand is at zero (the service at its autoscaler's own floor, wanting no more, at half its target or less), the pedal is lifted all the way in one move, straight to idle, with every safety check still holding.
- **The kill switch.** Separate from all of the above, and for **security only**: one switch in a human hand (`python3 tools/omni_switch.py off`) turns Omni-Compass's governing off across the whole machine at once, for anything rogue, or for anyone trying to drive a system through Omni-Compass. Every governor hands back and exits; none starts while the switch is off. The reset is the end of a run; the kill switch is the end of trust.

The floor of two machines is an operator's number; lifting off never takes a system below it, however far the pedal is lifted. There is no ceiling: every machine the operator has is usable, and the protection is the band inside each machine.

## 1.4 Nothing is hardwired

Omni-Compass carries no table of per-stack special cases, and an installation adds none. The few numbers the governor holds are the same on every muscle and are declared, not chosen per benchmark: the centre of the band, the 5% cushion at each edge, and the 2% do-no-harm allowance. Everything else a muscle needs (how fast it answers, how often it may be moved, how far it may go) is read from the muscle's own declaration in the catalog or from the native controller's own settings at the start of the run, never typed in by hand. Where a stack needs a line, a cover or a step size (the MySQL pool moves in the server's own 128 MB chunks, the Redis ceiling in notches), the number comes from the stack being governed and is written down before the first counted run, so a reader of the receipt can see it was not chosen after the result.

For an installer this means one thing: the settings an installation writes are the operator's own (chapter 4), and nothing else is to be set by hand. A behaviour seen in a receipt is the governor reading the wires and the settings it was given; where it looks wrong, the wires and the settings are the first place to look (section 5.5), because there is no hidden per-stack rule to blame.

## 1.5 What it sets, muscle by muscle

Every muscle keeps its own control, and Omni-Compass sets what that control already accepts:

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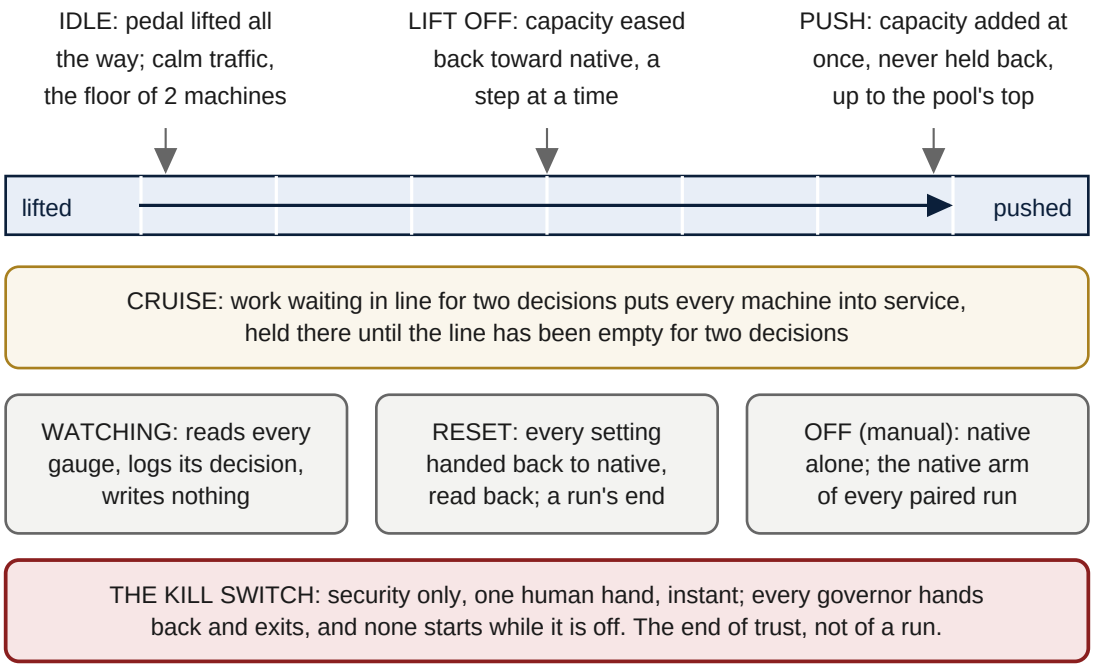



**Figure 3.** One pedal, no brake. Pushing the pedal adds capacity at once; lifting it eases capacity back toward native a step at a time, never below idle, the floor of two machines. Cruise holds every machine in service while a known queue waits. Watching reads and logs but writes nothing; reset hands every setting back to native and reads it back at the end of a run; off is native alone. The kill switch stands apart from all of these: for security only, in a human hand, instant. After a crash the lease walks every setting back to native on its own.

| Muscle | Its own control (kept) | What Omni-Compass sets |
|---|---|---|
| Kubernetes service | the HPA | the HPA's CPU target; replica floors |
| Kubernetes node pool | Cluster Autoscaler / Karpenter / MachineSet | how many machines stay in service (park and wake) |
| NVIDIA GPU | the card's firmware (boost, power and thermal limits) | the clock ceiling (up wire) and the power limit (down wire) |
| CPU | the kernel's frequency governor | the frequency ceiling |
| Data hall, building | the chiller and air handler loops | the supply-air setpoint; units in service |
| Battery site | the inverter | the reserve level; the peak ceiling |
| Robot joint, vehicle axis | the servo loop | speed and effort limits |
| Process loop, feeder | the PI controller | the setpoint inside its band |

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| Muscle | Its own control (kept) | What Omni-Compass sets |
|---|---|---|
| Database behind a pooler | PgBouncer's pool, the DBA's fixed setting | the pool size through the pooler's own console |
| Database's storage engine | MongoDB's WiredTiger cache, the operator's fixed setting | the cache size through the server's own console |
| Message broker | the consumer group at the operator's count | how many consumers are in the group |
| Cache | the operator's memory ceiling and eviction rule | the memory ceiling through the cache's own console |
| Substation | the tap changer's own controller | the tap position, one whole tap per move |
| Drone | the shipped autopilot | the cruise override inside the autopilot's limits |

When Omni-Compass stops, every one of those values goes back to what it was before Omni-Compass acted: not to the last value it wrote, but to the value it read once, before its first write.

CHAPTER 2

# Your Stack as One Body: Muscles and Organisms

## 2.1 The muscles you can wire

A muscle is anything with a meter and a setting: a compute pool and its machine count, a GPU and its clock ceiling, a chiller and its setpoint, a battery and its reserve, a feeder and its tap, a robot joint and its speed limit, a pump and its flow. Each muscle has a native controller of its own, which is what the muscle does when Omni-Compass is not there, and Omni-Compass wires to it through one wire in (the meter) and one wire out (the setting). The catalog (`realms/catalog_v5.csv`) lists **1,107 distinct muscles in 70 families**; Appendix E gives every one with what it is, what Omni-Compass reads from it, what it moves and the factory setting it runs on, and gives every family its wiring recipe (`docs/wiring_recipes.csv`): the native controller, the wire out, the wire in, the restore, and whether the wire has run live in this repository or only on a model.

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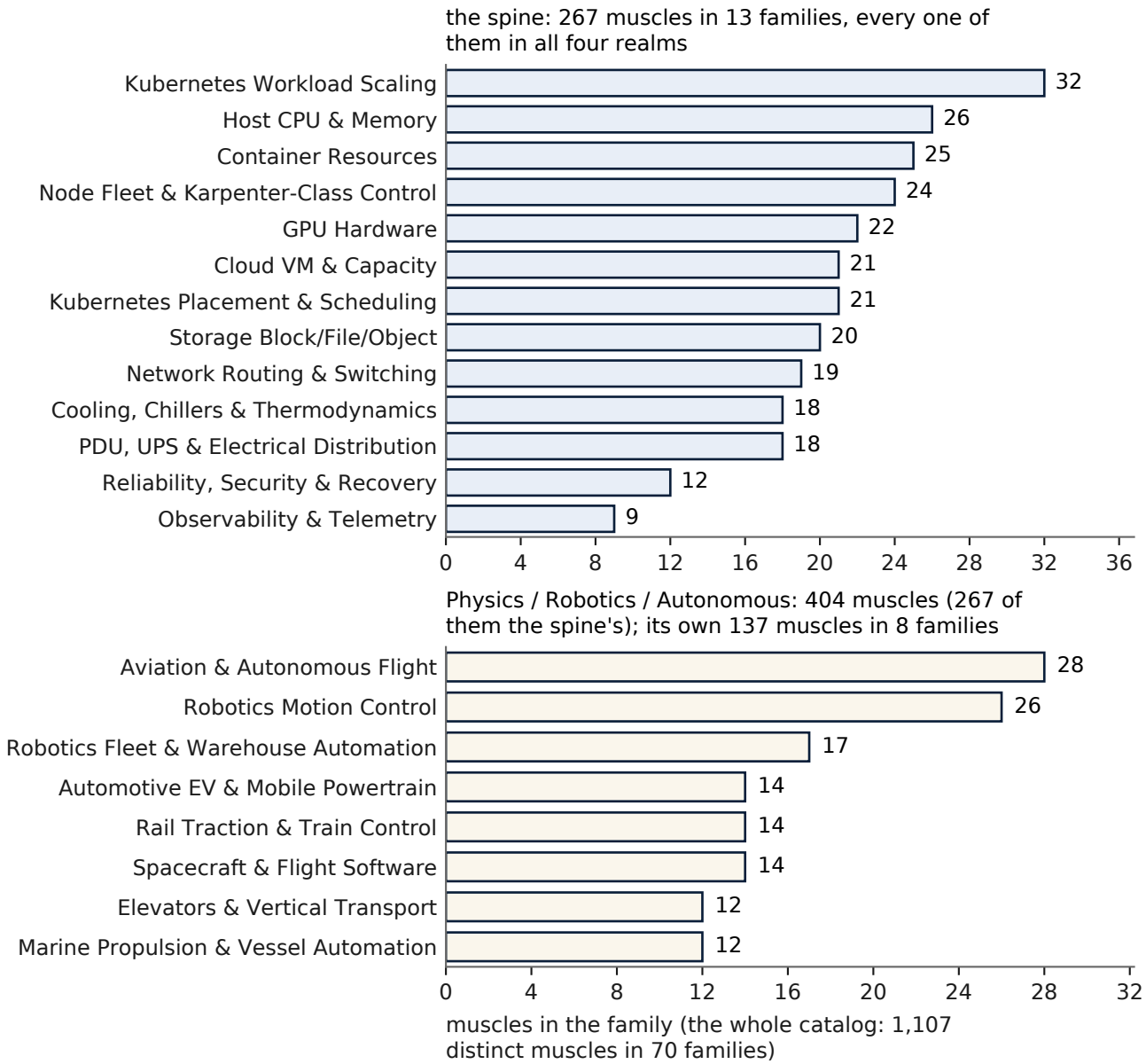



**Figure 4.** Grid: the families of the spine and of the Physics / Robotics / Autonomous realm, from realms/catalog_v5.csv. The spine's 267 muscles, every one of them in all four realms, in their 13 families; and the realm's own muscles, those it adds on the spine, in their families, by count.

The seventy families, by realm, are these. **Compute, AI and cloud** (twenty-seven): AI inference serving, AI training, blockchain and ledger nodes, CI/CD and build farms, cloud virtual machines and capacity, container resources, cross-cluster and edge placement, DPU and programmable IO, distributed cluster managers, game servers and real-time interaction, GPU fabric and RDMA, GPU hardware, HPC and distributed compute, host CPU and memory, Kubernetes dynamic device allocation, Kubernetes placement and scheduling, Kubernetes workload scaling (the largest family, 32 muscles), Linux kernel and operating-system control, media streaming, node fleets and Karpenter-class control, OpenShift and the Machine API, quantum computing

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control, serverless functions, virtualization and hypervisors, work admission and demand shaping, and the body's gut (data-plane intake and waste) and skin (perimeter and admission). **Physics, robotics and autonomous** (eight): automotive EV and mobile powertrains, aviation and autonomous flight, elevators and vertical transport, marine propulsion and vessel automation, rail traction and train control, robotics fleets and warehouse automation, robotics motion control, and spacecraft and flight software. **Energy, facility and industrial** (seventeen): agriculture and irrigation, building and critical-environment HVAC, cooling and chillers, district heating and cooling, energy storage and microgrids, facility and grid optimisation, grid transmission and distribution, healthcare critical environments, industrial PLCs and process automation, mining and mineral processing, oil and gas pipelines, PDUs, UPS and electrical distribution, pharmaceutical and food manufacturing, power generation and turbine control, renewable generation and inverter control, semiconductor fabs and precision manufacturing, and water and wastewater pumping. **Distribution and specialized** (eighteen): cache and memory services, commerce and payments, content delivery and edge caches, data analytics and ETL, databases and transactions, financial markets and trading systems, medical imaging and clinical systems, messaging and streaming, network routing and switching, observability and telemetry, ports and maritime logistics, reliability, security and recovery, runtimes and applications, search, indexing and vector databases, service meshes and API reliability, block, file and object storage, telecom radio access and edge radio, and workflow, logistics and fulfilment. The open-source power and resource managers many operators already run (Kepler, Climatik, EAR, CruiseKube, Goldilocks, the Kubernetes power manager, PEAKS, adaptive GPU power capping and NVIDIA's platform power budget) are muscles too, each in the family its knob belongs to: Omni-Compass sits on top of them as it sits on any native controller.

## 2.2 One body: the spine, the realms and the organism you build

An installation governs one body. The muscles of a stack, its clusters, databases, caches, cards, cooling and power, are read by one governor and judged together, so that a step on one muscle is refused when it would push another past its cushion (chapter 6). Under every realm's own muscles stands the same **spine** of 267 muscles (Kubernetes, machines, GPUs and CPUs, network, storage, observability, security, cooling and electrical distribution), because every realm's work runs on computers that must be scheduled, powered and cooled. The spine is an organism in its own right, the base every stack runs on as an operating system is the base of every program, and it is wired first (the chapter on the spine follows this one). The catalog groups the muscles into four realms and builds seven organisms, the spine first because the other six stand on it:

| Organism | Muscles | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| The spine (`spine`) | 267 | the muscles every real stack runs on, every one in all four realms: clusters, containers, placement, node fleets, cloud capacity, hosts, GPUs, network, storage, observability, reliability and security, electrical distribution, cooling; an organism of its own, the base of the other six |

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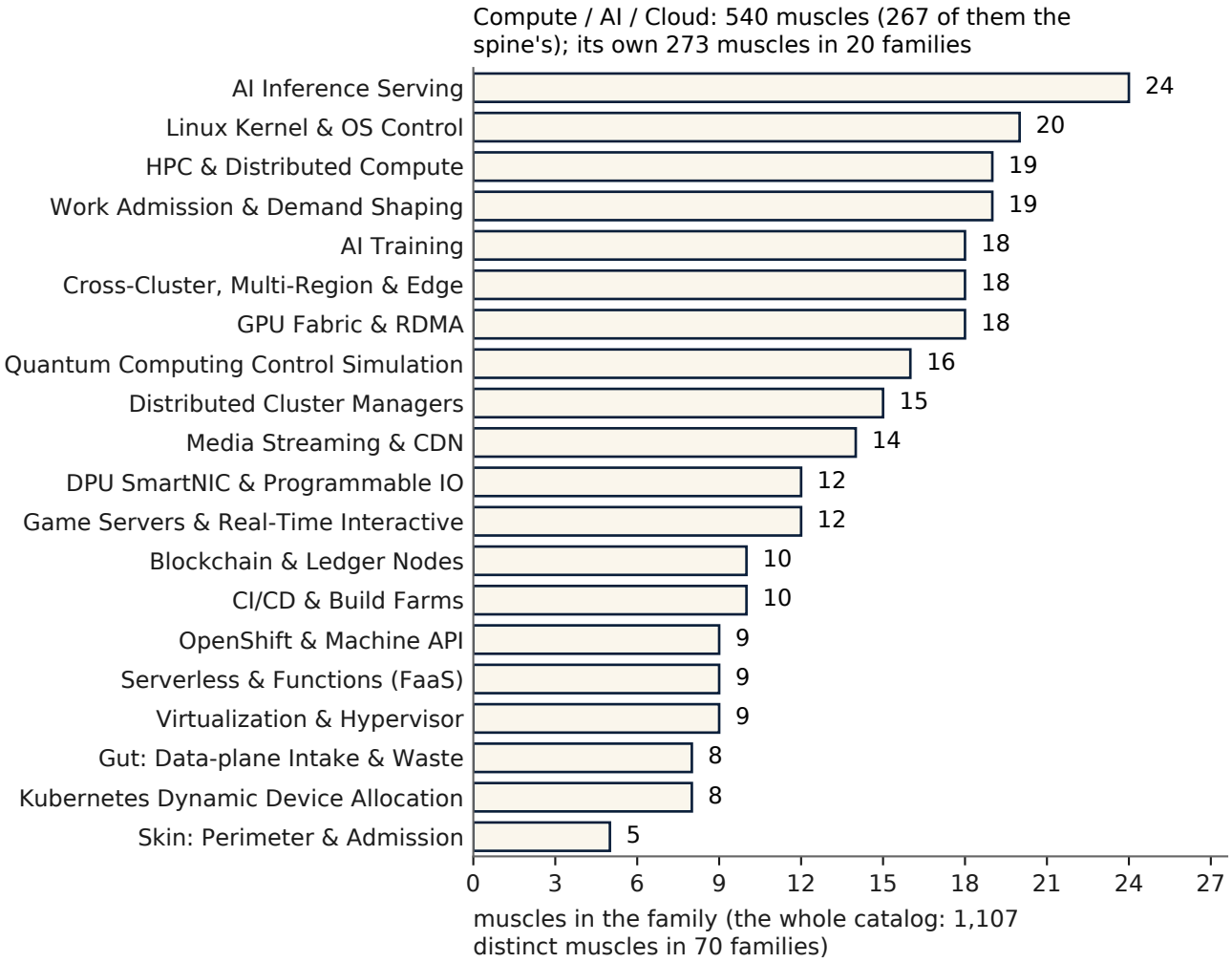



**Figure 5.** Grid: the families of the Compute / AI / Cloud realm, its own muscles on the spine, by count.

| Organism | Muscles | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| 1. Compute / AI / Cloud | 540 | clusters, GPUs, AI training and inference, cloud capacity, kernels, functions, media, games, ledgers, build farms |
| 2. Physics / Robotics / Autonomous | 404 | joints, fleets, vehicles, flight and spacecraft axes |
| 3. Energy / Facility / Industrial | 480 | data halls, buildings, batteries, UPS, process loops, feeders, hospitals, farms, pipelines, mines, district heat, power plants, renewables, pharmaceutical and food plants |

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| Organism | Muscles | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| 4. Distribution / Specialized | 484 | networks, storage, databases, commerce, trading, content delivery, workflows, radio networks, clinical systems, ports |
| 5. The four stacked, every duplicate kept | 1,908 | all four realms on one clock, the shared spine counted in each |
| 6. The whole tower, every muscle once | 1,107 | every distinct muscle on one clock |

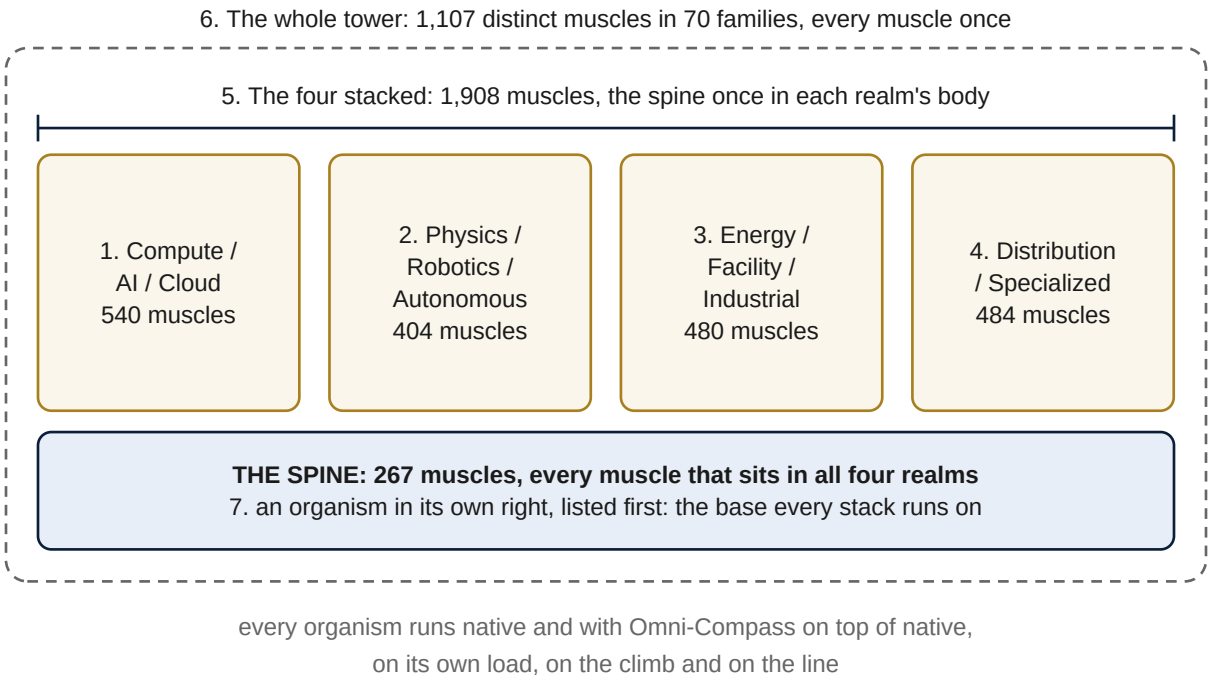



**Figure 6.** The seven organisms. The spine, the 267 muscles that sit in all four realms, is the base every stack runs on and an organism in its own right, listed first. The four realms stand on it; the four stacked count the spine once in each realm's body (1,908 muscles); the whole tower counts every distinct muscle once (1,107 in 70 families). Each organism runs native and with Omni-Compass on top of native.

**Building your own organism.** A real installation is rarely a whole realm. It is the muscles one company runs, wired in the order of chapter 7: the cluster first (its pods, then its machines), then the cards and the processors under it, then the databases, brokers and caches beside it, then the site under all of them. Three rules make the result one body rather than a collection of separate governors:

1. **One governor per body.** Every muscle of the body is wired into the same governor, so every step is judged against every other muscle's cushion. Two governors on one body are two brains, and the coupling

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between them (more pods feeding a database at its connection limit, more cooling pulling a power feed toward its limit) is exactly what neither would see.

2. **Every shared resource is a muscle or a gauge.** Where muscles share a power feed, a cooling loop, a connection limit or a network link, that shared thing is wired in, as a muscle where it has a setting and as a gauge where it does not (a site limit read in watts, a database's connection count), so the governor can see the coupling it must respect.
3. **A muscle with nothing to gain stays wired.** A muscle whose knob never passes a trial stays native, but its gauges still reach the governor, because its state may be what makes another muscle's step unsafe. Watched is not the same as unwired.

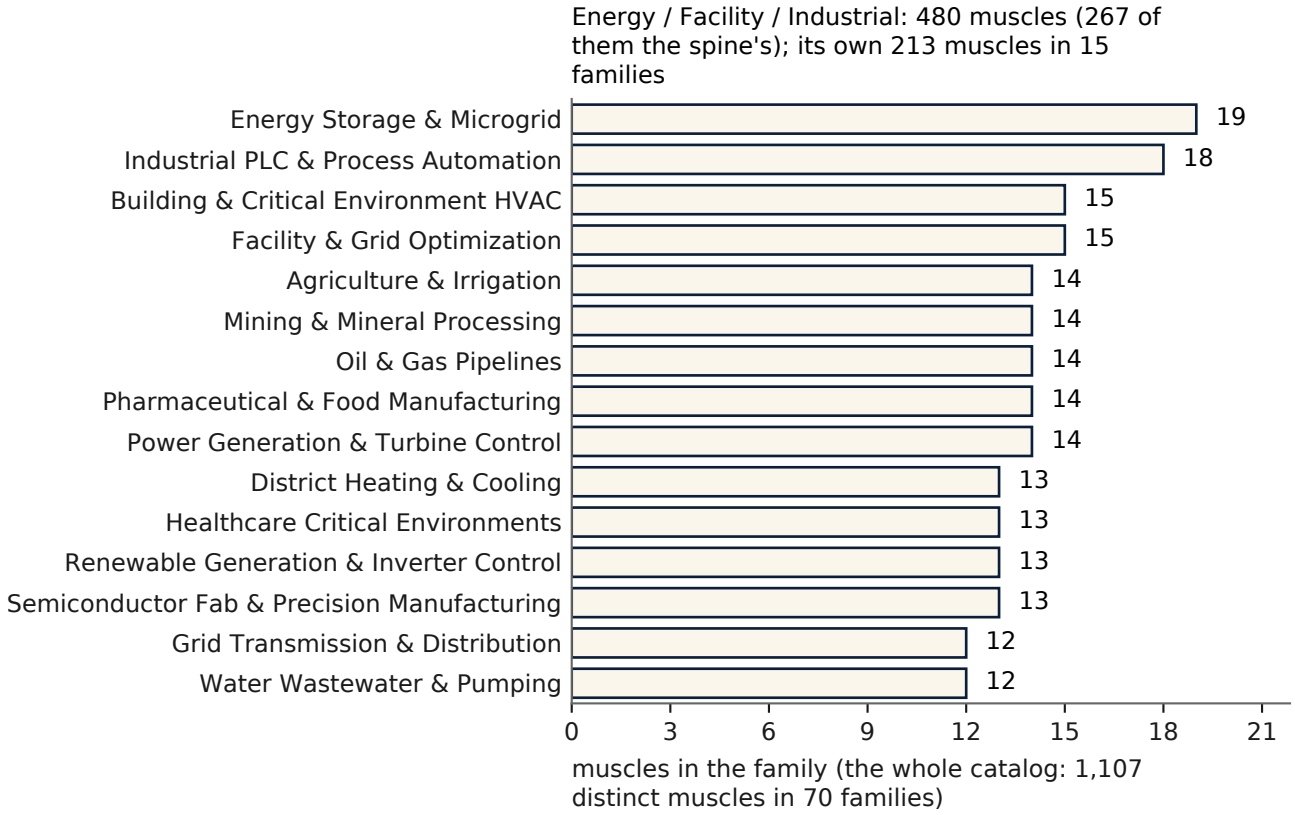



**Figure 7.** Grid: the families of the Energy / Facility / Industrial realm, its own muscles on the spine, by count.

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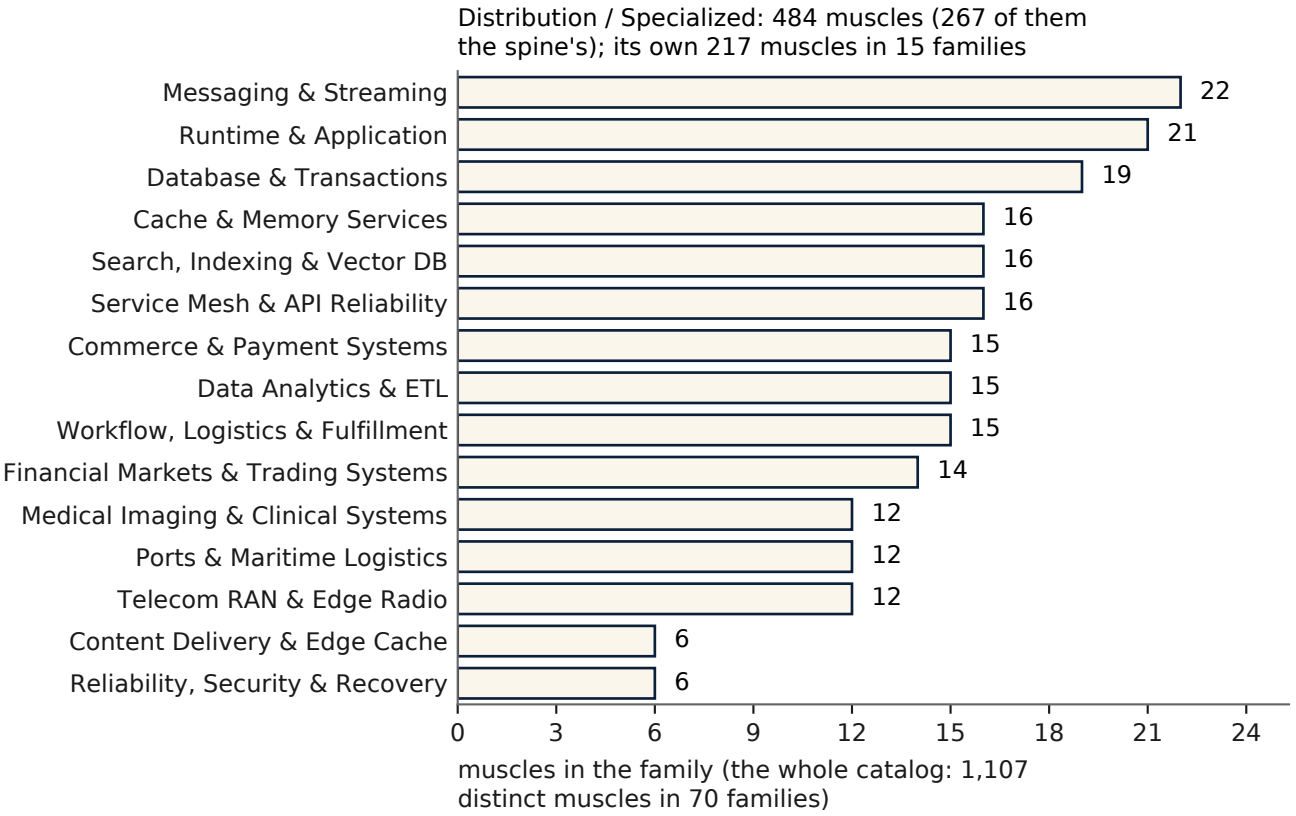



**Figure 8.** Grid: the families of the Distribution / Specialized realm, its own muscles on the spine, by count.

CHAPTER 3

# The Spine: the Base Every Stack Runs On

The **spine** is the set of muscles every real stack runs on: the 267 muscles of the 1,107-muscle catalog (`realms/catalog_v5.csv`) whose realm list names all four realms. A robot fleet, a trading system, a hospital's critical environment and an AI training pool differ in every muscle of their own trade, and they are alike in this: their work runs on computers that are scheduled, placed, given processors and memory, connected, stored, watched, kept alive, powered and cooled. Those thirteen families are the spine. Since 16 October (the founder's order) the spine is an **organism in its own right**, the seventh, run native and with Omni-Compass on top of native exactly as the other six are, because the base of a stack deserves its own reading before any trade is put on it. The relation is the one between an operating system and the programs that run on it: no program re-implements scheduling, memory or the disk, it stands on the system that does them; no realm's trade muscles re-implement the cluster, the fleet, the power or the cooling, they stand on the spine.

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## 3.1 What the spine is made of

| Family | Muscles | Plant model | Native controller class | The knob |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kubernetes Workload Scaling | 32 | compute pool (server) | the pod autoscaler, KEDA, the operator's rightsizers | replicas, targets |
| Container Resources | 25 | compute pool (server) | the vertical autoscaler, the scheduler's requests and limits | capacity, admission |
| Kubernetes Placement & Scheduling | 21 | compute pool (server) | the scheduler, descheduler, topology and affinity rules | admission, capacity |
| Node Fleet & Karpenter-Class Control | 24 | compute pool (node) | the cluster autoscaler, Karpenter-class provisioners | machines |
| Cloud VM & Capacity | 21 | compute pool (node) | the cloud's own scaling sets and capacity reservations | machines |
| Host CPU & Memory | 26 | compute pool (CPU host) | the kernel's frequency governor, memory and cgroup controls | capacity, power |
| GPU Hardware | 22 | compute pool (GPU) | the card's firmware: clocks, power limit, partitioning | clock ceiling, power cap |
| Network Routing & Switching | 19 | compute pool (network) | routing, queueing and buffer controls | capacity, admission |
| Storage Block/File/Object | 20 | compute pool (storage) | tiering, caching and throughput controls | capacity, admission |
| Observability & Telemetry | 9 | compute pool (server) | sampling, retention and scrape controls | admission |
| Reliability, Security & Recovery | 12 | compute pool (server) | disruption budgets, recovery and admission controls | admission |
| PDU, UPS & Electrical Distribution | 18 | energy storage (UPS) | the UPS and PDU controllers, their reserves and line limits | power, setpoint |
| Cooling, Chillers & Thermodynamics | 18 | thermal zone (data hall) | the chillers, air handlers and their setpoints | setpoint |

Two hundred and sixty-seven muscles in thirteen families: 156 capacity knobs, 48 admission knobs, 35 power knobs and 28 setpoints. Every one is listed, with its knob, in `docs/REALM_MUSCLES.md` (the spine first), and explained, wired and carded in `docs/MUSCLE_CATALOG.md` (the manuals' muscle appendix, with every family's wiring recipe from `docs/wiring_recipes.csv`: the native controller, the wire out, the

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wire in, the restore, and whether the wire has run live in this repository or only on a model). The muscles of the spine's Kubernetes families are the ones the live Kubernetes benchmarks run on real clusters (evidence class L); the spine as an organism is modelled (class S), and nothing in it is presented as proof of a real stack.

## 3.2 Why the spine is an organism

An **organism** is a set of muscles stepped on one clock, each from its own plant model with its own native controller, the whole fed one demand from one seed, so that the heat the machines make is load on the rooms, the power swing of the body is load on every site's line, and one brain judges every step against every other muscle's cushion. Run alone, the spine is a data center with nothing of any one trade in it: clusters, fleets, processors, cards, network, storage, power and cooling, and the governor on top of their native controllers. Three readings come from it that the realms alone cannot give:

1. **The base before the trade.** Whether Omni-Compass helps the machines every stack runs on, before any realm's own muscles are put on them. A buyer wiring only a cluster and its site wires the spine and nothing else.
2. **What a trade adds.** Each realm's organism is its own families on the spine. Read beside the spine's reading, a realm's reading shows what that realm's trade muscles add to, or take from, the base they stand on.
3. **The same base under four trades.** The four stacked carry the spine once in each realm's body, the tower carries it once in all. The spine run alone is the control for both: the same muscles, the same native controllers, no trade on top.

The spine is run under the same three loads as every organism (its own load; the climb, 1 2 3 2 3 4 …; work waiting in line), is judged by the same rule (work, speed and misses against native, the energy the max takes shown as power given), and has the same two arms and no other: **native**, every native controller alone, and **omni**, Omni-Compass on top of those same controllers, moving only the settings they expose, within their own ranges, and handing every setting back at the end.

## 3.3 How the spine is wired on a real stack

The spine is wired as any organism is: one governor per body, every shared resource a muscle or a gauge, a muscle with nothing to gain kept wired and watched (the Operator's Manual, chapter 2). The order is the order of the levels in the Operator's Manual, chapter 6, which is the order of the spine's own families: the cluster first (its workloads, then their resources and placement, then the machines under them), then the processors and the cards, then network and storage, then the site under all of them (electrical distribution and cooling), with observability and recovery wired from the first level, because the governor reads through them. Each family's wire is one row of `docs/wiring_recipes.csv`: which native controller owns the setting, where the reading is tapped, where the setting is written, and how it is restored. A realm's own muscles are wired after the spine they stand on, never instead of it.

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## 3.4 The spine in the runners and the pages

The organisms are groupings of catalog rows made in the runners; no engine file names them, so the spine entered the runners without changing the engine that stands (`python3 tools/omni_version.py` prints the same fingerprint before and after). In every runner the spine is `spine`; in `tools/run_scale.py` and the grid conductor (`scripts/dispatch_grid.py`) it is organism `7`, after the six that were numbered before it, so that every grid run already started reads back under its own number. Every table lists the spine first, because the other six stand on it.

| Where | The spine |
|---|---|
| `tools/run_realms_v5.py` | every muscle alone, then the seven organisms under three loads; the spine's row first in every organisms table (`results/realms_v5/REALMS_V5.md`) |
| `tools/run_scale.py --organisms 7`, workflow `six` | the spine at 1, 10, 100 and, on GitHub's own machines, 1,000 copies, over 1 to 1,000 paired runs |
| `tools/run_kil.py --organism spine`, workflows `six-kube`, `aks-metered`, `gke-metered`, `eks-metered`, `cloud-organism` | the spine with the real Kubernetes cluster inside it as one more muscle |
| `tools/run_hil.py` | the spine with the real card inside it (the GPU Hardware family is a spine family) |
| `scripts/dispatch_grid.py` | the spine's squares started, read back and never started twice like every other organism's |
| `docs/REALM_MUSCLES.md`, `docs/MUSCLE_CATALOG.md` | the spine's 267 muscles listed first; each muscle's organisms column names the spine |
| `results/realms_v5/`, `results/grid_v5/`, `docs/STATE_OF_PLAY.md` | the spine's readings, native against Omni-Compass on top, each named for the engine it ran on |

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CHAPTER 4

# Tuning: The Factory Tune, the Dial and the Settings You Write

## 4.1 The factory tune

Omni-Compass ships tuned. The engine in the repository is presented as The Omni-Compass LLC tuned it and ships it: a self-running engine, set at the factory, the way a vehicle leaves the plant with its engine already mapped. Every muscle in the catalog is wired and runs on the setting found for it: its own card where one was found and kept (section 4.3), the engine's own setting for every other muscle. The whole tune is fixed and fingerprinted by version (`python3 tools/omni_version.py`), so an installation can always tell whether it is running the factory tune or a tune of its own. Every published result is the factory tune of the engine its table names (`python3 tools/omni_version.py`), and is run again on each engine that stands.

No setting is universal. Muscles differ, and no single setting is right for every muscle, family, sector, domain or realm; none is presented as such. What the factory tune fixes is the starting point an installation can trust: each muscle on the setting that was found for it, every muscle wired, nothing switched off.

**One tuned engine, and a tuning bench.** Every benchmark result is one engine at one tune: the engine that stands at its factory tune. The live engine page (the Live Engine Manual) and the control panel's buttons (Chapter 10) are a tuning bench. On the bench every knob can be turned in real time: the beat, the dial, the pedal, each muscle driven or left native, up or down, in or out, minus or plus. It shows the mechanism of action with native alone, with Omni-Compass on top, or both side by side. Treat Omni-Compass as you would any engine. Turning the mixture, the intake, the exhaust, the firing or the pistons changes what a car's engine delivers. In the same way, **turning any knob can change every metric, up or down, in any direction you choose**, which is why one engine can serve many stacks, tuned many ways. What you read on the bench at a setting other than the factory tune shows the range; it is not a benchmark result. A tune you write is your own configuration, its results are your own, and they are read again, native against Omni-Compass, before you rely on them. The factory tune is not set by hand. Of the tunes that harm no gauge against native, it is the one against which no other tried tune reads GAIN on one service gauge and LOSS on none, searched on development seeds and read again on untouched ones. How that search is done is in the Owner's Manual.

## 4.2 The max, and the dial that tunes it down

The factory setting is **the max**: every muscle runs up to its own limit, read live from the system, never past it and never below what native gives. It rides the edge of each muscle's range, not the middle. The energy it

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takes to do more work is **power given**, shown beside the work, the speed and the wear it bought, never called a loss; on the engine that stands the max takes nothing from one muscle to give to another. A knob that native already runs at the top of its range is "at its limit on native", and the max leaves it there.

The **dial** turns the max down. It has two positions, the same on every live controller:

| Position | Switch | What it does |
|---|---|---|
| **max** (the default) | `--dial max`, or `OMNI_DIAL=max` | the most work, faster: the service held well inside its line so every rush finds its capacity already there; never a machine given back below what the system ran on its own; on a card, the clock ceiling never stepped below the top while the card serves |
| **save** (the tune-down) | `--dial save`, or `OMNI_DIAL=save` | native's work on the least resource: the service held nearer its line, machines and clock steps given back where the paired trial on the muscle shows the response time allows (section 1.2) |

The tune-down never does less work than native and never misses its line more often; it spends less to do the same. An installation chooses its position per governor, writes the choice down before its paired runs, and reads every receipt against the position it ran.

## 4.3 Each muscle's own card

The governor is one, but its settings are each muscle's own. A muscle's **card** holds the numbers the max uses for that muscle alone: for a machine pool, how full it runs on its forecast before it calls for more and how many decisions of history it reads; for a battery, how many wobbles of margin it keeps under its line and, where it is wired by its power, how long it reads its line before it holds and how much of it it keeps clear. The cards were found by a search over every muscle on development cases only, today's engine setting always one of the choices, and a card was kept only where it beat the engine setting beyond the noise on two separate sets of cases and was never behind native on any case under any load (never over its line more often, never less work, never its line cleared later). 364 muscles carry one (`realms/muscle_cards_v5.csv`); every card is written out in plain words with its muscle in Appendix E; the rest run the engine setting. Inside a body, a battery wired by its power keeps the body's own margins on its line, because the line carries the whole body's swing, which the card chosen for the battery alone never saw.

An installation reads a muscle's card before it wires that muscle, so that the receipt can be read against the setting the muscle actually ran on.

## 4.4 The settings an installation writes

Everything else an installation writes is the operator's own, taken from the operator's own system and objectives, and written down before the first counted run:

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| Setting | What it is | Where it comes from |
|---|---|---|
| **The line** (`--slo-ms`, or the stack's own line) | the response time, or other limit, the service must meet | the operator's own service objective, never ours |
| **The band** | the reading's range from calm to the line; on a service, from a tenth of the line (the bare service time) to the line | the line, by rule |
| **The cushions** | the last 5% of the band at each edge, 10% in all; a reading in a cushion is treated as already too close to the edge | fixed, the same on every muscle |
| **The centre** (`--compass-center`) | where in the band the governor holds the reading: 0.3 at the max, 0.4 at the tune-down, unless the operator writes another | the dial, or the operator |
| **The cover** | the knob's hard range; every write is clipped to it | read from the system (the autoscaler's range, the card's supported clocks, the pooler's connection limit), or written by the operator inside it |
| **The ceiling of a growing lever** (`--replica-ceiling`, the machine lever's top) | how far a lever that can keep adding may go | read live by default: what the machines can hold, one under it; an operator may write a lower one, or 0 to keep native's own cap |
| **The floor** | the least a pool may run on | two machines by default; never below 1 for any muscle |
| **The allowance** (`--allow`) | the most a step on trial may cost the muscle's own work | 2%, the same on every muscle |
| **The site's limits** (`--site-limit-w`, `--cooling-min-c`, `--cooling-max-c`, `--cooling-restore-c`) | the facility's power limit and the setpoint band | the facility engineer, inside the equipment's ratings |
| **Setting** | **What it is** | **Where it comes from** |
| **The heartbeat** (`--interval`) | how often the governor takes its full decision: the main engine | the factory's 60 s, or the operator's own beat; the live engine page |

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| Setting | What it is | Where it comes from |
|---|---|---|
| | every 60 s, a dial from 5 to 120 s; the fast checks stay every 5 s | shows every beat beside native, with what it buys and what it costs (the page's section 2d) |

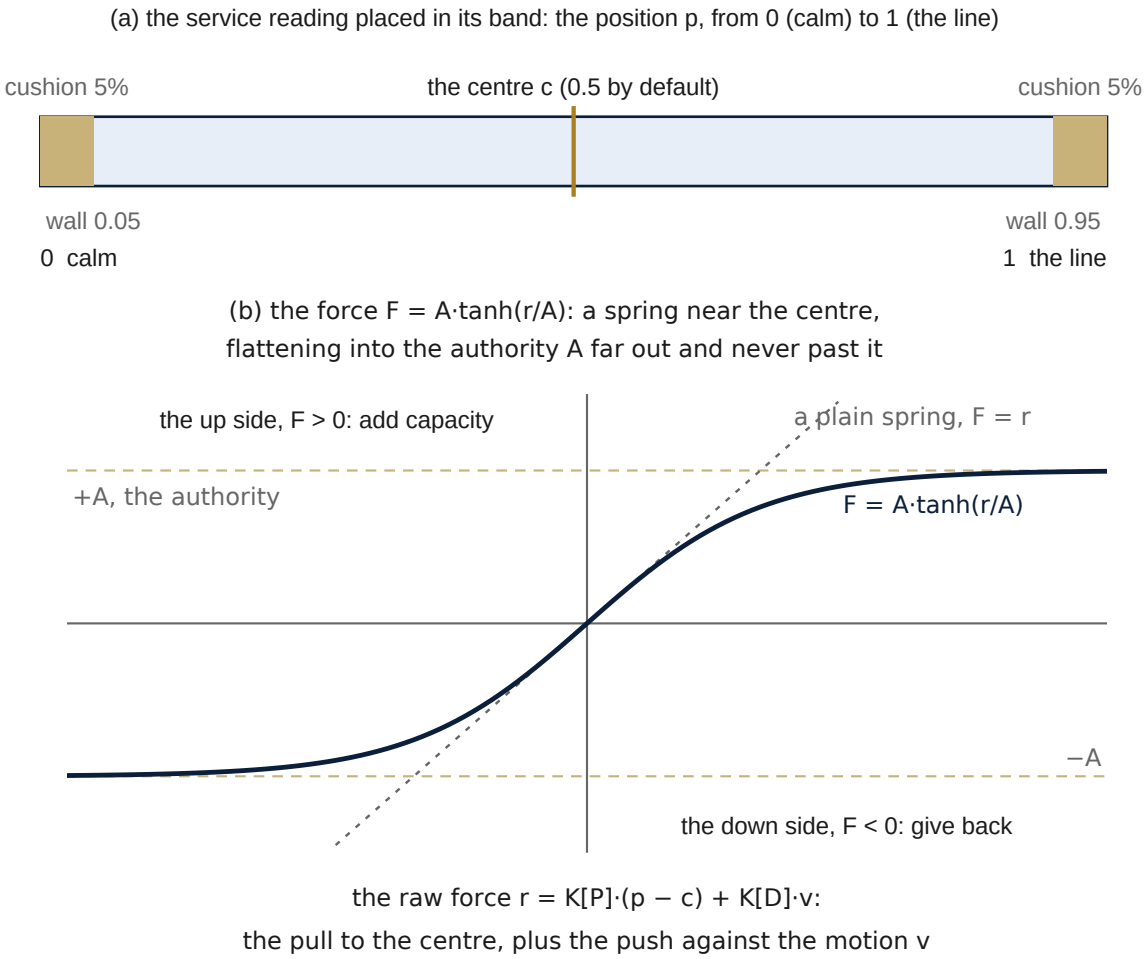



**Figure 9.** The compass band and the smoothing of the force. (a) The service reading placed in its band as a position p from 0, calm, to 1, the operator's line; the walls at 0.05 and 0.95 leave a cushion of 5% at each edge, and the centre c is where the needle comes to rest (0.5 by default; on a service 0.3 at the max and 0.4 at the tune-down).

(b) The force F = A·tanh(r/A) against the raw force r = K[P]·(p − c) + K[D]·v, the pull toward the centre plus the push against the reading's motion: near the centre a spring, far out a curve that flattens into the authority A and never passes it. Past the upper wall the up side goes to A at once, and the down side may not act until the reading is back inside the band.

Two settings are deliberately not on that list. The governor's damping and how fast each muscle answers are the muscle's own declaration, read from the catalog or measured from the system at the start; an installation

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does not tune them, and a receipt that needed them changed is a receipt to read as wiring first (section 5.5). The heartbeat is on the list since omni-v17: every rule the governor keeps counts seconds, so the beat changes only how often it looks, and an operator may set any beat, a fast one for its reads of the cluster at the cost of the governor's own processor, or a slow one. Each beat may want its own combination of the other settings; a beat other than 60 s is the operator's own configuration and its results are its own (section 4.7).

## 4.5 Profiles: service and batch

The governor has two **profiles**, service (the default) and batch, which differ only in what the pedals do with a pile of work: in the service profile the governor paces the slack; in the batch profile, cruise puts every machine in service while work waits for a place, and idle takes them straight to the floor when the queue is done (section 1.3). An installation running a queue of jobs chooses batch for that service and service for everything else, and writes the choice down beside the dial's position.

## 4.6 Profiles: factory, candidate, active and custom; the two restoring controls

Omni-Compass consists of a governing engine, its muscle adapters, a complete configuration profile and a validation harness. Four words name the profile, and they are kept apart in every log, page and report:

| Profile | What it is |
|---|---|
| Factory profile | The complete, versioned set of Omni-Compass default settings shipped together: the factory tune of section 4.1. |
| Candidate profile | A proposed combination of settings undergoing evaluation; never published as a result. |
| Active profile | The settings actually governing the current run, as the governor's own audit records them. |
| Custom profile | An identifiable configuration differing from the released factory profile: yours, with its own receipts. |

"One setting" means one complete profile: the beat, the dial, the band, the waits, the cards and which muscles are driven, read together, since turning one can move what another does. Freezing the factory profile fixes the released rules and default tuning; the engine's internal state, its commands and the resources it moves keep answering the system as it changes.

**Start from the factory profile.** Install, wire and run with no setting of your own (Chapters 5 to 10): that is the factory profile, and `python3 tools/omni_version.py` names the engine it belongs to. **Make a custom profile** by writing the settings you change on the governor's command line or through the control panel (Chapter 10), each with its reason; the governor records its active profile in its audit at every start, so a run always says which profile governed it.

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**Read the command's acknowledgement.** Every setting lives in three states, kept apart in the audit and on the control panel: the setting requested, the setting the panel accepted (pending until the governor reads it applied at its next decision), and the setting the system acknowledged when it was read back. A refused request changes nothing and says why (a missing role, a value out of range, a muscle's own limit).

**Two controls restore, and they mean different things. Restore factory profile** reapplies the released Omni-Compass configuration: every knob back, Omni-Compass still governing. **Return to native** hands governance back and restores native's own recorded settings as the adapter supports (the kill switch, Chapter 10): Omni-Compass stops governing. Use the first to leave a custom profile; use the second to take Omni-Compass out of the loop.

## 4.7 A changed tune is your own configuration

As with any engine, a licensee may add on, retune, upgrade or tune down any muscle or any combination of muscles: the dial, the cards, the bands and the service lines are all exposed. A changed tune is the licensee's own configuration, and its receipts are its own, never the published ones. The discipline for a changed tune is the discipline for the factory tune: write the change down before the paired runs, run native and omni three times on it, show every row, and read the receipts against the tune that ran. Where a changed tune reads differently from the factory tune, the change is the first thing to look at, and then the wiring.

## 4.8 The output follows the input

Every number Omni-Compass produces is the result of three inputs, and a reader who changes any one of them has changed the result: **the tune** (the factory tune as shipped, or the dial turned down, or a card changed), **the wiring** (which muscles are wired in and which are watched, what each wire reads and writes, how fresh each feed is) and **the load** (the work offered, its shape and its line). The published receipts are the record of one setting of all three, and every receipt names it: the engine's fingerprint, the harness, the load and the window. The same engine wired onto another stack, or tuned to another purpose, gives another result, and that result is its own.

A team that wants a different outcome sets the inputs for it and reads its own receipts against native: the most work at any spend (the max, the default); the same work as native for a smaller bill (the tune-down on the machines alone, the cloud's rule); a muscle held at a limit of the team's own choosing (its card, or its cover); a knob left native (watched, never written). Each of those is a legitimate setting of the inputs, and each has its own result. What no reader may do is read one tune's receipt as another's, or read a receipt without its inputs. The factory tune (section 4.1) is the one setting whose receipts this book publishes; the dial (section 4.2) and the cards (section 4.3) are the inputs a licensee may change, and section 4.6 says what a changed tune's results are. Where a result read elsewhere differs from the published one, the first presumption is an input: the wiring, the settings or the reading (`DISCLOSURES.md`, section 4).

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PART TWO

# The Harness: Plugs, Wires and the Rules They Obey

*The universal plug, the adapters, the wire check that must pass before anything writes, and the rules every wire obeys.*

CHAPTER 5

# The Plug, the Adapters and the Wire Check

Think of a high-end car stereo: one head unit, one standard plug on its back, and an adapter harness for each make of car that matches the car's factory plug. You never cut a factory wire, and when you pull the stereo, the car works as it did. Omni-Compass is wired the same way.

## 5.1 The plug (one design for every muscle)

Each plug has as many channels as its muscle has knobs. Every channel declares its cover (range), its direction (which way is "more"), its units and how fast it may move. Every plug keeps the same five-line contract, and an adapter for a new muscle is written to it:

1. **attach** - read the knob once, before any write: the snapshot. It never moves afterwards.
2. **read** - the service reading, placed in its band.
3. **write** - one value, clipped to the cover, then read back from the device.
4. **one writer** - if the knob is found at a value Omni-Compass did not write, someone else owns it: Omni-Compass stops writing and leaves that value alone.
5. **restore** - on stop, the knob returns to the snapshot (where Omni-Compass found it, not the last value it wrote). For muscles whose native controller moves the knob itself, restore hands control back.

## 5.2 Adapters (one per standard plug)

Omni-Compass speaks each industry's standard control interface through an adapter. Status is stated plainly:

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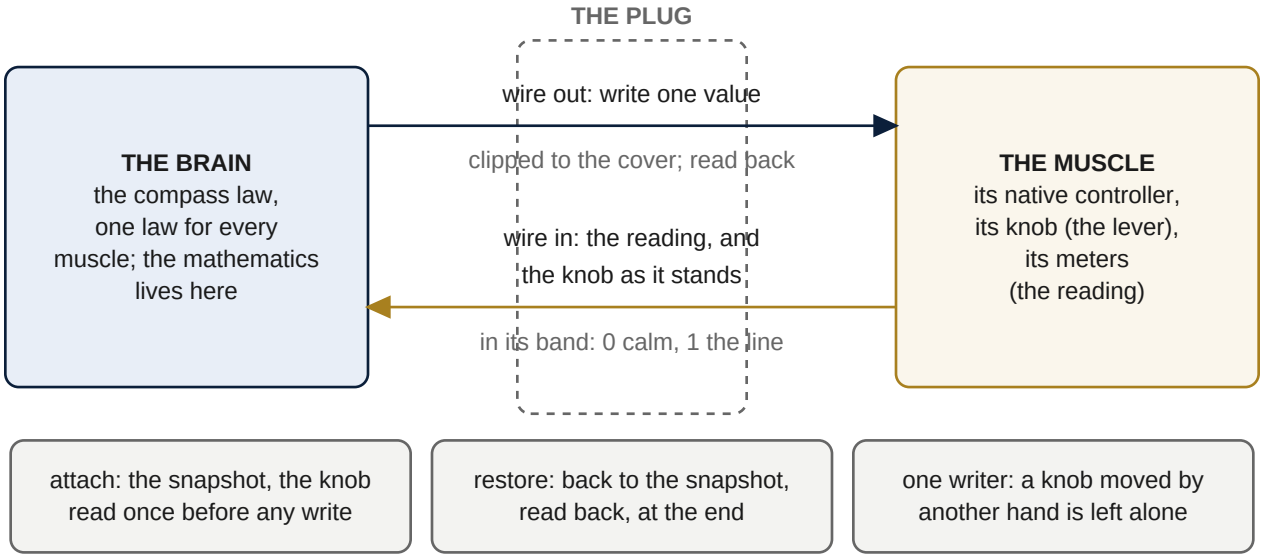



**Figure 10.** The two-way plug. One wire out carries the governor's write, one value per decision, clipped to the knob's cover and read back from the device; one wire in carries the muscle's reading, placed in its band, and the knob as it stands. The snapshot taken at attach, before any write, is the restore point, and a knob found where the governor did not put it belongs to another writer and is left alone. The brain holds the mathematics; the plug holds nothing but the contract.

| Standard | Muscles | Adapter status |
|---|---|---|
| Kubernetes API | HPAs, deployments, pods, nodes | **built** (`python3 -m omni_controller.controller`) |
| NVIDIA NVML / `nvidia-smi` | GPU clock ceiling, power limit | **built** (`python3 -m omni_controller.gpu_compass`, two wires; `omni_controller.gpu_governor`, one wire) |
| Linux cpufreq, RAPL | CPU frequency ceiling, package watts | **built** (`--cpufreq-policy-root`, `--rapl-cmd`) |
| Site meter, building controller by command | site watts, supply-air setpoint | **built** (`--power-cmd`, `--cooling-cmd` command templates) |
| Cloud node groups (Karpenter, Cluster Autoscaler, MachineSet) | machines | **built** through `--node-scale-cmd` templates |

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| Standard | Muscles | Adapter status |
|---|---|---|
| BACnet, Modbus, SNMP | chillers, air handlers, PDUs, UPS | designed; today reached through the command templates above |
| OPC UA, EtherNet/IP, PROFINET, EtherCAT, ROS 2, CAN | PLCs, drives, robots, vehicles | designed; reached today through a command template written to the plug's contract |
| IEC 61850, DNP3, OpenADR, IEEE 2030.5, SunSpec, OCPP | substations, batteries, inverters, chargers | designed; reached today through a command template written to the plug's contract |

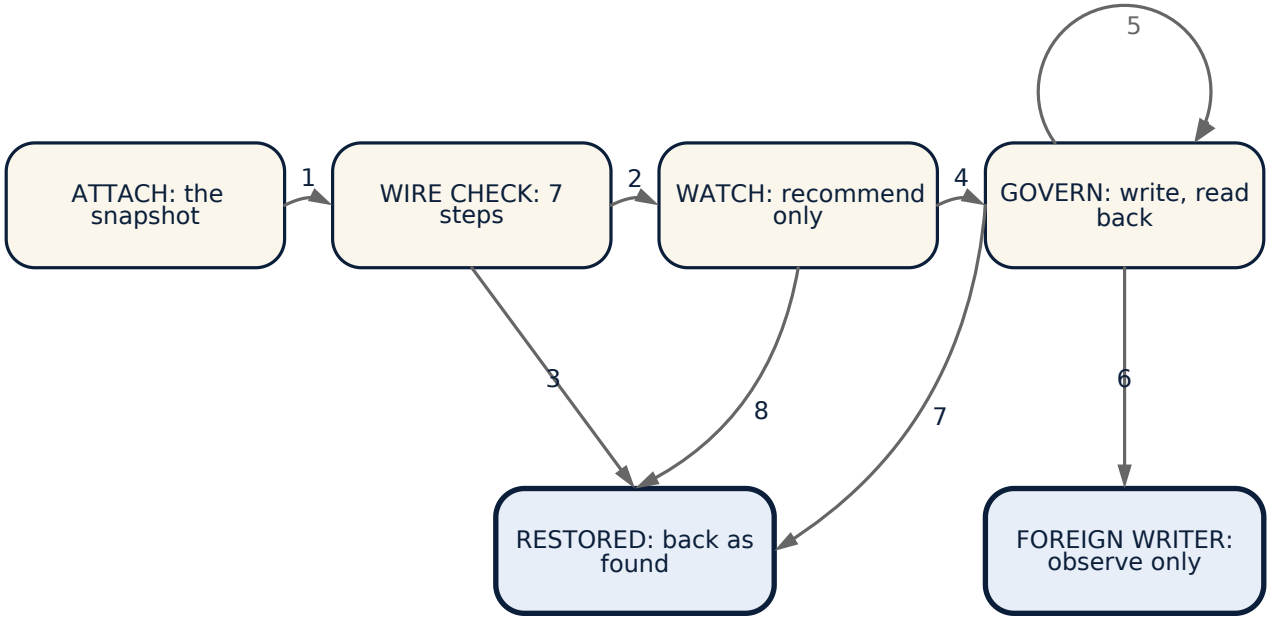
The engineer's job for one muscle is three things: which adapter, the address of the knob, and its safe range.

**The plug contract, line by line, and why each line is there.** *Attach* reads the knob once before any write and keeps that value as the snapshot. It is read once and never again, because a snapshot that moved with the knob would restore to wherever the governor last left it, and the whole point of the restore is to return to where the operator had it. *Read* takes the service reading (a response time, a temperature, a queue, an error) and places it in its band; the plug declares the band, the governor does not guess it. *Write* takes one value, clips it to the cover before it leaves the plug, sends it through the muscle's own interface, and then reads the lever back from the device and records both the sent and the taken value; a device that took something other than what was sent (a clock that rounds to 15 MHz steps, a pool size the pooler capped) is recorded as it is, not as it was asked. *One writer* compares the lever as found at every read with the value last written; a lever found elsewhere has another owner, after which the governor leaves that lever alone for the rest of the run and says so in its audit and its exit code. *Restore* writes the snapshot back on stop and reads it back; a restore that does not read back is an error (exit 3), never a silent success. The same five lines are implemented for Kubernetes objects (annotations hold the snapshot on the object itself, so a watchdog can restore from the object without the governor's memory), for `nvidia-smi`, for PgBouncer's console, for Redis's `CONFIG SET`, for the consumer group and for the simulators' knobs. An adapter written for a new muscle keeps the same five lines, and is proved against a stand-in device of that muscle before it is pointed at a real one.

## 5.3 Power-up order

Read-only first; then take the knobs, the least consequential first; on stop, hand them back in reverse order. In the Kubernetes controller the order is: the latency feed and the cluster's own metrics (read); the HPA target (a setting the HPA accepts and corrects within a minute); the pods' CPU limits (conveyance, in place); the machines (the slowest and most consequential, through the release gate and the verdict). On stop the machines are woken first, then the limits, then the target, so the cluster is never left with fewer machines than its pods need while a setting above them is still being handed back.

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1 the snapshot taken · 2 WIRED RIGHT · 3 FAIL: nothing written, the knob as found · 4 the paired trial passed · 5 every decision: clamp, gate, write, read back, receipt · 6 the knob found where the governor did not put it · 7 stop: reset, OFF, the lease · 8 stop before the trial passed

**Figure 11.** State machine: the life of one muscle under the plug. Attached with its snapshot, checked by the seven-step wire check, watched in recommend-only mode until the paired trial passes, then governed, one clamp, gate, write, read-back and receipt a decision; a knob found where the governor did not put it moves the muscle to observe only, and every stop restores it to the setting as found.

## 5.4 The wire check (mandatory before any write)

For the GPU it is one command, `sudo python3 tools/gpu_wire_check.py --gpu 0`, and `scripts/gpu_rented_run.sh` runs it first and stops if it fails:

| Step | It proves |
|---|---|
| 1 read | every meter answers: watts, temperature, utilization, limit, clock, top clock |
| 2 snapshot | the start limit is recorded once |
| 3 up wire | with the card busy, a ceiling below its own busy clock pulls the clock down under it; reset, the clock comes back above it |
| 4 down wire | a lower power limit is reported back exactly; the start limit is reported back exactly |
| 5 restore | clocks reset and the start limit read back |
| 6 stop | the governor, stopped by its signal, hands both wires back |

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| Step | It proves |
|---|---|
| 7 other writer | a limit set by someone else while the governor runs is left alone, and the governor exits 5 |

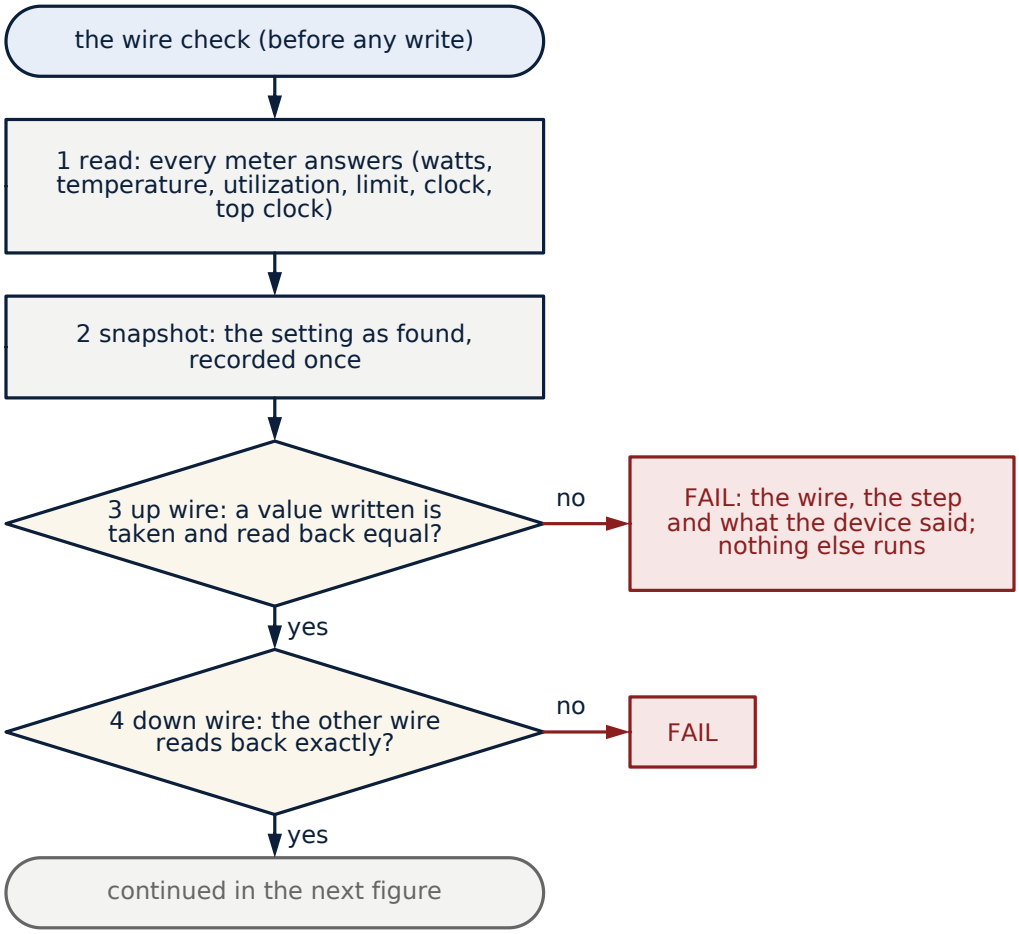



**Figure 12.** Flowchart: the wire check, steps 1 to 4. Before any write: every meter answers; the setting as found is recorded once as the snapshot; a value written on the up wire is taken and read back equal; the down wire reads back exactly. A step that fails stops everything with the wire, the step and what the device said; the chart continues in the next figure.

Any failure prints the wire, the step and what the device said, and nothing else runs. That turns a wiring fault from guesswork into one named line to fix.

## 5.5 Wired right or wired wrong

The wire check proves the wires move. It does not prove the governor reads the right thing. A correct installation leaves signatures in its own receipts; a wrong one leaves others. Check them on your first paired runs, before you believe any number, good or bad.

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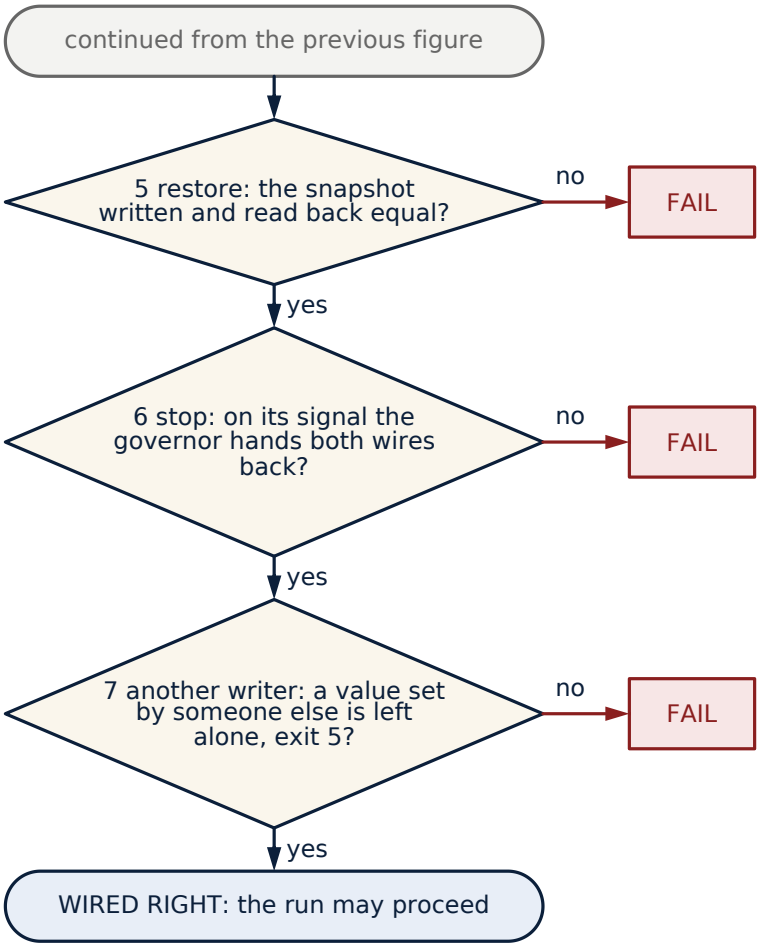



**Figure 13.** Flowchart: the wire check, steps 5 to 7 and the verdict. The snapshot written back reads back equal; on its stop signal the governor hands both wires back; a value set by someone else is left alone (exit 5). Only then is the muscle wired right and the run may proceed.

| Check | Wired right | Wired wrong, and what to look at |
|---|---|---|
| Watch arm against native | equal on every gauge (watch writes nothing) | different: the probe, the load or the machine differs between arms, not Omni-Compass |
| Requests served, failed requests | equal to native | fewer served or more failed: a lever is cutting capacity; check its cover and its sign |
| p95 and p99 response time | at native or faster | slower: the reading or the floors are wrong (rows below) |
| GPU: the card's clock while busy | at or above the clock the card reaches on its own | below it: the speed floor is missing or the lid is under the card's own draw |

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| Check | Wired right | Wired wrong, and what to look at |
|---|---|---|
| GPU: the lid while busy | at or above the card's own busy draw | at the envelope floor while busy: the lid is sized from a curve, not from the card's own meter |
| GPU: credit per write (`GPU_REPS.md`) | compass decisions pace the slack, race decisions cover the bursts; fail-up is rare | fail-up in most decisions: being busy is being read as a breach, or the service line is set too low |
| Kubernetes: machines given back | through the release gate, one per decision, with no pod waiting | machines given back while pods wait, or none at all while the service is far inside its band: check the latency feed, `--slo-ms` and the release gate's reasons in the audit |
| Kubernetes: the reset | every HPA target, replica range, CPU limit and worker back to native, no record left | anything left: an earlier run or another controller wrote the same objects |
| Every lever after the run | at its snapshot | not at its snapshot: another writer, or a restore that failed (exit 3): restore by hand and investigate |
| The feed itself | fresh samples every few seconds | stale or empty: Omni reads it as blind and fails up; fix the feed, not the governor |

**The rule.** If any row reads "wired wrong", the result of that run says nothing about Omni-Compass: fix the wiring, run the wire check and the watch arm again, and only then compare. The first real card run is the worked example: its receipts showed the card's busy clock under its own (736-768 MHz against 861-889), the lid at the 105 W floor under its own 135 W draw, and fail-up in 46% of decisions. Each of those is a row in this table.

## 5.6 The wire check on the other stacks

The GPU has a one-command wire check because its wires are the hardest to get right. The other stacks carry the same proof in a different place: every Kubernetes arm records `kubectl auth can-i` receipts for what the governor's identity can and cannot do (and fails if it can do anything it must not), checks that the cluster holds nothing but the harness, and ends with the reset check that every HPA target, replica range, CPU limit and worker is back at native with no record left; every database, broker and cache arm reads the knob back after every write and hands it back at the end, and the report says "handed back: yes" or the run is invalid; every simulator arm checks that every override was handed back. The watching arm, where it is run, is the

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wire check of the reading: a watching governor that disagrees with native on any gauge has found a difference in the probe, the load or the machine, not in Omni-Compass.

## 5.7 Coding a new muscle: the muscle SDK

A muscle not in the catalog (Appendix E), or one whose native controller speaks an API no adapter covers, is coded on the muscle SDK (`omnicompass/muscle_sdk.py`), the contract every adapter in this book obeys: **observe, bound, request, execute, read back, receipt, restore**. The SDK adds a muscle; it never adds a brain. The governor proposes a setting; the SDK's runtime earns the authority to write it, verifies the write and writes the receipt. An engineer codes five functions and declares three contracts; everything else (the clamp, the gate, the snapshot, the restore, the receipt) is the runtime's.

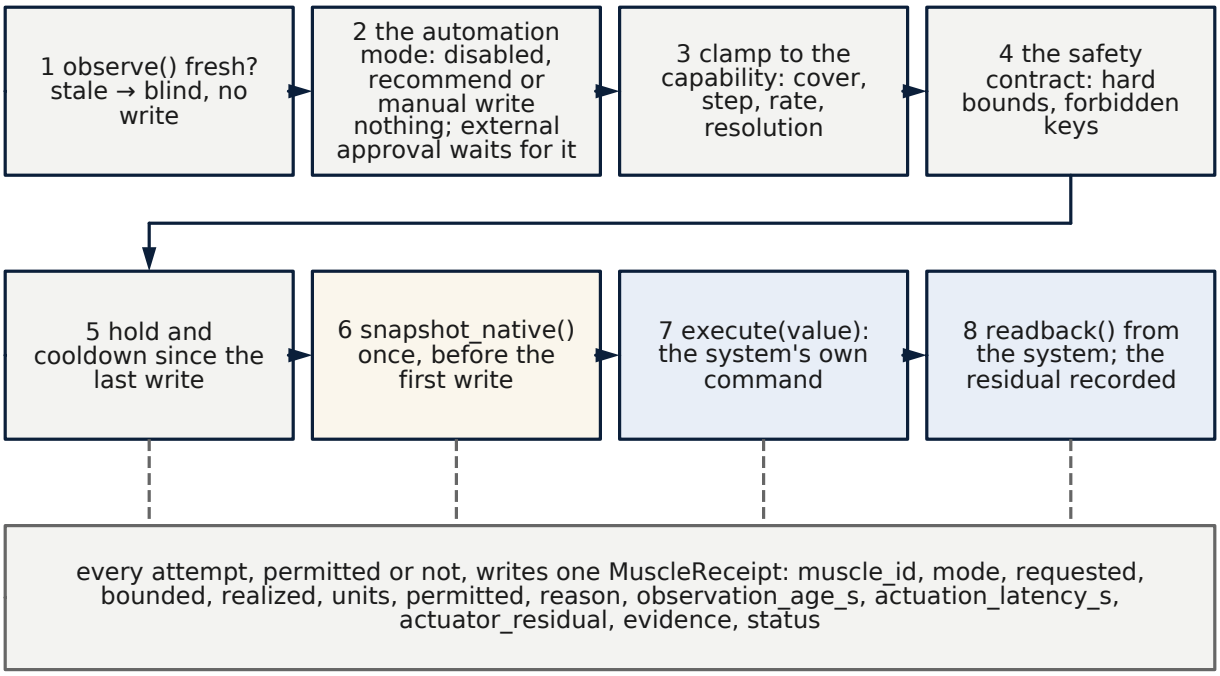
**The five functions** (the `MuscleAdapter` protocol, or `FunctionalMuscle` for a small connector): `observe()` returns the reading with its timestamp and quality (the wire out); `snapshot_native()` records the setting as found, once, before the first write; `execute(value)` writes one setting through the system's own command or API (the wire in; **WRITES**); `readback()` reads the setting back from the system, never from memory; `restore_native(snapshot)` puts the setting back as found. The adapter owns the vendor's API; the brain never sees it.

**The three contracts** (`MuscleSpec`): the **capability** (`CapabilityContract`: the cover's `minimum` and `maximum`, the `resolution`, the most one write may move (`max_step`) or the most a second may move (`max_rate_per_s`), the `units`, whether the knob is `reversible` and whether it reads back); the **timing** (`TimingContract`: the observation and decision periods, the actuation delay, the minimum hold and the cooldown between writes, the timeout, and `stale_after_s`, past which a reading is blind); the **safety** (`SafetyContract`: the `hard_min` and `hard_max` nothing may cross, `fail_closed`, a `safe_default`, and the `forbidden` context keys, such as a security hold, under which no write is permitted). The spec also names the muscle (`muscle_id`, `plant_id`), its class (`resource_type`, one of the standard classes below), its `automation` mode and its evidence class (`Evidence`: D design, S our own models, L live software, P physical meter, C commercial).

**The automation modes**, from least to most authority: `disabled`; `recommend` (every command computed and receipted, nothing written: the watch level of section 7.3); `manual`; `external_approval` (a write only with `approved=True` from your change process); `automatic`. A muscle starts at `recommend` and is promoted exactly as chapter 7's levels promote a stack.

**What the runtime does with each command** (`MuscleRuntime.command`), in order: a stale or invalid observation blocks the write and marks the muscle blind (section 6.3); the mode is checked; the request is clamped to the capability (cover, step, rate, resolution); the safety contract is asked (`outside_hard_bounds`, `forbidden:<key>`); the hold and the cooldown are checked (`hold_or_cooldown`); only then is the native snapshot taken, once, and the write made, and where the capability says the knob reads back, the setting is read back and the residual (realized minus bounded) recorded. Every attempt, permitted or not, writes one receipt (`MuscleReceipt`): `muscle_id`, `mode`,

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The five functions an engineer codes: observe, snapshot_native, execute, readback, restore_native. The three contracts declared: capability, timing, safety. The runtime does the rest, in this order, for every command.

**Figure 14.** The muscle SDK's runtime: what happens to one command. The eight steps the runtime takes, in order, for every value the governor proposes: the observation's freshness (stale means blind, no write), the automation mode (recommend writes nothing), the clamp to the capability contract, the safety contract, the hold and the cooldown since the last write, the snapshot taken once before the first write, the execute through the system's own command, and the read-back with its residual. Every attempt, permitted or not, writes one MuscleReceipt with the fields shown.

`requested`, `bounded`, `realized`, `units`, `permitted`, `reason`, `observation_age_s`, `actuation_latency_s`, `actuator_residual`, `evidence`, `status`. `MuscleRegistry` holds every muscle of a body, refuses a duplicate name, answers `catalog()` (every muscle with its cover, mode, evidence and status) and `restore_all()`, which hands every muscle back in the reverse of the order they were registered.

**A worked example.** The power limit of one graphics card, through the card's own command, first in `recommend`:

```
import json, subprocess
from omnicompass.muscle_sdk import (
    AutomationMode, CapabilityContract, Evidence, FunctionalMuscle,
    MuscleRegistry, MuscleRuntime, MuscleSpec, Observation,
    SafetyContract, TimingContract)
```

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```
def read_limit():
    # the wire out: the setting as the card reports it now
    out = subprocess.run(
        ["nvidia-smi", "-i", "0", "--query-gpu=power.limit",
         "--format=csv,noheader,nounits"],
        capture_output=True, text=True, check=True).stdout
    return float(out.strip())

def write_limit(w):
    # the wire in: one setting, the card's own command (WRITES)
    subprocess.run(["nvidia-smi", "-i", "0", "-pl", str(int(w))],
                   check=True)

spec = MuscleSpec(
    muscle_id="gpu0.power_limit", plant_id="card-0",
    resource_type="gpu.power_limit", adapter_version="1.0",
    capability=CapabilityContract(minimum=100.0, maximum=300.0,
                                  resolution=1.0, max_step=25.0,
                                  units="W"),
    timing=TimingContract(observation_period_s=2.0,
                          decision_period_s=2.0, minimum_hold_s=10.0,
                          stale_after_s=6.0),
    safety=SafetyContract(hard_min=100.0, hard_max=300.0,
                          forbidden=("security_block",)),
    automation=AutomationMode.RECOMMEND,
    evidence=Evidence.LIVE_SOFTWARE,
    native_owner="the card's firmware")
muscle = FunctionalMuscle(
    spec, observe=lambda: Observation(read_limit()),
    execute=write_limit, readback=read_limit,
    snapshot=read_limit, restore=write_limit)
audit = open("/var/log/omni/muscles.jsonl", "a")
registry = MuscleRegistry()
registry.register(MuscleRuntime(
    muscle, audit=lambda rec: audit.write(json.dumps(rec) + "\n")))
```

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```
receipt = registry.command("gpu0.power_limit", 250.0,
                           context={"security_block": False})
# recommend: permitted False, reason "recommend", nothing written;
# the receipt is in the audit
registry.restore_all()
# every muscle back as found, in reverse order; each one receipted
```

Promoted to `AutomationMode.AUTOMATIC`, the same code writes: a request of 250 W from the 300 W found is bounded to 250 and read back (residual 0); a request of 200 W ten seconds later is bounded to 225 by `max_step`; a request inside the 10-second hold is refused (`hold_or_cooldown`); a request made while `security_block` is true is refused (`forbidden:security_block`) and nothing moves; `restore_all()` returns the card to the 300 W found at the start and its receipt says `restored`. These outcomes are the SDK's own tests (`tests/test_muscle_sdk.py`).

**The standard classes** (`STANDARD_MUSCLE_CLASSES`) name the knob a new adapter governs, so that the catalog and the receipts read the same across a company's stacks: `kubernetes.replicas`, `.cpu_request`, `.cpu_limit`, `.memory_request`, `.memory_limit`, `.hpa_target`, `.pod_placement`, `.node_pool`; `host.cpufreq`, `.cpu_quota`, `.cpuset`, `.memory`, `.io`; `gpu.power_limit`, `.clock_envelope`, `.mig`, `.admission`; `cloud.instance_count`, `.instance_size`, `.placement`, `.start_stop`, `.capacity_policy`; `storage.volume_size`, `.tier`, `.iops`, `.throughput`, `.placement`; `network.traffic_weight`, `.rate_limit`, `.bandwidth`, `.routing`; `application.concurrency`, `.worker_count`, `.queue_admission`, `.jvm_heap`, `.thread_pool`, `.batch`; `facility.cooling_setpoint`, `.rack_power`, `.site_power`. A class is a contract, not a claim that a connector for it has run live: each adapter earns its own evidence class, and Appendix E's wiring recipes say which have (`docs/wiring_recipes.csv`).

A muscle coded on the SDK is wired into a body as any other (chapter 2): one governor per body, the muscle's reading a gauge of that body, its receipts in the body's audit; the wire check of section 5.4 applies to it unchanged (snapshot, write, read-back, restore, nothing left behind), and it enters service through the levels of chapter 7, watched first.

CHAPTER 6

# The Rules the Wires Obey

Every muscle is wired both ways: a sensory wire in (its meters) and a motor wire out (its knob), with the read-back closing the loop. Between them, the governor decides how much authority each muscle has at each moment, by four rules that an installer must know because they decide what a receipt can show:

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- **Expand is always allowed** (except under a security hold, Chapter 10): adding capacity, power, cooling or protection never waits.
- **Contract needs calm and a clean service record:** giving anything back is allowed only while the muscle is calm and the service has been inside its line for the clear time, 180 s (`--slo-clear-s`); a continuous muscle gives back at most its calm share of its surplus per decision, a discrete one one unit at a time, through a release gate (section 6.1).
- **Fail up:** while the service is past the wall (95% of the band) the knob returns at once to full capacity, the operator's own setting or the cover's top, whichever the muscle's direction asks.
- **Blind means hold:** if a sense goes stale or unreadable, nothing is given back until it returns (section 6.3).

The rules are asymmetric on purpose. Adding is cheap to undo and expensive to delay, so it is never gated beyond the security hold. Taking back is cheap to delay and expensive to get wrong, so it is gated three ways: by calm, by the service record (inside the line for the last 180 s, not merely at this decision), and by the release gate, whose reasons are written into the audit every time it holds.

"Two-way" is a statement about wiring, and it is checked, not assumed. Each muscle's plug carries exactly one sensory wire and one motor wire, and the wire check that must pass before any write (section 5.4) proves that the wires move: a value written through the motor wire is taken by the device and read back as the value sent, and the snapshot is restored and read back at the end. No governor writes a knob whose wire check has not passed, because a knob that can be written but not read back cannot be handed back with proof. What the wire check does not prove, section 5.5 says plainly: that the governor is reading the right gauge for the knob; that is what the watching arm is for. The receipts of every run carry, for every write, the value sent and the value the device reported, side by side.

## 6.1 The release gate

On Kubernetes the **release gate** lets one machine be given back only when every one of the following holds, and writes the first reason that fails into the audit, so a reader can see why a machine was kept:

1. more than one machine is in service (the floor of two is never crossed);
2. no pod is waiting for a place;
3. the pods are not scaling up;
4. the service is not past its line now, and its feed is live;
5. the remaining machines would run at or under the utilisation target ρ: the work in use divided by the capacity of the machines that would remain, against the engine's own demand clipped to between 50% and 95%;
6. the machine organ's own engine state grants contraction (its calm at or over 0.7, its line clean, no security hold);
7. every sense is live;

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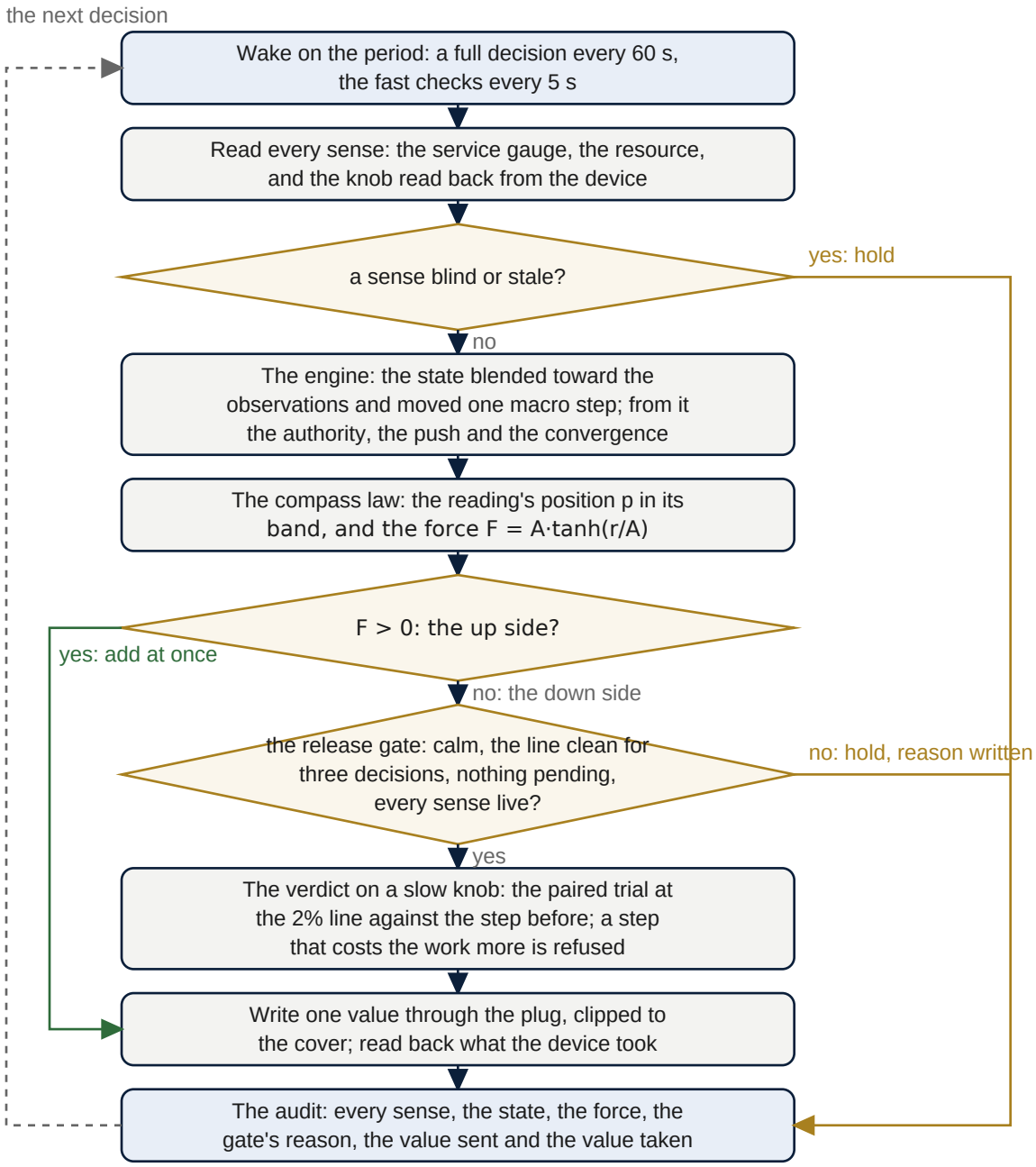



**Figure 15.** One decision of the governor. It wakes on its period, reads every sense, and holds if any sense is blind or stale: nothing is given back, and adding capacity is still allowed. The engine blends its state toward the observations and moves one macro step; the compass law turns the reading's position into a force. A positive force adds capacity at once, gated by nothing but the security hold.

A negative force must pass the release gate (calm, the line clean for three decisions, nothing pending, every sense live) and, on a slow knob, the verdict's paired trial at the 2% line. What survives is one write through the plug, read back, and one line in the audit that records every sense, the state, the force, the gate's reason and the value sent and taken, whether or not anything was written.

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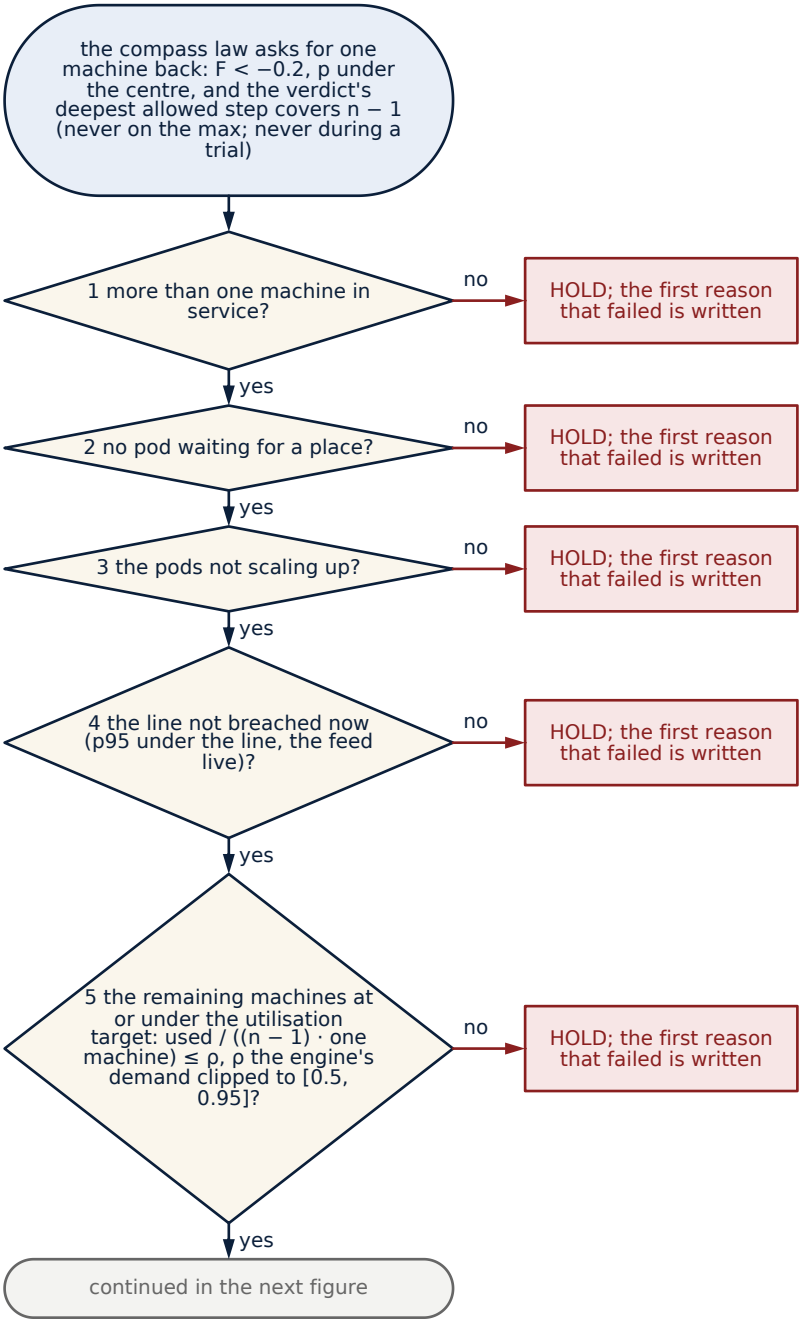



**Figure 16.** Flowchart: the release gate, reasons 1 to 5. The compass law asks for one machine back (its force past the release threshold, the reading under the centre, the verdict's deepest allowed step covering the count; never on the max, never during a trial). The gate then tests, in the governor's own order: more than one machine in service; no pod waiting for a place; the pods not scaling up; the line not breached now, the feed live; the remaining machines at or under the utilisation target ρ (the engine's demand, clipped to between 50% and 95%).

The first reason that fails holds the machine and is written in the audit. Continued in the next figure.

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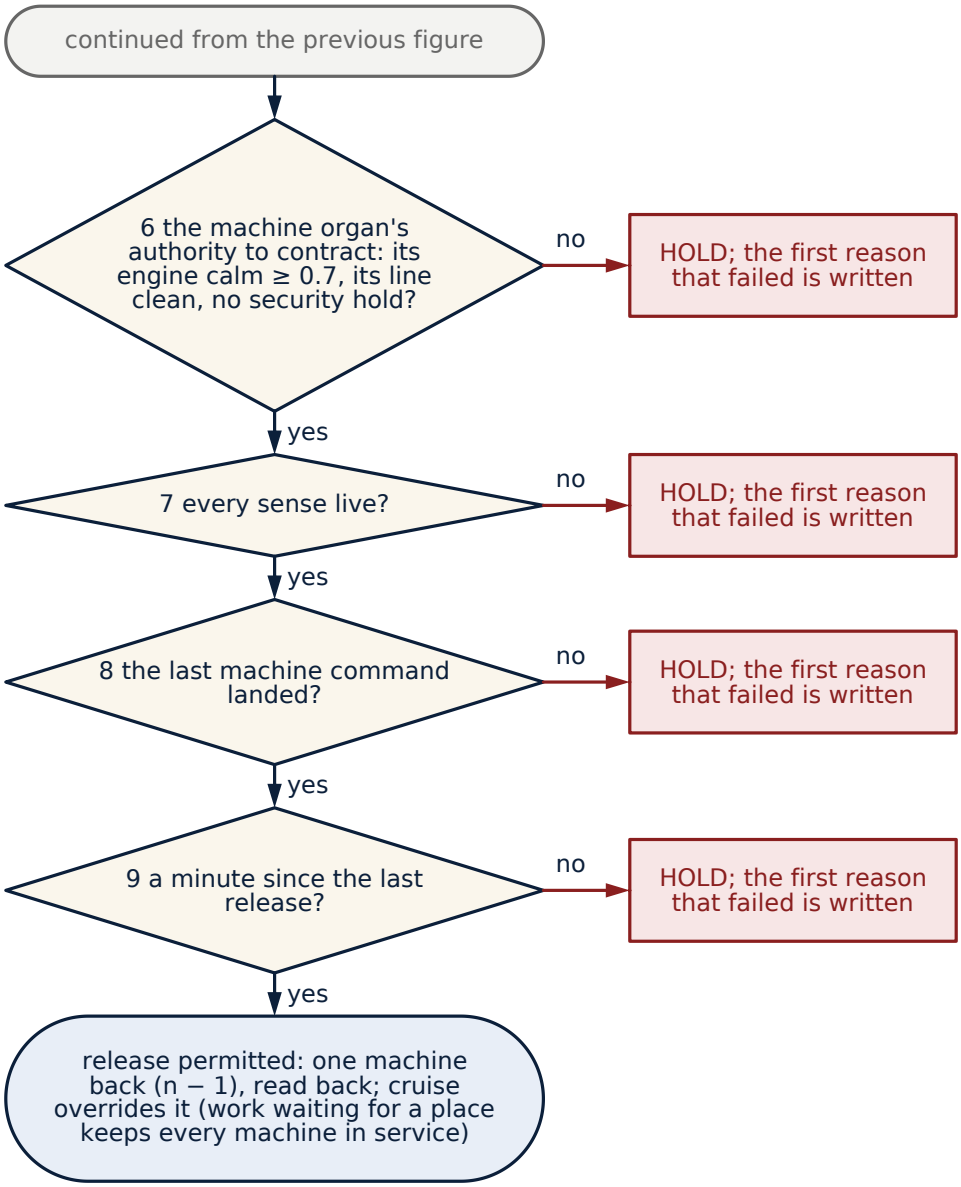



**Figure 17.** Flowchart: the release gate, reasons 6 to 9 and the release. The machine organ's own authority to contract (its engine calm at or over 0.7, its line clean, no security hold), every sense live, the last machine command landed, and a minute since the last release; only then is one machine given back and read back. Cruise overrides the release: while work waits for a place, every machine stays in service.

8. the last machine command has landed (no new order goes on top of one the cluster has not yet carried out);
9. a minute has passed since the last release.

The gate is asked only when the compass law itself asks for a machine back (its force past the release threshold, the reading under the centre, the verdict's deepest allowed step covering the count), never on the max and never during a trial; and cruise overrides it (while work waits for a place, every machine stays in

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service). One machine per decision is the rule in the slow, reversible direction; past the wall, one machine up at once. The same shape holds on every discrete muscle: a consumer, a chunk of a buffer pool, a notch of a cache ceiling, a tap. The gate's records read, in the governor's own words, "release permitted" (with the utilisation the remaining machines would carry), "no contraction authority" (a calm system whose state has not yet earned the right to give back), or a list of reasons at once, such as "latency breached now; a sense is blind". A machine kept in service always has a stated cause.

## 6.2 The snapshot, the read-back and the one-writer rule

The governor knows where its own levers are. The rule begins with the **snapshot**: the governor reads every knob it may move once, at the start, before its first decision, and that reading is the operator's setting for the whole run. Every reset, every hand-back and every kill returns the knob to the snapshot, never to a value computed later, and the receipt records the snapshot beside the final read-back so a reader can check the two are equal. The rule continues with the **read-back** after every write: the plug sends a value, waits for the device to take it, and reads the device's own report of what it holds. Where the device takes time to apply a setting, the plug knows that and does not mistake the transition for a foreign hand: MySQL's buffer pool is resized by the server in chunks over several seconds and reported as it goes, so the plug reads the server's own resize status, treats a pool caught mid-resize as its own write in progress, and waits for the server to report completion before it judges the write. The same shape holds on the autoscaler's bounds, Redis's memory ceiling and MongoDB's cache size: the value is read from the device's own console, and only a value the governor neither wrote nor is waiting on is read as someone else's.

If a lever is found at a value Omni-Compass did not write, someone else owns it: the governor stops writing that lever and leaves it alone, because restoring over it would fight the new owner. An operator who changed a knob by hand meant to, and a second controller that changed it is a conflict to be reported, not won. The lever is left where it was found, the audit records the value and the time, the governor goes on governing the other levers, and its exit code says so. A reader of the receipts who finds such a record knows at once that two hands were on the stack, and the paired run that contains it is read with that in mind. For an installer this rule has one consequence above all: **a knob may have only one writer besides its native controller**. A runbook, a cron job, a building schedule or a second tool that writes the same setting must be stopped or handed the knob before Omni-Compass is granted it.

## 6.3 Blind means hold, and fail up

A sense that goes stale or unreadable is not read as calm. It is read as **blind**, and while any sense is blind nothing is given back; the knob holds, or, if the service was past its line when the sense went blind, returns to full capacity at once. Omni-Compass never acts on a reading it does not have. An API that answers a read with a server error produces a held decision, logged with the reason the API gave, and the next decision is taken on schedule when the API answers again. The same holds for a response-time feed that pauses: the governor holds through the gap and resumes when the feed returns. A stale or missing reading produces a hold, never a move, and the hold is in the record.

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For an installer, the consequence is that the freshness of every feed is part of the wiring. A latency file that is written late, a meter that is polled less often than the governor decides, or an exporter that caches its readings will read as blind and keep the governor holding; the audit says so (`gate: a sense is blind`), and the fix is in the feed, never in the governor.

## 6.4 One body, one governor

The alternative to one governor is a controller per layer, each tuned alone: an autoscaler that adds pods while a power cap is trying to hold the machines down, a cooling loop that chases heat the clock governor is about to remove. These controllers fight because none of them knows the others' intent. One governor that sets every knob from one reading of the body cannot fight itself: the step on each lever is decided from the same reading of the same body at the same moment, and a step that would push another part of the body past its cushion is refused. Nothing anywhere is pushed into a LOSS to move one thing to a GAIN; one trial runs at a time inside a body, so every receipt can name the step that produced it.

This is why chapter 2 asks for every muscle of a body, and every resource the muscles share, to be wired into the same governor. Where a shared resource is left out, the governor cannot see the coupling, and no rule in this chapter can respect a limit the wires do not carry.

## 6.5 The rules of the engine that stands, as an operator meets them

The engine that stands in this edition is **omni-v18** (`python3 tools/omni_version.py` prints it; chapter 13); the receipts quoted here ran on omni-v7, whose rules omni-v18 carries (omni-v8, omni-v9 and omni-v10 changed one wire, the CityLearn battery, and the interval table; omni-v11 added one guard to the Kubernetes governor; omni-v12 holds a raise the cluster's admission refused until something changes, and the swarm's wire acts on a neighbour at once; omni-v13 hands the CPU limits it gave back to the operator's on a shared host at its top while another workload there has room of its own, and counts every other pod by its own limit; omni-v14 runs the operator's own commands without a shell unless they hold a pipe, a redirect or a variable, and takes `--native` to leave any muscle where native runs it; omni-v15 asks for the power cap's trim only while the response line has been clean for the governor's own clear time, its `--slo-clear-s`, so the request cannot switch back and forth at one threshold, and holds every wire in its fingerprint; omni-v16 keeps every time the governor counts in seconds, so `--interval` changes only how often it decides, and omni-v17 makes the beat a dial, the full decision every 60 s by default (the main engine) and any beat from 5 to 120 s on the command line; omni-v18 carries Omni direct, Omni-Compass run on the muscles with no Kubernetes beneath it (`omni_orchestrator/`), as part of the engine, so its three arms (native, Omni on native, Omni direct) run from one fingerprint: the conveyance runs every `--convey-every-s` (15 s) whichever check falls due, a quiet deployment is scaled to zero after `--coldstart-idle-s` (180 s), and a step that runs past its slot is skipped, never run in a burst, with `behind_s` in the audit). The hand-back shows in the audit as `"convey": "handed back"`, with the host's busy share on each write; a muscle left native shows as `"native_muscles"` at the start and `"held"` on each write it withholds. The guard shows in the audit: when the cluster's reading shows no machine in service (every worker cordoned, tainted NoSchedule or

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unreachable at once), the decision is recorded as `held: the cluster's reading shows no machine in service; nothing decided, nothing written`, and the governor takes up again at the first reading with machines. A held decision is never an error and needs no action from anyone; several in a row point at the cluster's nodes, not at Omni-Compass. Its mechanism is the Owner's Manual's; five of its rules show in the wiring, the settings and the audit, and are stated here so that a line in the audit is read for what it is.

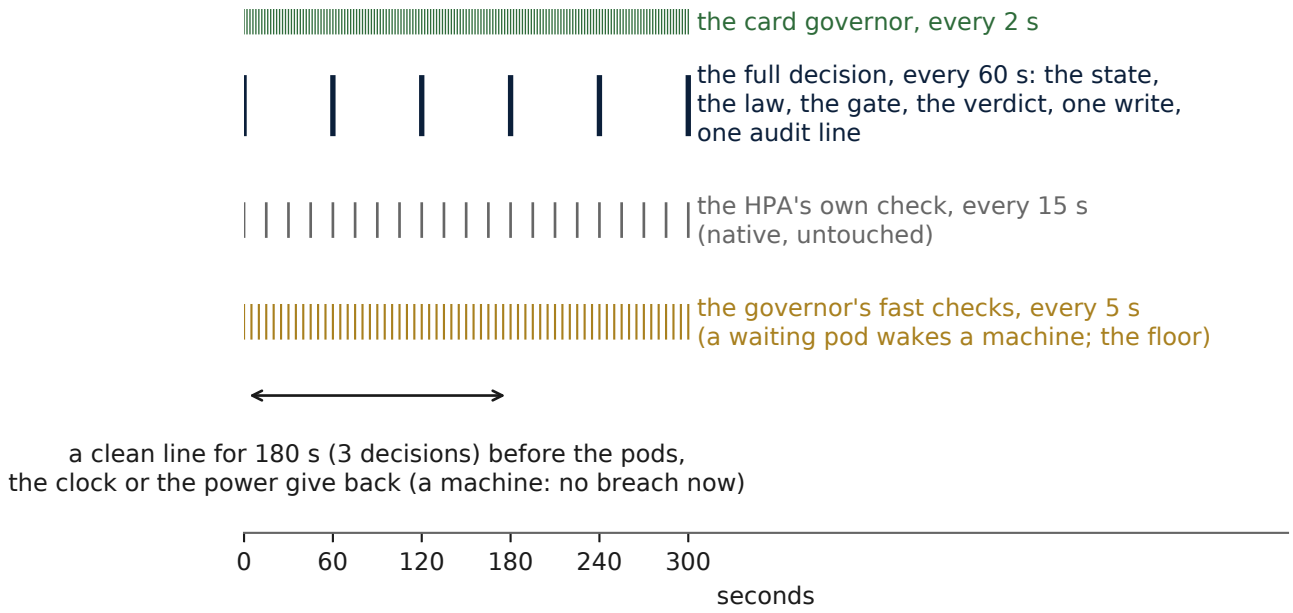



**Figure 18.** Timing diagram: the governor's clocks against the native controllers' own, over five minutes. The card governor decides every 2 s; the Kubernetes governor's fast checks run every 5 s (a waiting pod wakes a machine; the floor); native's own autoscaler keeps its 15-second check underneath, untouched; the full decision (the state, the law, the gate, the verdict, one write, one audit line) runs every 15 s, and nothing is given back until the line has been clean for 180 s, twelve decisions.

**Conveyance obeys the namespace's own quota.** Where the governor conveys a machine's idle processor to the serving pods on it (`--cap-deployments`, level 3), every raise of a pod's CPU limit is bounded by the namespace's ResourceQuota as Kubernetes reads it (hard and used; the stricter of the quota's spec and its status), and a raise the quota would not admit is not written. The governor never raises, lowers or deletes a quota. Where its role cannot read the quotas, the budget is **no budget known**, not zero: the raise proceeds as the plug has always made it, Kubernetes' own admission refuses any write over a quota the governor cannot see, the plug reads the refusal back, and the audit says so once a pass (`quota: no budget known: the raise proceeds, Kubernetes admission is the authority`, with the namespace and the reason). An operator who wants the budget bounded before the write grants the governor's role `get` and `list` on `resourcequotas`; one who does not loses nothing but that line.

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**On a shared host, no limit is raised while the machine is at its top.** Where several nodes are containers on one machine (a kind cluster, a laboratory host), the governor raises no pod CPU limit while that machine's measured busy share is at or over 75%, or cannot be read; limits already given stay; lowering is never held. Each hold is one audit record, `convey: held`, with the machines held, the host's busy share and whether the host is shared. On separate machines the guard never binds. It is the same guard the replica room obeys before it adds a replica on a shared host.

**The clocks are in seconds.** Every rule that waits is stated in seconds and keeps its time at any decision period: the clear time after a breach (`--slo-clear-s`, 180 s), the cruise wait (`--cruise-after-s`, 120 s), the strict window (`--strict-window-s`, 300 s), the verdict's spacing, recheck and trial (`--verdict-every-s` 600 s, `--verdict-recheck-s` 7,200 s, `--verdict-trial-s` 1,200 s) and the reflex window (`--reflex-window-s`, 30 s). Each is converted to a count of decisions at the running period, n = max(1, round(seconds / period)), so a governor deciding every 15 s waits the same minutes as one deciding every 60 s; the cruise wait is never fewer than two decisions, because work that waits decision after decision takes two readings to see (at a beat of 90 or 120 s its 120 s would round to one). The compass moves an autoscaler's target by the same amount a minute at any period, and the node pool gives back at most one machine a minute. The full decision comes every 60 s by default, the main engine's beat, and the beat is a dial (section 4.4): any value from 5 to 120 s may be set with `--interval`, 15 s among them, the pace of native's own autoscaler; the fast checks run every 5 s at every beat, and native's own autoscaler keeps its own 15-second check untouched.

**The verdict reads a trial in the words of a receipt.** Before a knob moves one step further from native, the step runs as a trial and its cost per piece of work is compared with the cost at the reference, on the logarithm of each piece's cost, with a 95% interval. The interval wholly above zero is a **LOSS** and the step is undone whatever the allowance says; wholly below is a **GAIN**; across zero is **EVEN**; a GAIN or EVEN step is kept only if both the median and the mean of the logarithms are inside the allowance (`--allow`, 2%); while the interval is wider than the allowance the trial measures on, up to three times its sample count, before it decides. Every judgement is in the audit as `reading` (`GAIN`, `EVEN`, `LOSS` or `past the allowance`) and `interval_ln`, so an operator can see why a machine stayed given back or came back (Appendix L, `verdict`).

**The cloud's rule is one flag.** `--give-back-only` turns off every pod, processor, power, clock, cooling and batch actuator, sets the replica ceiling to 0 and the dial to the tune-down, and leaves the node pool as the only knob, whatever else the command line says: the governor can then only park a machine the cloud already made, after its own trial, and wake it on a breach, so the bill can only fall or stay. The cloud install file (`deploy/install/omni-compass-cloud.yaml`) passes it; chapter 20 is written on it.

None of these is a setting an operator tunes (Appendix K lists each with its shipped value). They are stated so that the audit lines they write are read as the rules they are, and so that a reading taken on this engine is never set beside one taken on another (chapter 13).

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PART THREE

# Wiring It onto Your Stack, Step by Step

*The eight levels, from watching to governing the site, and the wiring of each kind of stack.*

CHAPTER 7

# Before You Start, and the Eight Levels

## 7.1 What your system needs

| You run | You need |
|---|---|
| Kubernetes (vanilla, EKS, GKE, AKS, OpenShift/OKD, Rancher, kind) | Kubernetes 1.34 or newer (in-place pod resize); metrics-server (`kubectl top nodes` works); an HPA with a CPU target on each governed service; a readiness probe and a short preStop pause on each service |
| A response-time feed (strongly recommended at every level) | a CSV per service, `elapsed_seconds,latency_ms,ok`, written continuously; `scripts/latency_probe.py` writes one against any HTTP endpoint |
| NVIDIA GPUs | a driver with `nvidia-smi`; root (or the capability to run `nvidia-smi -pl` and `-lgc`); on a VM, full GPU passthrough |
| CPU power control | Linux cpufreq with the schedutil governor; RAPL for package watts; usually bare metal |
| Site power and cooling | a command that prints site watts, and a command that sets the supply-air setpoint through your building management system |

**Why each requirement is there.** Kubernetes 1.34 or newer is required because the conveyance muscle resizes a pod's CPU limit in place, which older versions do only by restarting the pod, and a restart is a

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disruption Omni-Compass never causes. metrics-server is the HPA's own eyes and the governor's: without it neither knows what the pods use. An HPA with a CPU target on each governed service is the native controller Omni-Compass sits on; a service without one has nothing for level 2 to move. A readiness probe and a short preStop pause are what make a drain invisible to clients: the Service stops sending requests to a pod before it stops, and kube-proxy sends them to another ready endpoint. The response-time feed is the one wire a cluster does not already have: Kubernetes knows what its pods use, not what its users wait; the compass needs the second, and `scripts/latency_probe.py` writes it against any HTTP endpoint every five seconds. On the GPU, root is needed only for the two `nvidia-smi` writes, and a VM must pass the whole card through or the driver refuses to lock clocks (the wire check's step 3 is where that shows).

## 7.2 Get the software and check it

```
git clone https://github.com/The-Omni-Compass-LLC/The-Omni-Compass.git
cd The-Omni-Compass
pip install -r requirements.txt
python3 verify.py                       # every check; ends with VERIF
    ↪ ICATION: PASS
```

Build the container image once:

```
docker build -f deploy/Dockerfile -t <your-registry>/omni-compass:<tag
    ↪ > .
docker push <your-registry>/omni-compass:<tag>
```

It runs as non-root, with a read-only root filesystem and no Linux capabilities.

What `verify.py` checks is worth knowing before it is run, because its last line, `VERIFICATION: PASS` or `FAIL`, is the only thing an installer has to read. It runs every test in the repository (the plugs, the readings rule, every stack's harness against a stand-in server), checks every fingerprinted file of the engine against its registry so that a changed file fails before anything is installed, compares the release's files with its manifest, and checks that every path the documents name exists. It takes a few minutes on a laptop and needs no network beyond the clone. GitHub runs the same script on every push under Python 3.12, and each run is listed under the repository's Actions tab with the commit it checked; install only a commit whose run passed.

To know which engine a checkout carries, ask it:

```
python3 tools/omni_version.py                 # the engine version (f
    ↪ or example omni-v11), or every file that differs
python3 tools/omni_version.py --commit <sha>   # the same question of
    ↪ any pushed commit
```

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Every receipt names the commit it ran on, and the three-run tools refuse to combine runs from different engine versions (chapter 13). No receipt is ever read across engine versions, and the command above is how an installer checks that for themselves.

## 7.3 The levels

Take them in order. Each has a pass condition; go to the next level only when it holds. The OFF switch works at every level.

The levels exist because a governor earns authority the way a new operator does: by watching first, then by touching the setting that is cheapest to undo, then the next. Level 0 touches nothing and proves the software is the software (`verify.py` checks every sealed file's fingerprint and runs every test). Level 1 watches a live cluster for as long as the operator likes and logs every decision it would have taken, so the operators can read those decisions against what they would have done; nothing passes level 1 until they agree with its readings. Level 2 moves the HPA target, which the HPA itself corrects within a minute if the governor is wrong, and raises replica floors ahead of bursts; it is the first level that can show a gain and the first that can show a loss, and the paired receipts of chapter 11 are its pass condition. Level 3 moves machines, the slowest lever, through the release gate and the verdict; it is where the bill moves and where the most care is spent. Level 4 hands Omni-Compass the replica decision itself, with the HPA kept as the fast reflex upward; it is an option, not a step on the way, and it is not part of the factory tune. Levels 5 to 7 are the GPU, the CPU and the site, each with its own wire check and its own pass. An installation may stop at any level and run there indefinitely; most will stop at level 3.

**Level 0 - Evaluate without touching anything.**

```
python3 verify.py
python3 tools/run_scale.py --runs 10 --scale 1 --out results/scale/eva
    ↪ l     # the seven organisms, modelled
python3 tools/run_gpu_card.py results/sim/gpu_two_wire/eval
    ↪        # the two-wire card, modelled
```

Pass: `VERIFICATION: PASS`. Nothing in your systems is touched. What you should see: `verify.py` ends `VERIFICATION: PASS`, and `python3 tools/omni_version.py` prints `omni-v18 (digest 1cb92edb64c4391d, 62 files)`; the modelled run writes a receipt whose organism rows read GAIN on misses with power given beside them, as `results/realms_v5/REALMS_V5.md` does on the same seeds. Anything else means the copy is not the copy: chapter 33.

**Level 1 - Watch (read-only).**

```
kubectl apply -f deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml     # set the image
    ↪ line; it runs --mode observe
kubectl -n omni-compass logs deploy/omni-compass -f
```

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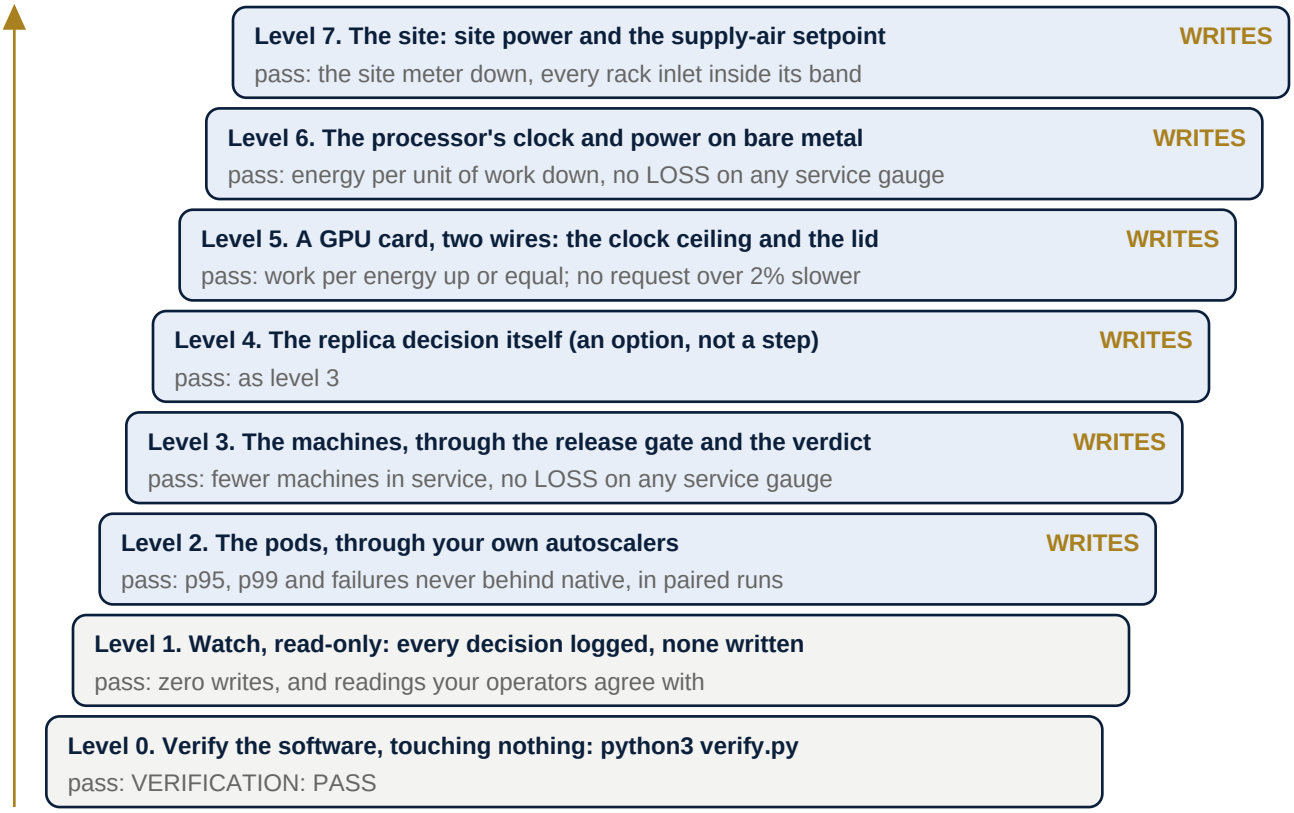



**Figure 19.** The eight levels of an installation, taken in order, each with its pass condition. Levels 0 and 1 write nothing; from level 2 the governor writes, and the wire check must pass before any level that writes. An installation may stop at any level and run there indefinitely.

The install file grants a read-only identity; `scripts/pilot_shadow.sh` records `kubectl auth can-i` receipts that show it cannot write. Every decision it would take is logged with its reason. Pass: zero writes, and readings your operators agree with. What you should see: an audit with a `decision` record every 60 s (the main engine's beat, or the beat you set) and no `write` record at all (`jq -c 'select(.write)' audit.jsonl` prints nothing); `authority.senses.blind` false for every sense once the feed is wired; `nodes_recommended` at or below `nodes_observed` while the service is calm and above it when it is not. A `write` here is a wiring fault (the identity can write: chapter 10); a sense that stays blind is a feed fault (section 6.3).

**Level 2 - The pods, on top of your autoscalers. WRITES.**

1. Grant `patch horizontalpodautoscalers` and `patch pods/resize` (`deploy/rbac-target.yaml`).
2. Run with `--mode target --latency-file <feed> --slo-ms <your p95 target>`.

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3. Optional pod muscles, one at a time:

| Muscle | Switch | What it does |
|---|---|---|
| convey | `--latency-file` and `--cap-deployments ns/name` | gives each machine's idle CPU to the serving pods on it |
| rightsize | `--rightsize-deployments ns/name` | each pod's CPU request follows its measured use times (1 + headroom), in place |
| coldstart | `--coldstart-deployments ns/name` `--coldstart-signal ns/configmap` | scales a service to zero while no work waits, wakes it when work arrives |
| batch | `--batch` | admits held Jobs labelled `omnicompass.io/batch=true` when there is load and power headroom |
| batch pace | `--batch-pace` | pauses Jobs labelled `omnicompass.io/pausable=true` under power or heat stress, resumes them after |
| rollout guard | `--rollout-guard ns/name` | pauses a rollout while change is not permitted |
| contain | `--contain-namespaces ns` `--contain-cpu-m <m>` | holds an agent namespace to a CPU budget |
| security hold | `--security-configmap ns/name` | key `hold: "true"` blocks every expansion |

Your HPAs keep scaling as before; Omni-Compass sets their targets and raises floors ahead of bursts. Pass: p95, p99 and failed requests never behind native, over paired runs (chapter 11). What you should see: in the paired receipt (chapter 11), response time at the 95th percentile and time over the line reading GAIN or EVEN, failed requests EVEN, the autoscaler's replicas EVEN or power given. On our own services of this kind, rightsized with Goldilocks or scaled by KEDA, the 95th percentile read −52% to −75% and alert minutes −93% to −100% in all three of our runs on this engine (chapter 11, the reference bands). A LOSS on any service gauge at this level is read as a wiring fault first: the feed's freshness and its line (chapter 19), the sensed autoscaler's name, the window's length against the interval widths of chapter 11.

**Level 3 - The machines. WRITES.**

1. Grant `patch nodes` and `patch pods` (`deploy/kind/rbac-omni.yaml`).
2. Run with `--mode nodepool --active-nodes-only --closure /app/law/closure.json --node-scale-cmd "<command with {n}>"` and `--node-restore-cmd "<command>"` for the OFF switch. For the compass on the same levers, use `--law compass` (it reads the mean response time of the latency window in the band from a tenth of `--slo-ms` to `--slo-ms` and holds it at the centre of the band (section 4.4): 0.3 at the max and 0.4 at

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the tune-down; p95 at the line, a blind feed or a waiting pod adds capacity at once; the HPA target never goes above the operator's; at the max no machine the cluster had on its own is given back, and at the tune-down machines go back one at a time through the release gate and the paired trial).

| Your platform | The park/wake command |
|---|---|
| any cluster, bare metal, kind | `bash scripts/kind_nodepool.sh {n}` |
| Karpenter / EKS Auto Mode | the NodePool CPU limit at `{n}` times node CPU, parked nodes kept |
| Cluster Autoscaler node group | the group's desired size, scale-down through parking |
| OpenShift / OKD | the worker MachineSet replicas, parked |

A machine is given back only when every sense is live, the last order landed, pods are not scaling up, nothing waits for a place, and the remaining machines stay inside the band. Pass: fewer machines in service, with no LOSS on any service gauge. What you should see: `verdict` records reading `trial`, then `step allowed` or `step refused`, each with its `reading`; machines in service and node-hours EVEN or GAIN, the bill EVEN or GAIN; no `refused` record from the scale command; after an OFF, the lease walking every machine back. A machine count that never falls is not a fault: it is the governor finding no machine it can give back without a LOSS, and the audit says which gate held (`node_gate.reason`).

**Level 4 - Omni-Compass decides; Kubernetes is the muscle. WRITES.** Add `--strict-replicas`: Omni-Compass decides each service's replica floor and when to shrink; the HPA stays as the fast reflex upward. Pass: as level 3. What you should see: as level 3, with the floors the governor set in the audit, and the HPA still raising replicas on a burst before the governor's next decision.

**Level 5 - A GPU box, two wires. WRITES.**

```
sudo python3 tools/gpu_wire_check.py --gpu 0                    # must
    ↪  end: WIRED RIGHT
# watch: computes both wires and writes neither
sudo python3 -m omni_controller.gpu_compass --mode watch --gpus 0 --au
    ↪ dit /var/log/omni/gpu.jsonl \
     --latency-file <feed> --slo-ms <p95 target> --floor-w <your lowes
    ↪ t watts>
# govern: writes the clock ceiling and the power limit
sudo python3 -m omni_controller.gpu_compass --mode cap --gpus 0 --audi
    ↪ t /var/log/omni/gpu.jsonl \
     --latency-file <feed> --slo-ms <p95 target> --floor-w <your lowes
    ↪ t watts>

# OFF: clocks reset, power limit back to the start, read back
sudo touch /tmp/omni-gpu-kill
```

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Every `--interval` seconds (default 2) it reads the card's own meters and the response times, and:

- **learns the card on its own** first: while the ceiling is at the top and the card is busy, its busy clock and busy draw; until 15 such readings are in, neither wire moves;
- **races while work waits**: at 95% utilization or more, the ceiling to the top and the lid to the start limit;
- **at the max** (`--dial max`, the default): the clock ceiling is never stepped below the top while the card serves, and the lid sits above the card's own busy draw, never over the start limit;
- **at the tune-down** (`--dial save`), it paces the slack: the mean response time of the last 5 s, in the band from a tenth of `--slo-ms` to `--slo-ms`; the ceiling moves in whole 15 MHz steps, never under the card's own busy clock, and the lid never under the card's own busy draw plus 10%, never over the start limit; and before the ceiling may go one step lower, a paired trial measures the card's own time on each request (the workload's `service_ms`) at the top and at that step, and the step is allowed only if it adds at most `--allow` (2%). Where no step passes, the ceiling stays at the top: the card runs as it does alone, and the audit says so (`verdict_state: left native`);
- **fails up** when p95 reaches `--slo-ms`, a request fails, the feed goes blind or the card reports a heat slowdown.

The settings are the card's own (its busy clock and busy draw as learned), the line (`--slo-ms`), the allowance (`--allow`) and the dial. The workload must write `service_ms` (the card's own time per request) in its latency file, as `tools/gpu_workload.py` does; without it no step is ever allowed and the card stays native. Pass: work per energy up or equal; requests served equal; no request more than 2% slower at the median, p95 and p99 at native or within 2%; every row of section 5.5 reads "wired right". What you should see: `tools/gpu_wire_check.py` ending WIRED RIGHT; a `snapshot` record, then a `decision` every 2 s; at the max no `clock_write` below the top while the card serves; at the tune-down a `verdict` for every step and `verdict_state: left native` where no step passed; `restored` with `ok: true` after the kill file (Appendix L.5). The receipt: work per energy GAIN or EVEN, requests served EVEN, the 95th percentile EVEN or inside the allowance.

**Level 6 - CPU clock and power. WRITES.** On bare metal, add to the controller: `--cpufreq-policy-root /sys/devices/system/cpu/cpufreq --cpufreq-require-schedutil --rapl-cmd "<prints CPU package watts>"`. The OFF switch writes every policy's recorded maximum back exactly. Pass: energy per unit of work down, no LOSS on any service gauge. What you should see: one `cpu_pstate_snapshot`, then `cpu_pstate_write` records naming the cap and the envelope; energy per unit of work GAIN; every service gauge EVEN or GAIN; at OFF, `cpu_pstate_restore` putting every policy's ceiling back exactly (Appendix L.4).

**Level 7 - Site power and cooling. WRITES.** `--power-cmd "<prints site watts>" --site-limit-w <limit>` brings site power stress into the engine; `--cooling-cmd "<sets {c}>" --cooling-min-c 18 --cooling-max-c 27 --cooling-restore-c 22` lets it hold the supply-air setpoint in its band. CPU and GPU sharing one power budget, and groups of cards sharing a site

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budget, run as models today. Batteries are designed as a muscle of the site, not yet wired (section 8.10). What you should see: site power stress entering the decisions (the `compass` record) and the cooling setpoint held inside its band; nothing written outside the band; at OFF, the setpoint back at `--cooling-restore-c`.

## 7.4 Wiring for superiority: watch first, then the paired trial on every knob

Every knob is wired out first and in last, and the wire in is connected only by a measurement the governor makes on the knob itself. The steps, for any stack:

1. **Wire out, everything.** Every muscle's readings reach the governor, one wire out per muscle. Nothing is written. This is watch mode (section 1.3): where every installation starts, and where any knob returns the moment it stops paying.
2. **Run the observation.** With the stack together and under its real or replayed demand, let the governor watch for at least one full cycle of that demand. In watch mode the governor learns the band of every reading, where the native controllers hold them, and which readings leave calm and when. Nothing is decided yet; the audit says what the governor saw.
3. **Let the paired trial decide each knob, one trial at a time.** Switch the knobs the operator is willing to have moved into trial mode. A knob still writes nothing until the governor has run a paired trial on it (section 1.2): the knob is held at the operator's setting for a reference, then one notch away, under the same traffic, and the step is allowed only if the muscle's own cost did not rise under the declared objective. The objective is the operator's one declaration per knob: the resource reading (the service, the resource and the processor time weighed together) or the service reading (work and speed alone). A refused step is not retried for a set time; an allowed step widens the allowance by one notch, and the next trial probes the next. The governor then moves the knob inside the allowance, never outside.
4. **Keep checking.** The trials recur. A knob whose last step stops paying when the demand changes is refused on its recheck and the allowance narrows back; a knob that never passes a trial stays native for good, which is the right answer for that knob and costs nothing. New noise in the system is answered the same way: the governor reacts inside the allowance, and the allowance itself is re-earned by measurement.
5. **Read the trials, muscle by muscle.** The audit carries the state of every knob every second (`verdict_phase`, `verdict_direction`, `allowed_low`, `allowed_high`, the cost sample), and the arm's record sums it. An operator who wants one knob wired both ways and another watched only sets the objective on the first and leaves the second in watch.

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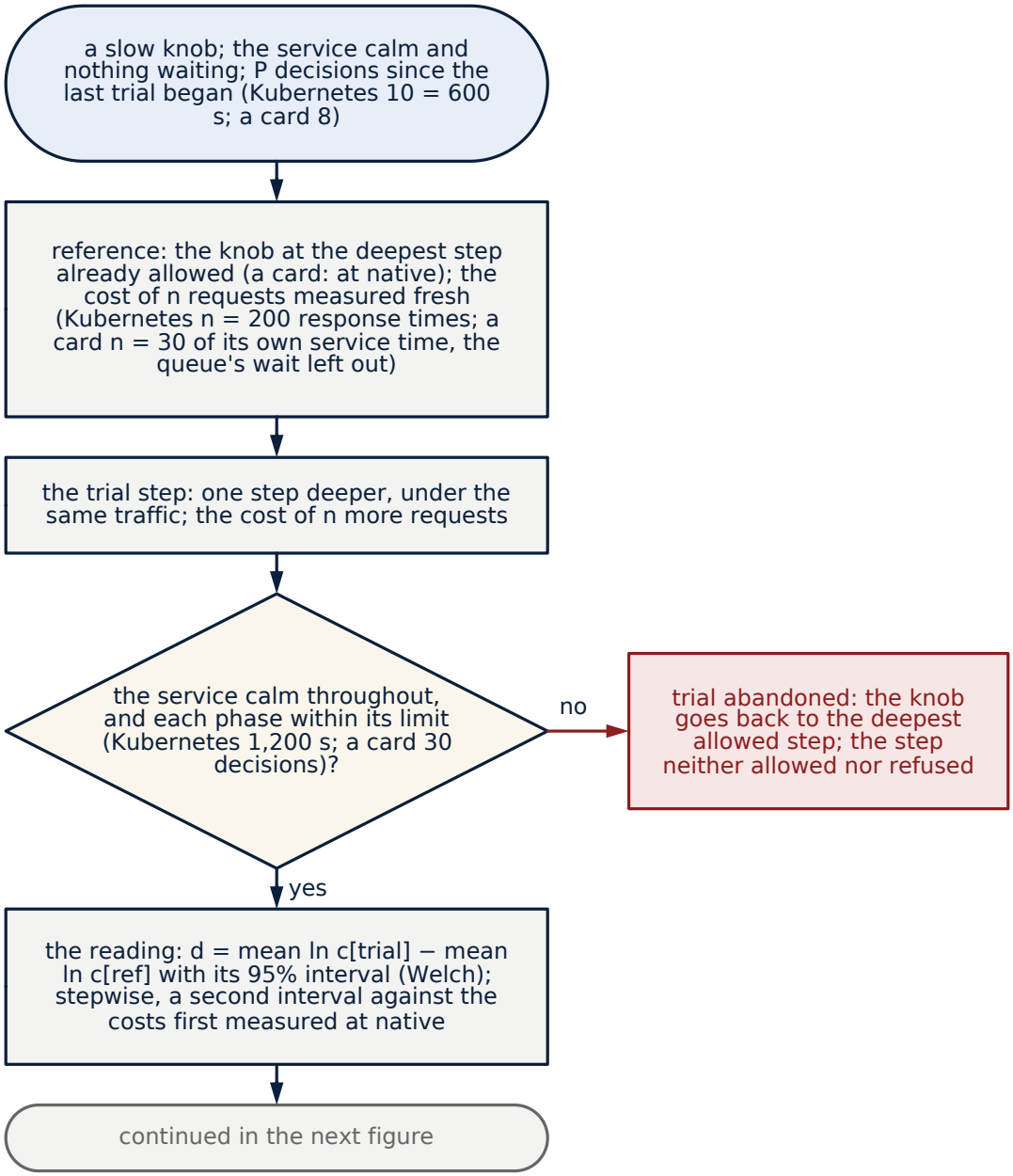



**Figure 20.** Flowchart: the verdict's trial on one step, from the reference to the reading. While the service is calm and nothing waits, and P after the last trial began (600 s on Kubernetes, 10 decisions at the main engine's 60 s; 8 decisions on a card), the reference is measured fresh at the deepest step already allowed (on a card, at native): n requests (200 response times on Kubernetes; 30 of a card's own service time).

One step deeper, under the same traffic, n more are the trial. A phase that sees the service leave calm or outlasts its limit (1,200 s on Kubernetes, 20 decisions at the main engine's 60 s; 30 decisions on a card) is abandoned: the knob goes back, the step neither allowed nor refused. The reading is the 95% interval of the change in log cost. Continued in the next figure.

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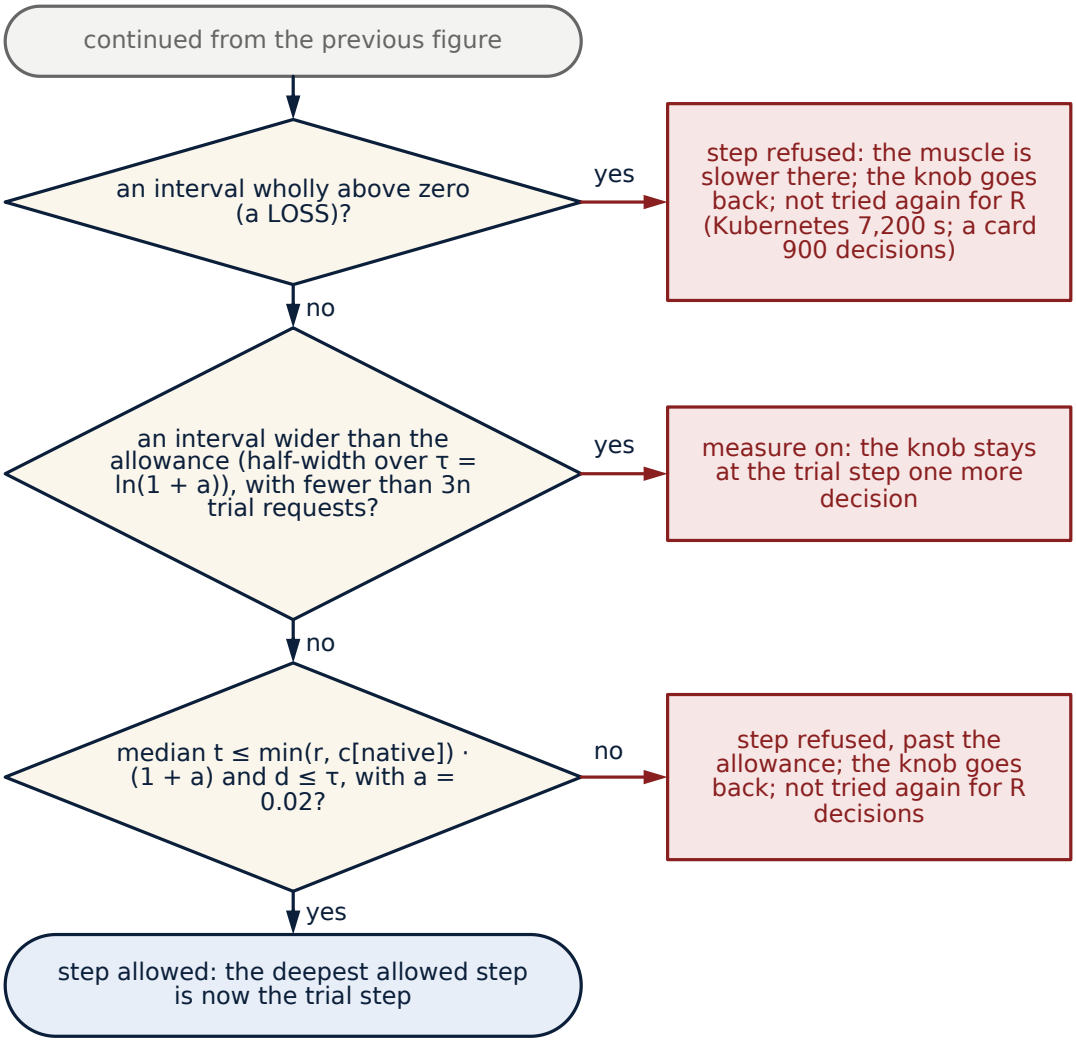



**Figure 21.** Flowchart: the verdict's trial on one step, from the reading to the step allowed or refused. An interval wholly above zero is a LOSS: the step is refused, the knob goes back, and the step is not tried again for R (7,200 s on Kubernetes, 120 decisions at the main engine's 60 s; 900 decisions on a card). An interval wider than the allowance with fewer than 3n trial requests measures on. Otherwise the step is allowed only if the trial's median is within the allowance of the reference and of native and the mean change is within it too; else it is refused, past the allowance. An allowed step moves the deepest allowed step one deeper.

What this gives: no knob is ever written on faith. Where Omni-Compass can do more than the native controller on the muscle's own gauges, it will have shown it on that muscle before it moved it; where it cannot, the muscle runs by itself and Omni-Compass reads it. The body's result is then the sum of the knobs that earned it, not one turn of a single dial for the whole system. The live stacks of chapter 8 (the pooler, the broker, the cache, the storage engine's cache and the buffer pool) carry this trial on their knob, and on Kubernetes it guards every machine given back (section 1.2).

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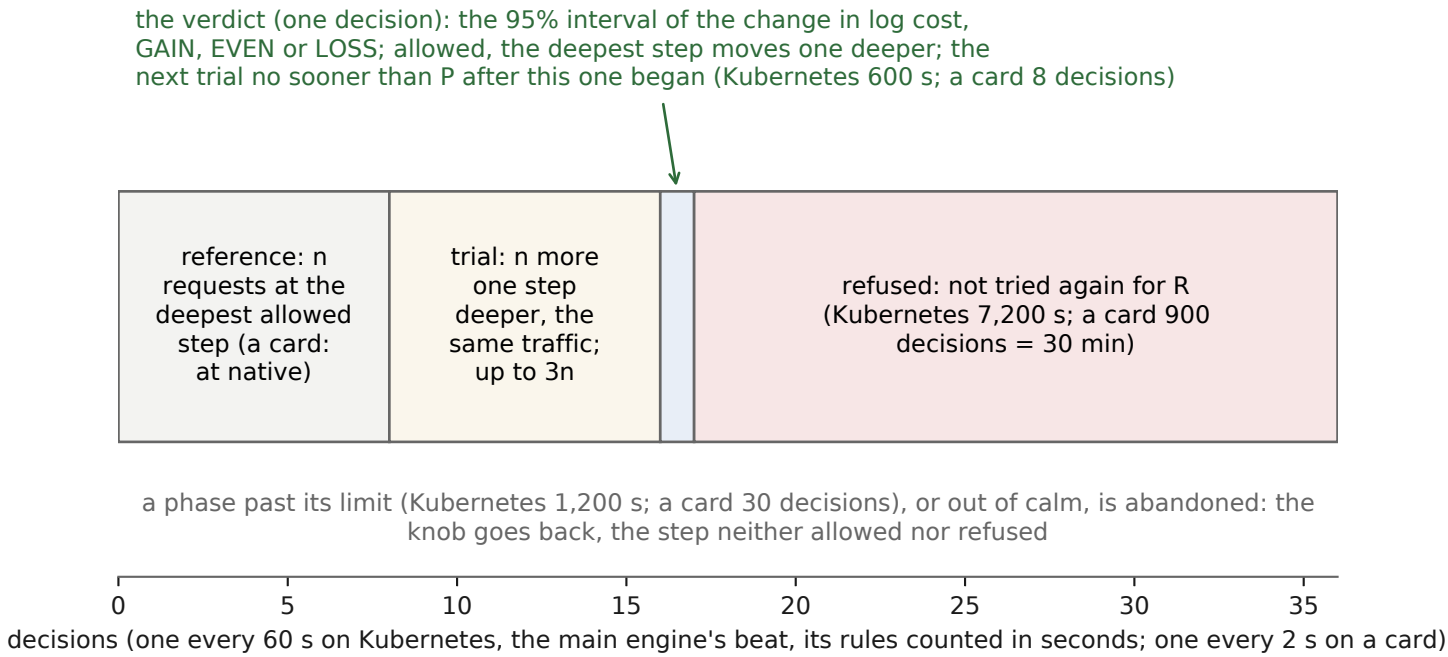



**Figure 22.** Timing diagram: a give-back trial from reference to verdict, in decisions. The reference (n requests at the deepest allowed step; on a card, at native), the trial (n more at one step deeper under the same traffic, measuring on up to 3n while the interval is wider than the allowance), the verdict in one decision, and, on a refusal, the quiet period in which the step is not tried again (7,200 s on Kubernetes, 120 decisions at the main engine's 60 s; 900 decisions on a card, 30 min).

A phase that outlasts its limit (1,200 s on Kubernetes; 30 decisions on a card), or sees the service leave calm, is abandoned: the knob goes back, the step neither allowed nor refused.

CHAPTER 8

# Stack by Stack

Every wiring below is the same plug (section 5.1): one wire in (the stack's own meter), one wire out (one setting the stack already accepts), a snapshot taken once before the first write, every write read back, everything restored on OFF. Native is always the stack's own controller left as shipped; omni is that controller with Omni-Compass on top.

| Stack | Levels | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Vanilla Kubernetes, kind, Rancher | 1-7 | as written |

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| Stack | Levels | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Amazon EKS | 1-5 | machines via Cluster Autoscaler node group or Karpenter; CPU power control is not exposed on EC2 VMs; GPUs on bare-metal or full-GPU instances |
| Google GKE, Azure AKS | 1-5 | the provider's node-pool size as the park/wake command; on AKS the managed cluster autoscaler stays native and deletes the machines Omni-Compass idles (7.1) |
| Red Hat OpenShift / OKD | 1-5 | the same permissions through a Role; machines via the worker MachineSet |
| NVIDIA GPU servers without Kubernetes | 5 | the two-wire GPU governor alone |
| Bare-metal CPU servers | 6 | cpufreq and RAPL through sysfs |
| Slurm / HPC | 5 on the GPU nodes | a job-level Slurm connector is not built |
| Building management | 7 | through your BMS's command line or API, in the command templates |
| PostgreSQL behind PgBouncer (any database behind a pooler with a console) | one knob | the pool size through the pooler's own admin console (7.2) |
| A power grid's substation tap changer (pandapower, SimBench) | one knob | the tap position, one whole tap per move (7.3) |
| Buildings with batteries (CityLearn) | one knob a building | the battery's charge and discharge inside the simulator's own limits (7.3) |
| Robot arms (MuJoCo Menagerie) | one knob an axis | the joint speed where the axis has slack; never on an axis at its takt (7.3) |
| A message broker's consumer group (Apache Kafka) | one knob | the consumer count inside [1, partitions], read from the consumers' own records; the rebalance paid on every move (7.4) |
| A cache's memory ceiling (Redis) | one knob | `maxmemory` through the cache's own console, grown only while the cache is full (7.5) |
| Drone swarms (gym-pybullet-drones; PX4 and ArduPilot next) | one knob a drone | the cruise override inside the autopilot's limits; a separation wall; collisions void the cell (7.6) |

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| Stack | Levels | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| A database's storage-engine cache (MongoDB under YCSB) | one knob | the WiredTiger cache size through the server's own console, grown only while the cache is full (7.7) |

## 8.1 Managed Kubernetes on Azure: the bill as the gauge

On Azure Kubernetes Service the muscle is the same as on any cluster (chapter 7, levels 1 to 3) and one thing is new: the bill is real. The workflow `aks-metered` builds a fresh cluster for every arm the same way: a system pool of one machine, tainted so no workload lands on it (Azure's add-ons and the load generator live there; it is never measured and never governed), and one or several **work pools** under Azure's own cluster autoscaler, every pool labelled `omni-role=work`, every pool starting full. Native is that autoscaler alone. Omni on top is the same autoscaler with Omni-Compass idling the machines it gives back, which the autoscaler then deletes on its own schedule. The bill counts every work machine that exists, every 15 seconds, priced at Azure's list price for its family; each cluster is deleted when its arm ends, so nothing keeps billing.

**Sizing the fleet to the lever.** The smallest saving a fleet can show is one machine. On 4 workers one machine is 25% of the fleet, so only a saving of about 30% or more can clear the noise; on 15 workers about 10%; on 96 about 3%. A few percent of a 4-worker fleet is less than one machine, so a 4-worker receipt reading no difference beyond the noise on the machine rows is the honest reading of a fleet too small for the lever, not a result against it. A new subscription allows 200 vCPUs in a region but 10 per machine family, so one family gives five 2-vCPU workers; the way past it is **several families at once**: eight pools of four to five workers each make a fleet of 39 (`worker_pools` input, `size:max,size:max,...`; `pool_prices` names each family's price). The app's replica ceiling is raised with the fleet (`hpa_max`: nine 200-millicore pods fit one 2-vCPU worker, so 9 × workers lets the fleet fill), the same in both arms; Omni-Compass's replica room, read live from what the machines can hold, lets the omni arm raise that cap while it binds and hand it back once demand holds still (section 3.4). A cloud region can refuse a new cluster for hours at a time; check the subscription's allowances before building anything, so that a refusal costs cents and not a cluster. The account setup, click by click, is in `docs/AZURE_SETUP.md`.

**In the cloud, the bill is the gauge, and it is never raised.** In a public cloud every machine that exists is billed, whether it carries work or not, so the aim on a managed cluster is native's work for a smaller bill, never a bigger one. The cloud therefore runs at the tune-down (`dial save`, the `dial` input of `aks-metered` and its default) with the governor on the machines alone (`OMNI_MACHINES_ONLY=1`, which starts the governor with its one cloud flag, `--give-back-only`): it moves no pod autoscaler, conveys no processor and caps no power, so the pods are exactly native's and the cloud's own autoscaler alone makes machines; the governor parks a machine the cloud already made only after its own trial shows the response time holds, and wakes it on a breach. It can hold no more pods and no more machines than native: the bill can only fall or stay, and it falls in the quiet stretches between bursts and in a day's trough. The max (`dial max`) belongs where the machines are already paid for (your own racks, a chip whose heat line is its limit), where more work from

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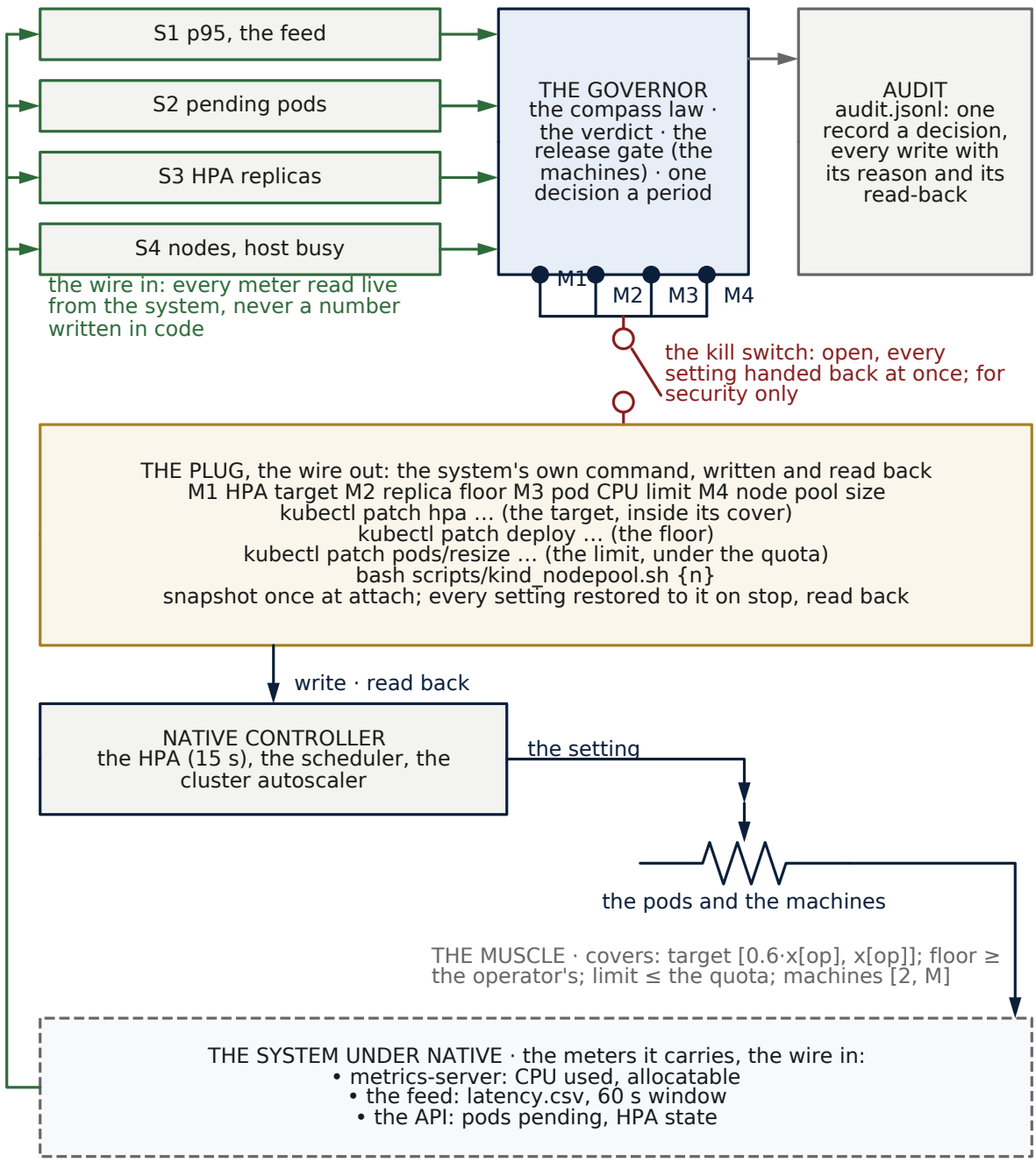



**Figure 23.** Wiring schematic: Kubernetes in the cluster, levels 2 to 4. The schematic is read top to bottom as an electrical drawing: the governor (the control unit) with its sense terminals S1, S2, … on the left and its motor terminals M1, M2, … on its lower edge; the motor bus through the kill switch into the plug, the system's own command written and read back; the plug into the native controller; the native controller setting the muscle, drawn as a potentiometer with its cover; the system under native carrying the meters; and the meters back along one bus, the wire in, to the sense terminals.

The audit stands beside the governor. Here the senses are the response-time feed, the pods waiting for a place, each autoscaler's replicas, and the machines with the host's busy share; the motors are the autoscaler's target,

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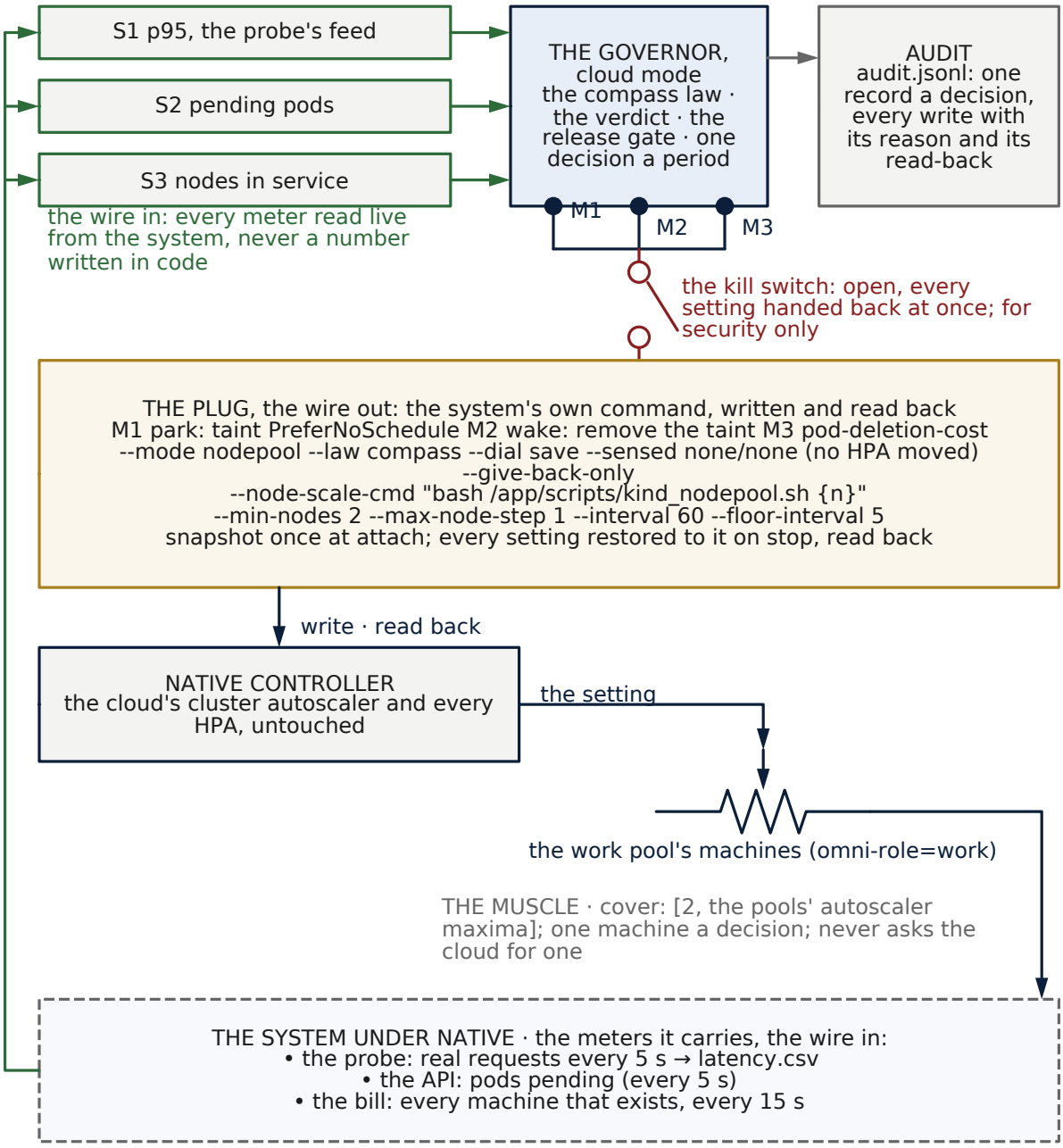



**Figure 24.** Wiring schematic: a managed cloud cluster, the machines alone (the cloud mode). The schematic is read top to bottom as an electrical drawing: the governor (the control unit) with its sense terminals S1, S2, … on the left and its motor terminals M1, M2, … on its lower edge; the motor bus through the kill switch into the plug, the system's own command written and read back; the plug into the native controller; the native controller setting the muscle, drawn as a potentiometer with its cover; the system under native carrying the meters; and the meters back along one bus, the wire in, to the sense terminals.

The audit stands beside the governor. The senses are the probe's feed, the pods waiting and the machines in service; the only motors park a machine (a PreferNoSchedule taint), wake it (the taint removed) and mark its

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pods first to go; no autoscaler is moved, no processor conveyed, no power capped. A machine is parked only after its own trial (the response time holds within 2%) and woken on a breach: at the next decision (15 s) for a response time over the line, at the next fast check (5 s) for a waiting pod. No cloud credential: the governor holds a Kubernetes service account that can read, taint and annotate, nothing more.

the replica floor, the pod CPU limit and the node pool size, each through kubectl's own patch and resize commands. Level 2: the target and the floor; level 3: the machines through the release gate and the verdict; level 4 (--strict-replicas): the replica decision itself. The HPA keeps its own 15-second check underneath. Nothing is ever deleted or evicted; a parked machine is emptied by the autoscaler's own scale-down.

the same machines is the gain; in a cloud it buys speed with machines, and every machine it adds is on the bill. The benefit of the max is taken before the cloud, in the service's own engine, or after it, in the chip. In the cloud, as everywhere, the governor's fast check (a parked machine woken for pods that wait) runs every 5 seconds, three times as fast as the autoscaler's own 15-second check, and its full decision every 60 seconds, the main engine's beat (a dial: 15 seconds, the autoscaler's own pace, is one of its settings); a pod's start and a new machine's join are not shortened by deciding faster, so the governor acts on the reading while it climbs, before the line. On machines already paid for, the fast checks also give the running pods the processor their machine already has, which takes seconds and needs no new pod; in the cloud mode that lever is off, because a pod given more processor reads busier to its autoscaler, which then asks for more pods and, through them, more machines.

## 8.2 A database behind its connection pooler

PostgreSQL is wired through PgBouncer, the pooler most of its deployments already run. Nothing models the database. The wire in is the pooler's own report (`SHOW STATS`, `SHOW POOLS`), read once a second over one connection held open for the whole run, so that no process is launched for a reading: the larger of two figures, the time a transaction spent in the server plus the time clients waited for one, over the transactions completed, and the share of the pooler's clients queued for a server. The second figure is what makes the wire honest: a pool too small for the offered rate shows at the pooler as clients waiting even while its own service time reads calm. The wire out is one setting through the pooler's own admin console, `SET default_pool_size`, inside the cover [2, 90]: never under two server connections, never within ten of PostgreSQL's connection limit. The reading is held at 40% of a 50 ms line. Where the time was spent decides the direction: while clients waited for a server one percent or more of the last second, servers are added back, one for every percent of waiting, up to the pooler's own setting; a server is taken back only while clients waited under one percent of the second and a transaction was served, and only one the pooler itself shows idle. At 95% of the line the knob is handed back to the pooler's own setting at once. If the knob is found at a value Omni-Compass did not write, it stops writing (one writer). At the end of every omni arm the pool size is restored to the snapshot and read back. The same plug fits any pooler or proxy with a console and a pool-size setting (PgBouncer, Pgpool-II, ProxySQL, the application's own pool); the processor time the plug's own readings take on the host is recorded beside the host's, so the receipt shows what the wiring itself costs.

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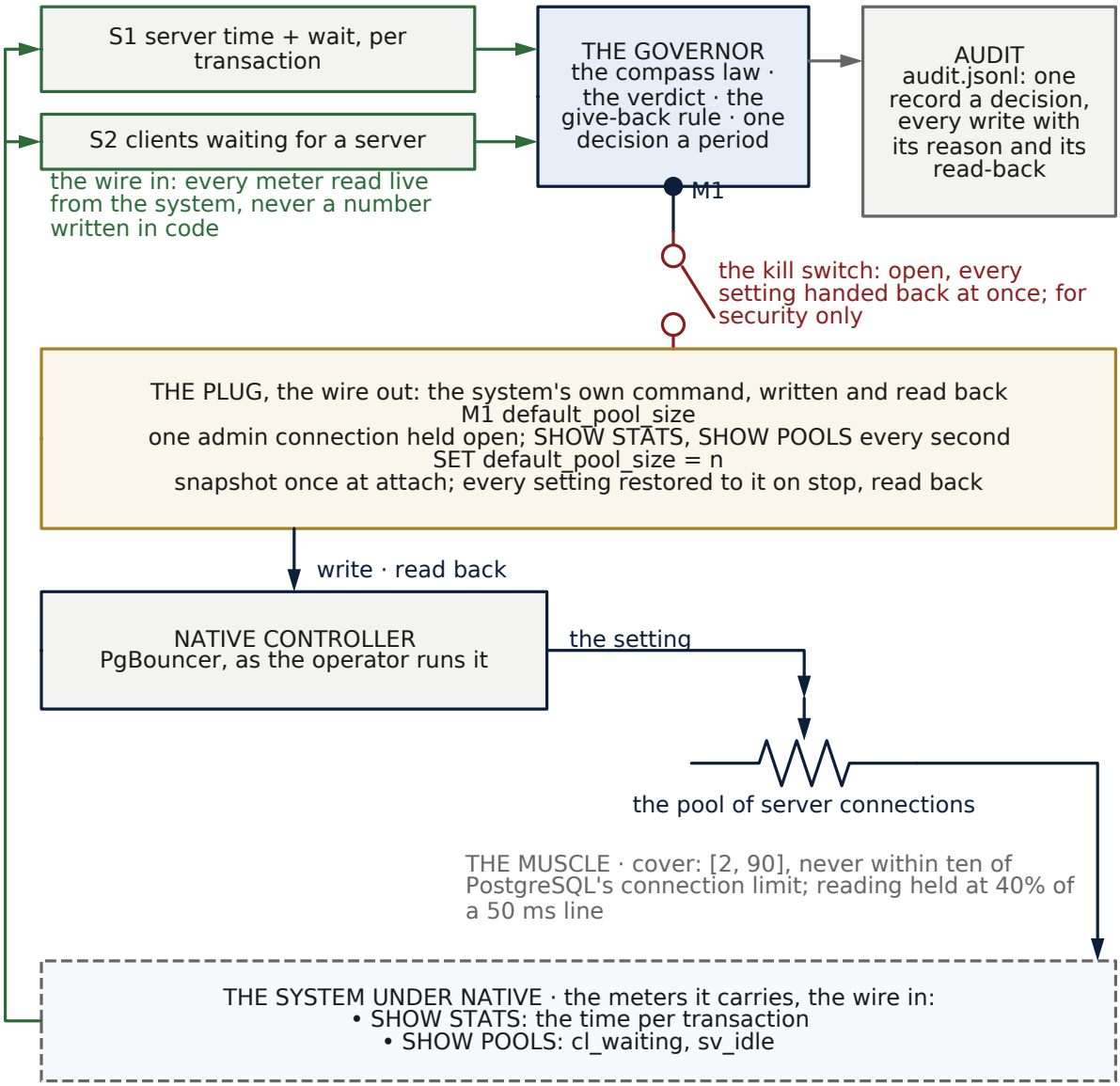


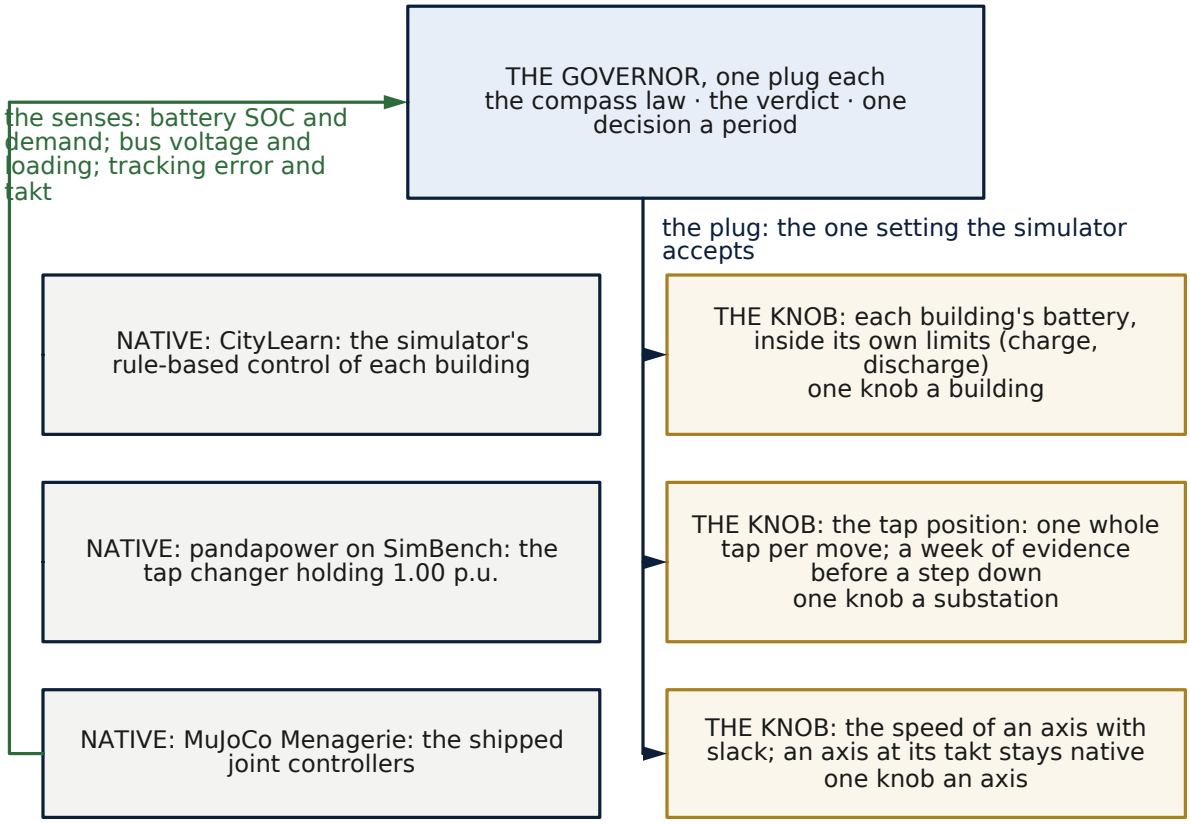

**Figure 25.** Wiring schematic: a database behind its connection pooler. The schematic is read top to bottom as an electrical drawing: the governor (the control unit) with its sense terminals S1, S2, … on the left and its motor terminals M1, M2, … on its lower edge; the motor bus through the kill switch into the plug, the system's own command written and read back; the plug into the native controller; the native controller setting the muscle, drawn as a potentiometer with its cover; the system under native carrying the meters; and the meters back along one bus, the wire in, to the sense terminals.

The audit stands beside the governor. The senses are the server time plus the wait per transaction and the clients waiting for a server; the one motor is default_pool_size, written over one admin connection held open. Up: a server for every percent of clients waiting; down: one idle server, only while clients waited under 1%; at 95% of the line the pool goes back to the pooler's own setting at once. One writer; the restore read back at the end.

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## 8.3 Independent simulators, each with its own native controller

Three published simulators show how the plug is wired onto three more kinds of native controller, and the simulator's own controller is always native:




The simulator's own controller is native in every cell; the plug writes the one setting it accepts, reads it back and restores it at the end. Receipts are class S: statements about the simulator's model, never about hardware.

**Figure 26.** Wiring schematic: three independent simulators, each on its own native controller. One plug for each: CityLearn's rule-based control of each building, pandapower's tap changer on SimBench, and the shipped joint controllers of the MuJoCo Menagerie. The governor writes the one setting each simulator accepts, reads it back and restores it at the end; the senses come back along one bus. Receipts here are class S: statements about the simulator's model, never about hardware.

- **A building's batteries** (CityLearn): the knob is each building's battery charge and discharge inside the simulator's own limits; native is the simulator's own rule-based control.
- **A substation's tap changer** (pandapower on SimBench grids): the knob is the tap position, one whole tap per move and a week of evidence before stepping down; native holds the tap at 1.00 per unit as the grid ships.

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- **A robot arm's joints** (MuJoCo Menagerie): the knob is the joint speed of an axis that has slack; a paired physics trial before the run leaves an axis at its takt native, so an arm whose axes are all at their takt has nothing for Omni-Compass to move.

The same three wirings apply to the real controllers they model: a building management system's battery dispatch, a substation's tap-changer controller, a robot's servo limits. Receipts from a simulator are evidence class S: statements about the simulator's model, never about hardware.

## 8.4 A message broker's consumer group

Apache Kafka is wired as an operator runs it: one broker as shipped, a topic of eight partitions, a consumer group at the operator's count of two. Nothing models the broker. The wire in is the group's own end-to-end latency: each message carries its production time, each consumer records when its handling ended, and the reading is the mean over the messages consumed in the last second; a second with nothing consumed while messages wait reads as the line (someone is waiting and no one is taking), and nothing consumed with nothing waiting reads as calm. The wire out is the count of consumers in the group, which is what an operator changes, inside the cover [1, 8]: never fewer than one, never more than the topic has partitions. The compass holds the reading at 40% of a 500 ms line with a response time of 3 s, because a consumer added or removed shows only after the group rebalances. Slow service with messages waiting adds consumers in proportion to the force; calm with nothing waiting gives back one idle consumer a second after a five-second dwell; at 95% of the line every consumer the topic can use starts at once. The rebalance that every move costs is paid by Omni-Compass and counted in the gauges. At the end of every omni arm the count is handed back to the operator's and read back. The receipt this wiring is built to produce has the queue kept short and no message lost, at the cost of consumers running, which reads power given by rule and stands beside the gain.

## 8.5 A cache's memory ceiling

Redis is wired as Ubuntu ships it, with the two settings an operator sets for a cache, a memory ceiling of 64 MB and the allkeys-lru eviction rule. The application in front of it is ours and declared: 1,500 requests a second from 32 threads on a Zipf working set that widens and narrows one notch at a time; a miss costs a declared 5 ms trip to the store behind the cache and a write-back. The wire in is the application's own request latency, the mean over the last second (a hit about 0.3 ms, a miss about 5.5 ms). The wire out is one setting through Redis's own console, `CONFIG SET maxmemory`, inside the cover [16, 512] MB. The compass holds the reading at 40% of a 2 ms line. Its direction rule carries the do-no-harm gate in the form this stack needs: misses grow the ceiling by notches of 8 MB **only while the cache is full** (memory used at 90% of the ceiling or more), because a miss in a cache with room to spare is a cold miss that no ceiling can mend; calm with nothing evicted in the last second gives back one notch a second, after a five-second dwell since the last growth; at 95% of the line with the cache full a quarter of the cover is added at once. One writer: a ceiling found at a value Omni-Compass did not write stops it. At the end of every omni arm the ceiling is handed back to the operator's 64 MB and read back. The memory the compass holds for a wide working set is the resource this wiring trades and reads power given by rule; the gain is the hit rate and the work inside the line.

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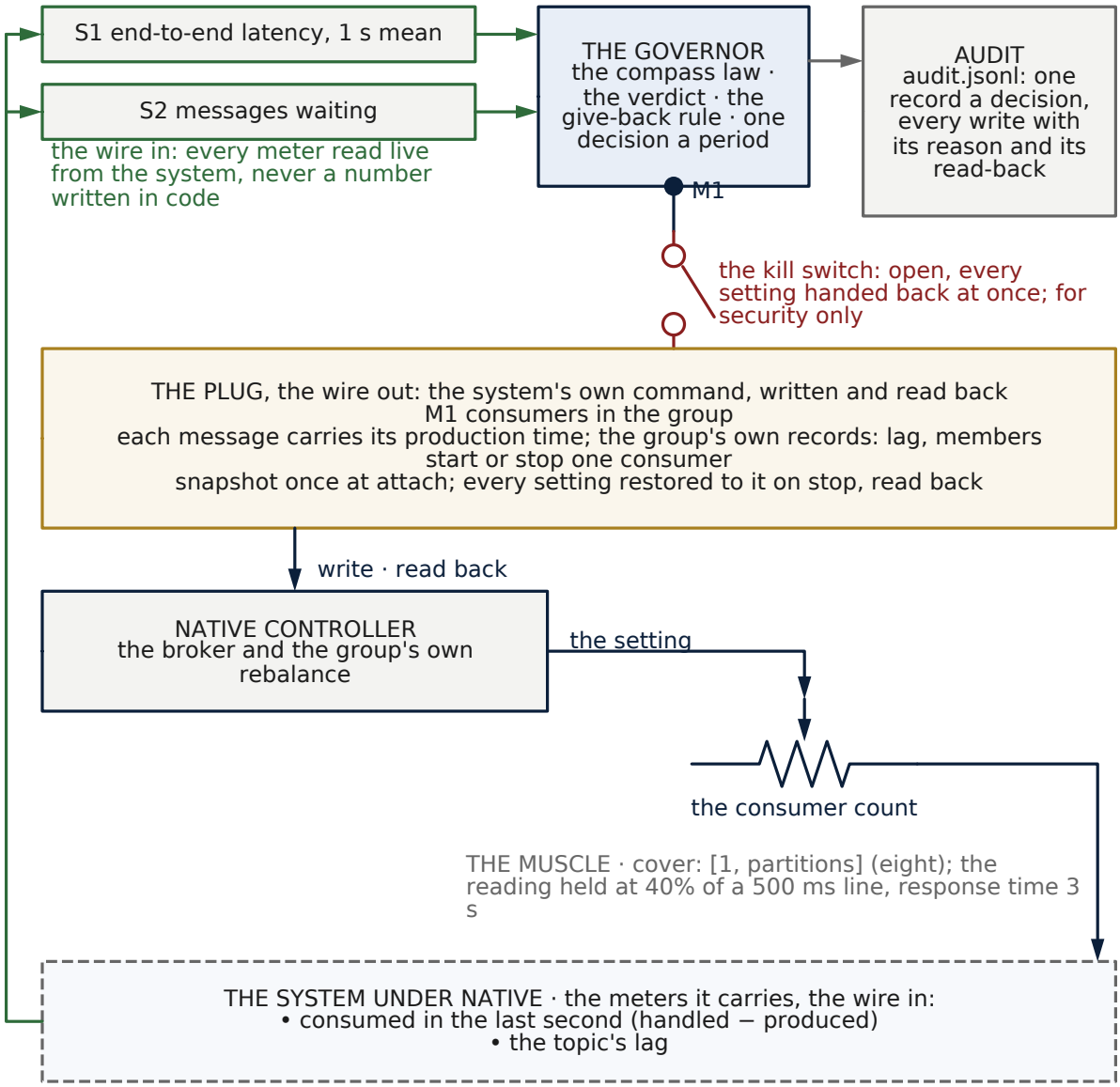



**Figure 27.** Wiring schematic: a message broker's consumer group. The schematic is read top to bottom as an electrical drawing: the governor (the control unit) with its sense terminals S1, S2, … on the left and its motor terminals M1, M2, … on its lower edge; the motor bus through the kill switch into the plug, the system's own command written and read back; the plug into the native controller; the native controller setting the muscle, drawn as a potentiometer with its cover; the system under native carrying the meters; and the meters back along one bus, the wire in, to the sense terminals.

The audit stands beside the governor. The senses are the end-to-end latency and the messages waiting; the one motor starts or stops one consumer. Slow with messages waiting: consumers added in proportion to the force; calm with nothing waiting: one idle consumer given back a second after a five-second dwell; at 95% of the line every consumer the topic can use. The rebalance every move costs is paid by Omni-Compass and counted in the gauges.

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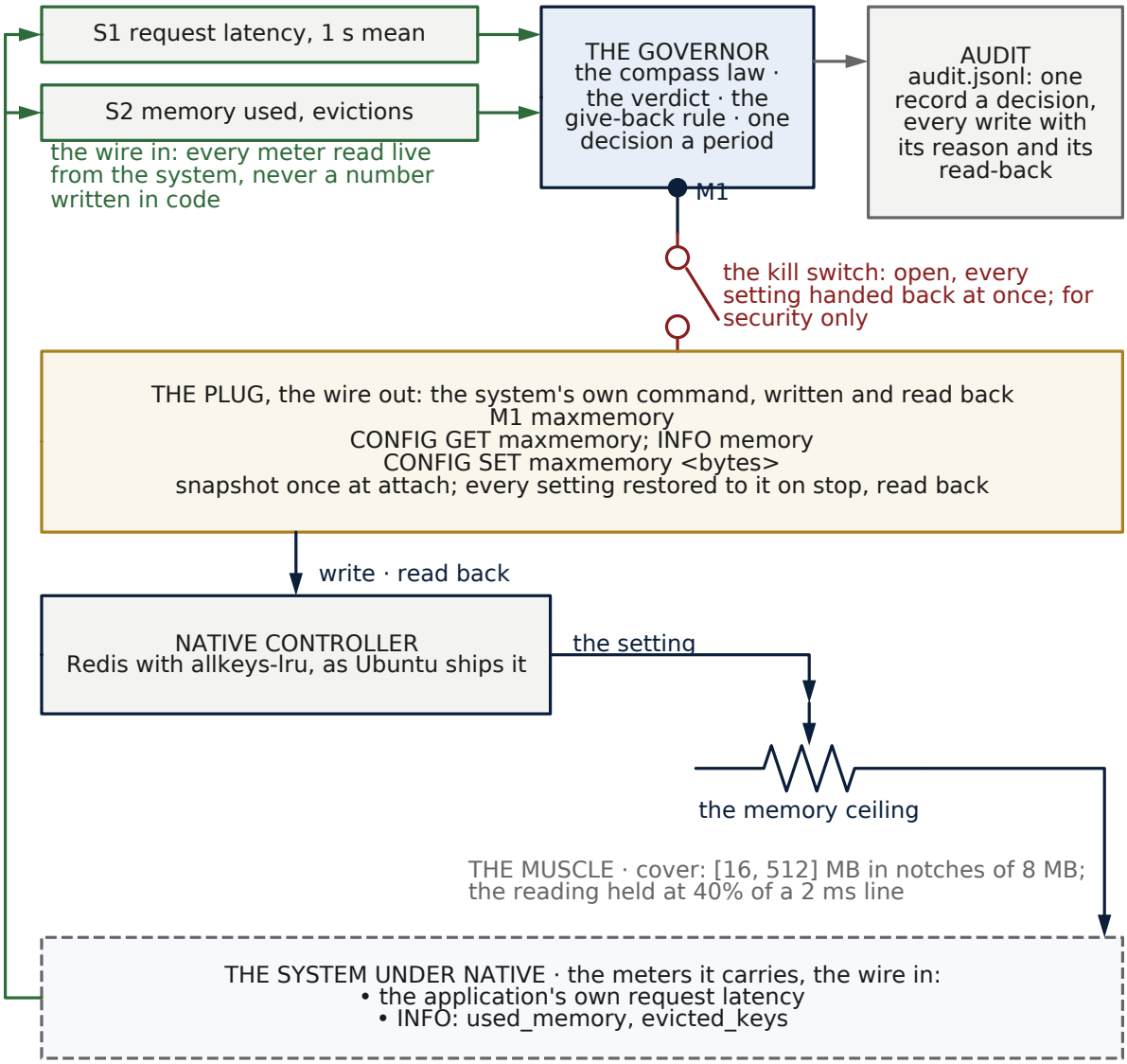



**Figure 28.** Wiring schematic: a cache's memory ceiling. The schematic is read top to bottom as an electrical drawing: the governor (the control unit) with its sense terminals S1, S2, … on the left and its motor terminals M1, M2, … on its lower edge; the motor bus through the kill switch into the plug, the system's own command written and read back; the plug into the native controller; the native controller setting the muscle, drawn as a potentiometer with its cover; the system under native carrying the meters; and the meters back along one bus, the wire in, to the sense terminals.

The audit stands beside the governor. The senses are the request latency and the memory used with the evictions; the one motor is maxmemory, written with CONFIG SET. Misses grow the ceiling only while the cache is full (used ≥ 90% of the ceiling); calm with nothing evicted gives one notch back a second after a five-second dwell; at 95% of the line with the cache full, a quarter of the cover.

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## 8.6 Drone swarms: the autopilot's cruise

In gym-pybullet-drones (University of Toronto, MIT License) every Crazyflie 2.x flies its shipped position controller along the planner's path at the planner's cruise: that is native. The wire in is each drone's tracking error, the distance between the drone and the point its autopilot was told to be at, on a band from 0 to a declared safe error of 0.25 m. The wire out is one knob a drone, the cruise override: the fraction of the planner's cruise the carrot moves at, never under 1.0 (the planner's own) and never over 2.0 (a quarter of the autopilot's own speed limit), moving by at most 0.01 a control tick. With slack the compass spends it as speed; as the error grows it eases; at 95% of the safe error the cruise is the planner's at once. Two guards belong to this stack: a **separation wall** (a drone with another within 0.5 m flies the planner's cruise, whatever the error reads) and the **paired physics trial** before the counted missions, which asks the simulator's own figures whether a faster mission costs less energy at all and keeps the error under the safe error; where it does not, the override is left native for that cell and the cell reads "nothing for Omni to move". Energy is a declared model from the simulator's own motor constants, said to be a model wherever it is printed; a collision voids the cell. At every landing and at the end of the run the override is handed back and read back.

## 8.7 A database's storage-engine cache

MongoDB is wired as an operator runs it: the server as its publisher ships it, its configuration as shipped but for the one setting an operator sets for the storage engine, the WiredTiger cache (512 MB in the reference wiring). The wire in is the server's own mean read latency over the last second, from its `serverStatus` operation latencies, differenced, beside the cache's own counters (bytes in the cache, pages requested from it and pages read into it). The wire out is one setting through the server's own console, `setParameter wiredTigerEngineRuntimeConfig cache_size`, inside the cover [256 MB, 2,048 MB]: the server's own floor at one end, a quarter of the machine at the other. The line is set on the stack's own figures so that a hit reads calm and a full cache that misses reads slow (1 ms in the reference wiring, held at 40%). The direction rule is the cache's: slow reads grow the cache by notches of 64 MB only while the cache is full (bytes in it at 90% of its size or more) and missing (pages read into it one percent or more of the pages requested from it in the last second), because slow reads in a cache with room to spare, or in a cache that already holds its working set, are not the cache's to mend; calm gives back one notch a second after a five-second dwell, and only while the cache's miss share is under one percent, because "no page evicted" is true of every cold cache while it fills; at 95% of the line with the cache full a quarter of the cover is added at once. One writer, read-back and the hand-back at the end are the plug's, as everywhere. Where the data files fit in the operating system's own page cache, a storage-engine cache miss is a read from memory and a decompression, not a disk read, so the gain available to this knob is smaller than on a machine whose data does not fit in memory; say so beside the receipt. The same plug fits any store whose engine exposes a cache size at run time (InnoDB's buffer pool, RocksDB's block cache); a store that can only be sized at restart has no knob Omni-Compass moves.

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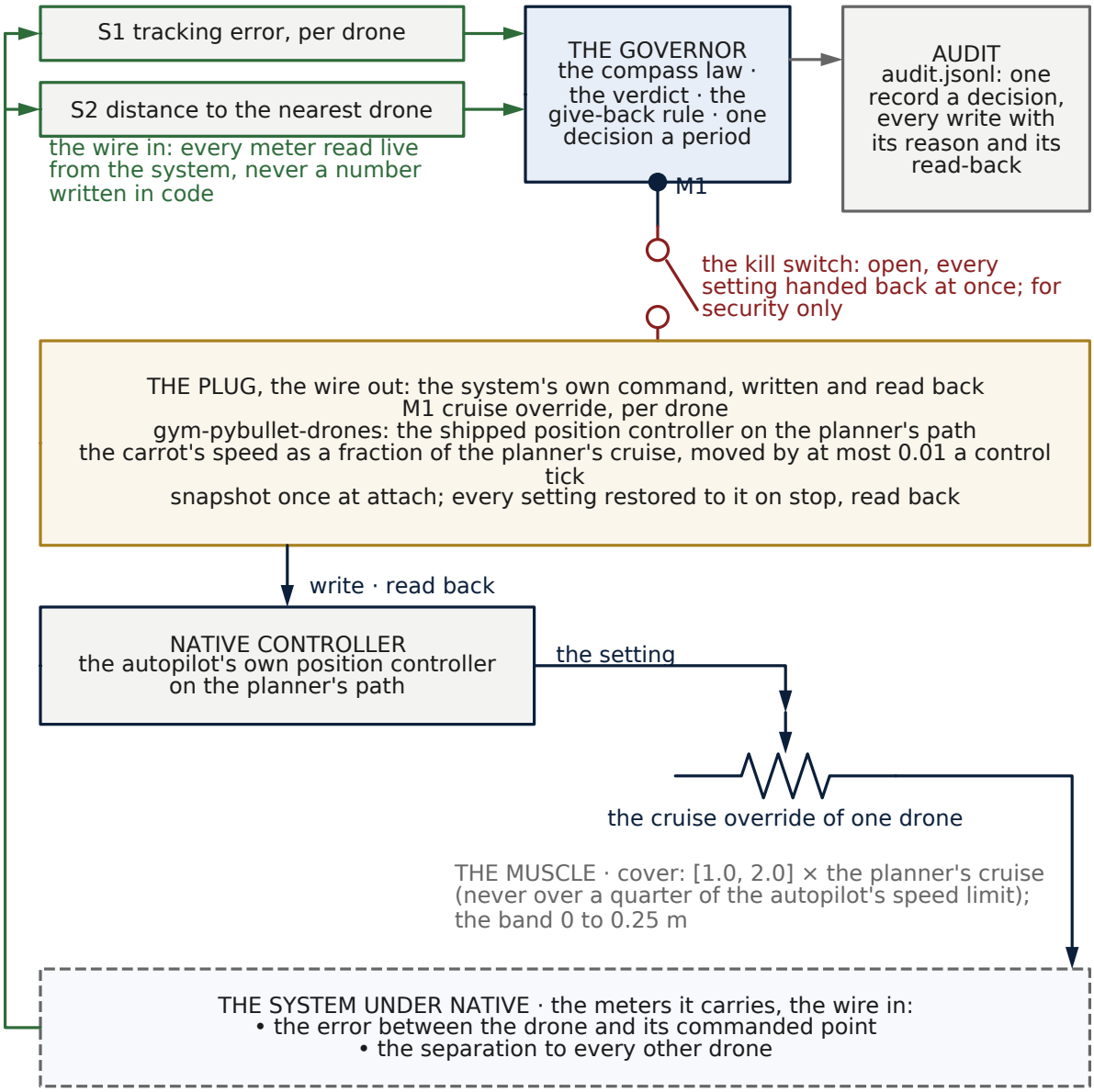



**Figure 29.** Wiring schematic: a drone swarm's cruise override. The schematic is read top to bottom as an electrical drawing: the governor (the control unit) with its sense terminals S1, S2, … on the left and its motor terminals M1, M2, … on its lower edge; the motor bus through the kill switch into the plug, the system's own command written and read back; the plug into the native controller; the native controller setting the muscle, drawn as a potentiometer with its cover; the system under native carrying the meters; and the meters back along one bus, the wire in, to the sense terminals.

The audit stands beside the governor. The senses are each drone's tracking error and its distance to the nearest drone; the one motor is the cruise override of one drone, a fraction of the planner's cruise moved by at most 0.01 a control tick. With slack the compass spends it as speed; as the error grows it eases; at 95% of the safe error the planner's cruise at once. The separation wall: a drone within 0.5 m of another flies the planner's cruise whatever the error reads. A collision voids the cell.

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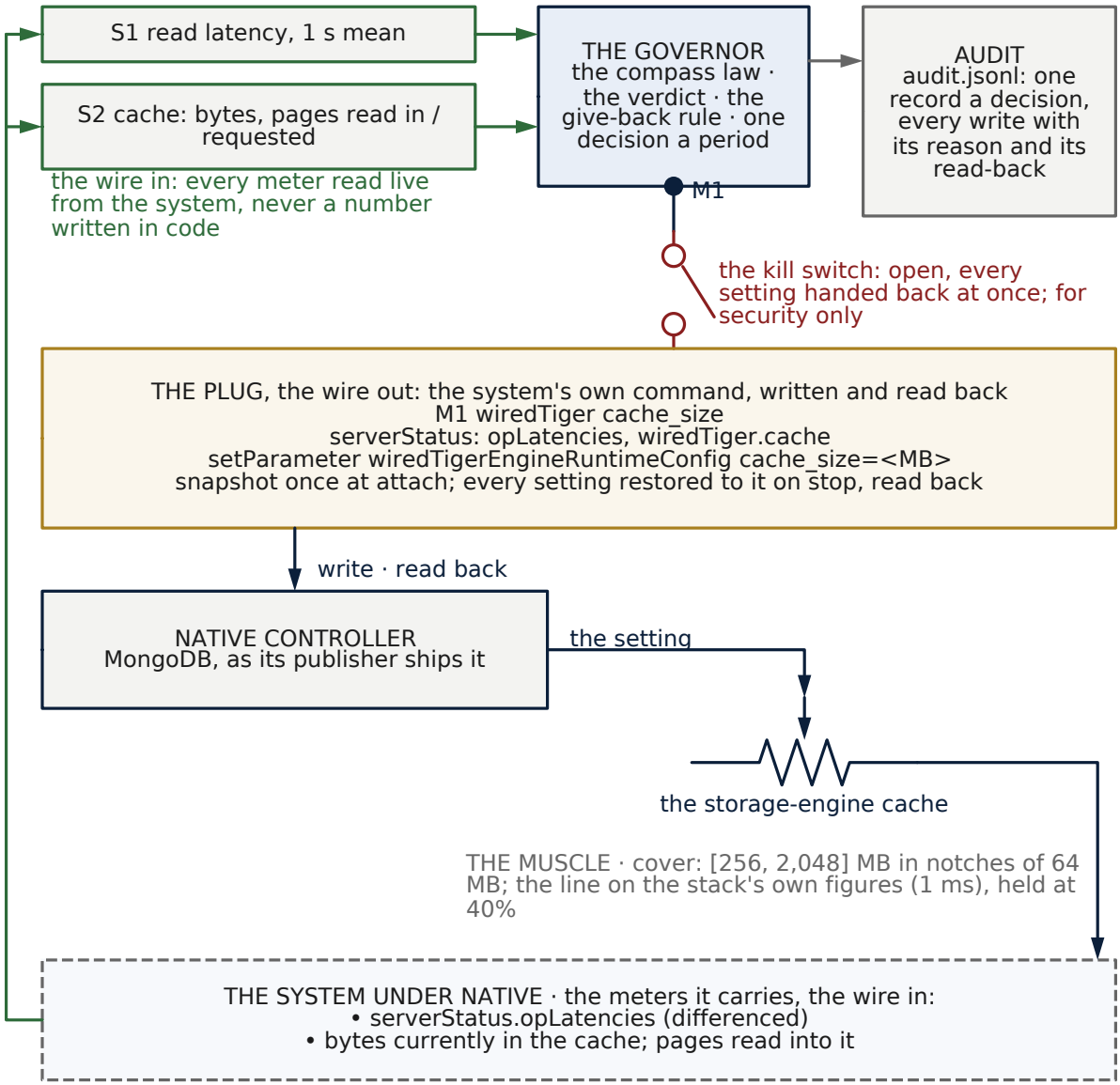



**Figure 30.** Wiring schematic: a database's storage-engine cache. The schematic is read top to bottom as an electrical drawing: the governor (the control unit) with its sense terminals S1, S2, … on the left and its motor terminals M1, M2, … on its lower edge; the motor bus through the kill switch into the plug, the system's own command written and read back; the plug into the native controller; the native controller setting the muscle, drawn as a potentiometer with its cover; the system under native carrying the meters; and the meters back along one bus, the wire in, to the sense terminals.

The audit stands beside the governor. The senses are the read latency and the cache's bytes with its pages read in against pages requested; the one motor is the WiredTiger cache size, written through setParameter. Grow only while the cache is full (≥ 90%) and missing (pages read in ≥ 1% of pages requested); give one notch back after a five-second dwell only while the miss share is under 1%; at 95% of the line with the cache full, a quarter of the cover.

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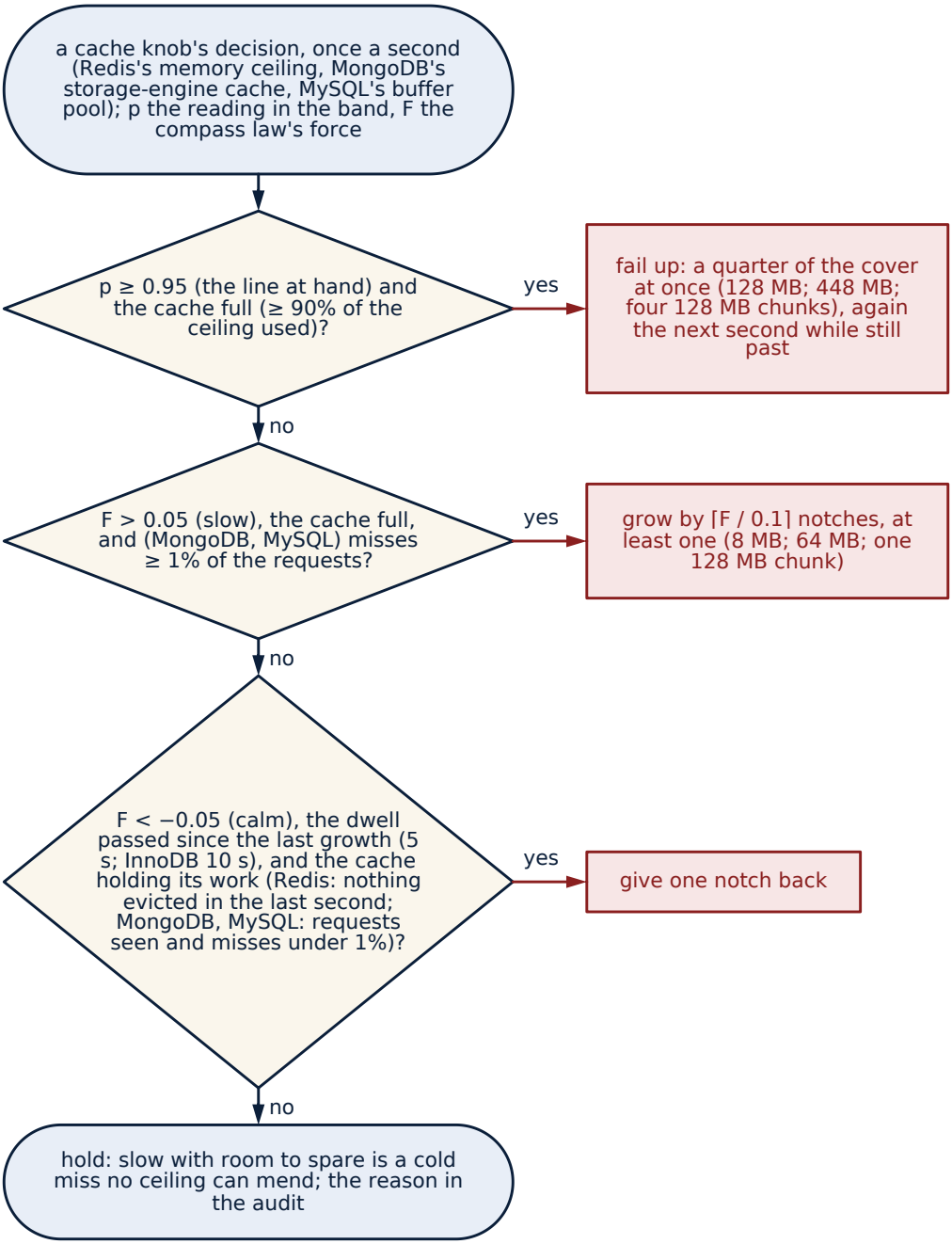



**Figure 31.** Flowchart: the direction rule of a cache knob (Redis, MongoDB, MySQL), once a second, tested in this order. With the reading at 95% of the line or more and the cache full (90% of its ceiling used), a quarter of the cover is added at once (128 MB; 448 MB; four 128 MB chunks), again the next second while still past. Slow (the compass law's force over 0.05) with the cache full, and for MongoDB and MySQL with misses at 1% of the requests or more, the knob grows by ⌈F / 0.1⌉ notches, at least one (8 MB; 64 MB; one 128 MB chunk).

Calm (the force under −0.05), the dwell passed since the last growth (5 s; 10 s for InnoDB) and the cache holding its work (Redis: nothing evicted in the last second; MongoDB and MySQL: requests seen and misses

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under 1%), one notch is given back. Otherwise the knob holds, because a slow read in a cache with room is a cold miss no ceiling can mend.

## 8.8 A database's buffer pool, resized online in the server's own chunks

MySQL is wired as an operator runs it: the server as its distribution ships it, its configuration as shipped but for the settings an operator sets for InnoDB, the buffer pool (512 MB in the reference wiring), the chunk the server resizes in at its shipped 128 MB, one pool instance, and the performance schema on. The wire in is the server's own mean statement latency over the last second, from the performance schema's statement summary, differenced, beside the pool's own read requests and reads from disk. The wire out is one statement through the server's own console, `SET GLOBAL innodb_buffer_pool_size`, inside the cover [128 MB, 2,048 MB] and always in whole chunks, because that is how the server itself moves the pool. Two things about this knob differ from a cache the server resizes at once, and the plug carries both. The server resizes asynchronously and reports its progress in its own status variable, so the plug waits for the resize to complete before reading back, and a pool found mid-resize is the server still carrying out Omni-Compass's own write, not a foreign hand. And a shrink evicts pages while the resize runs, so the dwell after any move is ten seconds rather than five. The line is set on the stack's own figures, above a hit and under a miss (a 0.6 ms statement line in the reference wiring, held at 40%). Slow statements grow the pool by chunks only while the pool is full and missing (one percent or more of its read requests), at 95% of the line with the pool full four chunks are added at once, and calm gives one chunk back after the dwell only while the pool's misses are under one percent of its read requests and a read request was served, because InnoDB keeps stale pages resident, so neither "pages free" nor "no page read from disk" ever says that a pool holds its working set, and the miss share does. **The hand-back waits for the server.** Under load InnoDB finishes a shrink only when the pages the load has pinned are released, and it ignores a new pool size while a resize is in progress; the plug therefore waits for the resize the server is carrying out, writes the snapshot, writes once more if the server ignored the first write, and records the restore (what was in flight, the seconds waited, the writes, the final read-back) in every omni arm's receipt. A knob the device applies on its own time is handed back on the device's time, and the proof of the hand-back is the read-back, not the write.

## 8.9 The machine itself: the kernel's frequency governor under the processor's meter

The lowest level a governor can sit on is the machine it runs on. Linux already has a controller for the processor's clock, the frequency governor (`schedutil`, or the processor driver's own), choosing the clock every few milliseconds under a ceiling the operator sets once; and the processor has its own energy meter (RAPL) ticking in microjoules. Omni-Compass sits on top of the governor exactly as it sits on the HPA: the governor keeps running, and Omni moves one knob, the frequency ceiling of every CPU, through the kernel's own files.

The reading is the service's own mean latency, held at 40% of a 20 ms line by the compass law; calm gives one notch of the ceiling back (5% of the top clock), a slow service raises it by notches, the wall puts the top on

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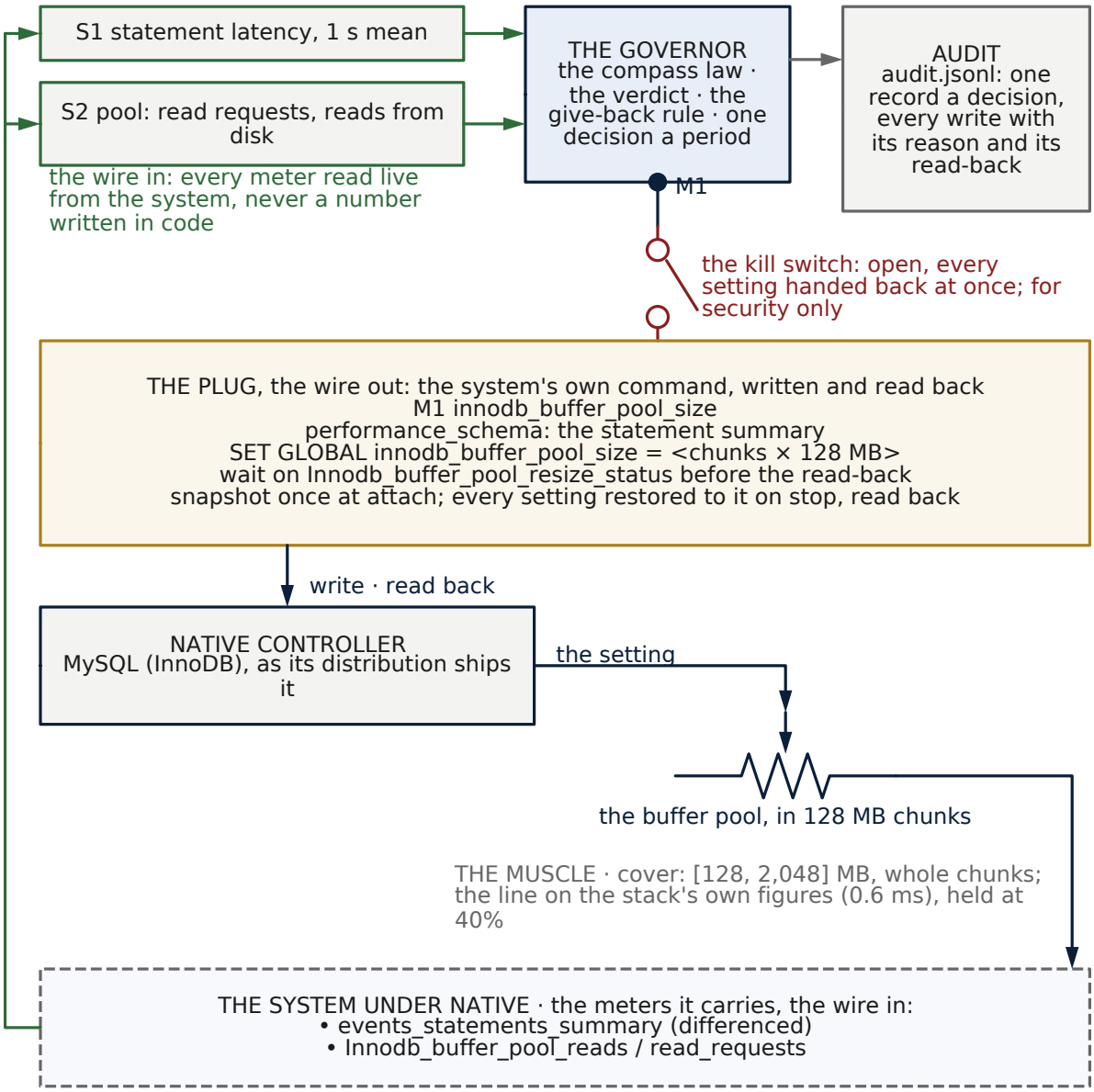



**Figure 32.** Wiring schematic: a buffer pool resized online in the server's own chunks. The schematic is read top to bottom as an electrical drawing: the governor (the control unit) with its sense terminals S1, S2, … on the left and its motor terminals M1, M2, … on its lower edge; the motor bus through the kill switch into the plug, the system's own command written and read back; the plug into the native controller; the native controller setting the muscle, drawn as a potentiometer with its cover; the system under native carrying the meters; and the meters back along one bus, the wire in, to the sense terminals.

The audit stands beside the governor. The senses are the statement latency and the pool's read requests against reads from disk; the one motor is innodb_buffer_pool_size, in whole 128 MB chunks. The server resizes on its own time: the plug waits for the resize before reading back, and the dwell after a move is ten seconds; the hand-back waits for the server too, writes again if ignored, and records what it waited for.

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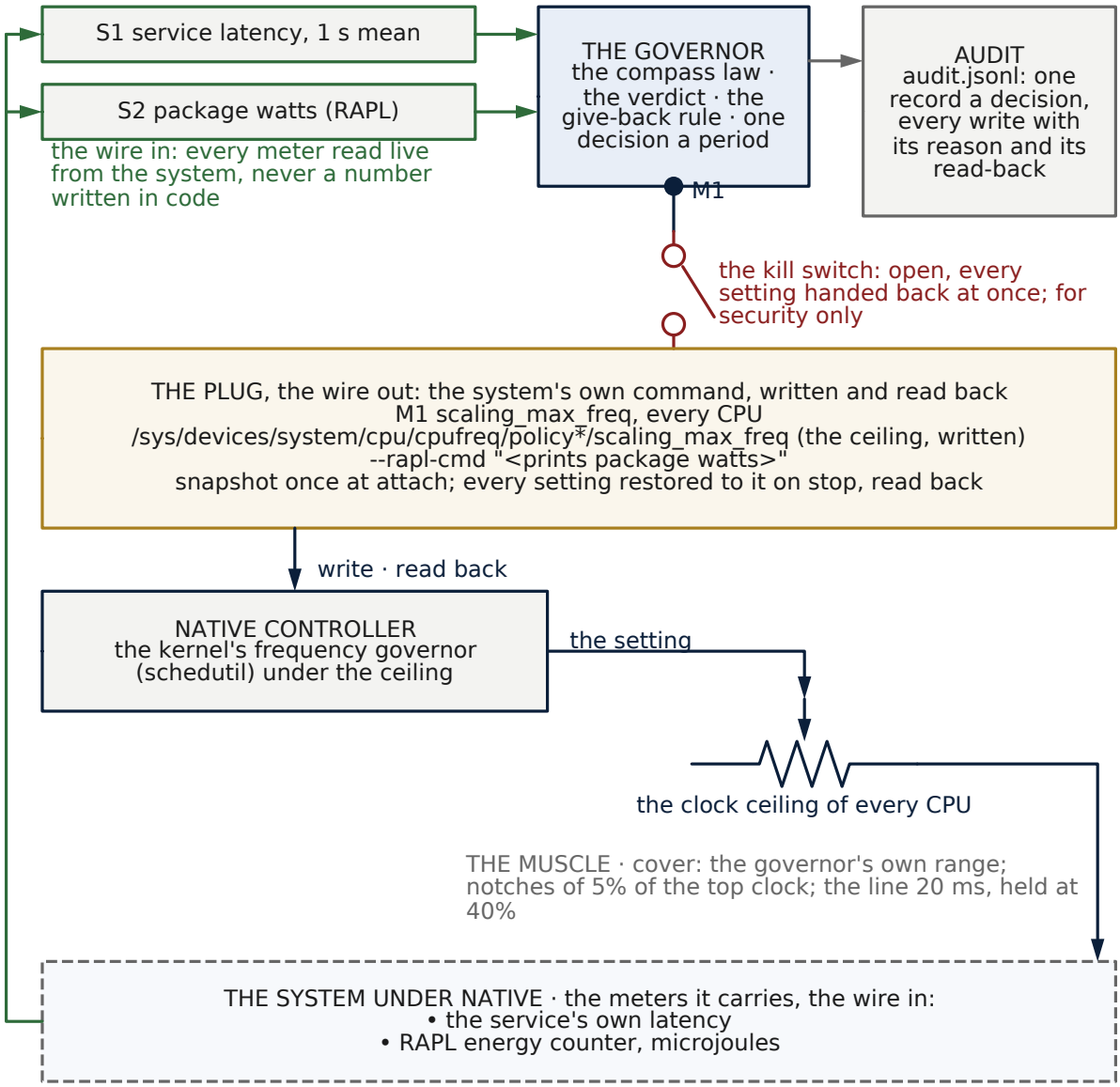



**Figure 33.** Wiring schematic: the machine's frequency governor under the processor's meter. The schematic is read top to bottom as an electrical drawing: the governor (the control unit) with its sense terminals S1, S2, … on the left and its motor terminals M1, M2, … on its lower edge; the motor bus through the kill switch into the plug, the system's own command written and read back; the plug into the native controller; the native controller setting the muscle, drawn as a potentiometer with its cover; the system under native carrying the meters; and the meters back along one bus, the wire in, to the sense terminals.

The audit stands beside the governor. The senses are the service's latency and the package watts from RAPL; the one motor is scaling_max_freq, the ceiling of every CPU's frequency policy. Every notch down is tried on the machine first: eight cost samples at the deepest notch allowed and eight one further, allowed only if package power × latency / work inside the line does not rise within 2%. A snapshot of every policy, restored exactly.

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at once. Every notch down is tried on the machine itself first (section 7.4): the paired trial, eight cost samples at the deepest notch already allowed and eight one notch further, allowed only if the cost does not rise within 2%. The cost is the index's own reading for one machine (package power × latency / work inside the line), so a notch that saves less energy than it costs in speed is refused and the ceiling stays where the operator left it; a second declared objective, energy per request inside the line with the line as the guardrail, is run beside it. The snapshot of every CPU's governor and ceiling is taken once; the ceiling is handed back and read back at the end; a ceiling found at a value Omni-Compass did not write stops it; the master switch and the lease hand back if Omni-Compass dies.

The meter is the processor's own counter, class P with the caveat that it is the processor's calibrated counter and not an external meter; a smart plug on the wall socket (`WALL_METER`) adds the whole machine, read by the harness only. GitHub's own machines are virtual and expose neither the governor nor the meter. The paired run for this muscle runs on a machine on the metal as root, in one command (`sudo bash scripts/cpu_power_run.sh`): a workstation on Linux, a bare-metal server, or a self-hosted runner on either.

## 8.10 The data center under the servers: cooling, power and batteries

Under every cluster in this book stands a building. Its native controllers are older and more conservative than any autoscaler: the building management system holds the supply-air temperature through the cooling units' own loops, the chilled-water plant runs its own sequence, the uninterruptible power supply holds its reserve, the power distribution units meter every rack, and every server's management controller and every card's firmware enforce their own power limits. Omni-Compass sits on top of them exactly as it sits on the HPA. They keep running; it moves only the settings they already accept, and only inside the band the operator writes down.

**What it may set, and what it never sets.**

| Muscle | Native controller | The knob Omni-Compass may hold | Switch | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cooling | the building management system and the cooling units' own loops | the supply-air setpoint, inside the operator's band | `--cooling-cmd "<sets {c}>" --cooling-min-c --cooling-max-c --cooling-restore-c` | built (level 7) |
| Site power | the site's own limit and its breakers | none: site watts are read, and the site limit enters the engine as a stress | `--power-cmd "<prints site watts>" --site-limit-w` | built (level 7) |

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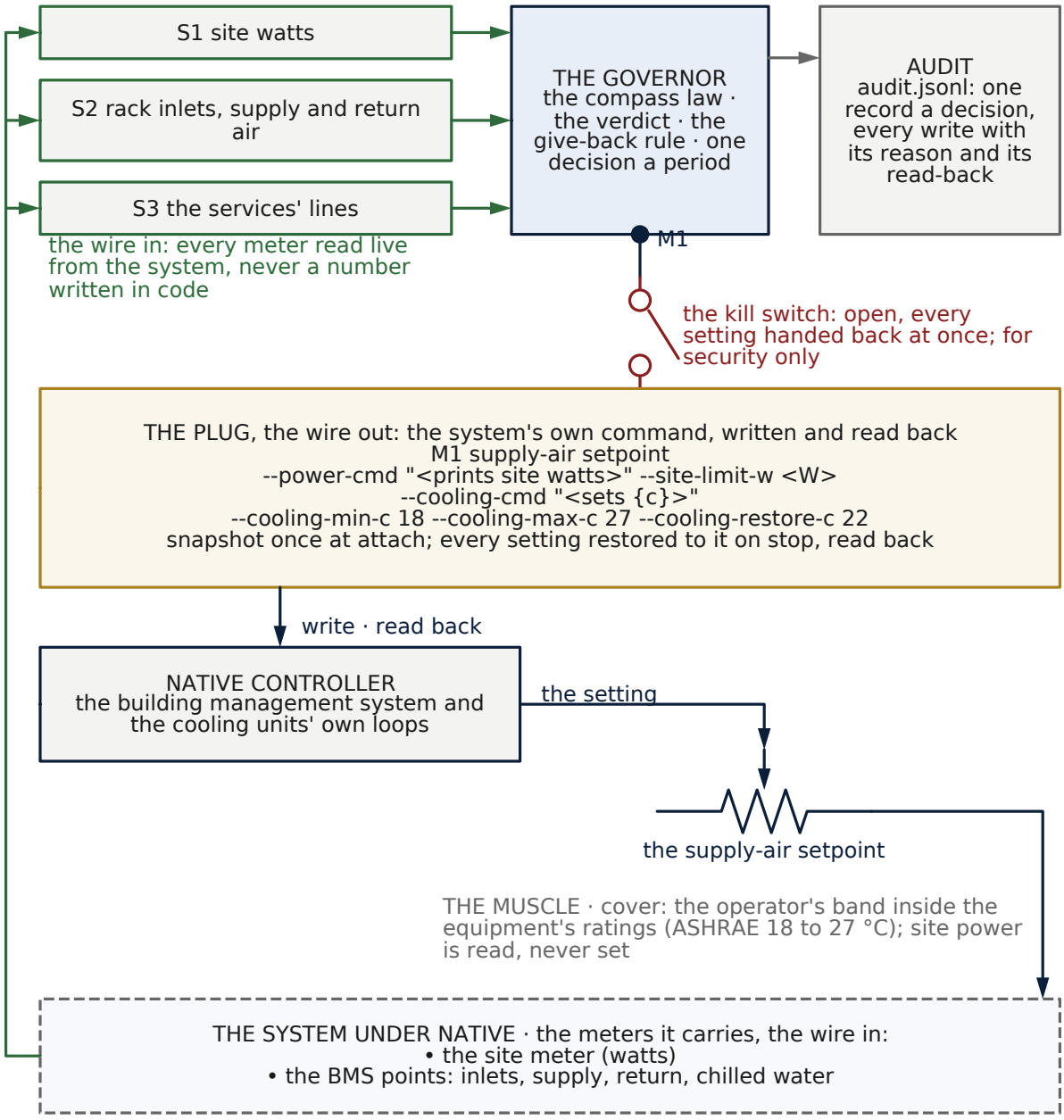



**Figure 34.** Wiring schematic: the data center under the servers. The schematic is read top to bottom as an electrical drawing: the governor (the control unit) with its sense terminals S1, S2, … on the left and its motor terminals M1, M2, … on its lower edge; the motor bus through the kill switch into the plug, the system's own command written and read back; the plug into the native controller; the native controller setting the muscle, drawn as a potentiometer with its cover; the system under native carrying the meters; and the meters back along one bus, the wire in, to the sense terminals.

The audit stands beside the governor. The senses are the site watts, the rack inlets with the supply and return air, and the services' lines; the one motor is the supply-air setpoint, inside the operator's band. Warmer while every reading is cool, colder as heat rises; a step allowed only where the paired trial at the site meter shows the

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site's energy no higher for the same work, every inlet inside its band and no LOSS on any service gauge. A reserve held for an outage (the UPS) is never a lever. Modelled today (class S); no live facility has run yet.

| Muscle | Native controller | The knob Omni-Compass may hold | Switch | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | <limit> | |
| Servers' processors | the kernel's frequency governor and the processor's own limits | the clock ceiling and the power limit | section 8.9 | built (level 6) |
| Cards | the card's firmware | the clock ceiling and the power limit | level 5 | built |
| Uninterruptible power and batteries held as reserve | the UPS's own reserve | **none, ever**: a reserve held for an outage is never a lever (the physics criterion) | | native by design |
| Batteries held for shifting energy | the site's dispatch | the charge window | | designed as an organ, not yet wired |

**How the cooling muscle moves.** The setpoint is moved by the heat state between the operator's minimum and maximum: a warmer setpoint while every reading is cool, which saves the chiller's energy, and a colder one as heat rises. The band must sit inside what the equipment is rated for; for most data-center equipment that is the 18 to 27 °C inlet range of the ASHRAE thermal guidelines, and inside any narrower limit the equipment's own warranty sets. The restore value is the operator's own setpoint, handed back and read back on OFF, at the end of every run, and by the lease if the governor dies.

**The do-no-harm gate at the site meter.** A warmer setpoint saves chiller energy only up to the point where the servers' own fans spend the saving: fan power rises steeply with inlet temperature. That is why the cooling knob is judged at the site meter and not at the chiller: a step is allowed only where the paired trial shows the site's energy for the same work no higher, every rack inlet inside its band, and no LOSS on any service gauge. Where it does not, the setpoint stays the operator's, and the result says so.

**Wiring it, in order.**

1. **Watch.** Give Omni-Compass read access to the building management system's points (supply and return air, every rack inlet, the chilled-water temperatures) and to the site meter, and let it watch at least one full cycle of the site's demand. Nothing is written.
2. **Write the band.** The minimum, the maximum and the restore value of the supply-air setpoint, inside the equipment's ratings, signed off by the facility's engineer; the site limit in watts.

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3. **The wire check** (section 5.4). The cooling command must read back the setpoint it wrote; a building schedule that rewrites the setpoint is another writer, and Omni-Compass stops writing that lever by itself (section 6.2).
4. **One hall first.** A test hall or a single row, paired against its own native weeks, before any other hall.
5. **Keep the switches in reach.** The master switch and the kill file work at the facility level exactly as at every other level.

**What is measured, and what is modelled.** The facility muscles are modelled today (class S): the data-hall cooling family of the catalog, the power distribution family, and the site budget shared by groups of cards, which held out with no minute over its budget. No live facility has run yet. A class P result needs a building management system's point list, read access, a site meter and a test hall; until a facility pilot has produced its own paired receipts, this section is a wiring instruction, not a claim of savings.

PART FOUR

# Operating It

*The OFF switch, the rules the governor obeys, the log it keeps, and the care of a running installation.*

CHAPTER 9

# The OFF Switch, the Rules, and the Log

**The rules Omni-Compass keeps on your system.**

1. **The master switch, for the whole harness, in a human hand:** `python3 tools/omni_switch.py off` turns every Omni-Compass governor on the machine off at once (the Kubernetes controller and the GPU governors). Each puts every setting it ever wrote back to the value it read before its first write, reads it back and exits; the command waits until all have, and says so. While the switch is OFF, no governor will start. `python3 tools/omni_switch.py on` allows them to be started again (nothing restarts by itself); `status` shows the switch and every governor running. Use it the moment anything looks wrong, including a suspected breach. Each governor also keeps its own switch for one muscle at a time: the kill file (or `OMNI_KILL=1`, or SIGTERM to the GPU governor). **If a governor dies without handing back** (killed outright, the machine crashed, it hung), nothing it wrote is left in place: every governor records, before its first write, the exact commands that put every setting back, and renews a lease every decision. Run `python3 tools/omni_switch.py watchdog` as

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its own service next to the governors: it hands back for any governor whose process is gone or whose lease has run out (a hung one is stopped first). `status` names any governor that died without handing back. The watchdog acts only on records its own user wrote that no other user can change (run it as the governors' user, or name theirs with `--trust-uid`), and never signals a process number the system has given to another process. Put the switch and the registry in a directory only the governors' user can write (`OMNI_MASTER_OFF`, `OMNI_REGISTRY`); `status` warns when they are not.

2. It records before it acts (annotations on Kubernetes objects; the `snapshot` line in the GPU audit).
3. It watches before it writes.
4. It never acts blind.
5. Service first: while response time is over its target, and for `--slo-clear-s` seconds after (180 by default), nothing is given back.
6. Every change is read back; no new order goes on top of one that has not landed.
7. The living band and the cover: no organ is driven outside its range; machines are parked, never switched off by Omni-Compass; it never evicts or moves a pod.
8. One writer: if anyone else changes a knob, Omni-Compass stops writing it and leaves it alone.
9. Everything is logged: every read, decision, write and reason goes to the audit log.

**On autopilot: why nobody babysits it.** Omni-Compass is an autopilot: a closed-loop supervisory controller that runs, steers and corrects itself inside the system it governs, as a self-driving car's controller does inside the car. Once the paired trial on a muscle has passed and the governor is set to govern, nobody turns a knob and nobody has to react. Every change is the governor's own, and the governor audits itself: every write is read back from the system, every machine it gives back is kept only after its own paired trial shows the response time holds, every reading, decision and reason is in its audit, and it hands every setting back at the end; nobody has to check its work either. It holds the response time at the centre of its band, under the line, and acts as the reading approaches the line, so the correction lands before the line is crossed, not after a person is paged. What a native stack pays in people for the same service (an engineer watching dashboards, paged while the service is over its line, retuning an autoscaler's target or a node pool by hand) is the **babysitting tax**, and every Kubernetes and cloud receipt counts it in both arms: the **alert minutes** (whole minutes whose 95th percentile, failed requests counted over, was over the line: the minutes an on-call page would be open; judged, the aim lower), the **settings commands the governor wrote on its own**, and the **share of its additions decided while the service was still inside its line** (both shown, not judged). No person touches either arm of a paired run. The aim in the cloud is **no alert minute at all**: a minute over the line is a person woken, so an alert minute in the omni arm is a LOSS of the aim, its cause found and fixed and the test run again. Where native itself is short of machines (over its line on its own), the receipt says so beside the row: the same machines can be made to carry more, but no governor creates compute that the machines do not have.

**The three ways a governor stops, and what each leaves behind.** A referee or an underwriter should know exactly what happens to a governed system in each of the three ways Omni-Compass can stop, because the answer is the same in all three: every setting at native, read back, with no record left.

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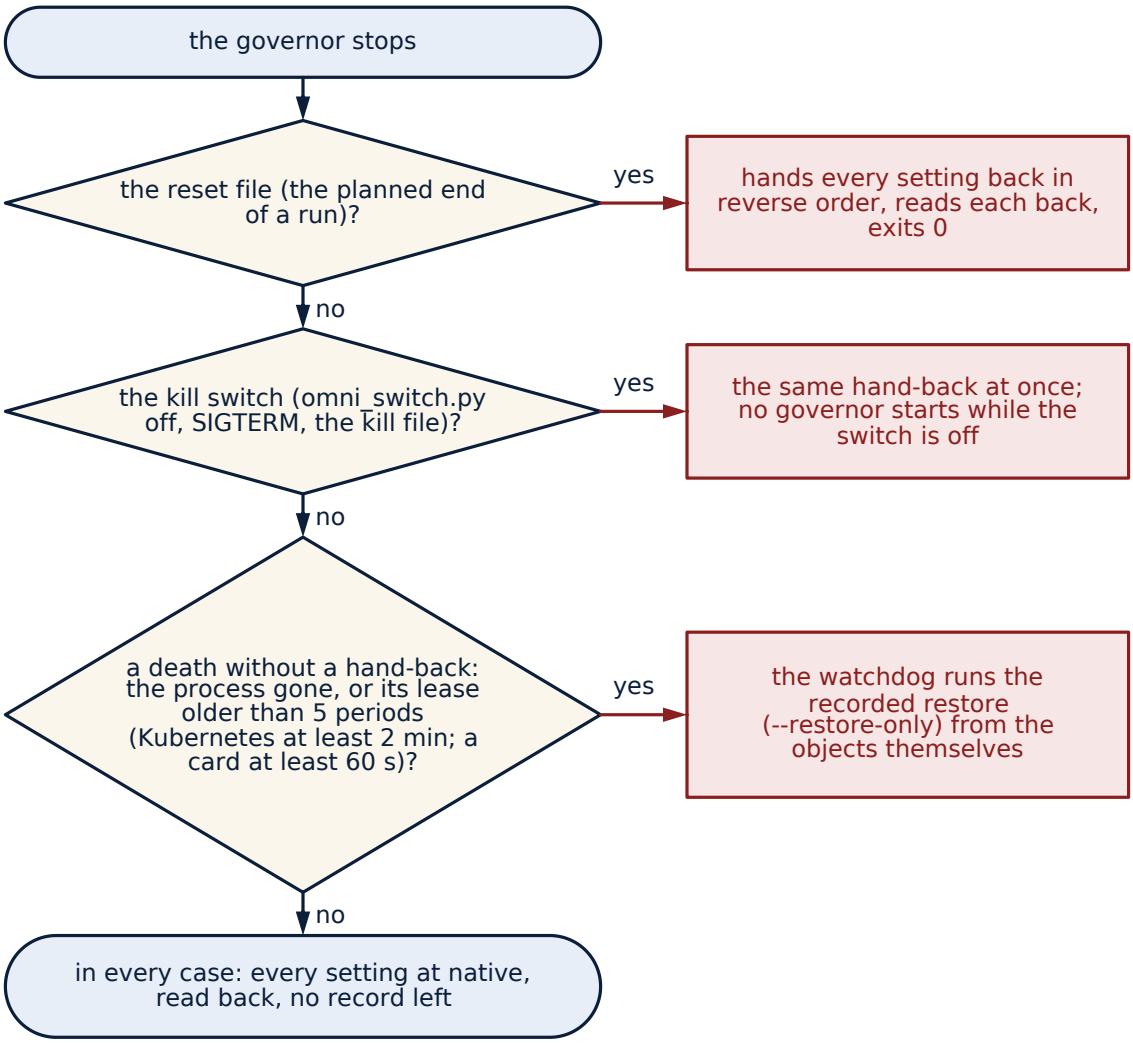



**Figure 35.** Flowchart: the three ways a governor stops. The reset file at the planned end of a run hands every setting back in reverse order, reads each back and exits 0; the kill switch (omni_switch.py off, SIGTERM or the kill file) does the same at once, and no governor starts while the switch is off; a death without a hand-back (the process gone, or its lease older than five periods) is caught by the watchdog, which runs the recorded restore from the objects themselves. In every case every setting ends at native, read back, with no record left.

- **The reset** (every setting handed back to native) is the planned end of a run. The governor sees its reset file, hands every setting back in reverse order of power-up, reads each back, writes its last audit line and exits 0. Every benchmark arm ends with one and then checks the cluster from outside the governor: the HPA target at the operator's, the replica range as set, every pod's CPU limit at its shipped value, every worker back in service, no `omnicompass.io/` annotation left on any object. An arm whose reset check fails is invalid and is left out of the table, never counted.
- **The kill switch** (security) is the unplanned end of trust. `tools/omni_switch.py off` writes the switch file and sends every registered governor SIGTERM; each performs the same hand-back as a reset and exits; the command waits until all have and reports any that have not. No governor starts while the

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switch is off. It is one switch for the whole machine, not one per muscle, because the case it exists for, something driving a system through Omni-Compass, is not a case for picking which muscle to stop.

- **A death without a hand-back** (killed outright, a crash, a hang) is the case the lease covers. Before its first write every governor registers itself with the exact command that puts every setting back (`omni_controller.controller --restore-only`, which restores from the snapshot annotations on the objects themselves, so it needs no memory of the dead process), and renews a lease every decision. The watchdog (`tools/omni_switch.py watchdog`), run as its own service beside the governors, finds any governor whose process is gone or whose lease is older than its limit (five decision periods, at least two minutes), stops a hung one, runs its recorded restore command, and records what it did. Drill it before production: kill the governor outright in the middle of a governed paired run on your own system, and record how many seconds pass before every setting is back at the snapshot and what the service saw in that gap.

**Reading the log.**

| Line | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `gate: a sense is blind` | a reading failed; nothing is given back until it returns |
| `gate: pods scaling up` | pods first, machines after |
| `decision failed (n in a row)` | the cluster could not be reached; nothing was written; turn it OFF for native |
| `decided_by: compass` | the compass set the wires this decision |
| `decided_by: fail_up` / `blind_fail_up` | the service crossed the 0.95 wall, or a sense went blind: full capacity at once |
| `decided_by: thermal_hold` | the card reported a heat slowdown; nothing was tightened |
| `foreign_writer` | someone else changed a knob; Omni-Compass now observes only |
| `restored ... ok: true` | the OFF switch put every setting back and read it back |
| `"watchdog": "handed back"` (in the watchdog's own log) | a governor died or hung without handing back; the watchdog ran its recorded restore command; `ok` says whether every command exited 0 |
| `cruise: on` / `cruise: off` | work waited for a place for two decisions: machines in service up to the pool's own top; the line has been empty for two: cruise ends |
| `idle_floor` | the work is done and demand is at zero: the pedal lifted all the way, straight to the floor in one move |

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| Line | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `verdict_state: left native` | no step of the slow knob passed the paired trial (section 1.2): the knob is never moved on this muscle |
| `shield_interventions` | the shield clipped a write to its bounds or its step limit; the count says how often |
| `overhead` (the last line of the audit) | the governor's own CPU over the window: its process and every command it ran |

**How to read an audit from end to end.** The audit (`audit.jsonl`, one JSON record a line, every line timestamped) is the governor's complete account of itself, and a reader can follow a run through it without the manual: the first lines are the snapshot (every setting as found, written to the objects as annotations so a watchdog can restore from them); then, every decision, the readings (the response time and its age, the pods waiting, the machines seen, whether any sense is blind), the reading's place in its band (`compass`), the authority granted and the release gate's reason (`authority`, `node_gate`), the decision itself (the machines recommended against the machines seen, the HPA target set), every write with the command that made it and the value read back, and the decision's wall time (`decision_ms`); in cruise, the floor step's silence; at the end, the reset's writes and read-backs and the `overhead` record. The paired-run harness prints a decision trail from the audit at the end of every omni arm, one line a decision, so a reviewer reading a run's log sees what the governor saw and did at each minute.

CHAPTER 10

# Maintenance, Upgrades and Security

- Run `python3 verify.py` after every upgrade; it must end `VERIFICATION: PASS`.
- Upgrade in watch mode first; take the levels again from level 1.

**What an upgrade is, and what it is not.** The engine is fingerprinted by version (chapter 13). An upgrade that changes any rule, guard, preset or muscle of the engine is by definition the next engine version, and every receipt an operator made on the old version must be made again on it before the two are read side by side; `tools/omni_version.py` says which version a checkout carries, and a checkout that matches none says which files differ. An upgrade that changes only the harness, the tools or this manual leaves the engine's fingerprint as it was and every receipt standing. An operator can therefore tell, from one command, whether a new checkout is the engine their receipts were made on or something that must prove itself again.

- The container runs non-root, read-only, with no capabilities; the Kubernetes identity has only the permissions of the level you run.
- The GPU governor needs root only for `nvidia-smi -pl` and `-lgc`.

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- Report a security issue as `SECURITY.md` describes.

**Least privilege, proven on every run.** The Kubernetes governor runs as its own service account (`deploy/kind/rbac-omni.yaml`) with exactly the verbs the level needs: patch on the governed HPA, nodes, pods and the governed deployment, get on its security ConfigMap, create on pod evictions. It cannot delete nodes, create or delete pods or deployments, touch the load generator or anything in `kube-system`, read any secret, create a namespace, or write its own security hold. Every paired arm records `kubectl auth can-i` for each of these and fails if a "cannot" reads yes or a "can" reads no (`rbac_omni.txt` in every paired run's files). The security hold itself is a ConfigMap another identity owns: when its key reads `hold: "true"` every expansion is blocked, and the governor cannot clear it.

**Credentials, and the notice.** Cloud credentials live only in an encrypted secret store and are used only by the jobs that need them; no credential, key or token belongs in any file, log, receipt or commit. Every source file carries its SPDX license identifier so that license scanners (Black Duck, FOSSA, Snyk) read the evaluation license correctly, and every generated report carries the legal notice at its head and foot.

**Supply chain.** Everything the paired-run harnesses download is pinned and checked: metrics-server by version and SHA-256 (`scripts/kind_bench.sh`), Apache Kafka against the Apache Software Foundation's own SHA-512 file for that release, Redis as the Ubuntu runner's own package, MongoDB from its publisher's own repository signed by the publisher's key and YCSB against the SHA-256 written in its preregistration, gym-pybullet-drones at one named commit, Python packages by `requirements.txt`. A download whose checksum does not match stops the run before anything else happens.

**The upgrade drill, step by step.** An operator who receives a new checkout does five things, in order, and stops at the first that fails. First, `python3 tools/omni_version.py`: if it prints the version the operator's results were made on, the engine is unchanged and the rest of the drill is about the harness; if it prints a list of differing files, the checkout is a new engine and nothing the operator measured before applies to it until measured again. Second, `python3 verify.py`, which must end with its pass line; a checkout that fails it is not installed anywhere. Third, the wire check on the operator's own stack, which proves that every wire the new checkout would use still follows, reads back and returns. Fourth, watch mode for at least one full cycle of the operator's load, reading the log the governor would have written and comparing its would-be decisions against what the operator would have done. Fifth, the levels again from level one, each with its paired receipt. An upgrade that skips a step has not been upgraded; it has been installed.

**The security hold, and who holds it.** The hold is the one control that outranks the governor's own judgment, and it is deliberately not the governor's to hold. It lives in a ConfigMap owned by another identity (the operator's security team, in practice); while its key reads true, every expansion the governor would make is blocked and every contraction is still allowed, so a governor under a hold can only give capacity back, never take more. The governor reads the hold on every decision and records in its audit that it read it; it has no verb that could write it. The kill switch (chapter 9) is the blunter instrument beside it: the hold constrains a running governor, the switch stops every governor on the machine and hands everything back. An operator who suspects anything untoward uses the switch first, reads the audit second, and rotates the governor's identity

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third; the hold is for the slower case of a change window or an incident elsewhere during which no one wants capacity added.

**What has been reviewed, and what has not.** Tested on every paired run: the governor's permissions against the list above, read from the cluster itself; the refusal of every write past a cover, of every give-back while blind, and of every move under a hold; the lease and the watchdog's hand-back on a real cluster; the checksums of every download. Not yet done, and said so: an independent security review of the code by a party outside the company, and a penetration test of the deployed governor on a customer-like cluster. Until those are done, the operator's own review stands in for them, and this chapter tells the operator exactly what to look at.

PART FIVE

# Checking It on Your Own System

*Paired runs and receipts on your own system, evidence classes, the engine version and the three-run rule.*

CHAPTER 11

# Paired Runs and Receipts on Your Own System

The method of every published benchmark is the method an installer uses on their own system, and it is deliberately simple: the same system, the same work, native and then omni back to back on the same machines, repeated with the order rotated, each gauge reported with the 95% interval of its paired difference. Pairing is what makes a difference of a few percent visible on a shared machine whose own noise is larger than that: two arms run minutes apart on one runner see the same neighbours and the same hour, so their difference is a difference between arms, while two arms on separate machines differ by about 15% in p95 on their own. The order rotates so that no arm always runs first, warm or cold. The work is held equal by an open-loop load, a fixed rate of requests at fixed moments, so that a lower resource count can never mean that less work was done. The steps below are the whole method.

1. **Paired runs.** Run your service the same way twice, once native and once with Omni-Compass on top, back to back on the same machines, the order rotated, at least 5 times (10 for a result you publish). `scripts/kind_paired.sh` and `tools/live_reps.py` do this on Kubernetes;

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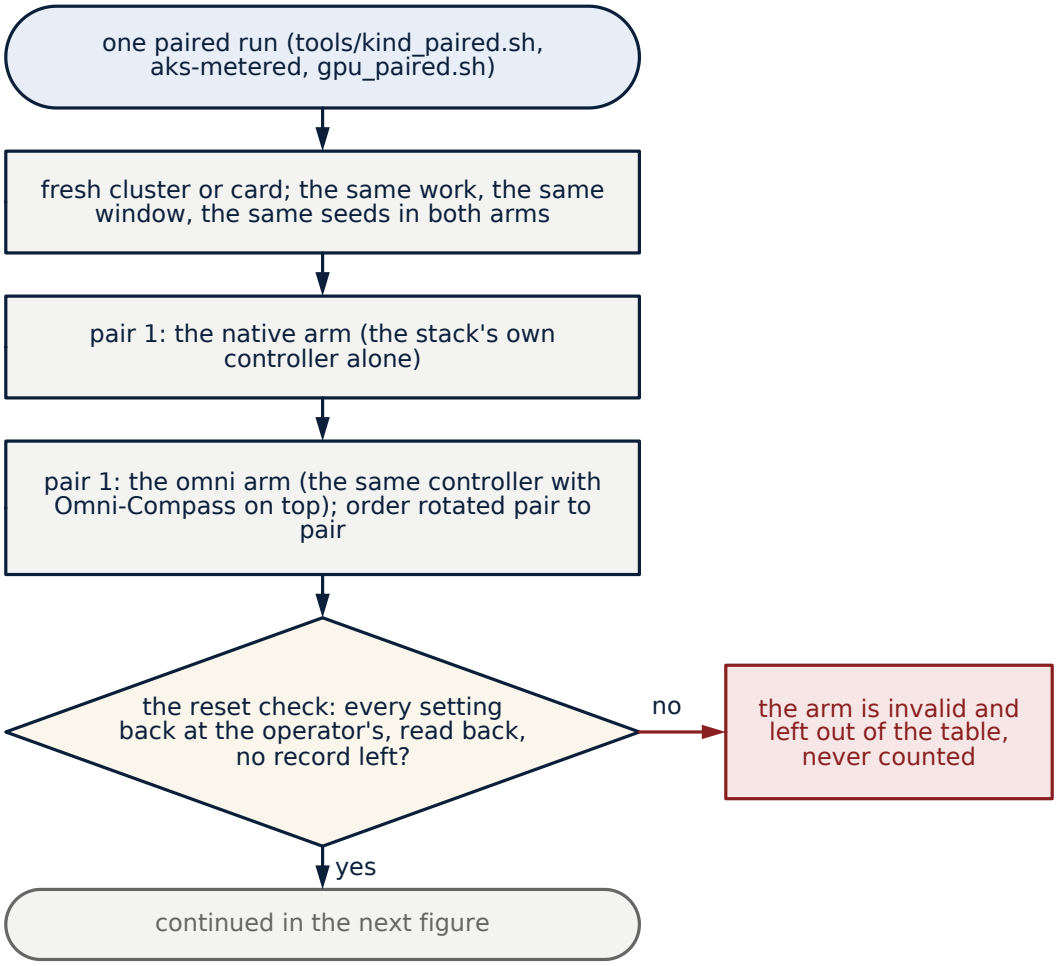



**Figure 36.** Flowchart: one paired run, the pairs. A fresh cluster or card; the same work, the same window and the same seeds in both arms; each pair runs the native arm (the stack's own controller alone) and the omni arm (the same controller with Omni-Compass on top), the order rotated pair to pair; the reset check after each arm (every setting back at the operator's, read back, no record left) invalidates an arm that fails it, and that arm is never counted. Continued in the next figure.

`scripts/gpu_rented_run.sh` does it on a GPU box, in one command: the wire check, a smoke run, then the counted run.

2. **The switch drill** after every run: turn Omni-Compass OFF; check every setting is back at its recorded original; turn it ON.
3. **The receipt.** Each gauge: native, Omni-Compass, the change, the 95% interval of the difference, and whether the interval excludes zero. A change reads GAIN, LOSS or power given, clear of the noise, only when it does; otherwise it reads EVEN, no difference beyond the noise.
4. **The label, by rule written before the run:** SUPERIOR WITHIN GUARDRAILS / ENERGY IMPROVEMENT WITH SERVICE TRADEOFF / NONINFERIOR / INCONCLUSIVE / NOT ESTABLISHED / AWAY FROM ITS AIM / NOT ATTRIBUTABLE / INVALID. Guardrails: work not

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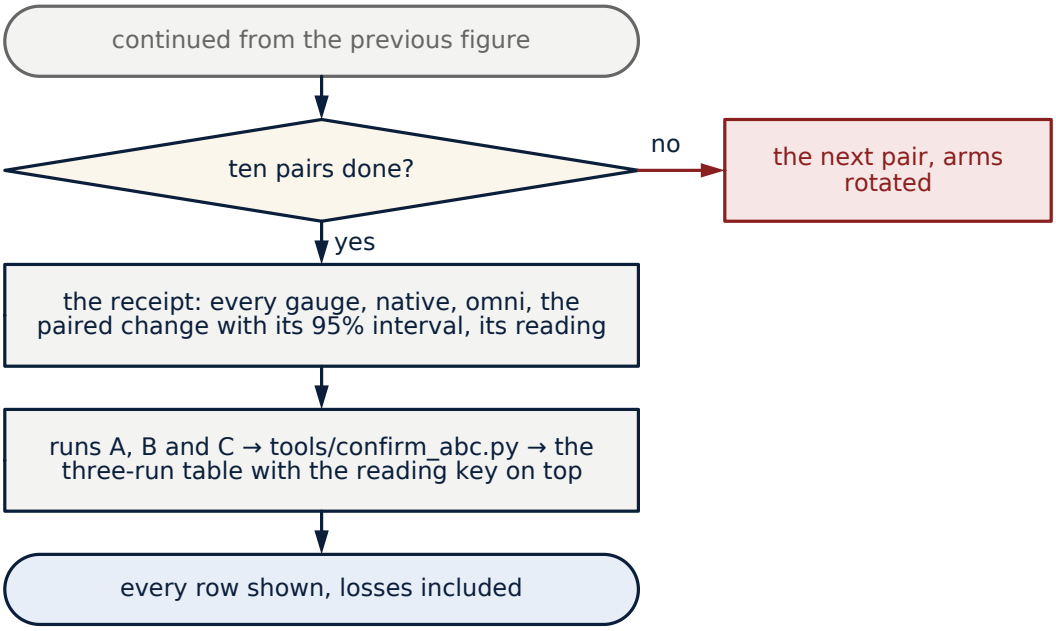



**Figure 37.** Flowchart: one paired run, from the pairs to the three-run table. After ten pairs the receipt is written: every gauge, native, omni, the paired change with its 95% interval and its reading; runs A, B and C go through tools/confirm_abc.py into the three-run table with the reading key on top; every row is shown, losses included.

lower by more than 1%; the share of time outside the service line not higher by more than 1 percentage point. The band-first rule is stricter: no win is claimed while the time outside the service line is above native's.

5. **Write it down, then run.** The arms, the knob, the cover, the gauges and the readings are written down before the first counted run; the rules are fixed on one tuning case and then applied unchanged to the cases that are counted. A change made after a result has been seen is written down with its time and reason, and the receipt says so.
6. **Every row, losses included.** A row that went against Omni-Compass is reported with the others. If Omni-Compass loses, the first suspect is the wiring, then native's setup, then the scoring; that is fixed and the run repeated, and the loss stays in the record.
7. **Keep the raw files.** Every run's files (capture, response times, audit log, controller log, one SHA-256 manifest per repetition) are kept with the receipt, and every receipt names the runs and the commit it was made from, so that anyone holding the files can rebuild it.

**How many repetitions, and why.** The width of a paired interval shrinks with the square root of the number of pairs, $w \propto 1/\sqrt{n}$, so going from five pairs to ten narrows it by about a third ($1 - 1/\sqrt{2} \approx 0.29$), and from ten to forty by half again. On shared cloud runners, ten pairs of a 900 s window typically put the interval on a cluster's work inside the line at about ±10 points of native and on its 95th-percentile response time at ±15 to ±30 points: wide intervals, which clear zero only when the effect is tens of percent. A gauge computed from a declared formula over counts (an energy model over machines in service) has a much narrower interval, and a

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difference inside it is read as no difference, never as a small gain. A gain of a few percent on a cluster needs forty pairs or more to clear zero at these widths. On a stack with a finer knob (connections, consumers, megabytes) the intervals are narrower at three pairs than a cluster's at ten, because the knob moves in hundreds of small steps rather than in whole machines. Run five pairs first, look at the interval widths on the gauges you care about, and set the count for the counted run from those widths, never from the result.

**Why the load is open-loop.** A closed-loop load generator waits for each answer before sending the next request, so a slower system is offered less work and its throughput "improves" its own latency; two arms under closed-loop load are not doing the same work. An open-loop generator sends requests at fixed moments whatever the system does, so both arms are offered the same work to the request, a queue forms when the system falls behind, and the time over the line and the failed requests record the cost. Every paired-run harness (the cluster's load generator, pgbench's rate limit, Kafka's producer at a fixed rate, Redis and YCSB at a fixed target rate) offers its work open-loop, and a lower resource count in the omni arm can therefore never mean less work was asked. A burst is a schedule of open-loop rates written before the run and applied identically in both arms; only the load generator reads it, never the governor.

**What a receipt looks like.** One row per gauge: the gauge's name and direction; native's value and omni's; the paired change as a percentage of native with its 95% interval; the reading. A head naming the system, the knob, the cover, the window, the number of pairs, the order rotation, the engine's fingerprint and the commit; a foot saying whether every arm was handed back. `tools/live_reps.py` prints exactly this for a Kubernetes run and `tools/confirm_abc.py` prints it for three runs side by side; a receipt from any other tool should be laid out the same way so that a reader of this manual can read it without learning a new shape.

**The readings to expect, and what it means when you do not see them.** The published tables are the reference an installer reads their own receipt against: not their numbers, which belong to our systems and our loads and are printed only in the Owner's Manual (chapter 17) and `results/live/`, but the words each kind of service has read in all three of our runs on real Kubernetes:

| The service | Reads GAIN | Reads EVEN | Power given |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rightsized with Goldilocks and the VPA's recommender | response time (mean, 95th and 99th percentile); time over the line | machines, failed requests, replicas, pods started, pod start wait, alert minutes | parked-worker energy |
| Scaled by KEDA's HTTP add-on | response time (mean and 95th percentile); alert minutes; replicas; pods started | machines, failed requests, pod start wait | parked-worker energy |
| Scaled by KEDA on CPU and requests | response time (mean, 95th and 99th percentile); time over the line | machines, failed requests, replicas, alert minutes | parked-worker energy |

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| The service | Reads GAIN | Reads EVEN | Power given |
|---|---|---|---|
| Governed by CruiseKube's own recommendations | nothing: no setting written | every gauge | none |
| Held at a fixed CPU cap, four caps | nothing: the cap blocks the one lever | completed work and work inside the line at every cap | none |

Read your receipt against this table in three steps. **First the words.** A service gauge that reads LOSS on your receipt, where the table reads GAIN or EVEN for the same kind of service, is read as a wiring fault before anything else (`DISCLOSURES.md`, section 4): the feed's freshness and its line (chapter 19), the sensed autoscaler's name, the identity's permissions (chapter 15), the window's length against the widths of your receipt's own intervals. **Second the direction.** Where the table reads GAIN, your receipt should read GAIN or EVEN; a smaller gain is your stack's, not a fault, because the gain is bounded by how far native stood from its own best. **Third the power given.** A resource that rose on your receipt is read beside the work and the speed it bought; a rise with nothing bought is a question for Appendix L: what did the governor write, and why. Two readings are not faults: EVEN on every gauge where native already runs at the top of its range (the knob is at its limit on native, and the governor leaves it there by design, section 6.5), and a machine count that does not fall where no machine can be given back without a LOSS (the audit's `node_gate.reason` names the gate that held). What the table cannot give is your number: the same engine on another stack is another result, and it is yours (section 4.8).

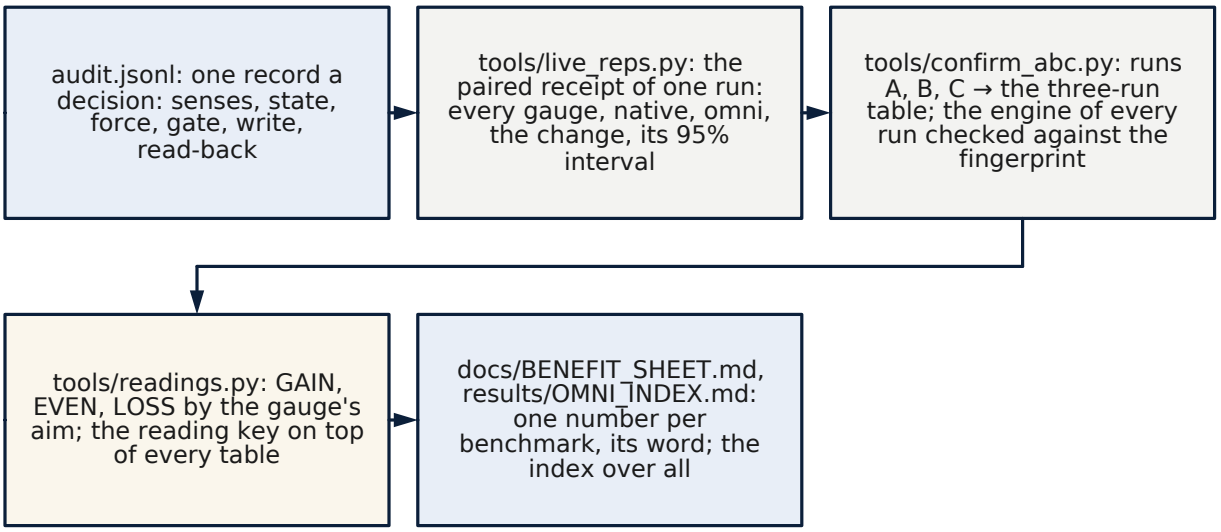
CHAPTER 12

# Evidence Classes and How to Read a Receipt

**One number, one word.** In every receipt a change keeps its raw sign: a response time that fell reads "-65%", a cache that grew reads "+300%", and the Reading column beside it gives its word, GAIN, EVEN or LOSS, decided by what the gauge is for and never by its sign (the key at the front of this manual): a response time cut 65% is GAIN, a cache grown 300% is **power given**, a fall in work is LOSS. Wherever a change is written in a sentence, it is written in words, never as a bare sign: "p95 cut 65% (GAIN)", so it cannot be misread against a receipt that shows the same change as "-65%". Read the Reading column, never the sign alone.

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| Class | Rung | What it is | What it can show |
|---|---|---|---|
| T / V | E1 | deterministic tests of the software | the software does what its documentation says |
| S | E2 | a run on a modelled plant | what the governor does to the model, and where it breaks |
| L | E3 | real software, no hardware meter | real decisions on real software; energy there is a declared model |
| P | E4 | a physical meter (a card's own power reading, the processor's energy counters, a site meter) | the hardware's own answer |




Every table is made by a tool, never by hand; raw records keep their recorded values, every page that shows them uses the words. A reader can follow one run from its audit line to its row in the benefit sheet.

**Figure 38.** Flowchart: from the audit to the receipt, the table and the one number. The audit (one record a decision) is read by tools/live_reps.py into the paired receipt of one run; runs A, B and C go through tools/confirm_abc.py into the three-run table, each run's engine checked against the fingerprint; tools/readings.py sets GAIN, EVEN or LOSS by the gauge's aim and puts the reading key on top of every table; the benefit sheet and the Omni index carry one number per benchmark. Every table is made by a tool, never by hand.

Read every number with its class beside it. A modelled number is never quoted as a hardware result. When a receipt's energy line is modelled, the receipt says so.

**What each class can and cannot carry.** A class **T / V** result says that the software computes what its documentation says it computes; it says nothing about whether the governor helps any machine. A class **S**

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result says what the governor does to a model of a plant under that model's own native controller; it carries exactly the model's fidelity and no more, and every S line that reports energy says that the energy is a declared model. A class **L** result says what the governor did to real software making real decisions on real requests; where the machines are containers on one host, they are counted in machine-hours in service and their energy, where it is reported, is a declared formula, which the receipt says; the processor seconds of the host are measured. A cloud bill is an L result with a real bill: the machines billed are the provider's own count and the price its list price, and the energy is still not a meter. A class **P** result says what a physical meter read, and only a P result speaks for hardware energy.

**How to read a row.** Every row in every three-run table has the same shape: the gauge and its direction; native's value in run A and omni's value in run A, so the size of the numbers is visible; the paired change in each of the three runs as a percentage of native with its 95% interval; and the reading. Read the reading first, then the intervals, then the sizes. A reading of "GAIN in all three of our runs" with intervals of −0.5% to −0.1% is a small, real effect; a reading of "no difference beyond the noise (3 of 3 runs)" with intervals of −30% to +25% is a test that could not see an effect of that size either way, which is a statement about the test's power, and the receipt should say so (a 4-worker fleet cannot show a saving smaller than one machine, section 8.1). A "LOSS in all three runs" row stands in the receipt.

**Three questions to ask of any class L result.** First, what was native, exactly: which controller, at which published version, with which settings, and were those settings an operator's or ours? (Write them down before the run; a native set anywhere other than the operator's own setting must say so.) Second, what did the governor spend: machines, memory, connections, CPU, its own cost? (Every receipt has the resource rows; a result with a gain and no resource row is not a receipt.) Third, who else could have produced the gain: the order of the arms, the warm-up, the runner's neighbour, the clock? (Rotation of the arm order, the warm-up before every window, the paired design on one machine and the clock rule are the answers; whatever residue they do not remove is written beside the receipt.)

CHAPTER 13

# The Engine Version and the Three-Run Rule

**Every engine version has a fingerprint.** The engine is fingerprinted file by file: one SHA-256 per file and one digest over all of them, held in the version's registry (`OMNI_V5.json` for the engine that stands). Any change to a rule, guard, preset or muscle makes **the next version**, and every receipt is made again on it; no receipt is ever read across versions. When the engine is declared final, the engine that stands then is published as Omni-Compass 1.0.

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```
python3 tools/omni_version.py                    # this checkout: its e
    ↪ ngine version, or every file that differs
python3 tools/omni_version.py --commit <sha>     # the engine at the co
    ↪ mmit any receipt ran on
```

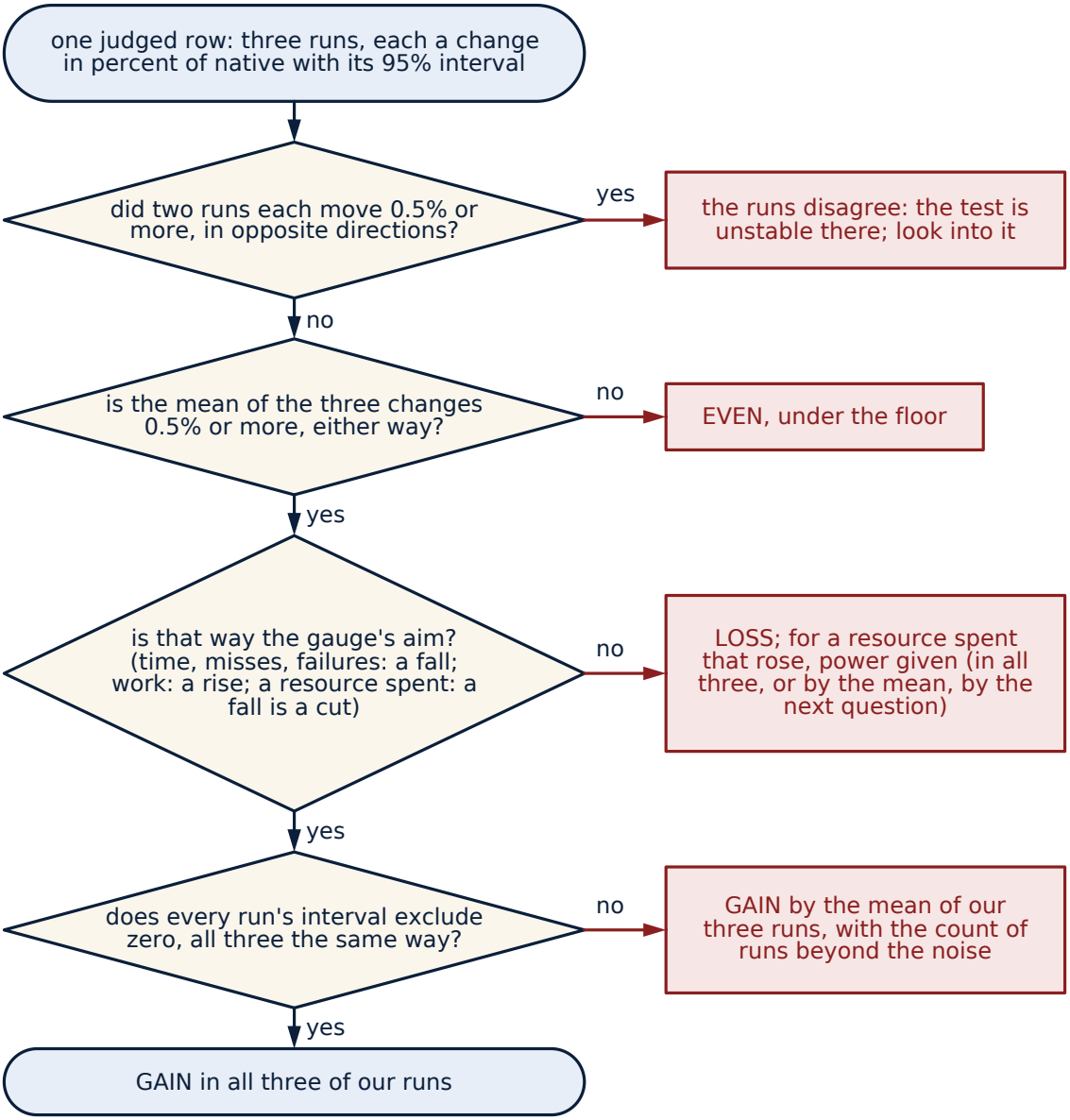



**Figure 39.** Flowchart: the three-run reading rule, as a procedure (the founder's order of 24 October 2026). For one judged row: if two runs each moved 0.5% or more in opposite directions, the runs disagree; if the mean of the three changes is under 0.5%, EVEN, under the floor; otherwise the word follows the gauge's aim, GAIN, LOSS or, for a resource spent that rose, power given, in all three of our runs when every run's interval excludes zero the same way, by the mean of our three runs otherwise.

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A receipt names the commit it ran on, and every table made by rule checks each run's commit against the fingerprint and heads itself with a warning if any run is not the engine it claims or if the three are not separate runs. An operator's own tune (section 4.7) does not change the engine's fingerprint, and must therefore be written down beside the receipt.

**The three-run rule.** A result is run as **A, B and C**, three separate runs on the same engine version. Every judged row gets one of these readings, and all three runs are shown beside it:

- **GAIN** or **LOSS in all three runs** (a resource spent that rose reads **power given**, never a loss): a change of 0.5% or more, the mean of the three runs, the same sign in all three runs, each with its 95% interval clear of zero.
- **GAIN** or **LOSS by the mean of the three runs**: a change of 0.5% or more, the mean of the three runs, where one run's interval or more includes zero; the count of runs beyond the noise stands beside it (the founder's order of 24 October 2026: a change of 0.5% or more either way is a change, never EVEN).
- **EVEN, under the floor**: the mean of the three runs' changes is under 0.5% either way.
- **The runs disagree**: runs that each moved 0.5% or more point different ways. The test itself is then unstable on that measure, and it is looked into before anything is claimed.

The three-run table is made by a tool, never by hand: `tools/confirm_abc.py` for the paired Kubernetes and cloud runs, with one sibling tool per kind of raw record for the other stacks (`pgbench_abc.py`, `kafka_abc.py`, `redis_abc.py`, `ycsb_abc.py`, `sysbench_abc.py`), each checking the engine of every run it reads. A deterministic simulator's three runs must reproduce each other to the digit, or to the declared tolerance where the simulator is not bit-reproducible across machines.

**Why three separate runs, and why the readings are what they are.** One run of ten paired repetitions gives one interval, and an interval from one run can be narrow by luck: the machine was quiet that hour, the order of arms happened to favour one side. A second run on another day and another machine is a replication; a third makes a coincidence expensive. The three runs are separate runs, on separate machines, at separate hours, with separate installations of every dependency, so what agrees across them is not an artefact of one machine. The readings are designed so that no reading can be mistaken for something it is not: a change of 0.5% or more, the mean of the three runs, is always named by its word and its direction, and the words say how firm it is (in all three runs, every interval clear of zero; or by the mean, with the count of runs beyond the noise); a change under 0.5% is EVEN; and two runs that each moved 0.5% or more in opposite directions are reported as a disagreement, which is an instability in the test to be found and fixed, not averaged away.

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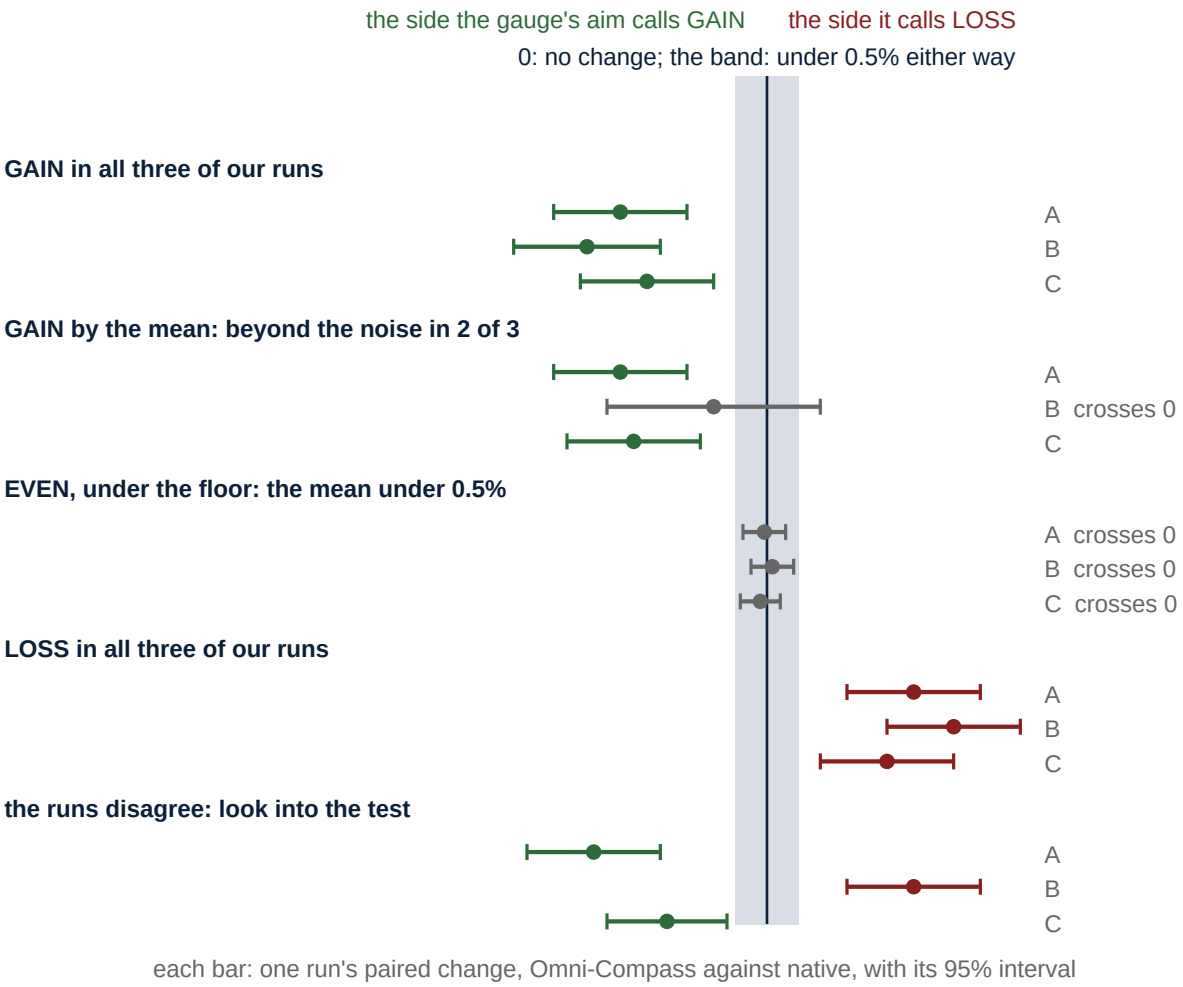



**Figure 40.** The three-run rule, read from the intervals (the founder's order of 24 October 2026). Each row is one gauge; each bar is one run's paired change of Omni-Compass against native with its 95% interval; the shaded band is 0.5% either way of no change. A change of 0.5% or more, the mean of the three runs, is a change: GAIN or LOSS in all three of our runs when every interval is clear of zero on the same side, GAIN or LOSS by the mean of our three runs, with the count beyond the noise, when one or more intervals hold zero.

EVEN, under the floor: the mean under 0.5%. The runs disagree: runs that moved 0.5% or more in opposite directions, an unstable test to be looked into. Which side reads GAIN is set by what the gauge is for: for time waited, misses and failures a fall; for work done a rise; for a resource spent a fall is a cut and a rise is power given, never a loss.

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PART SIX

# The Implementer's Guide: Omni-Compass on a Cloud

*For the engineer who installs it on Azure, Google Cloud or Amazon Web Services and keeps it in service: the path and its gates, the permissions, each cloud step by step, the response-time feed, the cloud mode, day two, the graphics processor, observability, change and risk, planning the saving, own racks and private clouds, hardening, a fleet, the failure drills, a complete installation, and the questions implementers ask.*

CHAPTER 14

# The Implementer's Path: From an Empty Account to a Governed Cluster

This part is written for the **implementer**: the platform, site-reliability or infrastructure engineer who is handed Omni-Compass and a cloud account and is responsible for installing it, proving it on the company's own cluster, putting it into service and keeping it there. It assumes fluency with Kubernetes objects, role-based access control (RBAC), the cloud provider's command-line tool and a container registry, and nothing about how the governor is built. Every step names the object it creates, the permission it needs, the evidence it leaves and the check that must pass before the next step begins. Where the three clouds differ, the step is written once per cloud (chapters 16 to 18); where they do not, it is written once here or in chapters 15, 19, 20 and 21.

## 14.1 What the implementer delivers

At the end of this part an implementer has delivered five things, each with its own evidence:

| Deliverable | Evidence that it is done |
|---|---|
| A verified copy of the software, at a known engine version | `python3 verify.py` ends `VERIFICATION: PASS`; `python3 tools/omni_version.py` names the version (chapter 33) |

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| Deliverable | Evidence that it is done |
|---|---|
| The governor installed in watch mode, writing nothing | its audit shows a `decision` record every period (the machines and the target it recommends) and no `write` record; every object it reads is listed in chapter 15 |
| A response-time feed for the service, and the service's line written down | the feed file advancing at least every 5 seconds; the line taken from the service's own objective (chapter 19) |
| A paired receipt on the company's own cluster: native against native with Omni-Compass on top | the receipt's rows, each read GAIN, EVEN or LOSS, and the run's commit and engine version (chapters 11 to 13) |
| The governor in service, with its OFF switch, its watchdog and its alarms wired | the switch tested, the watchdog's hand-back drilled, the alert route proven by a test page (chapter 21) |

None of the five is skipped, and they are delivered in that order. The order is not bureaucracy: each one is the evidence the next one stands on. A governor that has not watched cannot be judged before it writes; a receipt without a written line cannot be read; a governor in service without a drilled OFF switch is not in service, it is at large.

## 14.2 What Omni-Compass needs from the cluster, and what it never touches

**What it needs.** A Kubernetes cluster on a supported minor version of the provider's managed service; the Kubernetes Metrics API (`metrics.k8s.io`, served by metrics-server: built into Azure Kubernetes Service and Google Kubernetes Engine, installed by the implementer on Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service); a HorizontalPodAutoscaler (HPA) on each service it governs, scaling on CPU utilisation; a cluster autoscaler on the work node pools (the provider's own, or Karpenter on Amazon); a namespace and a service account for the governor; and a response-time feed for each service whose line it holds (chapter 19). In-place pod resize (the `pods/resize` subresource) is needed only where the governor conveys processor to running pods, which it never does in the cloud mode of chapter 20.

**What it never touches, in any mode.** The governor never creates, deletes, evicts or restarts a pod; never changes a container image, a command, an environment variable or a request; never changes a node's machine type or a pool's configuration in the provider; never holds a cloud credential in the cloud mode (it acts through the Kubernetes API alone); and never writes a setting it has not first recorded on the object it writes, so that every setting can be put back from the object itself (chapter 9). In the cloud mode it also never moves a pod autoscaler, never conveys processor and never caps power: it moves the machines alone (chapter 20).

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## 14.3 The eight phases and their gates

| Phase | What happens | Gate to the next phase | Typical time |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0. Verify | the copy is checked against its manifest and engine version | `VERIFICATION: PASS`, the version named | under an hour |
| 1. Account and cluster | the cloud account, quotas, the cluster with a system pool and work pools | the cluster autoscaler scales a work pool up and down on its own | half a day |
| 2. Identity | namespace, service account, the read-only role | `kubectl auth can-i` answers exactly the table of chapter 15 | an hour |
| 3. Watch | the governor installed in watch mode | an audit with decisions and no write, for at least one full day of the service's own load | one to seven days |
| 4. Feed and line | the response-time feed and the written line | the feed's age under 15 seconds at every decision; the line signed off by the service's owner | a day |
| 5. Paired run | native against native with Omni-Compass on top, on the company's own cluster | a receipt read row by row, every LOSS explained or fixed and rerun | two to five days |
| 6. Govern | the governing role granted, the governor switched to govern, the OFF switch and the watchdog wired | the OFF switch drilled: every setting back and read back within 60 seconds | a day |
| 7. Day two | upgrades, rollbacks, audits, alarms, fleet roll-out | quarterly drill of the OFF switch and the watchdog | ongoing |

Phases 3 and 5 are the long ones, and they are long on purpose: a governor is judged on the service's own load, which has its own daily and weekly shape. A watch phase shorter than one full cycle of the service's own load (a day for most services, a week for a service with a weekly peak) has not seen the service.

## 14.4 Roles, approvals and the separation of duties

| Role | Holds | Signs off |
|---|---|---|
| Implementer | the namespace, the service account, the install, the feed | phases 2 to 5 |
| Service owner | the service's line (its response-time objective) and its HPA | the line (phase 4) and the receipt (phase 5) |

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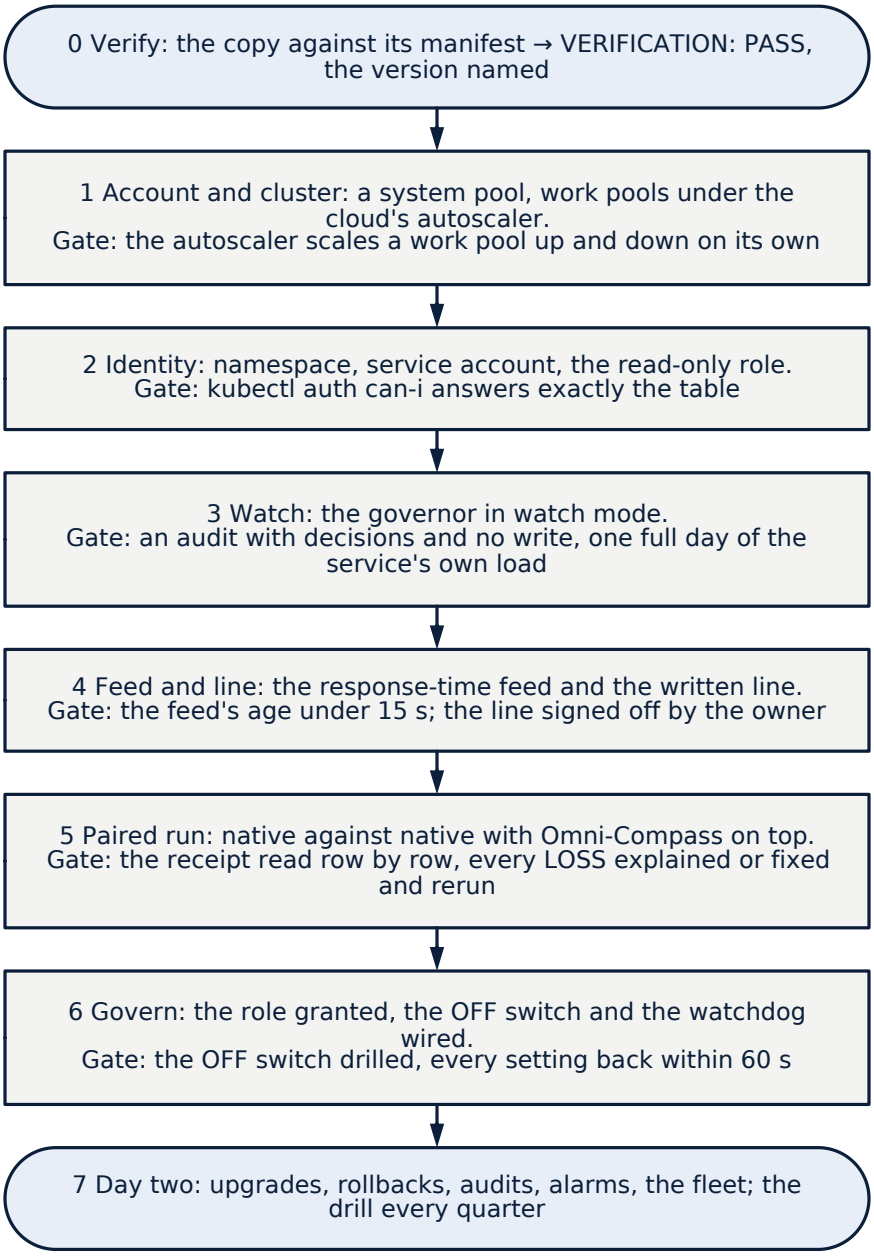



**Figure 41.** Flowchart: the implementer's eight phases and their gates. From the verified copy through the account and the cluster, identity, the watch, the feed and the line, the paired run and the governing grant to day two; each phase has a gate that must pass before the next begins, and the OFF switch is drilled before the governor writes.

| Role | Holds | Signs off |
|---|---|---|
| Platform owner | the cluster, its pools and its autoscaler profile | the governing role (phase 6) |

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| Role | Holds | Signs off |
|---|---|---|
| Security | the RBAC review and the OFF switch | the role table (phase 2) and the OFF switch drill (phase 6) |
| Finance (cloud cost) | the bill's gauge and its list prices | the bill rows of the receipt (phase 5) |

The OFF switch (`python3 tools/omni_switch.py off`, chapter 9) is held by someone who is not the implementer. It is the one control in this part whose purpose is to stop the governor when the people who installed it are not available or not trusted, and it is only worth what that separation makes it worth.

## 14.5 What it costs to implement

The governor's own cost is small and is measured in every receipt (the row "Omni's own CPU (cores), mean"): one process, a request of 50 millicores and 128 MiB, a limit of 500 millicores and 256 MiB in the shipped manifest. The cost of an implementation is the cost of the evidence: a cluster for the paired run, sized like the service's own, for the hours the run takes. On the managed services in this part, a two-vCPU worker costs between about USD 0.07 and USD 0.10 an hour at list price (Google's e2-standard-2, Azure's Standard_D2s_v4 and Amazon's m5.large in their eastern United States regions; check each provider's price list on the day), a control plane costs nothing or about USD 0.10 an hour depending on the provider and tier, and a paired run of five repetitions on four workers is a few tens of dollars. The run builds a fresh cluster for every arm and deletes it when the arm ends, so nothing keeps billing.

## 14.6 How to read the rest of this part

Chapter 15 sets the permissions, identically on every cloud. Chapters 16, 17 and 18 build the cluster and install the governor on Azure, Google Cloud and Amazon Web Services, click by click and command by command. Chapter 19 sets up the response-time feed and the line, on any cloud. Chapter 20 is the cloud mode itself: why the governor moves the machines alone in a cloud, what that guarantees about the bill, and how to read the bill and the alarm minutes. Chapter 21 is day two: running the governor as a service, upgrades, rollbacks, the watchdog, alarms and a fleet of clusters. Chapter 21 is the graphics processor, written for the implementer who will put the governor on a card, rented or owned. Chapter 23 connects the governor to the company's own monitoring in both directions, and chapter 24 maps the installation onto change management, risk and compliance. Chapter 25 bounds, before any run, the saving a cloud pool can show and where in the day it lives. Chapter 26 is for clusters on the company's own racks and in private clouds; chapter 27 hardens the installation and its supply chain; chapter 28 rolls it out across a fleet and under continuous delivery; chapter 29 lists every failure to expect, with the drills that rehearse them; and chapter 30 is the whole path at once, on one cluster, start to finish. Chapter 31 is the implementer's questions, answered. The accounts and the paired run from GitHub are in Appendices F to H, the install manifests in Appendix I, and the checklists in Appendix J.

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CHAPTER 15

# Identity, Permissions and Least Privilege on a Managed Cluster

The governor acts on a cluster only through the Kubernetes API, as one service account, with the verbs its level needs and no more. This chapter gives those verbs exactly, level by level, the same on every cloud; the cloud-specific steps (registry, cluster credentials, the provider's own identity) are in chapters 16 to 18.

## 15.1 One namespace, one service account, one process

The governor runs as one Deployment of one replica in its own namespace, `omni-compass`, under the service account `omni-compass`. One replica is a rule, not a default: the governor is the one writer of every setting it moves (section 5.2), and two copies would be two writers. A second replica for availability is not needed and must not be added; if the one process dies, the watchdog of chapter 21 puts every setting back from the records on the objects themselves, and the native controllers carry the service as they did before the governor was installed.

The pod runs as a non-root user (UID 10001) with a read-only root filesystem, no Linux capabilities, no privilege escalation and the runtime's default seccomp profile. It writes only two places: its audit log (an `emptyDir` volume mounted at `/var/log/omni`, or a persistent volume where the audit must outlive the pod, section 21.4) and `/tmp` (an `emptyDir` for its kill file). It needs no secret, no host path, no host network and no service exposed to anything.

## 15.2 The verbs, level by level

The table is the complete list. A verb not in it is not needed at that level and must not be granted.

| Level | API group | Resources | Verbs | Why |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Watch (every level) | core | `nodes`, `pods` | `get`, `list` | read the machines, their allocatable processor and the pods on them |

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| Level | API group | Resources | Verbs | Why |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Watch | `metrics.k8s.io` | `nodes`, `pods` | `get`, `list` | read processor in use |
| Watch | `autoscaling` | `horizontalpodautoscalers` | `get`, `list` | read each autoscaler's target, range and current replicas |
| Watch | `apps` | `deployments`, `replicasets`, `daemonsets` | `get`, `list` | read what each autoscaler scales, and tell workload pods from per-node agents |
| Watch | core | `configmaps` (the one security-hold ConfigMap, by name) | `get` | read the security hold, where one is wired |
| Machines (the cloud mode) | core | `nodes` | `patch` | park a machine (a `PreferNoSchedule` taint) and wake it (remove the taint); a machine someone else cordoned is never uncordoned |
| Machines | core | `pods` | `patch` | mark the pods on a parked machine first to go (the `pod-deletion-cost` annotation), so the autoscaler's own scale-down removes them first |
| Pod target (not in the cloud mode) | `autoscaling` | `horizontalpodautoscalers` (each governed one, by name) | `patch`, `update` | move the autoscaler's CPU target inside its cover, and record the operator's own target on the object |
| Processor conveyance (not in the cloud mode) | core | `pods/resize` | `get`, `patch` | resize a running pod's processor limit in place; no pod is restarted |
| Batch admission (where wired) | `batch` | `jobs` | `patch` | admit held work |

Two verbs are absent from every level and are refused by review if they appear: `delete` on anything, and `create` on `pods/eviction`. The governor does not delete or evict; a parked machine is emptied by the

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cluster autoscaler's own scale-down, as it would be without the governor, and only once its pods have gone by the autoscaler's own rules.

## 15.3 The cloud mode's role, complete

For the cloud mode of chapter 20 (the machines alone), the grant is the watch role plus two verbs. Apply it in place of the level-2 and level-3 files of chapter 7:

```
apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
kind: ClusterRole
metadata: {name: omni-compass-machines}
rules:
  - apiGroups: [""]
    resources: [nodes]
    verbs: [patch]
  - apiGroups: [""]
    resources: [pods]
    verbs: [patch]
---
apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
kind: ClusterRoleBinding
metadata: {name: omni-compass-machines}
roleRef: {apiGroup: rbac.authorization.k8s.io, kind: ClusterRole, name
    ↪ : omni-compass-machines}
subjects: [{kind: ServiceAccount, name: omni-compass, namespace: omni-
    ↪ compass}]
```

The watch role is in the install manifest (`deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml`, printed in Appendix I); it grants only `get` and `list`. Together the two files are everything the governor can do in the cloud mode, and every write it makes is in its audit with the command and the reason.

## 15.4 Proving the grant before the governor runs

Before the governor is started at any level, the implementer proves the grant from outside it, as the service account, and keeps the output with the installation record:

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```
SA=system:serviceaccount:omni-compass:omni-compass
for v in "get nodes" "list pods" "get horizontalpodautoscalers.autosca
    ↪ ling" "list deployments.apps" \
         "patch nodes" "patch pods" "patch horizontalpodautoscalers.au
    ↪ toscaling" "patch pods/resize" \
         "delete pods" "create pods/eviction" "delete nodes" "create p
    ↪ ods"; do
  printf '%-48s %s\n' "$v" "$(kubectl auth can-i $v --as=$SA -A)"
done
```

In the cloud mode the answers are `yes` for the four reads and for `patch nodes` and `patch pods`, and `no` for everything else, including `patch horizontalpodautoscalers.autoscaling` and `patch pods/resize`. Any other answer is a grant to correct before the governor starts, not after.

## 15.5 No cloud credential

In the cloud mode the governor holds no credential of the cloud provider: no Azure service principal, no Google service account key, no Amazon access key, no workload-identity binding. It parks and wakes machines through the Kubernetes API; the provider's own cluster autoscaler, with the provider's own identity, makes and deletes machines. This is a security property worth stating to a reviewer in one sentence: an attacker who took the governor's pod would hold a Kubernetes service account that can read the cluster's shape and taint nodes and annotate pods, and nothing that can spend money in the provider, open a network path or read a secret.

The paired runs from GitHub (Appendices F to H) are different: there the workflow itself builds and deletes clusters, and it holds a provider credential as a GitHub secret (`AZURE_CREDENTIALS`, `GCP_CREDENTIALS`, `AWS_ACCESS_KEY_ID` and `AWS_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY`). That credential belongs to the test harness, never to the governor, and it is removed when the evaluation ends.

## 15.6 Network and data

The governor talks to one endpoint: the cluster's API server, through a single local proxy it starts itself (one `kubectl proxy` for the life of the process; `--no-api-proxy` falls back to one `kubectl` call per read, at a higher cost of its own). A NetworkPolicy may restrict its egress to the API server and, where the response-time feed is read over the network, to the feed; it accepts no ingress. It sends nothing off the cluster. The audit holds object names, replica counts, machine counts, response-time statistics and the governor's reasons; it holds no request payload and no personal data, because the governor never sees either.

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## 15.7 The record an installation keeps

| Item | Where |
|---|---|
| The engine version and the copy's verification receipt | `python3 tools/omni_version.py`, `results/VERIFY_RECEIPT.txt` (chapter 33) |
| The grant as applied, and the `kubectl auth can-i` output of section 15.4 | the installation record |
| The governor's command line (its arguments in the Deployment) | the Deployment object, kept with the installation record |
| The service's line, and who signed it | the installation record (chapter 19) |
| The audit of every decision and every write | the audit volume (chapter 21) |
| Every OFF-switch drill, with the seconds to hand back | the installation record (chapter 21) |

CHAPTER 16

# Azure Kubernetes Service, Step by Step

This chapter takes an implementer from an Azure subscription to Omni-Compass watching an Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) cluster, ready for the governing switch of chapter 20. Every command runs in Azure Cloud Shell (Bash) or on a workstation with the Azure CLI (`az`), `kubectl` and Docker; nothing else is needed. Replace the names in angle brackets.

## 16.1 The subscription and its allowances

1. **Sign in and choose the subscription.** `az login`, then `az account set --subscription <subscription-id>`.
2. **Register the provider once:** `az provider register --namespace Microsoft.ContainerService --wait`.
3. **Read the allowances before building anything.** Azure counts vCPUs per region and, separately, per machine family in that region; a cluster fails on the family's allowance, not the region's. Read both:

``bash az vm list-usage -l <region> -o table | grep -Ei "Total Regional vCPUs|Standard DSv4|Standard DSv5|Standard Dv4" ``

A new pay-as-you-go subscription commonly has 10 vCPUs a family and a few hundred a region. A work pool of four two-vCPU machines plus a one-machine system pool needs 10 vCPUs of the families used. Raise

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an allowance in the portal (**Quotas**, then **Compute**, the family and region, **Request quota increase**) before the cluster is built, not after a half-built cluster fails.

4. **Pick the machine family the region offers.** `az vm list-skus -l <region> --size Standard_D2 -o table` lists what the subscription may create there. A size marked "NotAvailableForSubscription" is refused at build time.

## 16.2 The cluster: a system pool, a work pool, the autoscaler

The layout is the one every receipt in this manual is made on, and it is the right layout for production too: the cluster's own add-ons and the governor on a small **system pool** that no workload may land on, and the service on one or more **work pools** under Azure's cluster autoscaler, each labelled `omni-role=work`.

```
RG=<resource-group>; NAME=<cluster>; LOC=<region>; SIZE=Standard_D2s_v
    ↪ 4
az group create -n $RG -l $LOC -o none
az aks create -g $RG -n $NAME -l $LOC --tier standard --node-count 1 -
    ↪ -node-vm-size $SIZE \
  --nodepool-name system --nodepool-taints CriticalAddonsOnly=true:NoS
    ↪ chedule --nodepool-labels omni-role=system \
  --cluster-autoscaler-profile scale-down-unneeded-time=10m scale-down
    ↪ -delay-after-add=10m scan-interval=10s \
  --generate-ssh-keys -o none
az aks nodepool add -g $RG --cluster-name $NAME -n work0 --mode User -
    ↪ -node-vm-size $SIZE --labels omni-role=work \
  --node-count 2 --enable-cluster-autoscaler --min-count 2 --max-count
    ↪  <pool top> -o none
az aks get-credentials -g $RG -n $NAME
kubectl get nodes -L omni-role,agentpool
```

Four choices in those lines matter, and each is the operator's, not the governor's:

- **The tier.** `standard` (about USD 0.10 an hour a cluster, with Azure's uptime agreement) or `free`. The control plane is not in the bill the receipts count, which is worker machines only. In some regions at busy hours Azure refuses new free-tier clusters ("creating a new cluster is unavailable at this time in region"); the standard tier is the way past.
- **The autoscaler profile.** `scale-down-unneeded-time` is how long a machine must be unneeded before Azure deletes it, and so how long a machine the governor has parked keeps billing once its pods are gone. Azure's default is 10 minutes; the paired receipts in this manual used 2 minutes in both arms. Choose it for the service, write it down, and keep it the same in both arms of any paired run. The governor never changes it.

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- **The pool's floor.** `--min-count` is the autoscaler's own floor. The governor's floor of two machines in service (`MIN_NODES`, section 4.4) is applied on top of it; set the pool's floor to at least two for a service that must survive one machine's loss.
- **The pool's top.** `--max-count` is the most machines Azure will make. The governor never asks Azure for a machine; it parks and wakes the ones Azure made (chapter 20), so the pool's top is the operator's cost ceiling, as it is without the governor.

Several machine families can be pooled, each as its own work pool with its own top, all labelled `omni-role=work`; that is how a fleet gets past a ten-vCPU allowance a family, and the governor treats all labelled pools as one set of machines.

**Prove the autoscaler before anything else.** Scale a test Deployment past the pool's capacity and back, and watch Azure add and delete a machine (`kubectl get nodes -w`). A cluster whose autoscaler has not been seen to work both ways is not ready for a governor that relies on it to delete the machines it parks.

## 16.3 metrics-server and the service's autoscaler

AKS runs metrics-server in every cluster; check it with `kubectl top nodes`. The service must have a HorizontalPodAutoscaler on CPU utilisation, with requests set on its containers (an HPA cannot compute utilisation without them):

```
kubectl autoscale deployment <service> -n <namespace> --cpu-percent=<t
    ↪ arget> --min=<min> --max=<max>
kubectl get hpa -n <namespace>
```

The target, the minimum and the maximum are the service owner's, written down before the governor is installed. In the cloud mode the governor never moves them; they are recorded because the receipt's native arm runs on them.

## 16.4 The registry and the governor's image

```
ACR=<registry-name>
az acr create -g $RG -n $ACR --sku Basic -o none
az aks update -g $RG -n $NAME --attach-acr $ACR -o none
az acr build -r $ACR -t omni-compass:<version> -f deploy/Dockerfile .
az acr build -r $ACR -t omni-compass-cloud:<version> -f deploy/Dockerf
    ↪ ile.cloud \
  --build-arg BASE=$ACR.azurecr.io/omni-compass:<version> .
```

The first image is the shipped one (`deploy/Dockerfile`): the governor, non-root, read-only, with `kubectl`. The second adds what the cloud mode needs to move machines and to feed itself, and is written once for every cloud in section 19.4. Tag images with the engine version printed by `python3`

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`tools/omni_version.py` and the commit, never `latest`, so the audit of any decision can be tied to the exact code that made it.

## 16.5 Watch first

```
kubectl apply -f deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml
kubectl -n omni-compass set image deployment/omni-compass controller=$
    ↪ ACR.azurecr.io/omni-compass:<version>
kubectl -n omni-compass rollout status deployment/omni-compass
kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass -- tail -n 5 /var/log
    ↪ /omni/audit.jsonl
```

The install manifest (Appendix I) creates the namespace, the service account, the read-only role and one Deployment running `--mode observe`. In watch mode the governor computes every decision it would make and writes none: each `decision` record carries the machines and the pod target it recommends (`nodes_recommended`, `hpa_target_recommended`), and no `write` record appears. Leave it watching for at least one full cycle of the service's own load (section 13.3). To keep the audit past a pod restart, mount a persistent volume at `/var/log/omni` (section 21.4); on AKS the `managed-csi` storage class provides one.

## 16.6 The paired run on Azure

The receipt that decides whether the governor goes into service is a paired run on the company's own service: native against native with Omni-Compass on top, the same load in both arms, a fresh cluster per arm, repeated (chapter 11). The repository's own workflow `aks-metered` runs exactly that from GitHub, on clusters it builds and deletes itself, and counts Azure's billed machines every 15 seconds at list price; Appendix F connects it to a subscription, click by click. To run it on a company's own service instead of the reference service, the service's manifests replace `deploy/kind/demo.yaml` in a fork, and its line replaces the reference line of 500 ms (chapter 19).

## 16.7 Tearing down

`az group delete -n $RG --yes --no-wait` deletes the cluster, its machines and its registry. Every paired run of the workflow deletes its own resource group at the end of every repetition, whatever happened, so nothing keeps billing; a run cancelled by hand runs the same deletion as its last step.

## 16.8 What goes wrong on Azure, and what to do

| Symptom | Cause | Fix |
|---|---|---|
| `QuotaExceeded` or `OperationNotAllowed` on | the family's vCPU allowance in the region | request the family's increase; or add a second work pool in another |

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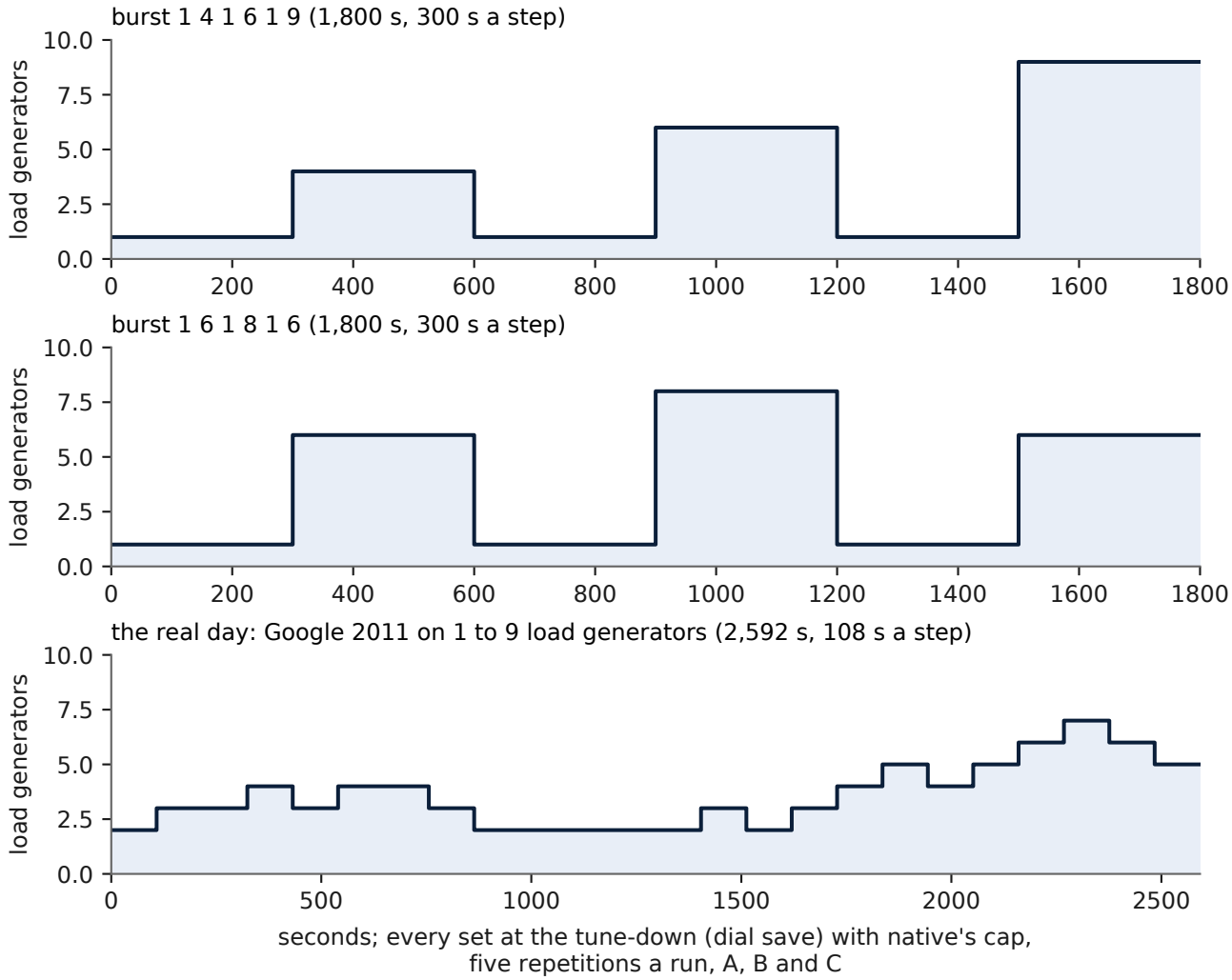



**Figure 42.** The load schedules of the cloud sets: the two bursts (1 4 1 6 1 9 and 1 6 1 8 1 6, 300 s a step) and the real day (the Google 2011 trace on one to nine load generators, 108 s a step). Every set runs at the tune-down with native's cap, five repetitions a run, as runs A, B and C; the load generator alone reads the schedule, never the governor.

| Symptom | Cause | Fix |
|---|---|---|
| `az aks create` or `nodepool add` | | family |
| "creating a new cluster is unavailable at this time in region" | Azure's free-tier capacity in the region | `--tier standard`, or another region |
| A size "is not available for this subscription" | the family is not offered there | `az vm list-skus` and choose an offered size (the receipts used Standard_D2s_v4 and Standard_D2_v4 in eastus) |

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| Symptom | Cause | Fix |
|---|---|---|
| Pods `Pending`, no machine added | the pool is at its `--max-count`, or the pods do not fit any machine size in the pool | raise the top, or add a pool of a larger size |
| A parked machine keeps billing for minutes | `scale-down-unneeded-time` (10 minutes by default) | expected; it is native's own setting, kept the same in both arms |
| The governor's image will not pull | the registry is not attached | `az aks update --attach-acr` |

CHAPTER 17

# Google Kubernetes Engine, Step by Step

This chapter takes an implementer from a Google Cloud project to Omni-Compass watching a Google Kubernetes Engine (GKE) cluster, ready for the governing switch of chapter 20. Every command runs in Cloud Shell or on a workstation with the Google Cloud CLI (`gcloud`), `kubectl` and Docker. The layout and the order are those of chapter 16; only the provider's commands differ.

## 17.1 The project and its allowances

1. **Sign in and choose the project.** `gcloud auth login`, then `gcloud config set project <project-id>`.
2. **Enable the two services once:** `gcloud services enable container.googleapis.com compute.googleapis.com artifactregistry.googleapis.com`.
3. **Read the allowances.** Compute Engine counts CPUs per region (the `CPUS` quota) and, for some families, per family (for example `N2_CPUS`); a new project's regional CPU quota is often 24 or less. Read them with `gcloud compute regions describe <region> --format="table(quotas.metric,quotas.limit,quotas.usage)"` and raise them in the console (**IAM and Admin**, **Quotas**) before the cluster is built.
4. **Pick the zone and machine type.** The receipts' reference is `e2-standard-2` (two vCPUs) in `us-central1-a`.

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## 17.2 The cluster: a system pool, a work pool, the autoscaler

```
NAME=<cluster>; ZONE=<zone>; MACHINE=e2-standard-2
gcloud container clusters create $NAME --zone $ZONE --num-nodes 1 --ma
    ↪ chine-type $MACHINE \
  --node-taints CriticalAddonsOnly=true:NoSchedule --node-labels omni-
    ↪ role=system \
  --autoscaling-profile balanced --release-channel regular

gcloud container node-pools create work0 --cluster $NAME --zone $ZONE
    ↪ --machine-type $MACHINE \
  --num-nodes 2 --enable-autoscaling --min-nodes 2 --max-nodes <pool t
    ↪ op> --node-labels omni-role=work
gcloud container clusters get-credentials $NAME --zone $ZONE
kubectl get nodes -L omni-role
```

The default node pool created with the cluster becomes the system pool: one machine, tainted so that no workload lands on it, labelled `omni-role=system`. The work pool carries the label `omni-role=work`, which is how the governor knows which machines it may park.

**The autoscaling profile.** GKE offers two: `balanced` (Google's default) and `optimize-utilization`, which removes underused machines sooner and so lets a parked, emptied machine leave the bill sooner. The receipts used `optimize-utilization` in both arms. As on Azure, the profile is native's own setting: choose it for the service, write it down, keep it the same in both arms of any paired run. The governor never changes it.

**Prove the autoscaler.** As in section 16.2: push a test Deployment past the pool and back, and watch a machine come and go. GKE's autoscaler may take several minutes to remove a machine even under `optimize-utilization`; that time is the time a parked machine keeps billing after its pods have gone, and it is the same in both arms.

## 17.3 metrics-server and the service's autoscaler

GKE runs metrics-server; check with `kubectl top nodes`. The service needs a CPU HorizontalPodAutoscaler and container requests, exactly as in section 16.3. GKE Autopilot clusters are a different product: their nodes are managed by Google and not visible as a pool the governor can park, so the governor's machine lever has nothing to move there. Use a Standard cluster.

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## 17.4 The registry and the governor's image

```
REPO=<region>-docker.pkg.dev/<project-id>/omni-compass
gcloud artifacts repositories create omni-compass --repository-format=
    ↪ docker --location=<region>
gcloud auth configure-docker <region>-docker.pkg.dev
docker build -t $REPO/omni-compass:<version> -f deploy/Dockerfile . &&
    ↪  docker push $REPO/omni-compass:<version>

docker build -t $REPO/omni-compass-cloud:<version> -f deploy/Dockerfil
    ↪ e.cloud \
  --build-arg BASE=$REPO/omni-compass:<version> . && docker push $REPO
    ↪ /omni-compass-cloud:<version>
```

The cluster's nodes pull from an Artifact Registry repository in the same project with their default service account; a repository in another project needs `roles/artifactregistry.reader` granted to the nodes' service account there.

## 17.5 Watch first

```
kubectl apply -f deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml
kubectl -n omni-compass set image deployment/omni-compass controller=$
    ↪ REPO/omni-compass:<version>
kubectl -n omni-compass rollout status deployment/omni-compass
kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass -- tail -n 5 /var/log
    ↪ /omni/audit.jsonl
```

The governor watches and writes nothing (section 16.5). For an audit that outlives the pod, the `standard-rwo` storage class provides a persistent volume (section 21.4).

## 17.6 The paired run on Google Cloud

The workflow `gke-metered` is the same design as Azure's, on clusters it builds and deletes itself, with Google's billed machines counted every 15 seconds at the list price of the machine type; Appendix G connects it to a project, click by click. It runs at the tune-down with the governor on the machines alone, as every cloud set does (chapter 20), and its run title carries the load and the dial.

## 17.7 Tearing down

`gcloud container clusters delete $NAME --zone $ZONE` deletes the cluster and its machines; `gcloud artifacts repositories delete omni-compass`

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`--location=<region>` deletes the images. Every paired run deletes every cluster it made, whatever happened, as its last step.

## 17.8 What goes wrong on Google Cloud, and what to do

| Symptom | Cause | Fix |
|---|---|---|
| `Quota 'CPUS' exceeded` | the region's CPU quota | request an increase; or a smaller machine type |
| `ZONE_RESOURCE_POOL_EXHAUSTED` | the zone has no capacity of that type now | another zone in the region, or another machine type |
| The work pool never shrinks | the autoscaler sees a pod it may not move (local storage, a pod without a controller, a PodDisruptionBudget at zero) | find the pod in `kubectl describe` of the autoscaler's status ConfigMap; it holds native too |
| The governor's image will not pull | the nodes' service account cannot read the repository | grant `roles/artifactregistry.reader` |
| No pool for the governor to park on an Autopilot cluster | Autopilot hides the nodes | use a Standard cluster |

CHAPTER 18

# Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service, Step by Step

This chapter takes an implementer from an Amazon Web Services account to Omni-Compass watching an Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service (EKS) cluster, ready for the governing switch of chapter 20. Every command runs in AWS CloudShell or on a workstation with the AWS CLI (`aws`), `eksctl`, `helm`, `kubectl` and Docker. EKS differs from the other two in one respect that matters: it ships neither a cluster autoscaler nor metrics-server, and the implementer installs both.

## 18.1 The account and its allowances

1. **Sign in.** `aws configure` with an identity allowed to create EKS clusters, EC2 instances, IAM roles and CloudFormation stacks (eksctl builds the cluster through CloudFormation).

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2. **Read the allowances.** EC2 counts vCPUs of on-demand standard instances per region (the quota "Running On-Demand Standard (A, C, D, H, I, M, R, T, Z) instances"). Read it with `aws service-quotas get-service-quota --service-code ec2 --quota-code L-1216C47A --region <region>` and raise it in the Service Quotas console before building.
3. **Pick the region and instance type.** The receipts' reference is `m5.large` (two vCPUs) in `us-east-1`.

## 18.2 The cluster: a system node group, a work node group, the autoscaler

eksctl reads the whole cluster from one file. The system group carries the add-ons and the governor; the work group is tagged for the cluster autoscaler's auto-discovery and labelled `omni-role=work`:

```
apiVersion: eksctl.io/v1alpha5
kind: ClusterConfig
metadata: {name: <cluster>, region: <region>}
iam:
  withOIDC: true
  serviceAccounts:

    - metadata: {name: cluster-autoscaler, namespace: kube-system}
      wellKnownPolicies: {autoScaler: true}
managedNodeGroups:
  - name: system
    instanceType: m5.large
    minSize: 1

    maxSize: 1
    labels: {omni-role: system}
    taints: [{key: CriticalAddonsOnly, value: "true", effect: NoSchedu
    ↪ le}]
  - name: work0
    instanceType: m5.large

    minSize: 2
    maxSize: <pool top>
    labels: {omni-role: work}
    tags: {"k8s.io/cluster-autoscaler/enabled": "true", "k8s.io/cluste
    ↪ r-autoscaler/<cluster>": "owned"}
```

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```
eksctl create cluster -f cluster.yaml
helm repo add autoscaler https://kubernetes.github.io/autoscaler && he
    ↪ lm repo update
helm upgrade --install cluster-autoscaler autoscaler/cluster-autoscale
    ↪ r -n kube-system \
  --set image.tag=v1.<minor>.0 --set autoDiscovery.clusterName=<cluste
    ↪ r> --set awsRegion=<region> \
  --set rbac.serviceAccount.create=false --set rbac.serviceAccount.nam
    ↪ e=cluster-autoscaler \
  --set extraArgs.scale-down-unneeded-time=10m --set extraArgs.scale-d
    ↪ own-delay-after-add=10m \
  --set "tolerations[0].key=CriticalAddonsOnly" --set "tolerations[0].
    ↪ operator=Exists" \
  --set "nodeSelector.omni-role=system" --wait
kubectl apply -f https://github.com/kubernetes-sigs/metrics-server/rel
    ↪ eases/download/v0.7.2/components.yaml
```

- **The autoscaler's version** must match the cluster's Kubernetes minor version (`kubectl version` prints it); the autoscaler publishes one release a minor.
- **The autoscaler's identity** is the one place a cloud credential enters the cluster, and it belongs to the autoscaler, never to the governor: eksctl creates an IAM role for the `cluster-autoscaler` service account with the autoscaling policy and nothing else.
- **The scale-down timing** (`scale-down-unneeded-time`, 10 minutes by default) is native's own, kept the same in both arms of any paired run, never changed by the governor; the receipts used 2 minutes in both arms.
- **metrics-server** goes on the system machine: patch its Deployment with the same toleration and node selector, or it will take a work machine's room.

**Karpenter.** Where the cluster runs Karpenter instead of the cluster autoscaler, the governor's machine lever works the same way: it parks a machine with a `PreferNoSchedule` taint and marks its pods first to go, and Karpenter's consolidation removes the machine once it is empty. Karpenter's NodePool must carry the label `omni-role=work` on the machines it makes, and its disruption budget and consolidation policy are native's own settings, kept the same in both arms.

## 18.3 The service's autoscaler

As in section 16.3: a CPU HorizontalPodAutoscaler and container requests, the target and range written down by the service owner. Check that metrics-server answers with `kubectl top nodes` before the governor is installed; without it the governor reads the service's processor as blind and holds (section 6.3).

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## 18.4 The registry and the governor's image

```
ACCT=$(aws sts get-caller-identity --query Account --output text); REG
    ↪ =$ACCT.dkr.ecr.<region>.amazonaws.com
aws ecr create-repository --repository-name omni-compass --region <reg
    ↪ ion>
aws ecr create-repository --repository-name omni-compass-cloud --regio
    ↪ n <region>

aws ecr get-login-password --region <region> | docker login --username
    ↪  AWS --password-stdin $REG
docker build -t $REG/omni-compass:<version> -f deploy/Dockerfile . &&
    ↪ docker push $REG/omni-compass:<version>
docker build -t $REG/omni-compass-cloud:<version> -f deploy/Dockerfile
    ↪ .cloud \

  --build-arg BASE=$REG/omni-compass:<version> . && docker push $REG/o
    ↪ mni-compass-cloud:<version>
```

eksctl's managed node groups carry `AmazonEC2ContainerRegistryReadOnly` on their instance role, so the nodes pull from ECR in the same account without further grants.

## 18.5 Watch first

```
kubectl apply -f deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml
kubectl -n omni-compass set image deployment/omni-compass controller=$
    ↪ REG/omni-compass:<version>
kubectl -n omni-compass rollout status deployment/omni-compass
kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass -- tail -n 5 /var/log
    ↪ /omni/audit.jsonl
```

The governor watches and writes nothing (section 16.5). For an audit that outlives the pod, the EBS CSI driver's `gp3` storage class provides a persistent volume once the driver add-on is installed (section 21.4).

## 18.6 The paired run on Amazon

The workflow `eks-metered` is the same design as Azure's and Google's, on clusters it builds with eksctl and deletes itself, Amazon's billed instances counted every 15 seconds at list price; Appendix H connects it to an account, click by click. It runs at the tune-down with the governor on the machines alone (chapter 20).

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## 18.7 Tearing down

`eksctl delete cluster --name <cluster> --region <region> --wait` deletes the cluster, its node groups and the CloudFormation stacks; `aws ecr delete-repository --repository-name omni-compass --force` deletes the images. Every paired run deletes every cluster it made as its last step, whatever happened.

## 18.8 What goes wrong on Amazon, and what to do

| Symptom | Cause | Fix |
|---|---|---|
| `VcpuLimitExceeded` | the region's on-demand vCPU quota | request an increase |
| eksctl stops with a CloudFormation `ROLLBACK_COMPLETE` | a quota, a subnet or an IAM permission | read the stack's events in the CloudFormation console; delete the stack before retrying |
| The work group never grows or shrinks | the autoscaler's version does not match the cluster, or the group is not tagged for discovery | match the image tag to the cluster's minor; check the two tags |
| `kubectl top` fails | metrics-server is not installed or cannot reach the kubelets | install the pinned release; check its logs |
| A parked machine is never removed | Karpenter's or the autoscaler's disruption rules hold it (a PodDisruptionBudget, a do-not-disrupt annotation) | the same rule holds native; it is the operator's |

CHAPTER 19

# The Response-Time Feed and the Line

The governor holds a service at its line by reading the service's response time. The **feed** is how that reading reaches it; the **line** is the response time the service must meet, written down by the service's owner. Both are the implementer's to provide, on any cloud, and both are decided before the governor watches, because a governor watching a wrong feed against a wrong line produces an audit that teaches nothing.

## 19.1 The line

The line is a response-time objective in milliseconds, passed as `--slo-ms`. It is the service owner's, never the implementer's and never the governor's, and it is written down with its basis before the first counted run:

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- **The percentile it binds.** The governor reads the line against the 95th percentile of recent responses (a breach is the 95th percentile at or over the line) and holds the mean of recent responses inside its band below the line. An objective written on another percentile is translated by the owner, not by the implementer.
- **What counts as a response.** In the receipt a failed request (a timeout, a connection refused, a 5xx where the owner says so) counts over the line, whatever its timing. The governor builds its own reading from the served responses of its window; a window in which no request was served reads as past the line, and every machine is held.
- **Where it is measured.** At the edge the customer sees (the load balancer or ingress), or behind it; the line and the feed must be measured at the same place.

A line set far above the service's real response times leaves the governor nothing to hold and reads as "no difference beyond the noise" on every row; a line set below what the service can meet on native reads as a breach in every decision and the governor holds every machine. Both are wiring faults, and Appendix D lists their symptoms.

## 19.2 The feed's format

The feed is a text file of comma-separated values that the governor reads with `--latency-file`. Its first line is the header and every later line is one response:

```
elapsed_seconds,latency_ms,ok
0.0,212.4,1
0.3,198.0,1
0.6,5003.1,0
```

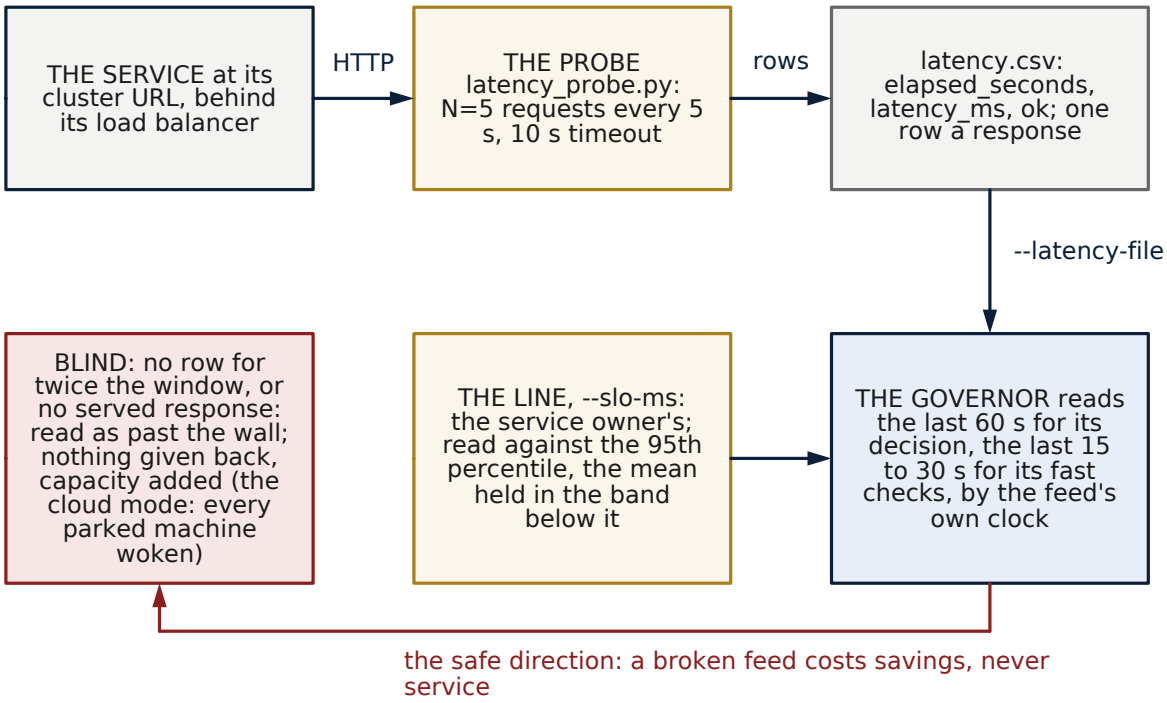
- `elapsed_seconds`: seconds since the feed began, increasing; the governor reads only rows newer than the last it read.
- `latency_ms`: the response's time, in milliseconds.
- `ok`: 1 for a response the owner counts as served, 0 for a failure.

The governor reads the window of recent rows (the last 60 seconds for its decision, the last 15 to 30 seconds for its fast reflexes) by the feed's own clock. **A feed whose file has not changed for twice the window, or whose window holds no served response, reads as blind**, and a blind sense makes the governor hold every machine in service and give nothing back until the feed returns (section 6.3). That is the safe direction, and it is why a broken feed costs savings, never service.

## 19.3 Feed one: the probe

The repository's probe (`scripts/latency_probe.py`) times real HTTP requests to one URL and writes exactly this file:

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Feed two: the service's own timings (an ingress, a mesh, the application's histogram) written in the same three columns, measured at the same place as the line, never pre-smoothed. One feed for one governor.

**Figure 43.** Wiring schematic: the response-time feed and the line. The probe times real requests to the service and writes one row a response to latency.csv (elapsed_seconds, latency_ms, ok); the governor reads the file by its own clock, the last 60 s for its decision and the last 15 to 30 s for its fast checks, against the line the service owner wrote (--slo-ms).

A feed that has not advanced for twice the window, or holds no served response, reads as blind, and a blind sense is read as past the wall: nothing is given back and capacity is added (in the cloud mode every parked machine is woken), the safe direction. A second feed, the service's own timings, may be written in the same three columns, measured at the same place as the line and never pre-smoothed.

```
INTERVAL=5 N=5 DURATION=31536000 python3 scripts/latency_probe.py http
    ↪ ://<service>.<namespace>.svc.cluster.local/ /feed/latency.csv
```

It sends `N` requests back to back, pauses `INTERVAL` seconds, and repeats for `DURATION` seconds; each request has a 10-second timeout, and a timeout or an error is written as `ok=0`. In the cloud mode it runs as a second container in the governor's own pod (section 20.4), writing to a volume both containers share. A probe measures a synthetic request; it is the right feed where the service has one representative endpoint, and the wrong one where the customer's requests differ widely in cost.

**A probe restart.** The probe's clock starts again at zero when its container restarts. The governor's reading follows the newest rows by their own clock and carries on, but a give-back trial counts only rows newer than

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the last it counted, so no trial completes, and no machine is given back, until the new clock passes the old one. That is the safe direction. Restart the governor's pod so both clocks start together (the governor hands every setting back on its way out; section 21.3), and alert on a restarted probe container (section 21.5).

## 19.4 Feed two: the service's own timings

Where the service already measures its responses (an ingress controller, a service mesh, the application's own histogram), an adapter can write those timings in the same three columns. The adapter is a small program the implementer owns: it appends one row per response, or one row per short interval carrying that interval's 95th percentile with `ok=0` rows for the interval's failures. Two rules keep it honest:

1. **The same place as the line.** Timings from the ingress for a line written at the ingress; timings from the application for a line written at the application.
2. **No smoothing the governor does not know about.** A row is a response or an interval's own statistic, never a moving average of earlier rows; the governor builds its own windows, and a pre-smoothed feed makes it late.

## 19.5 Checking the feed before the governor watches

| Check | How | Pass |
|---|---|---|
| The file advances | `tail -f /feed/latency.csv` for a minute | a new row at least every 5 seconds |
| The clock is monotonic | the first column never decreases | yes, across a full day |
| The failures are counted | stop the service's endpoint for 30 seconds in a test window | rows with `ok=0` appear, and the governor's audit reads the latency sense as blind or breached: either way past the line, every machine held |
| The line is plausible | the feed's 95th percentile on a normal day against `--slo-ms` | the 95th percentile sits below the line on a normal day, and reaches it only under real pressure |
| Blind is safe | stop the probe for two minutes in a test window | the audit shows `blind` and no machine given back until the feed returns |

## 19.6 One feed for one governor

A governor reads one feed (`--latency-file`), and a cluster has one governor on its machines (the one-writer rule, section 6.2). Where several services share the governed machines, the feed must speak for all of them: either the feed of the service most sensitive to a lost machine, or an adapter (section 19.4) that writes,

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for each short interval, the worst of the services' own 95th percentiles against their own lines, scaled to one line. Outside the cloud mode `--sensed` names the services whose autoscalers the feed speaks for, and only those are moved; in the cloud mode no autoscaler is moved at all, and the feed is the guard on the machines the governor parks: a machine is parked only while the line holds, and a breach wakes it at the next decision.

CHAPTER 20

# Running in the Cloud: the Machines Alone, the Bill and the Alarm Minutes

**THE CLOUD IS ONLY A WIRE BETWEEN THE SOFTWARE END AND THE HARDWARE END. OMNI-COMPASS ON THE CLOUD ALONE CAN GIVE ONLY A SMALL CUT IN THE BILL, FROM THE MACHINES THE CLOUD'S OWN AUTOSCALER MADE; THE BENEFIT LIVES AT THE TWO ENDS, IN THE SOFTWARE AND IN THE BARE METAL, AND THE CLOUD CARRIES IT.**

## 20.1 Why the governor moves the machines alone in a cloud

In a public cloud every machine that exists is billed, whether it carries work or not, so the benefit a cloud can show is the bill: the same work as native for a smaller bill, never a bigger one, and never more alarms. The governor has three levers a cloud would let it pull besides the machines: the pod autoscaler's target, the processor of running pods and their power. In a cloud each of them can only raise the bill: a lower pod target asks for more pods, and more pods ask the cloud for machines; more processor for a pod makes it read busier to its autoscaler, which then asks for more pods; and a power cap saves nothing a cloud bills. So in a cloud the governor moves the machines alone:

- **No pod autoscaler is moved.** Every HPA keeps the operator's own target, range and cap, so the pods are exactly the pods native would run.
- **No processor is conveyed and no power is capped.**
- **The machines.** The governor parks a machine the cloud's autoscaler already made, only after its own trial shows the service's response time holds without it (within 2% of the response time with it, through the release gate, one machine at a time), and wakes it on a breach: at the next full decision (within 60 seconds) for a response time over the line, and at the next fast check (within 5 seconds) for a pod that cannot be placed. A pod never waits for either: a parked machine's taint is `PreferNoSchedule`, so a pod that finds the open machines full lands on a parked one at once. A parked machine whose pods have gone is deleted by the cloud's own autoscaler, on the cloud's own schedule.

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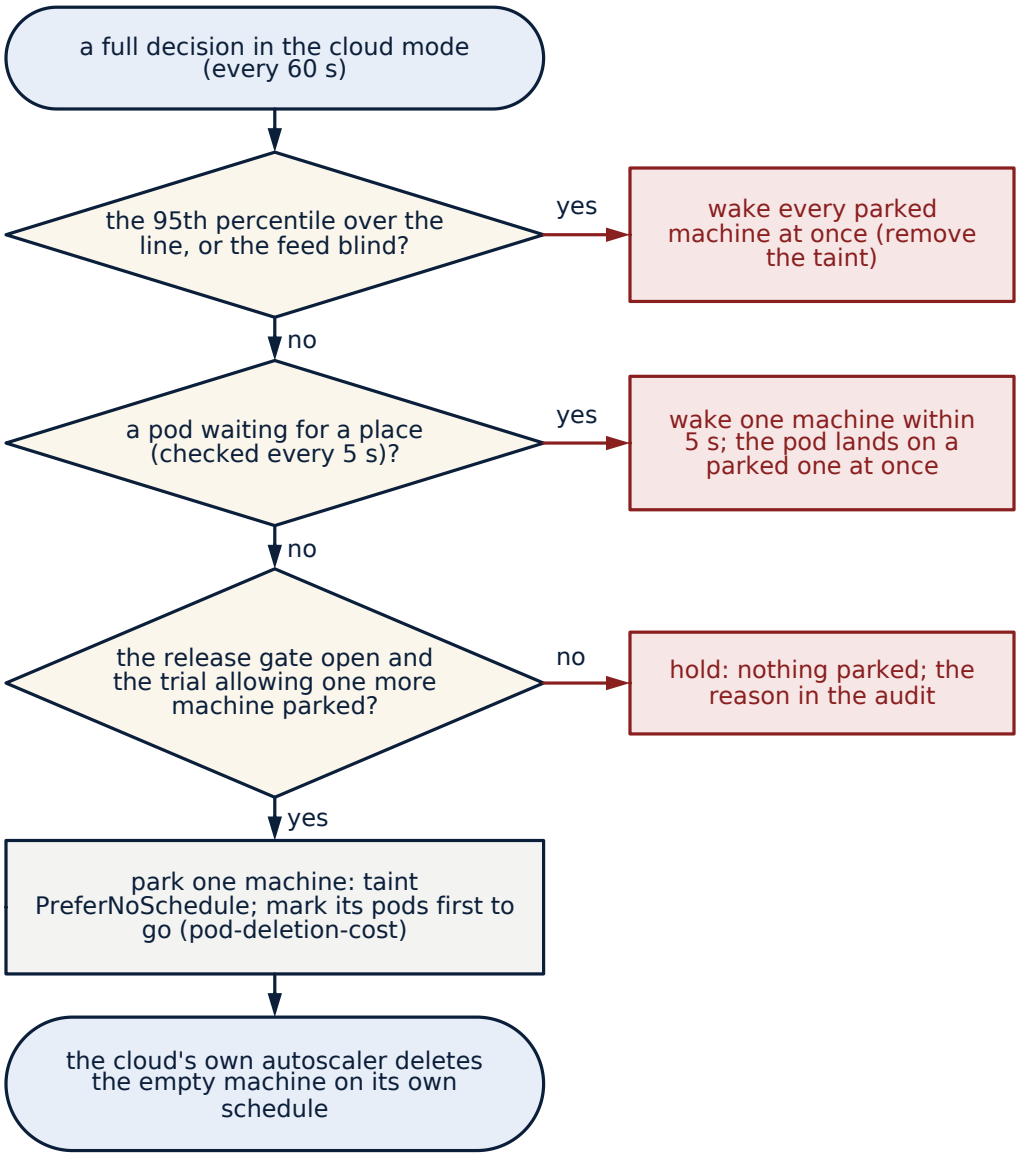



**Figure 44.** Flowchart: parking and waking a machine in the cloud. At every full decision: a 95th percentile over the line, or a blind feed, wakes every parked machine at once; a pod waiting for a place, checked every 5 s, wakes one machine within 5 s while the pod lands on a parked one at once; otherwise, only with the release gate open and the trial allowing it, one machine is parked (a PreferNoSchedule taint, its pods marked first to go), and the cloud's own autoscaler deletes it once empty, on its own schedule.

The governor never asks the cloud for a machine (its machine lever cannot ask for more machines than the cluster has), and it can hold no more pods than native's autoscaler gives it. **The bill can only fall or stay.** It falls where native holds machines the service does not need: the quiet stretches between bursts, the hours of a day's trough, the weekend. It stays where native is already short of machines; there the governor has nothing to give back, and the receipt reads EVEN on the bill.

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## 20.2 The dial in the cloud

The cloud runs at the tune-down (`--dial save`): native's work on the least resource. The max (`--dial max`) is for machines already paid for (a company's own racks, a card whose heat line is its limit), where more work from the same machines is the gain; it is never used in a cloud, and a run of the max in a cloud is never read as a bill result.

## 20.3 The settings the cloud mode writes

| Setting | Value in the cloud mode | Why |
|---|---|---|
| `--mode` | `nodepool` | the machine lever |
| `--law` | `compass` | the compass holds the response time in its band and gives machines back through the trial |
| `--dial` | `save` | the tune-down |
| `--sensed` | `none/none` | names no service, so no HPA is moved; every HPA keeps the operator's target |
| `--cap-deployments`, `--power-cmd` | absent | no processor conveyed, no power capped |
| `--latency-file`, `--slo-ms` | the feed and the line (chapter 19) | the guard on every machine parked |
| `--node-scale-cmd` | `bash /app/scripts/kind_nodepool.sh {n}` | parks and wakes machines that exist; never asks for one |
| `--node-restore-cmd` | `bash /app/scripts/kind_nodepool.sh 100000` | on a reset, wakes every parked machine (the script caps the number at the machines that exist) |
| `--active-nodes-only` | on | counts only machines in service |
| `--min-nodes` and `MIN_NODES` | 2, or the operator's floor | never fewer machines in service |
| `--max-node-step` | 1 | one machine a decision |
| `--max-nodes` | the work pools' top (the sum of their autoscaler maxima) | the most machines the lever counts on; it never asks for more than exist |
| **Setting** | **Value in the cloud mode** | **Why** |
| `--interval`, `--floor-interval` | 60 and 5 | the full decision every 60 seconds (the main engine's beat; a dial from 5 to 120 |

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| Setting | Value in the cloud mode | Why |
|---|---|---|
| | | seconds, section 4.4), the fast checks every 5 seconds |
| `--closure` | `/app/law/closure.json` | shipped in the image |
| `--audit`, `--kill-file` | `/var/log/omni/audit.jsonl`, `/tmp/omni.kill` | the record and the switch |
| `WORKER_SEL` (environment) | `omni-role=work` | which machines may be parked |

## 20.4 The cloud image and the governing Deployment

The cloud image adds five things to the shipped one: `jq` (the machine lever reads the cluster's JSON with it), the machine lever's script, the probe, the Prometheus feed adapter (section 23.8), and the switch tool that the in-pod watchdog runs (section 21.2). It is `deploy/Dockerfile.cloud`:

```
ARG BASE=omni-compass:local
FROM ${BASE}
USER root
RUN apt-get update && apt-get install -y --no-install-recommends jq &&
    ↪  rm -rf /var/lib/apt/lists/*
COPY scripts/kind_nodepool.sh /app/scripts/kind_nodepool.sh

COPY scripts/latency_probe.py /app/scripts/latency_probe.py
COPY tools/omni_switch.py /app/tools/omni_switch.py
COPY tools/prom_feed.py /app/tools/prom_feed.py
USER 10001
```

Build the shipped image first and pass it as the base (`--build-arg BASE=<registry>/omni-compass:<version>`). The governing Deployment is `deploy/install/omni-compass-cloud.yaml` (printed in Appendix I). Apply the machines role of section 15.3 (`deploy/install/rbac-machines.yaml`) first, set the image, the service's URL and the line, and replace the watch Deployment:

```
kubectl apply -f deploy/install/rbac-machines.yaml
kubectl apply -f deploy/install/omni-compass-cloud.yaml
kubectl -n omni-compass set image deployment/omni-compass controller=<
    ↪ registry>/omni-compass-cloud:<version> \
  probe=<registry>/omni-compass-cloud:<version>
kubectl -n omni-compass set env deployment/omni-compass -c probe TARGE
```

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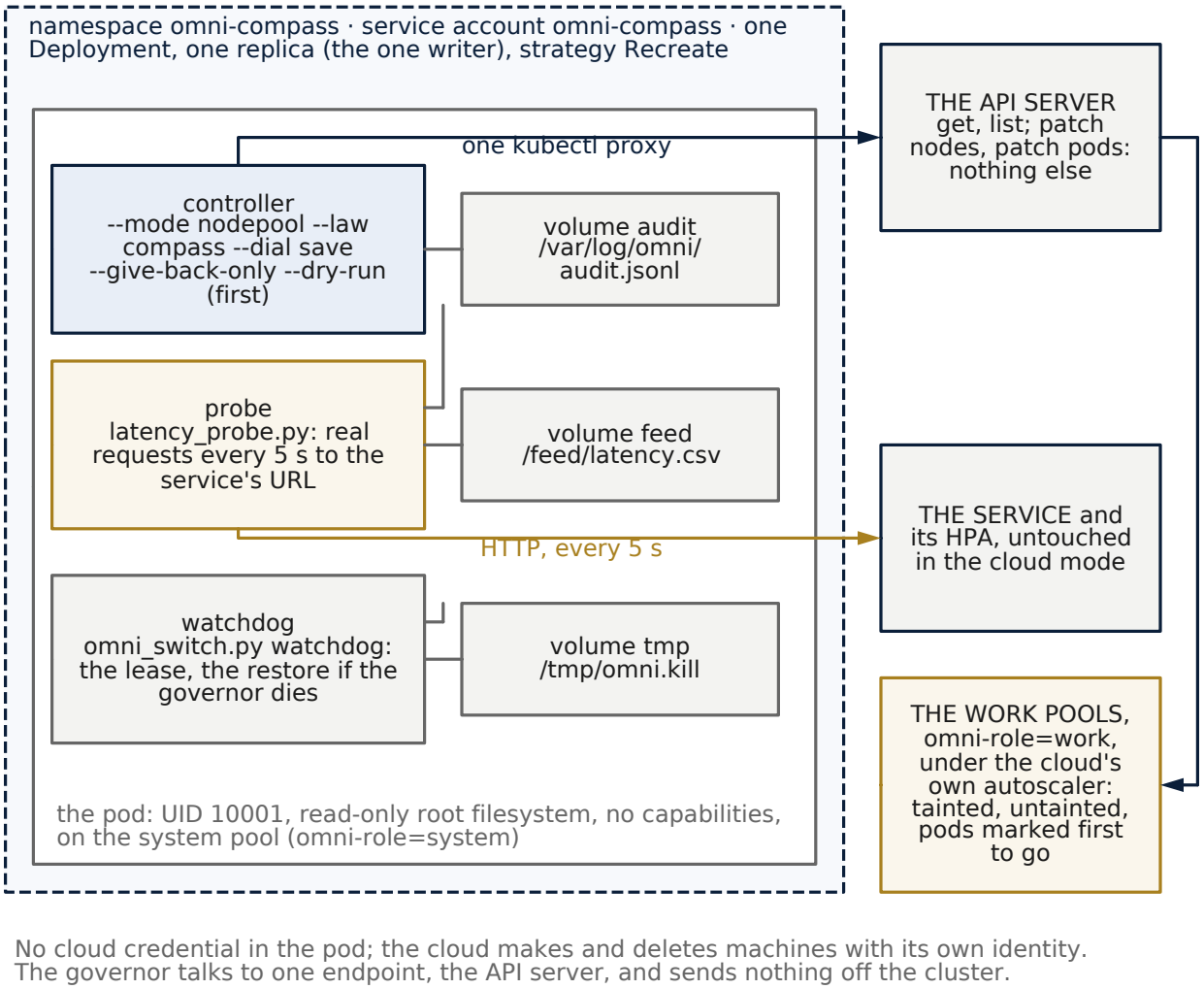



**Figure 45.** Deployment diagram: the governor on a managed cluster. One namespace, one service account, one Deployment of one replica (the one writer): the controller container with its command line, the probe beside it writing the feed to a shared volume, and the watchdog holding the lease; the audit, the feed and the kill file each on their own volume.

Outside the pod: the API server, reached through one kubectl proxy and granted get, list, patch nodes and patch pods, nothing else; the service and its autoscaler, untouched in the cloud mode; and the work pools under the cloud's own autoscaler, where machines are tainted, untainted and their pods marked first to go. No cloud credential is in the pod.

```
    ↳ T_URL=http://<service>.<namespace>.svc.cluster.local/
kubectl -n omni-compass rollout status deployment/omni-compass
```

**Dry run first.** The manifest ships with `--dry-run` on the governor's command line: it decides as it will, writes nothing, and records every command it would have run as a `write` record marked `"dry_run": true`. Read a day of its audit (section 23.7 traces one decision) before removing `--dry-run`. A dry run

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checks the commands, not their effect: because no machine is parked, a trial during a dry run compares the service with itself, and its `step allowed` is no evidence that the service holds without the machine. That evidence is the paired run's (phase 5). The first write after `--dry-run` is removed is the first machine the governor parks, in its audit with the trial that allowed it.

## 20.5 What to expect, hour by hour

| Hour of a typical day | Native | With Omni-Compass on top, machines alone |
|---|---|---|
| The peak | every machine the pods need | the same machines; nothing parked while the line is at risk |
| The descent after a peak | machines held until the autoscaler's own scale-down finds them unneeded | machines parked one at a time as each trial passes; their pods leave first on the autoscaler's next scale-down |
| The trough (night, weekend) | the pool held at what the pods' requests need | parked down to the floor where the trial allows; each empty parked machine deleted by the cloud |
| A new burst | the autoscaler adds machines when pods cannot be placed | pods that find the open machines full land on a parked machine at once (its taint only prefers against it); the governor wakes it within 5 seconds if pods wait, or at the next decision on a breach; the cloud adds machines past those, as for native |

The savings come from two places: the machines the governor parks before native's autoscaler would find them unneeded, and the empty machines the cloud deletes sooner because their pods were marked first to go. Neither changes how many pods run, and neither delays a pod: a parked machine carries a `PreferNoSchedule` taint, so a pod that finds the open machines full lands on a parked one at once.

## 20.6 Reading the bill and the alarm minutes

Every paired receipt on a cloud carries these rows, and they are read by the rules of chapter 12:

| Row | Its aim | How to read it |
|---|---|---|
| compute bill at list price ($) | lower | a cut is GAIN; EVEN where native was already short of machines; a rise is power given, and in the cloud mode it is a fault to find, because the mode cannot hold more machines than native |

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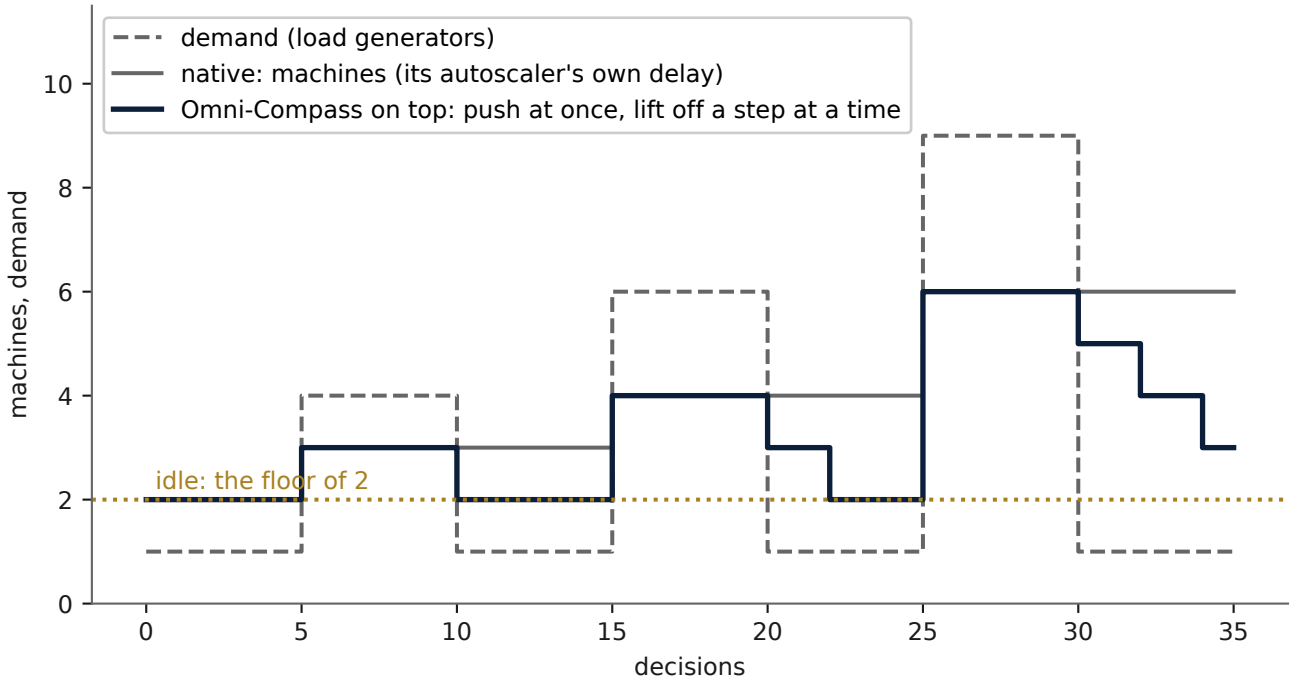



**Figure 46.** Modelled trace: one pedal over a burst, machines against demand (class S: the rules of the pedal drawn over the burst 1 4 1 6 1 9, five decisions a step). Native's autoscaler adds a machine when pods cannot be placed and removes one after its own delay; with Omni-Compass on top the push adds capacity at once at the wall and the lift off gives it back one machine at a time through the gate and the trial, never below the floor of 2.

| Row | Its aim | How to read it |
|---|---|---|
| machines billed, machine-hours | lower | as the bill |
| response time, 95th and 99th percentile | lower | must read EVEN or GAIN; a LOSS is a wiring fault to find first (section 5.5) |
| failed requests | lower | must read EVEN or GAIN |
| alert minutes | lower | the whole minutes whose 95th percentile, failed requests counted over, was over the line: the minutes an on-call page would be open. The aim in a cloud is none at all; an alert minute on the omni side is found and fixed |
| settings commands the governor wrote on its own | shown | the machines it parked and woke, each in its audit with its reason; no person touched either arm |
| HPA replicas | shown | must match native's within the noise in the cloud mode; a difference is a wiring fault (an HPA moved) |

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**A run of one day of real traffic says more than any burst.** The bill's saving lives in the quiet hours; a paired run of a steady load at the service's peak can read EVEN on the bill, honestly, because at the peak there is nothing to give back. The day-shaped load of the repository's own cloud sets (the Google 2011 trace on one to nine load generators) is the test that shows the trough.

## 20.7 What the cloud mode never does

It never raises a pod autoscaler's cap, target or range; never resizes a pod; never caps power; never asks the cloud for a machine; never deletes a machine (the cloud's autoscaler does, on its own schedule, once a machine is empty); never evicts or deletes a pod; and never holds a cloud credential. Each of those is checked from outside the governor at the end of every paired arm: every HPA back at the operator's, every pod's limit at its shipped value, every machine back in service, no `omnicompass.io/` record left on any object.

## 20.8 Any other cloud: a cluster built in the provider's own console

Oracle (OKE), DigitalOcean (DOKS), Alibaba Cloud (ACK), Linode (LKE), IBM Cloud (IKS) or any conformant managed Kubernetes run the same paired sets as Azure, Google and Amazon, on the same harness, through one workflow, `byoc-metered`. You build the cluster in the provider's console to one shape: a system pool of exactly one machine labelled `omni-role=system` and tainted `CriticalAddonsOnly=true:NoSchedule`, and a work pool labelled `omni-role=work` and `agentpool=work0` under the provider's own cluster autoscaler (minimum 1). You store a kubeconfig whose user holds a service-account token in the repository secret named for the cloud (`KUBECONFIG_ORACLE`, `KUBECONFIG_DIGITALOCEAN`, `KUBECONFIG_ALIBABA`, `KUBECONFIG_LINODE`, `KUBECONFIG_IBM` or `KUBECONFIG_OTHER`); a kubeconfig that logs in only through the provider's own command line is refused by name before anything is measured. `cloud-check` with the cloud's name reads the kubeconfig's shape and the cluster's, at no cost, and stops. Each arm starts from the work pool's own minimum; the bill is the work machines counted every 15 s times the list price you give for one machine-hour. This repository builds and deletes nothing in your account, and you delete the cluster when the set ends. Every step, click by click, is in `docs/BYOC_SETUP.md`. These clouds are wired and not yet run.

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CHAPTER 21

# Day Two: Running Omni-Compass in Production

An installation is in production when the governor writes, the service depends on the result, and nobody watches it by hand. This chapter is what keeps that state safe: the watchdog and the lease, the OFF switch drill, the audit as a record, the alarms, upgrades and rollbacks, a fleet of clusters, and the runbooks for the incidents an implementer should expect.

## 21.1 The governor's lifecycle on a cluster

| Event | What the governor does | What the implementer checks |
|---|---|---|
| Start | records every setting it may move, on the object itself (an `omnicompass.io/` annotation), before its first write; registers its lease | the first audit lines: the snapshot |
| Every decision | renews its lease, reads, decides, writes (or holds), reads back every write | the decision trail (Chapter 9) |
| Reset (planned stop) | hands every setting back in reverse order of power-up, reads each back, writes its last audit line, exits 0 | no `omnicompass.io/` annotation left; every machine in service |
| OFF switch (security) | the same hand-back at once, from a signal; no governor starts while the switch is off | `python3 tools/omni_switch.py status` |
| Death without hand-back (killed, crashed, hung) | nothing; the watchdog acts for it | the watchdog's log: `handed back` with `ok` |

## 21.2 The watchdog and the lease, in a cluster

A governor that dies without handing back leaves its settings in place: in the cloud mode, machines parked. The lease covers that case. Before its first write the governor registers the exact command that puts every setting back (`python -m omni_controller.controller --restore-only`, which restores from the annotations on the objects themselves, so it needs no memory of the dead process) and renews a lease

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every decision. The watchdog (`python3 tools/omni_switch.py watchdog`) finds a governor whose process is gone or whose lease is older than its limit (five decision periods, at least two minutes), stops a hung one, runs its recorded restore and records what it did.

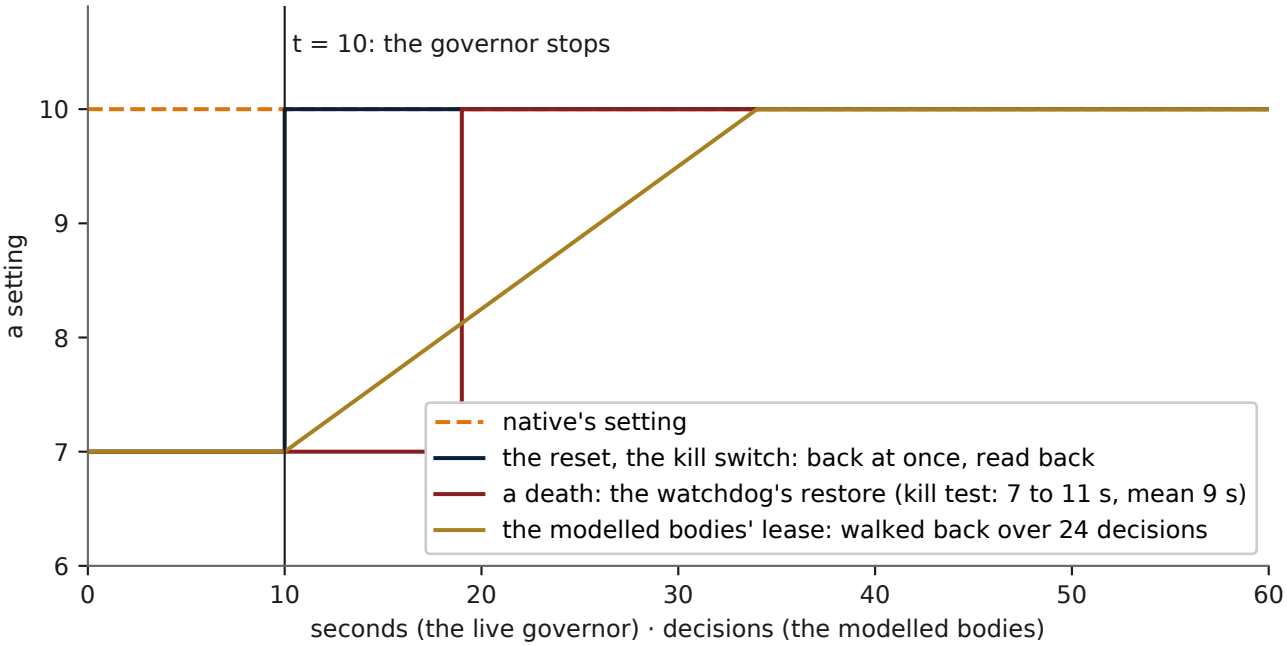



**Figure 47.** Timing diagram: the hand-back after a reset, a kill and a death. At t = 10 the governor stops. A reset or the kill switch writes every setting back at once and reads it back; a death without a hand-back is caught by the watchdog, which restored within 7 to 11 s (mean 9 s) in the kill test; in the modelled bodies the lease walks the setting back to native over 24 decisions.

In a cluster, the watchdog runs as a second container in the governor's own pod, with the pod's process namespace shared (`shareProcessNamespace: true`), as the cloud manifest ships it (Appendix I). It must: the watchdog judges a governor dead by its process, and a process is visible only inside its own process namespace, so a watchdog in a separate pod would find every governor dead and hand back over a governor that is running. In the pod, the watchdog sees the governor's process and its lease (on the pod's shared `/tmp`); when the governor's container dies or hangs, the watchdog stops a hung one and runs its recorded restore, which wakes every parked machine, and the kubelet restarts the governor's container, which begins again from the cluster as it finds it. When the whole pod is lost (its machine fails, or it is evicted), the Deployment starts a new pod; until it does, the parked machines stay parked, which never blocks a pod (a `PreferNoSchedule` taint), and the cloud's autoscaler adds machines for any pod that cannot be placed. No failure of the governor or the watchdog can leave a pod unscheduled.

## 21.3 The OFF switch drill

In a cluster the OFF switch has three forms, and the person who holds it (section 14.4) knows all three:

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| Form | Command | What happens | How long it holds |
|---|---|---|---|
| Scale to zero (the OFF switch of record) | `kubectl -n omni-compass scale deployment/omni-compass --replicas=0` | the pod receives `SIGTERM`; the governor hands every setting back at once (every parked machine woken, its marks on pods removed), reads each back, writes its last audit line and exits | until the holder scales it back to 1 |
| The kill file | `kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass -c controller -- touch /tmp/omni.kill` | at its next full decision (within 60 seconds) the governor hands every setting back, then writes nothing; each decision's audit reads `killed` | until the file is removed; the file lives in the pod's own `/tmp`, so a replaced pod starts ON |
| Revoke the grant | `kubectl delete clusterrolebinding omni-compass-machines` | every write the governor attempts is refused by the API server and recorded | until the binding is applied again |

Revoke the grant only after one of the first two forms has handed everything back: a governor without its grant cannot wake a machine it parked. (A parked machine never blocks a pod, so even then nothing waits; but its taint stays until the grant returns or a person removes it.)

The OFF switch is drilled before production and every quarter after, by its holder, on the production cluster, in a quiet hour:

1. Note the time and the machines parked: `kubectl get nodes -l omni-role=work -o custom-columns=NAME:.metadata.name,TAINTS:.spec.taints[*].key`.
2. Scale to zero.
3. Time it: no `omnicompass.io/idle` taint left on any machine, no `controller.kubernetes.io/pod-deletion-cost` mark left on any pod of the governed pools (unless another controller of the company's own sets that mark), the governor's pod gone. The limit is 60 seconds.
4. Scale back to 1 (`--replicas=1`) and record the drill: the date, the holder, the seconds, anything left behind.

A drill that leaves anything behind, or takes more than 60 seconds, stops the installation until the cause is found.

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## 21.4 The audit as a record

The audit (`audit.jsonl`, one JSON record a line, each timestamped) is the governor's complete account of itself: every reading, decision, write, read-back and reason. In production it is kept like any other operational record:

- **Storage.** Mount a persistent volume at `/var/log/omni` (Azure `managed-csi`, Google `standard-rwo`, Amazon `gp3` through the EBS CSI driver). An `emptyDir` loses the audit with the pod.
- **Shipping.** A log collector on the node reads the file and ships it to the company's log store; every line is already JSON. Keep the audit at least as long as the change record the company keeps for any production change.
- **Size.** One decision a minute writes a few records; a month is tens of megabytes. Rotate by size or day.
- **What to search for.** `"write"` (every change), `"refused"` (a write the cluster refused), `"error"` (a failed read or decision), `"proprioception"` in the `authority` record written with each decision (the drift between what the governor last commanded and what the cluster shows: a drift that does not close means a command did not land or another writer moved the setting), `"verdict"` (each give-back trial and its outcome), `"blind"` (a sense lost).

## 21.5 Alarms an implementer wires

| Alarm | Source | Why |
|---|---|---|
| Alert minutes on the service | the company's own monitoring of the line | the line is the service's; an alert minute is a person woken, whether or not Omni-Compass is installed |
| The governor's pod not running, or restarting | the cluster's own pod status | the watchdog hands back; someone must know why |
| The probe container restarted | the cluster's own pod status | no machine is given back until the governor's pod restarts (section 19.3) |
| `"error"` records in the audit, more than a few in an hour | the log store | the API is unreachable or a grant is missing; the governor holds |
| A `proprioception` drift that does not close over several decisions | the log store | a command did not land, or another controller or a person moves the same setting; find it (the one-writer rule) |
| A machine parked longer than a day with pods on it | `kubectl get nodes` and the taints | expected only in a long quiet stretch; worth a look otherwise |

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## 21.6 Upgrades and rollbacks

An upgrade is a new image of the governor at a new engine version (chapter 13):

1. Verify the new copy (chapter 33) and read what changed in its version notes.
2. Run the new version in watch mode beside nothing: replace the Deployment with the new image and `--mode observe` for at least a day; read its decisions against the old version's.
3. Run a paired check on the new version where the receipts matter (chapter 11): receipts are never read across versions.
4. Switch it to govern. The old image stays in the registry, tagged, for the rollback.

A rollback is the same in reverse, and safe at any moment: stop the governor (its reset hands every setting back, or the watchdog does), set the old image, start it. The governor carries no state between processes except the annotations it reads back at start, so an old version starting after a new one begins from the cluster as it finds it.

## 21.7 A fleet of clusters

One governor per cluster, never one governor for several clusters: each cluster has its own autoscaler, its own machines and its own line. A fleet is rolled out cluster by cluster, each through the phases of section 14.3, with a paired receipt on at least one cluster of each kind (each provider, each machine family, each service class) before the rest of that kind go to govern. The governor's settings are the same text in every cluster of a kind; keep them in the company's configuration repository and deploy them like any other workload, and keep one audit store for the fleet.

## 21.8 Runbooks

**A breach while machines are parked.** Expected and handled: a breach wakes a parked machine at the next full decision (within 60 seconds), and a pod that cannot be placed wakes one at the next fast check (within 5 seconds). If alert minutes persist with machines parked, turn the governor OFF (section 21.3), which wakes every machine, and read the audit for the decision that parked the last one: its trial, its readings and the feed's age.

**The governor parks nothing for days.** In the cloud mode at a steady peak that is the right answer: there is nothing to give back. Otherwise read `"verdict"` records: trials abandoned for too little work mean the feed is too thin (section 18.3); trials refused mean the service is slower without the machine, and the governor is right to keep it.

**The cloud's bill did not fall.** Read the receipt's machine-hours beside the autoscaler's own profile: a long `scale-down-unneeded-time` keeps a parked, empty machine billing; a PodDisruptionBudget or a pod with local storage can keep the autoscaler from removing one. Both hold native too, and both are the operator's settings.

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**Someone else moves a setting.** The `proprioception` drift in each decision's `authority` record does not close: the machines in service are not the machines the governor commanded. Find the other writer (a GitOps controller resetting node taints, a second autoscaler or descheduler, a person running `kubectl uncordon`); there must be one writer for each setting, and until there is, turn the governor OFF.

CHAPTER 22

# The Graphics Processor: Putting the Governor on a Card

A graphics processor (a GPU card) is the other end of the cloud from the bill: the card is paid for by the hour or owned outright, and the benefit there is **more work inside the card at native's own heat, never hotter**. This chapter is written for the implementer who will put the governor on one card or on every card of a server, rented or owned. It is complete and ready to run; it is not run until the processor side is finished, and the first run is given one exact commit.

## 22.1 What the governor moves on a card

Two wires, both the card's own settings, both written through the vendor's own management interface (`nvidia-smi`, the NVIDIA System Management Interface) and read back after every write:

| Wire | What it is | Its range |
|---|---|---|
| The clock ceiling (up wire) | the highest graphics clock the card may run (locked clocks) | the card's own supported clocks, read from the card |
| The power limit (down wire) | the card's own power cap, in watts | the card's own minimum and default limits, read from the card |

It moves nothing else: not the application, not the model, not the batch, not the card's fan curve, not its memory clock, not its persistence mode, not another process's settings. Native is the card as it ships: the vendor's own firmware and driver deciding its clock under the default power limit.

## 22.2 What the card needs

- **Bare metal or full passthrough.** A virtual machine that hides clock locking or the power limit from the guest cannot be governed; the wire check (section 22.4) fails on it and says which wire.
- **The vendor's driver**, recent enough to support locked clocks and power limits on the card; `nvidia-smi -q -d CLOCK,POWER` lists the supported clocks and the power-limit range.

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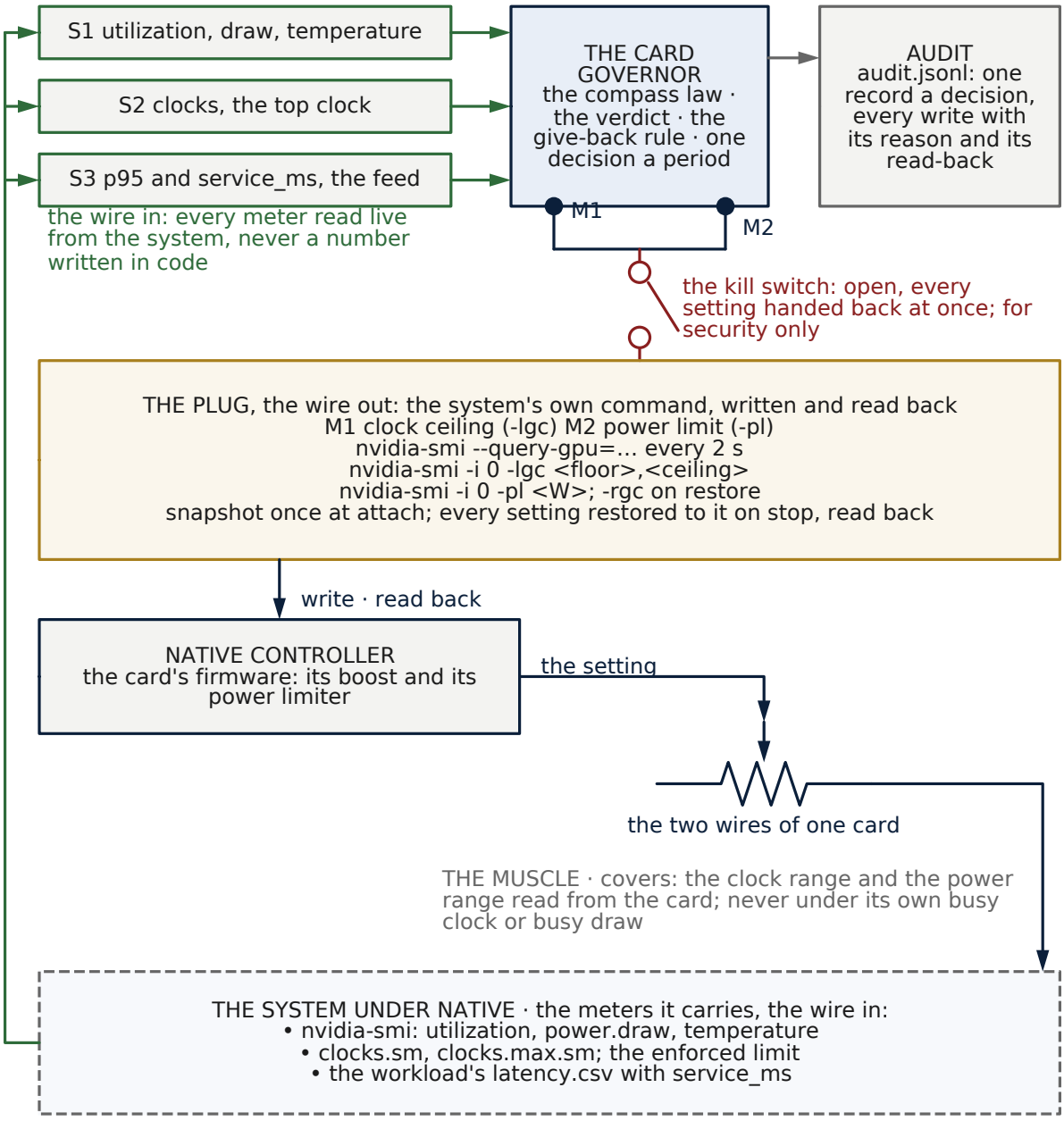



**Figure 48.** Wiring schematic: a graphics card, two wires. The schematic is read top to bottom as an electrical drawing: the governor (the control unit) with its sense terminals S1, S2, … on the left and its motor terminals M1, M2, … on its lower edge; the motor bus through the kill switch into the plug, the system's own command written and read back; the plug into the native controller; the native controller setting the muscle, drawn as a potentiometer with its cover; the system under native carrying the meters; and the meters back along one bus, the wire in, to the sense terminals.

The audit stands beside the governor. The senses are the card's utilization, draw and temperature, its clocks and top clock, and the workload's feed; the two motors are the clock ceiling (-lgc) and the power limit (-pl), both through nvidia-smi and both read back. Learns the card on its own first (15 busy readings); races while

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work waits (≥ 95% utilization); at the max never below the top while the card serves; at the tune-down paces the slack in 15 MHz steps, each step through the paired trial.

- **Root**, for the governor's writes; the governor is the only process allowed to set the card's clocks and limit while it runs, and the machine check refuses to start if another management agent holds them.
- **A response-time feed** for the work on the card (chapter 19): the serving engine's own per-request timings, or the probe against the serving endpoint.
- **The heat sensor** the card reports (`nvidia-smi --query-gpu=temperature.gpu,clocks_throttle_reasons.active`), read by the governor every decision; a thermal slowdown reported by the card holds every tightening (Chapter 9, `thermal_hold`).

## 22.3 Rented or owned

| | A rented card (for example a Lambda Cloud instance) | An owned card |
|---|---|---|
| Who pays for idle | the renter, by the hour | the owner, in power and heat |
| The gain | more work in the hours rented: fewer card-hours for the same work | more work from the same card at native's heat, and the same work at less power where the card is not the bottleneck |
| The meter | the card's own power reading (`power.draw`), class P | the card's own reading and, where fitted, a wall meter on the server (`tools/wall_meter.py`), class P |
| Access | root on the instance; full passthrough is standard on bare-metal rentals | root on the host |

## 22.4 The order on a card, step by step

1. **Verify the copy** (chapter 33) and record the commit; a card run is given one exact commit and run on it alone.
2. **The machine check.** One copy of the harness only, nothing else on the card, the card's default limit and full clock range restored. The harness's own scripts do this and refuse to start otherwise.
3. **Declare the envelope** once, before any trial: `python3 tools/declare_envelope.py envelope.json --gpu 0` writes the power range the governor may set, read from the card itself: from the larger of the card's own minimum and 70% of the limit read at declaration, up to that limit. The file is kept with the run.

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4. **The wire check:** `sudo python3 tools/gpu_wire_check.py --gpu 0` must end `WIRED RIGHT`. It moves each wire and reads the card back, proving the up wire raises and lowers the clock and the down wire moves the power. Its failures are listed in Appendix D with their fixes.
5. **Watch:** `sudo python3 -m omni_controller.gpu_compass --mode watch --gpus 0 --latency-file <feed> --slo-ms <line>` computes both wires every decision and writes neither.
6. **The paired run** on the card: native against native with Omni-Compass on top, the same work, repeated, the card's own power reading and the response times counted in both arms (the harness's `scripts/gpu_paired.sh` on an owned card, `scripts/gpu_rented_run.sh` for the whole rented sequence in one command, `scripts/gpu_8card.sh` for every card of an eight-card server at once).
7. **Govern:** `--mode cap` in place of `--mode watch`, with the OFF switch drilled (section 22.6).

## 22.5 The heat line

The aim on a card is more work at native's own heat. The governor reads the card's temperature and its own reported slowdown every decision and never tightens while the card reports a thermal slowdown; the card's own firmware protects the silicon underneath whatever the governor writes. Each receipt on a card reports the card's temperature in both arms beside the work and the power, so an implementer sees directly whether the omni arm ran hotter than native. A receipt in which it did is read as a wiring fault first: the clock ceiling raised where the card's cooling could not carry it.

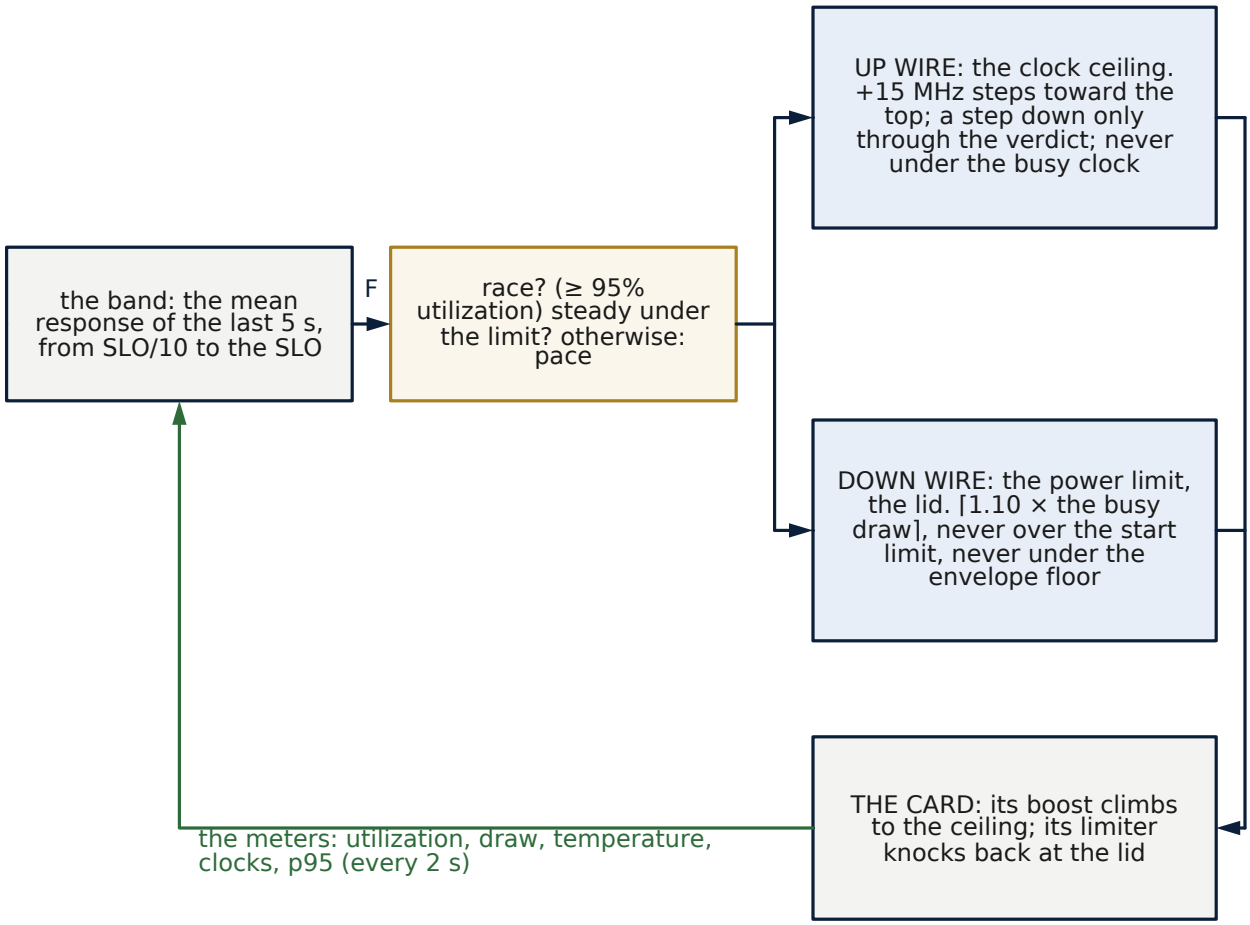
## 22.6 OFF on a card

`sudo touch /tmp/omni-gpu-kill` (one card's governor), `SIGTERM` to the governor, or the master switch (`sudo python3 tools/omni_switch.py off`, every governor on the machine) each restore the card at once: clocks reset to the card's own range (`nvidia-smi -rgc`), the power limit back to the value read at start, both read back. A restore that does not read back exits with code 3 and must be completed by hand before anything runs again (Appendix D). The fault drill of the rented sequence kills the governor outright mid-run and times the watchdog's hand-back; an implementer repeats it on every new card model.

## 22.7 Cards inside Kubernetes

Where the cards are nodes of a Kubernetes cluster (the vendor's device plugin exposing `nvidia.com/gpu`), the card governor runs as a privileged agent on each GPU node (it writes the card's own settings, which needs the host's management interface), one per node, with its feed taken from the serving pods on that node. It never schedules or moves a pod; the cluster's own scheduler and autoscaler place the work, and the cloud mode of chapter 20 governs the machines, if the cards are in a cloud. The two governors are different writers of different settings and never touch the same one.

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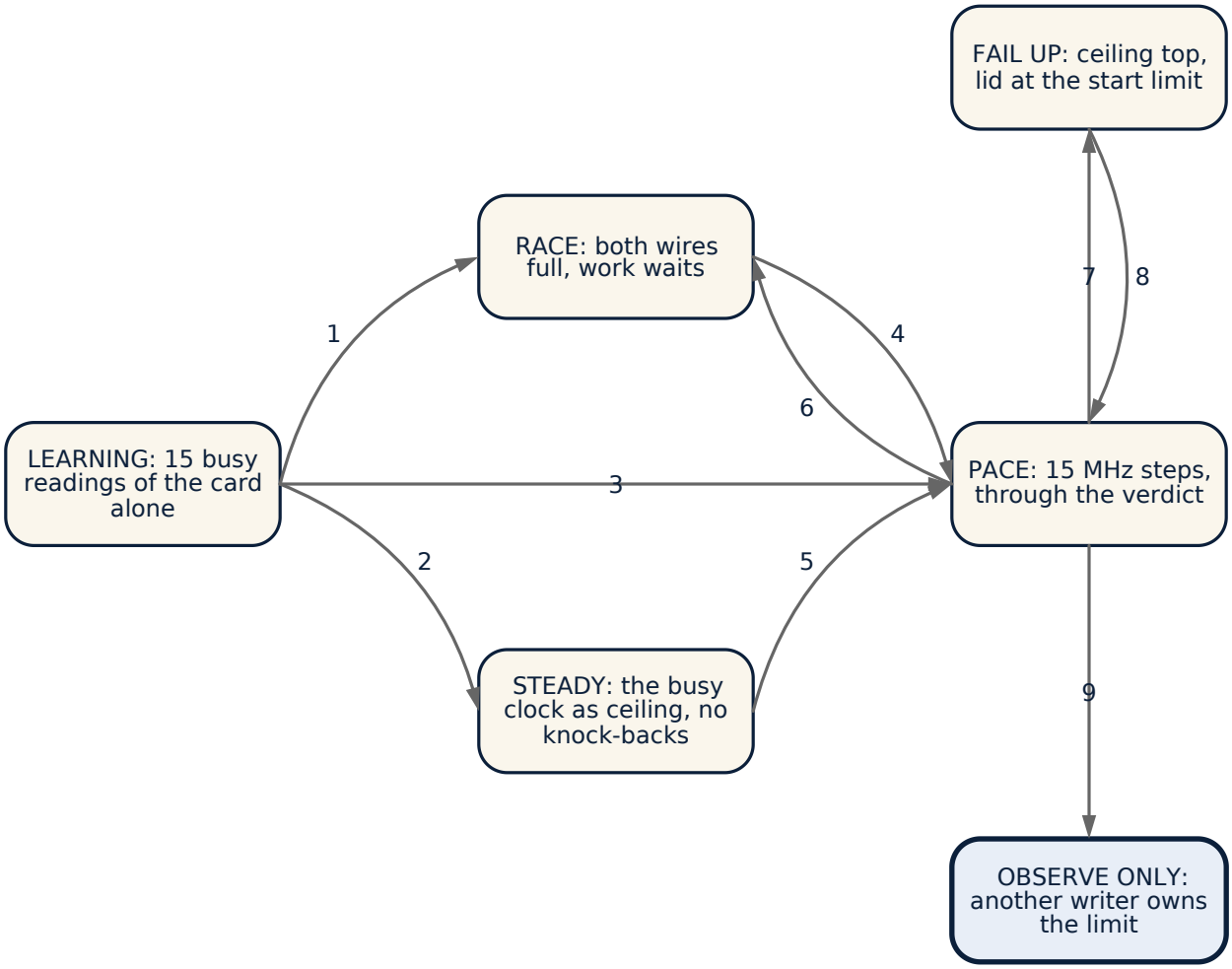



Race: both wires to full at once while work waits. Steady under the limit: the card's own busy clock as the ceiling, no knock-backs. Fail up on a breach, a failed request, a blind feed or a heat slowdown. A limit set by another hand: observe only from then on.

**Figure 49.** Block diagram: the two wires of a card as an antagonist pair. The band (the mean response of the last 5 s, from a tenth of the line to the line) yields the force F; the mode decides between racing (both wires to full while work waits, utilization ≥ 95%), steady under the limit (the card's own busy clock as the ceiling) and pacing.

The up wire is the clock ceiling, raised in 15 MHz steps toward the top and lowered only through the verdict; the down wire is the power limit, the lid at ⌈1.10 × the busy draw⌉, never over the start limit and never under the envelope floor. The card's own boost climbs to the ceiling and its own limiter knocks back at the lid; the meters close the loop every 2 s.

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1 learned; utilization ≥ 95% · 2 learned; saturated at an operator's cap (draw ≥ 97% of it) · 3 learned; slack · 4 slack (the tune-down) · 5 off the cap: slack · 6 work waits again · 7 from any state: p95 at the line, a failed request, a blind feed, a heat slowdown · 8 clear for --slo-clear · 9 from any state: a limit not written by the governor

**Figure 50.** State machine: the two-wire card governor. It learns the card on its own first (15 busy readings), then races while work waits (utilization at 95% or more), holds steady at the card's own busy clock while saturated under an operator's cap, or paces the slack in 15 MHz steps through the verdict; from any state it fails up on a breach, a failed request, a blind feed or a heat slowdown, and it observes only, for the rest of the run, once a limit is found that it did not write.

CHAPTER 23

# Observability: Feeding the Governor from Your Monitoring, and Watching It

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A company that runs a cloud cluster already measures it: an ingress or a service mesh times every request, a metrics system (Prometheus, Azure Monitor, Google Cloud Monitoring, Amazon CloudWatch, Datadog) stores the series, and a log store keeps the clusters' logs. This chapter connects the governor to that apparatus in both directions: the company's own response times as the governor's feed (section 19.4), and the governor's own audit as series and alarms the company's engineers already read.

## 23.1 The feed from the company's own response times

The governor's feed is a file of rows `elapsed_seconds,latency_ms,ok` (section 19.2). An adapter that writes it from the company's own measurements has four duties: read the measurements at the point where the line is written; write rows whose own distribution is the served requests' distribution; keep the feed as dense as the probe's (the probe writes five rows every five seconds; a feed thinner than twenty rows a minute leaves the governor's give-back trials short of samples, and the audit shows them as `trial abandoned (too little work)`, section 21.8); and never smooth. A metrics system stores counters and histograms, not single requests, so the adapter works in windows. For each window of length Δ ending at time t:

1. Read the count of requests served in the window, n[ok], and the count failed, n[fail], from the request counter's increase over exactly that window (not a rate over a longer one).
2. If n[ok] > 0, read the served requests' quantiles q[0.05], q[0.15], …, q[0.95] (the midpoints of ten equal shares of the requests) from the response-time histogram's bucket increases over the same window, and write one row with `ok` = 1 for each. Each row then stands for a tenth of the window's served requests, so the rows' own mean and percentiles are the window's, to the precision of the histogram's buckets.
3. Write one row with `ok` = 0 for each failure, up to a cap (twenty a window is enough for the governor to see a failing service; the receipt counts failures from its own probe or the service's own logs, not from the adapter).

Δ must be at least twice the metrics system's scrape interval, or the counter's increase over it is undefined (two samples are needed); with a 15-second scrape, a 30-second window read every 15 seconds gives forty rows a minute.

With Prometheus and the NGINX ingress controller, for example, n[ok] and n[fail] are the increases of `nginx_ingress_controller_requests` (status below 500, and 500 and above) for the service's ingress over the window, and the quantile q is `histogram_quantile(q, sum by (le) (increase(nginx_ingress_controller_request_duration_seconds_bucket[30s])))`. A histogram's buckets bound the precision of every quantile: a service whose line is 500 ms needs buckets around 250, 400, 500 and 750 ms, or the quantiles jump between bucket edges and the governor reads steps that are not there. A service mesh (Istio, Linkerd) exports the same two series under its own names; the application's own histogram is the closest measurement of all when the line is written at the application. Section 23.8 gives an adapter that does all of this.

**What the adapter must not do.** It must not average across windows, carry a value forward when a window is empty (an empty window is no row; a feed with no new row for twice the governor's window reads as blind,

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which is the correct reading of a service that answered nothing), or rewrite the file from the start (the governor reads rows newer than the last it read, by the feed's own clock; a restarted adapter continues the clock where it stopped, or the governor's pod is restarted with it, section 19.3).

## 23.2 The governor's own series

The audit is JSON, one record a line (section 21.4). A log store that parses JSON (Loki, Elasticsearch or OpenSearch, Azure Log Analytics, Google Cloud Logging, CloudWatch Logs, Datadog Logs) turns it into series without any code in the governor:

| Series | From the audit | What it shows |
|---|---|---|
| machines in service, machines seen | each `decision`: `nodes_observed`, `nodes_recommended` | the governor's view of the pool, decision by decision |
| machines parked and woken | each `write` whose `why` is `node pool size` (a decision) or `scheduling floor (pending pods)` (a fast check) | every move of the machine lever |
| trials and their outcomes | each `verdict`: `trial`, `step allowed`, `step refused`, `trial abandoned` | the give-back trials; abandoned trials point to a thin feed |
| the response time the governor read | each `decision`: `latency_p95_ms` | the governor's own reading, beside the company's own |
| senses | the `senses` of the `authority` record written with each decision: `blind`, `latency_age_s` | a feed lost, or late |
| proprioception | the `proprioception` of the same `authority` record | a command that did not land, or another writer |
| decision time | each `decision_ms` | the governor keeping its period |
| own cost | the last `overhead` record | the governor's processor over its life |

Without a log store, `tools/omni_exporter.py` serves the same series to Prometheus. It follows the audit file the governor writes, answers `GET /metrics` on one port (9464 unless `--port` says otherwise, bound to 127.0.0.1 unless `--bind` says otherwise) and writes nothing anywhere: it has no button, so a monitoring system that scrapes it can see everything and change nothing. Run it beside the governor, pointed at the same audit:

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```
python3 tools/omni_exporter.py serve --audit /var/log/omni/audit.jsonl
    ↪  --port 9464 --bind 0.0.0.0
python3 tools/omni_exporter.py once --audit audit.jsonl      # a finis
    ↪ hed run's audit, read once
```

| Gauge | What it shows |
|---|---|
| `omni_last_decision_timestamp_seconds` | the heartbeat: alert when `time()` less it passes three beats |
| `omni_heartbeat_seconds` | the beat the governor runs at, as measured: the median spacing of its last eleven decisions |
| `omni_master_switch` | 1 while governing, 0 once the kill switch has handed every setting back |
| `omni_verdict_state{state}` | where the trial of a step stands: left native, trial, kept, given back |
| `omni_sense_blind{sense}` | 1 while a feed is blind; the governor then holds |
| `omni_decisions_total`, `omni_decision_seconds_sum`, `_count`, `_last` | its pace, and the time each decision took |
| `omni_writes_total{why}` | every settings command it wrote on its own, by the head of its reason |
| `omni_recommended{setting}`, `omni_recommended_moves_total`, `omni_recommended_reversals_total` | what its last decision recommends, how often that moved and how often it turned back; a recommendation is not a write |
| `omni_nodes_observed` | the machines it saw in service |
| `omni_own_cpu_cores` | its own processor, from its last overhead record |
| `omni_compass_decisions_total{zone}` | decisions by where the service stood against its line: `slack` (under the lower cushion), `band`, `wall` (at or past the line); the share in `band` is the time-in-band figure |
| `omni_wall_recovery_seconds_sum`, `_count`, `omni_wall_recovery_seconds_max` | from the first decision at the line to the first back inside the band: the settling time after each excursion |
| `omni_recommended_travel_total{setting}` | the summed size of every change of each recommendation (actuator travel) |

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| Gauge | What it shows |
|---|---|
| `omni_errors_total{kind}` | the errors the governor recorded, by the head of the error (a refused write, an unreadable sense) |

The zone, recovery and travel gauges describe the governor's own steering and are not judged: native has no governor to read them from. The judged comparison of time over the line is the paired receipt's alert-minutes row (section 20.6). A test whose load holds the service near its line in both arms shows a large `wall` share in the governor's gauges while its alert minutes, the comparison with native, read GAIN.

`deploy/grafana/omni-compass.json` is a ready Grafana screen of these gauges: import it and choose the Prometheus data source. Its top row is the heartbeat, the switch, the verdict and the blind senses; below them the decisions, the writes by reason, the recommendations and their reversals, the machines and the governor's own processor, and at the foot the zones, the recovery time, the errors and the travel. Its links include the control panel's console (section 23.5).

## 23.3 A dashboard an on-call engineer can read in ten seconds

Four panels, on the service's own dashboard, beside the service's own response time:

1. **The line and the response time.** The service's 95th percentile against its line, from the company's own measurement, with the governor's own reading (`latency_p95_ms`) as a second line. The two should agree; where they do not, the feed is measuring something else (section 19.4).
2. **Machines.** Machines in the pool (from the cluster), machines in service and machines parked (from the audit). A parked machine is never a problem in itself; a parked machine during a breach is impossible by design and is a fault to report.
3. **Trials.** Allowed, refused and abandoned trials an hour. Many abandoned trials: the feed is too thin. Many refused: the service is slower without the machine, and the governor is right to keep it.
4. **Health.** Blind decisions, errors, decision time and the governor's own processor.

## 23.4 Alarms, routed where the company's alarms already go

The alarms of section 21.5 are written once in the company's alerting system (Prometheus Alertmanager, Azure Monitor alerts, Google Cloud alerting policies, CloudWatch alarms, Datadog monitors) against the series above, and routed to the same on-call rotation as the service. For Prometheus they are written already: `deploy/prometheus/omni-compass-rules.yaml` (load it with `rule_files:`, or wrap its `groups:` in a PrometheusRule for the Prometheus Operator) carries ten rules, each with its severity, its meaning and the action to take: the governor stale (no decision for three intervals while governing; critical), a governor orphaned (died or hung without handing back; critical), writes hammering (more than 300 settings commands an hour), write errors, a recommendation oscillating (more than 20 reversals an hour), a sense blind for five minutes, the service at its line in more than 10% of decisions, the master switch off (information), the audit unreadable, and the governor's own processor above half a core. The staleness bound is three of the

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governor's own beats as the exporter measures them (180 s at the main engine's 60 s, 45 s at 15 s, 360 s at 120 s), so it needs no edit when the dial is turned; the other rules count in minutes and hours, not in decisions. The alert that matters most is not the governor's: it is the service's own line. An installation in the cloud mode is judged first by whether that alert fires more often with the governor than without it, and the paired receipt's alert-minutes row (section 20.6) is the same measure taken under control.

**The whole wall in one command** (`docs/MISSION_CONTROL.md`). `deploy/monitoring/` stands up Prometheus, Grafana, Node Exporter, Alertmanager, the governor's exporter and the alert bridge with `docker compose up -d`, every image pinned and no password written, both Omni-Compass boards loaded at start. The monitor wall carries knobs (route, provider, machine, rate window, the control panel's address), the signals' row (redlining, steady, accelerating, each at its alarm's own threshold) and the control panel's buttons as a link. Its alarms press the panel's operator buttons through the alert bridge (`tools/omni_alert_bridge.py`): Return to native when the governor goes stale, watch when its writes hammer or are refused. The bridge writes what it would press until it is told to press, and never touches the kill switch or its arming. List your machines and clouds in `deploy/monitoring/targets/`, each with its route and provider.

## 23.5 The control panel: the buttons, behind sign-in, every press logged

`tools/omni_control.py` runs the governor as its child and serves its buttons over an authenticated HTTP API, with a console page for a browser. It writes no setting itself. The governor takes its mode and its dial when it starts, and when its own kill file appears it hands every setting it wrote back to the snapshot it took at its start, reads each one back and exits. So every press that changes the mode or the dial is carried out in four steps: the kill file is set, the governor's exit is awaited, the file is removed, and the governor is started again with the new arguments. Every change passes through native, and nothing is changed under a running governor.

```
python3 tools/omni_control.py token --name alice --roles operator --to
    ↪ kens /etc/omni/tokens.json     # printed once
python3 tools/omni_control.py token --name sam --roles security --toke
    ↪ ns /etc/omni/tokens.json
python3 tools/omni_control.py serve --tokens /etc/omni/tokens.json --a
    ↪ udit /var/log/omni/audit.jsonl \

    --log /var/log/omni/control.jsonl --state /var/lib/omni/control.js
    ↪ on \
    --governor "python3 -m omni_controller.controller --mode nodepool
    ↪ --audit /var/log/omni/audit.jsonl --interval 60"
```

To drive the governor from the live engine page served at another address, name that address when the panel is started: `--allow-origin https://the-page-host` (repeat it for more, or `OMNI_CONTROL_ALLOW_ORIGIN` as a comma list). Only a named origin is answered across addresses (its

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browser's preflight and its calls); every call still carries its bearer token and its role, and a bind beyond the loopback still needs `--cert` and `--key`. None is named by default.

| Button | Request | Role | What happens |
|---|---|---|---|
| Autopilot | `POST /v1/mode {"mode": "autopilot"}` | operator | the governor runs and writes |
| Watch | `POST /v1/mode {"mode": "watch"}` | operator | the governor runs, decides and audits every decision, and writes nothing (its `--dry-run`) |
| Off | `POST /v1/mode {"mode": "off"}` | operator | every setting handed back; the governor stops |
| Max, tune-down | `POST /v1/dial {"dial": "max" or "save"}` | operator | the governor handed back and started again on the new dial |
| One muscle on, or left native | `POST /v1/muscle {"muscle": NAME, "on": true or false}` | operator | the governor handed back and started again with `--native` naming every muscle left native; a muscle left native is never written (omni-v14; the names are `machines`, `replicas`, `cpu`, `clock`, `gpu`, `rollout`, `batch`, `rightsize`, `coldstart`, `contain`, `cooling`) |
| Heartbeat | `POST /v1/beat {"seconds": 5 to 120}` | operator | the governor handed back and started again with `--interval` set to the beat: its full decision every so many seconds (the main engine 60; the console's buttons 5, 15, 30, 60, 75, 90 and 120), the fast checks every 5 s at every beat (omni-v17) |
| Reset | `POST /v1/reset {"reason": ...}` | operator | every setting handed back to native; mode off until the next press |
| Kill switch | `POST /v1/kill {"reason": ...}` | security | the master switch OFF for every Omni-Compass governor on the machine; each restores and exits; none starts while it is OFF |
| Arm | `POST /v1/arm {"reason": ...}` | security | the master switch ON again once two different holders of the security role press it within ten minutes |

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The reads need the viewer role, which every token holds: `GET /v1/status` (the switch and its reason, the mode and dial the panel holds, the governor's process and its exit code, the registry with each lease's age, the governors orphaned, the age of the last decision), `GET /v1/presses` (the last presses, refused ones included) and `GET /metrics` (the panel's counters: presses by button and outcome, the mode, whether the governor is up, the master switch, the orphans). `GET /` is the console and `GET /v1/openapi.json` the OpenAPI 3 document; neither carries data, and every call the console makes carries the token typed into it. Reset, kill and arm need a reason, and every press, refused or done, is one JSON line in the control log: the time, the holder, the button, the reason, the outcome.

Security: the panel binds to 127.0.0.1 unless `--bind` says otherwise, and refuses a bind beyond the loopback without `--cert` and `--key` (HTTPS, TLS 1.2 or later). Tokens are stored as SHA-256 digests only, in a file only its owner can read; a request without a valid token is answered 401, one whose holder lacks the role 403. A governor that exits on its own is not restarted by the panel: its lease hands back what it wrote (`tools/omni_switch.py watchdog`), and a new start would take a new snapshot over settings not yet handed back; the status shows it as exited and the next press starts it. The kill switch stays on the command line and as a file as well (chapter 9), so the panel being down never stops anyone from switching Omni-Compass off.

## 23.6 The bill, from the provider's own records

The receipt's bill is the machines the cluster held, counted every 15 seconds, at list price (chapter 12). In service, the company reads the same thing from the provider's own billing records, and should, because list price is not what every company pays:

| Provider | Where the machine cost lives | How to separate the governed pools |
|---|---|---|
| Azure | Cost Management (cost analysis), or the cost export to a storage account | the node resource group of the cluster, and a tag on each work pool (`az aks nodepool update --tags`) |
| Google Cloud | the Cloud Billing export to BigQuery (detailed usage cost) | GKE cost allocation, enabled on the cluster, by namespace and node pool label |
| Amazon | the Cost and Usage Report, or Cost Explorer | a cost allocation tag on each node group's instances, activated in the Billing console |

The comparison that means something is the same service, the same weeks of the year, before and after the governor went into service, in machine-hours of the governed pools, with the load (requests served) beside it; a bill that fell because traffic fell is not the governor's saving, and the paired receipt, run on the same day for both arms, exists to remove exactly that doubt.

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## 23.7 Tracing a single decision end to end

An auditor's or an engineer's question about one moment ("why was this machine parked at 03:12?") is answered from the audit alone, in this order: the `verdict` record that allowed the step (the trial's response times with and without the machine); the `authority` and `decision` records of that minute (the senses, the release gate's reason, the machines seen and recommended); the `write` record (the command, its reason, whether it was a dry run); and the next decision's `authority` record, whose `proprioception` shows whether the command landed. If any of the four is missing, the governor did not park the machine, and the cause is elsewhere (the cluster autoscaler's own scale-down, a person, another controller).

## 23.8 A complete adapter: Prometheus to the feed

The repository's `tools/prom_feed.py` is the adapter of section 23.1 for any metrics system that answers Prometheus's HTTP query API (Prometheus itself, Thanos, Cortex, Grafana Mimir, and the managed services of the three clouds that expose that API). It reads three queries the implementer writes for the service, every `--interval` seconds over the last `--window`, and appends the rows of section 23.1 to the feed. It continues the feed's clock across its own restarts and never truncates the file; it writes nothing for an empty window or when the metrics system does not answer, so the governor reads a silent adapter as blind. It is in the cloud image (`deploy/Dockerfile.cloud`) and runs in place of the probe container:

```
      - name: feed                    # in place of the probe: the se
↪ rvice's own response times, from Prometheus
        image: <registry>/omni-compass-cloud:<version>
        command: ["python", "/app/tools/prom_feed.py"]
        args:
          - "--prometheus=http://prometheus-operated.monitoring.svc:
↪ 9090"
          - "--served=sum(increase(nginx_ingress_controller_requests
↪ {ingress=\"checkout\",status!~\"5..\"}[{w}]))"
          - "--failed=sum(increase(nginx_ingress_controller_requests
↪ {ingress=\"checkout\",status=~\"5..\"}[{w}]))"
          - "--quantile=histogram_quantile({q}, sum by (le) (increas
↪ e(nginx_ingress_controller_request_duration_seconds_bucket{ingre
↪ ss=\"checkout\"}[{w}])))"
          - "--unit-ms=1000"
          - "--interval=15"
          - "--window=30s"
          - "--out=/feed/latency.csv"
```

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```
        resources: {requests: {cpu: 10m, memory: 32Mi}, limits: {cpu
    ↪ : 100m, memory: 64Mi}}
        securityContext: {allowPrivilegeEscalation: false, readOnlyR
    ↪ ootFilesystem: true, capabilities: {drop: [ALL]}}
        volumeMounts: [{name: feed, mountPath: /feed}]
```

In the queries, `{w}` is replaced by the window and `{q}` by each quantile; every other brace is PromQL's own. The network policy of section 27.5 then allows the metrics system's address in place of the service's. Before the governor relies on the adapter, check its feed as section 19.5 checks any feed, and run it beside the probe for a day: the two feeds' 95th percentiles should agree within the histogram's precision, and the dashboard's two lines (section 23.3) should coincide.

| Setting | Default | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| `--prometheus` | (required) | the metrics system's base URL |
| `--served`, `--failed`, `--quantile` | (required; `--failed` may be empty) | the three PromQL templates |
| `--quantiles` | 0.05, 0.15, ..., 0.95 | the quantiles read, one row each |
| `--unit-ms` | 1000 | milliseconds per unit of the histogram (1000 for seconds) |
| `--interval` | 15 s | seconds between reads |
| `--window` | `30s` | the range of each read: at least twice the scrape interval |
| `--fail-cap` | 20 | the most failure rows a window |
| `--out` | (required) | the feed the governor reads (`--latency-file`) |
| `--once`, `--duration` | off, 0 | read one window and exit; run for a number of seconds |

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CHAPTER 24

# Change Management, Risk and Compliance

A governor that writes to production is a change to production, and companies with a change-management process will treat its installation as one. This chapter maps the phases of section 14.3 onto that process, lists the risks a risk owner will ask about with the control that answers each, and names the evidence a compliance review will want.

## 24.1 The installation as changes, phase by phase

| Phase | Change class it usually is | Why |
|---|---|---|
| 1. The cluster | the company's own class for new infrastructure | the governor is not involved yet |
| 2. Identity | standard (pre-approved) | a namespace, a service account and a read-only role |
| 3. Watch | standard | the governor writes nothing; its role cannot write |
| 4. Feed and line | standard, or normal where an adapter is new code | the line is a decision of the service owner, recorded |
| 5. Paired run | none in production | the paired run is on its own clusters, built and deleted by the run |
| 6. Govern | normal (reviewed and approved) | the first grant that can write, and the first write |
| 7. Upgrades | normal, with the same gates as phase 6 | a new engine version is a new governor (chapter 13) |

The normal change of phase 6 carries, as its evidence, the paired receipt of phase 5 read row by row, the grant and its `kubectl auth can-i` proof (section 15.4), the OFF switch drill (section 21.3), and the rollback plan, which is short: turn the governor OFF, and every setting it ever wrote is back at the operator's, read back, within 60 seconds.

## 24.2 The risks and the controls that answer them

| Risk | Control | Evidence |
|---|---|---|
| The governor makes a decision that harms the service | it gives back a machine only after its own trial shows the response | the `verdict` and `decision` records; the paired receipt |

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| Risk | Control | Evidence |
|---|---|---|
| | time holds; a breach wakes it at the next decision; nothing is given back while a sense is blind | |
| The governor raises the bill | in the cloud mode it moves no pod autoscaler and never asks the cloud for a machine (chapter 20) | the grant (no autoscaler write); HPA replicas equal to native's in the receipt |
| The governor dies holding machines parked | the lease and the watchdog hand everything back from the records on the objects (section 21.2); a parked machine never blocks a pod | the watchdog drill |
| Someone else moves the same setting | the one-writer rule; the drift is visible in every decision | the `proprioception` field of each `authority` record |
| A compromised governor is used against the cluster | least privilege: read, patch nodes and patch pods; no delete, no eviction, no secrets, no cloud credential (chapter 15) | the role and its proof |
| A tampered copy is installed | the copy is verified against its manifest and seal before it is installed (chapter 33) | the verification receipt |
| The feed lies | the feed is checked before the governor watches (section 19.5); a stopped feed reads as blind and the governor holds | the feed checks |
| The audit is lost | the audit on a persistent volume, shipped to the log store (section 21.4) | the log store's retention |

## 24.3 What a compliance review will ask for

Frameworks differ in their words, not in the questions. A review against the company's change-management control (for example SOC 2's change-management criterion, CC8.1, or ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Annex A control 8.32), its logging control (Annex A control 8.15) and its privileged-access control (Annex A control 8.2) asks the same five things of the installation, and each has its answer in the installation record (section 15.7):

1. **Who approved the change?** The phase-6 change record, with the service owner's and the platform owner's sign-off.

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2. **What exactly can the system do?** The role, the `kubectl auth can-i` output, and the statement that it holds no cloud credential.
3. **How is every action recorded?** The audit: every decision, write and reason, on a persistent volume, shipped to the log store, kept for the retention period.
4. **How is it stopped?** The OFF switch, its holder, and the drill records.
5. **How do you know it works?** The paired receipt, read row by row on the company's own cluster, on the engine version in service.

## 24.4 Separation of duties, restated for auditors

The implementer installs; the service owner writes the line and signs the receipt; the platform owner grants the governing role; security holds the OFF switch; finance signs the bill rows (section 14.4). No one person can both grant the governor its writes and be the only person able to stop it.

## 24.5 Records an installation keeps, and for how long

| Record | Keep for |
|---|---|
| The verification receipt and engine version of every version installed | the life of the installation |
| The grant as applied, with its proof | the life of the installation, and every change to it |
| The line, its basis, and who signed it | the life of the line |
| Every paired receipt that decided a phase | the life of the engine version it was made on |
| The audit | the company's retention period for production change records |
| Every OFF-switch and watchdog drill | the company's retention period for control tests |

## 24.6 Communicating the installation

The people who will notice the governor are the service's on-call engineers, and they are told before it governs: what it moves (in the cloud mode, only which machines are in service), what it never moves, how a parked machine looks in `kubectl get nodes` (a `PreferNoSchedule` taint, `omnicompass.io/idle`), where its audit is, how to turn it OFF, and who holds the switch. An engineer who finds a tainted node at three in the morning and does not know why is the failure this section exists to prevent.

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CHAPTER 25

# Planning the Saving Before the Run: Capacity, Cost and the Shape of Load

A paired run costs days of the implementer's time and the price of two clusters. Before it is spent, the implementer can bound, from the company's own monitoring and with arithmetic alone, how large a saving the cloud mode could show on the pools it will govern, and where in the day that saving lives. This chapter gives that bound, the settings that move it, and the pricing terms that decide whether a machine-hour saved is a dollar saved. Nothing in it predicts what the governor will do: the bound is a ceiling that no machine lever on top of the same pods can pass, and the paired run (phase 5) is the only measurement of how much of it the governor takes while the line holds.

## 25.1 Where the bill of a governed pool comes from

In every provider's on-demand pricing, a work pool's compute bill over a period T is the sum, over the machines that existed in it, of each machine's price per hour times the hours it existed:

$B = \Sigma_m \, p_m \, h_m$, $h_m = \int_0^T 1[\text{m exists at t}] \, dt$ .

For a pool of one machine family at list price p, this is $B = p \int_0^T N(t) \, dt$, where N(t) is the number of machines in the pool at time t. The cloud mode lowers B in one way only: it makes machines exist for fewer hours. It parks a machine (a `PreferNoSchedule` taint, chapter 20), marks that machine's pods first to go (`controller.kubernetes.io/pod-deletion-cost`), so that the next scale-down of the service's own HPA removes them first, and leaves the machine to empty; the cloud's own cluster autoscaler then deletes the empty machine on its own schedule. Every term of B that the governor reduces is a machine the cluster autoscaler deleted. Two consequences follow, and an implementer plans with both:

1. **The saving is realised by the cluster autoscaler.** A parked machine still exists, and is still billed, until the autoscaler deletes it. The autoscaler's own profile (section 25.4) sets how long that takes.
2. **The saving needs the pods to leave.** A parked machine whose pods stay keeps serving and keeps billing. Pods leave when the service's HPA scales down (the ReplicaSet controller removes the pods with the lowest deletion cost first) or when the cluster autoscaler drains an underused machine on its own rules. A service whose replica count never falls gives a parked machine no way to empty.

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## 25.2 The room: an upper bound on what any machine lever can save

Define, for each sampling instant t of the governed pools:

- N(t): the machines in the pools;
- Q[c] (t) and $Q_m$(t): the processor and memory **requests** of the pods running on them, DaemonSet pods excluded (a DaemonSet runs one pod on every machine whatever the count, so it is a per-machine overhead, not work);
- C[c] and $C_m$: one machine's allocatable processor and memory (`kubectl get node <name> -o jsonpath='{.status.allocatable}'`) less the requests of the DaemonSet pods on it;
- N[f]: the floor of machines in service (`--min-nodes`, never fewer than 2).

The fewest machines that could hold the pods' requests at instant t, packing perfectly, is

$$N[req](t) = \max(N[f], \lceil \max((Q[c](t))/(C[c]), Q_m(t)/C_m) \rceil),$$

and the **room** over the period is the machine-hours above it:

$$R = \int_0^T (N(t) - N[req](t))^+ \, dt \approx \Sigma_k \, \Delta t \, (N(t_k) - N[req](t_k))^+,$$

where $(x)^+ = \max(x, 0)$ and $\Delta t$ is the sampling interval. R is an upper bound for three reasons, each of which a real cluster exhibits: perfect packing is not achievable (pods have affinity rules, topology spread constraints and sizes that do not tile a machine); the scheduler places pods by its own scoring, not by packing; and a machine that is parked must also empty before the cloud deletes it. The cloud mode never asks the cloud for a machine and never holds more pods than native's autoscaler gives it, so the governed pool can never fall below N[req] by the governor's action, and it does not try to: every machine it parks first passes its own trial against the line.

**The billable room.** Where the company holds a commitment that pays for K machines of the family whether they exist or not (section 25.5), only machine-hours above K reach the bill:

$$R[\$] = p \, \Sigma_k \, \Delta t \, (N(t_k) - \max(K, N[req](t_k)))^+ .$$

**The governor's own floor.** The governor never parks a machine that would leave the processor requests of the pods on the machines in service, with the spare of its `--headroom` setting (half again, by default; Appendix K), or their processor in use, without a place. With Q′[c] (t) the requests of every pod on the machines in service (DaemonSet pods included), U[c] (t) the processor in use, and C′[c] one machine's allocatable processor, it keeps at least

$$N[gov](t) = \max(N[f], \lceil ((1+h) \, Q'[c](t))/(C'[c]) \rceil, \lceil (U[c](t))/(C'[c]) \rceil), \; h = 0.5,$$

so the room the cloud mode can take is at most $R[gov] = \int_0^T (N(t) - N[gov](t))^+ \, dt \le R$. A pool whose pods' requests, with half again to spare, already fill the machines the cluster autoscaler keeps has R[gov] = 0: there is nothing to park, and a paired run on it reads EVEN on the bill, correctly.

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**An arithmetic illustration (not a measurement).** A pool holds 12 machines from 08:00 to 20:00 and 8 machines overnight; the pods' requests need 9 machines at the day's level and 3 overnight; the floor is 2 and there is no commitment. Then R = 12 h × (12 − 9) + 12 h × (8 − 3) = 36 + 60 = 96 machine-hours a day. The overnight trough holds almost two thirds of the room; a paired run made only at the day's level could show at most 36 of the 96, and a run at a steady peak where N = N[req] could show none. The illustration's numbers are invented to show the arithmetic; the company's own samples replace them.

## 25.3 Measuring the room on the company's own cluster

The samples need nothing the cluster does not already have. The following loop, run from any workstation or as a CronJob with the watch role of chapter 15, writes one row every five minutes for the pools labelled `omni-role=work`:

```
#!/usr/bin/env bash
# One row every 5 minutes: time, machines in the governed pools, the r
    ↪ equests of the pods on them (DaemonSet pods
# excluded: processor in millicores, memory in MiB), and the processor
    ↪  requests of every pod on them (for N_gov).
SEL="omni-role=work"; OUT="room.csv"

[ -s "$OUT" ] || echo "epoch,machines,cpu_req_m,mem_req_mib,cpu_req_al
    ↪ l_m" > "$OUT"
while true; do
  nodes=$(kubectl get nodes -l "$SEL" -o json | jq -c '[.items[].metad
    ↪ ata.name]')
  kubectl get pods -A --field-selector status.phase=Running -o json |

    ↪ jq -r --argjson nodes "$nodes" '
    def mcpu: if endswith("m") then .[:-1] | tonumber else tonumber *
    ↪ 1000 end;
    def mib:  if endswith("Ki") then .[:-2] | tonumber / 1024 elif end
    ↪ swith("Mi") then .[:-2] | tonumber
              elif endswith("Gi") then .[:-2] | tonumber * 1024 elif e

    ↪ ndswith("k") then .[:-1] | tonumber * 1e3 / 1048576
              elif endswith("M") then .[:-1] | tonumber * 1e6 / 104857
    ↪ 6 elif endswith("G") then .[:-1] | tonumber * 1e9 / 1048576
              else tonumber / 1048576 end;
    [.items[] | select(.spec.nodeName | IN($nodes[]))] as $on
    | [$on[] | .spec.containers[].resources.requests // {}] as $all
```

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```
    | [$on[] | select(all(.metadata.ownerReferences[]?; .kind != "Daem
    ↪ onSet"))
             | .spec.containers[].resources.requests // {}] as $r
    | [now | floor, ($nodes | length),
       ($r | map(.cpu // "0" | mcpu) | add // 0 | floor), ($r | map(.m
    ↪ emory // "0" | mib) | add // 0 | floor),

       ($all | map(.cpu // "0" | mcpu) | add // 0 | floor)]
    | @csv' >> "$OUT"
  sleep 300
done
```

Two weeks of rows cover two weekly cycles. The room then follows from the formulas of section 25.2:

```
import csv, math
C_CPU, C_MEM = 3860, 12800      # one machine's allocatable less its D
    ↪ aemonSet requests (millicores, MiB): read them
FLOOR, DT_H, K = 2, 300 / 3600, 0  # the floor, the sampling interval
    ↪ in hours, the committed machines
rows = list(csv.DictReader(open("room.csv")))

need = [max(FLOOR, math.ceil(max(int(r["cpu_req_m"]) / C_CPU, int(r["m
    ↪ em_req_mib"]) / C_MEM))) for r in rows]
room = sum(DT_H * max(0, int(r["machines"]) - n) for r, n in zip(rows,
    ↪  need))
billable = sum(DT_H * max(0, int(r["machines"]) - max(K, n)) for r, n
    ↪ in zip(rows, need))

C_ALLOC, H = 3860, 0.5             # one machine's allocatable process
    ↪ or (millicores), the governor's headroom
gov = [max(FLOOR, math.ceil((1 + H) * int(r["cpu_req_all_m"]) / C_ALLO
    ↪ C)) for r in rows]
room_gov = sum(DT_H * max(0, int(r["machines"]) - g) for r, g in zip(r
    ↪ ows, gov))

print(f"{len(rows) * DT_H:.0f} h sampled: room {room:.0f} machine-hour
    ↪ s, billable room {billable:.0f}, "
      f"room under the governor's own floor {room_gov:.0f}")
```

The constants `C_CPU`, `C_MEM` and `C_ALLOC` above are placeholders for a machine with four virtual processors; each installation reads its own. The use term of N[gov] is left out of the script, because on a pool

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that holds its requests it rarely binds; it can be added from `kubectl top nodes`. The same rows, plotted by hour of the week, show where the room lives, and so which load the paired run must carry (section 25.6).

## 25.4 The settings that bound the room, and whose they are

None of the settings below is the governor's, and none is changed by it. They are the operator's, they shape native and omni alike, and a paired run holds each of them identical in both arms.

| Setting | Where | What it does to the room |
|---|---|---|
| The floor (`--min-nodes`, `MIN_NODES`) | the governor's command line | the least the governor keeps in service; set it to at least the number of zones the service's availability design needs serving at every moment, never fewer than 2 |
| The pools labelled `omni-role=work` | the node pools' labels | only these machines may be parked; a pool left unlabelled is never touched |
| The HPA's minimum replicas | the service's HPA | a replica floor holds pods, and their machines, at every hour |
| The HPA's scale-down behaviour (`behavior.scaleDown`, stabilization window 300 s by default) | the service's HPA | a long window keeps pods after a peak, so parked machines empty later |
| The cluster autoscaler's scale-down profile | the provider (table below) | how long an empty or underused machine is kept before it is deleted |
| PodDisruptionBudgets | the service's manifests | a budget of zero disruptions keeps the cluster autoscaler from draining a machine; native is held the same way |
| Pods the cluster autoscaler will not move (`cluster-autoscaler.kubernetes.io/safe-to-evict: "false"`, local storage on some providers, bare pods with no controller) | the workloads | such a pod pins its machine until it ends |
| Spot or preemptible pools | the node pools | billed at the spot price; parking one saves that price; the provider may reclaim it on its own |

The cluster autoscaler's scale-down profile is set per provider:

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| Provider | How the profile is set | The settings that matter |
|---|---|---|
| Azure (AKS) | `az aks update -g <rg> -n <cluster> --cluster-autoscaler-profile scale-down-unneeded-time=10m scale-down-delay-after-add=10m scale-down-utilization-threshold=0.5 scan-interval=10s` (the values shown are AKS's defaults) | how long a machine must be unneeded before deletion; how long after a scale-up no scale-down happens; the utilisation under which a machine counts as unneeded |
| Google (GKE) | `gcloud container clusters update <cluster> --autoscaling-profile balanced` or `optimize-utilization` | the profile as a whole; `optimize-utilization` removes underused machines sooner |
| Amazon (EKS), Cluster Autoscaler | the flags on the autoscaler's own Deployment: `--scale-down-unneeded-time`, `--scale-down-delay-after-add`, `--scale-down-utilization-threshold`, `--scan-interval` | as on Azure |
| Amazon (EKS), Karpenter | the NodePool's `spec.disruption`: `consolidationPolicy` (`WhenEmpty` or `WhenEmptyOrUnderutilized`) and `consolidateAfter` | how soon an empty or underused machine is consolidated away |

A shorter scale-down profile also lowers native's bill. The comparison the governor is judged on is always at the same profile in both arms; a saving that came from a profile changed for one arm only is not the governor's, and a paired run that changes the profile between arms is not a paired run.

## 25.5 Pricing terms, and whether a machine-hour saved is a dollar saved

| Pricing term | What a deleted machine-hour saves | Planning rule |
|---|---|---|
| On-demand, billed by the second or the minute (the common case on all three providers; read the provider's own page for the | its full price | the billable room is the room |

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| Pricing term | What a deleted machine-hour saves | Planning rule |
|---|---|---|
| machine family) | | |
| A reservation, committed-use discount or savings plan covering K machines of the family | nothing below K; the full price above K | size commitments to the governed pool's floor and trough, not its peak; R[$] of section 25.2 |
| Spot or preemptible | the spot price | govern the on-demand pools first; a spot pool's machines can vanish on the provider's notice, governor or not |
| Software licensed per machine or per core (a commercial operating system, an agent billed per node) | that licence too, where it is billed by the hour the machine exists | add it to p |
| The cluster's own fee (the control plane), storage, network egress, load balancers | nothing | never in the bill rows of a receipt; the cloud mode moves none of them |

The bill rows of a receipt (section 20.6) price machine-hours at the provider's list price for the family, because list price is the one price both arms share and anyone can check. The company's own discounts change the dollars, never the machine-hours; finance converts the machine-hour row to the company's own price after the run (section 23.5).

## 25.6 Choosing the load for the paired run from the shape of the room

| Shape of the company's load | Where the room lives | The paired run that can show it |
|---|---|---|
| Steady at a level the pool was sized for | nowhere: N ≈ N[req] | none; a steady run reads EVEN on the bill, honestly, and is still worth running for the response-time and alert rows |
| A daily cycle (business hours, consumer evenings) | the trough and the descent after the peak | a replay of the company's own day, compressed only as far as the autoscaler's profile allows (a 10-minute unneeded time cannot be compressed below 10 minutes), or the repository's own day-shaped load (the Google 2011 trace on one to nine load generators) |

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| Shape of the company's load | Where the room lives | The paired run that can show it |
|---|---|---|
| Bursts separated by quiet stretches | between bursts, as native's autoscaler holds machines through its scale-down delay | the burst steps of the service's own traffic; in the repository, the burst sets of section 20.6 |
| A weekly cycle with a quiet weekend | the weekend | a run long enough to include a quiet stretch as long as the profile's scale-down time several times over |
| Batch windows | after each window | the batch itself, with the service's line on the jobs' own completion time where that is the objective |

**The run must be long enough for the autoscaler to act.** A quiet stretch shorter than the cluster autoscaler's unneeded time plus its scan interval gives neither arm a chance to delete a machine, and the bill reads EVEN for a reason that has nothing to do with the governor. Plan each quiet stretch of the paired run to last at least three times the unneeded time.

## 25.7 What the plan delivers to the paired run

Before phase 5 starts, the implementer writes, and the service owner and finance sign:

1. the room and the billable room from two weeks of samples, with the constants used;
2. the hours of the week that hold most of the room;
3. the load the paired run will carry, chosen from section 25.6, with its quiet stretches sized to the profile;
4. the settings of section 25.4 as they stand, identical in both arms;
5. the price used for the bill rows (list price) and the company's own price for the conversion afterwards.

A receipt that then reads GAIN on the bill, with response time, failed requests and alert minutes reading EVEN or GAIN, has measured a share of a room that was known beforehand; a receipt that reads EVEN on the bill where the plan found room is a wiring question to answer first (section 5.5): the feed, the line, the autoscaler's profile, a pod that pins its machine.

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CHAPTER 26

# On Your Own Racks and in Private Clouds

Many companies that run a public cloud also run Kubernetes on machines they own: bare-metal clusters in their own data centers, Red Hat OpenShift, VMware's Kubernetes on vSphere, Rancher's distributions, clusters at the edge, and clusters with no route to the internet at all. This chapter is for the implementer who installs Omni-Compass there. The plug, the grant, the feed, the audit, the OFF switch and the phases are the same as in the cloud; what changes is what a machine costs, and so which way the dial stands.

## 26.1 What changes when the machines are already paid for

In a public cloud every machine that exists is billed by the hour, so the benefit is the bill and the dial stands at the tune-down (chapter 20). On machines the company owns, the machine is paid for whether it works or idles; an idle machine saves only the difference between its idle power and its working power, and nothing at all of its purchase price. The benefit there is **more work from the same machines**: the dial stands at the max (section 4.2), every muscle run at its own limit and never past it. The max never gives back a machine the cluster had on its own; it works the pods, the processor and, where wired, the power, each at its limit.

| | Public cloud | Own racks or a private cloud |
|---|---|---|
| What an idle machine costs | its full hourly price | its idle power, and its share of cooling |
| The dial | the tune-down (`--dial save`) | the max (`--dial max`), the default |
| The levers | the machines alone (chapter 20) | the pods, the processor, the power and the machines, level by level (section 7.3) |
| What the receipt is judged on | the bill, at native's work, speed and failures | work, speed, misses and failures; the power it took shown beside them as power given |
| The meter | the provider's bill at list price | the machine's own meter, a wall meter, or the facility's (evidence class P) |

An owner who wants the power an idle machine draws back, rather than more work, turns the dial down to the tune-down on that cluster; the machines then go back one at a time through the trial, exactly as in the cloud, and the receipt reads the machines and the power instead of the bill.

## 26.2 Bare-metal Kubernetes

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A cluster built on the company's own machines (with kubeadm, RKE2, k3s, Talos or a vendor's distribution) usually has no cluster autoscaler: the machines exist all the time. The wiring follows section 7.3 level by level, with three points specific to bare metal.

**No machine is created or deleted by the governor.** The shipped machine script (`scripts/kind_nodepool.sh`) parks and wakes machines that exist, with a `PreferNoSchedule` taint; a parked machine stays powered, joined and Ready, and a pod that needs it lands on it at once. On bare metal, parking concentrates the work on fewer machines, and a parked machine whose pods have gone idles at its idle power.

**Powering a parked machine down is the operator's own command, and its price is the boot.** The governor's machine lever runs whatever command the operator writes in `--node-scale-cmd`, with `{n}` replaced by the number of machines to keep in service. An operator may write a command that, in addition to parking, powers an empty parked machine down through its baseboard management controller (Redfish or IPMI, or a provisioning system such as Metal3 or MAAS) and powers it up before waking it. The command's contract is the shipped script's:

| The command must | Why |
|---|---|
| keep exactly `{n}` machines in service, never fewer than the floor and never more than exist | the governor reads the count back as proprioception (section 21.4) |
| be idempotent: the same `{n}` twice changes nothing the second time | the governor issues the count again at its next decision while the machines in service differ from it |
| exit 0 when the count stands, and non-zero when it cannot be met | a non-zero exit is recorded as `refused`, and the governor learns the pool's top from it |
| never move, evict or delete a pod, and never power down a machine carrying a pod | parking never disturbs work |
| never touch a machine someone else cordoned | a cordon is a person's or an upgrade's, never the governor's (section 29.1) |
| wake a powered-down machine and return only when it is Ready | a woken machine must take pods |

A powered-down machine takes minutes to boot and join; the shipped script's parked machine takes no time at all. A wake that takes minutes turns the governor's answer to a breach from seconds into minutes. An installation that powers machines down therefore runs its paired run (phase 5) with the power-down command in place, so that the boot time is in the receipt's response-time and alert-minute rows, and keeps powered-down machines only beyond a number of parked, powered machines large enough to carry the service's largest burst.

**The meter.** On owned machines the power the governor gives or takes is measured, not priced. The repository's wall meter reader (`tools/wall_meter.py`) reads a networked power meter or a power distribution unit; Kepler (the Kubernetes efficiency exporter) and the processor's own energy counters (RAPL

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on x86 servers) read per-machine estimates. A receipt that reports power names its meter and its evidence class (chapter 12).

## 26.3 Red Hat OpenShift and OKD

OpenShift adds three things an implementer must account for.

**Security context constraints.** OpenShift admits pods through security context constraints (SCCs). The default for a service account, `restricted-v2`, assigns each pod a user ID from the namespace's own range and refuses a pod that asks for a fixed one, so the governing Deployment, which runs as user 10001 (chapter 20), is refused under it. Grant the governor's service account the `nonroot-v2` constraint, which admits any non-root user ID and keeps every other restriction of `restricted-v2`:

```
oc new-project omni-compass
oc apply -f deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml
oc adm policy add-scc-to-user nonroot-v2 -z omni-compass -n omni-compa
    ↪ ss
oc -n omni-compass get pod -l app=omni-compass -o jsonpath='{.items[0]
    ↪ .metadata.annotations.openshift\.io/scc}'

# prints: nonroot-v2
```

No other constraint is needed for the governor on a cluster: it is not privileged, mounts no host path and adds no capability. (The card governor of section 22.7 is a privileged agent on each graphics node and is a separate decision for the cluster's security owner.)

**Machine sets and the cluster autoscaler.** On an installer-provisioned OpenShift cluster the machines are made by the Machine API from MachineSets, and the cluster autoscaler is configured by a `ClusterAutoscaler` resource and one `MachineAutoscaler` per MachineSet. Native is that autoscaler. The governed machines are those of the MachineSets whose node template carries the label `omni-role: work`:

```
# in the MachineSet: the label every node it makes will carry
spec:
  template:
    spec:
      metadata:
        labels:

          omni-role: work
```

The governor itself runs on the infrastructure or control-plane machines, never on a machine it may park: set its `nodeSelector` to the infrastructure label the cluster uses (for example

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`node-role.kubernetes.io/infra: ""`) and add the matching toleration, in place of the manifest's `omni-role: system`.

**`oc` and `kubectl`.** The governor's image carries `kubectl`, which works against OpenShift's API unchanged. Commands in this manual written with `kubectl` work with `oc` in their place.

## 26.4 VMware vSphere, Rancher and Cluster API

Where the cluster's machines are virtual machines on a private cloud and a cluster autoscaler makes and deletes them (VMware's Kubernetes on vSphere through Cluster API, Rancher's RKE2 with its node-pool autoscaling, OpenStack's Magnum, or any Cluster API provider with the cluster autoscaler's Cluster API integration), the cloud mode of chapter 20 applies as written: the work pools are labelled `omni-role=work`, the system pool carries the governor, and native is the cluster autoscaler. What changes is the price. A private cloud's bill is the company's own internal charge (chargeback or showback) per machine-hour, or, where there is none, the power and the licences per host; the receipt's machine-hour row is the measurement, and finance prices it.

Where the private cloud licenses its hypervisor per host and hosts are not released when virtual machines are deleted, deleting a virtual machine saves nothing until the platform consolidates hosts. Read the platform's own consolidation behaviour (for vSphere, Distributed Power Management) before claiming a saving from machine-hours alone.

## 26.5 Clusters with no route to the internet

An air-gapped cluster pulls nothing from outside, so every artifact the installation needs is carried in:

| Artifact | How it is carried in |
|---|---|
| The verified copy | the repository archive, its manifest and its seal, verified on a connected machine (`python3 verify.py`) and again inside (`python3 verify.py` and `python3 tools/seal.py --check` need no network) |
| The base images | `python:3.12-slim` and `registry.k8s.io/kubectl` (the shipped Dockerfile's two bases), pulled on a connected machine, pinned by digest, saved (`docker save`), carried in and pushed to the internal registry |
| The Python packages | the wheels for `requirements.txt` downloaded on a connected machine (`pip download -r requirements.txt -d wheels`) and installed inside from that directory (`pip install --no-index --find-links wheels -r requirements.txt`) |
| `jq` for the cloud image | the distribution's package carried in with the base image, or a static `jq` binary copied into the image |

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| Artifact | How it is carried in |
|---|---|
| The built images | built inside from the carried-in bases, with the `FROM` lines pointed at the internal registry |

The governor needs no network beyond the cluster's own API server and, for the probe, the service it measures. It sends nothing anywhere: no telemetry, no licence check, no update check.

## 26.6 Clusters at the edge

A cluster of a few machines at a factory, a store or a cell tower has a floor problem: the governor never keeps fewer than two machines in service, and a three-machine cluster can park at most one. The gain at the edge is usually not machines but work and power: the max on the pods and the processor, and, where a site has a power limit, the site's watts read into the engine (`--power-cmd`, `--site-limit-w`, level 7). The OFF switch, the watchdog and the audit are the same; the audit should be shipped off the site, because an edge site's disks are the first thing lost.

## 26.7 Own machines: what to check before claiming a gain

| Claim | What backs it |
|---|---|
| More work from the same machines | the paired receipt's work rows (requests served, jobs completed) reading GAIN, with response time and failures EVEN or GAIN, on the same machines in both arms |
| The same work on fewer machines | the machine rows reading GAIN at the tune-down, with every service row EVEN or GAIN |
| Power | a meter of class P named in the receipt; the power the max took shown as power given beside the work it bought, never called a loss |
| A dollar figure | the company's own price per kilowatt-hour or per machine-hour, applied by finance to the measured rows, never by the governor's receipt |

CHAPTER 27

# Hardening and the Supply Chain

A governor that can write to production is a privileged workload, however narrow its grant. This chapter takes the installation of chapter 20 from correct to hardened: the image built, described, scanned and signed; only that image admitted; the governor's writes narrowed below what role-based access control alone can express;

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its network reduced to the two endpoints it needs; and its every write cross-checked against the API server's own record. Each step is optional in the sense that the governor works without it, and expected in the sense that a security review will ask for it.

## 27.1 What the governor's grant allows, read as an attacker would

Least privilege (chapter 15) limits the governor to reading the cluster and patching nodes and pods. A security reviewer reads that grant by asking what a stolen copy of the governor's service-account token could do, not what the governor does with it:

| With the cloud-mode grant, a stolen token could | Consequence | The control that closes it |
|---|---|---|
| read nodes, pods, deployments, HPAs and config maps cluster-wide | the cluster's shape is disclosed | the token is short-lived and projected; the namespace admits only the signed image (section 27.3); no person or other workload uses the service account |
| taint a node `NoSchedule`, or cordon it | new pods cannot land there; enough of them and new pods wait | the admission policy of section 27.4 admits only the governor's own `omnicompass.io/idle` taint with the `PreferNoSchedule` effect, and no cordon |
| change a node's labels or annotations (for example, disable the cluster autoscaler's scale-down on it) | scheduling or the bill is distorted | the admission policy of section 27.4 |
| change a pod's labels | the pod leaves its Service's selector and stops receiving traffic | the admission policy of section 27.4 admits, on a pod, only the `controller.kubernetes.io/pod-deletion-cost` annotation |
| change a mutable field of a pod's spec (its container image, its active deadline, its tolerations) | code the company did not ship runs, or pods end | the admission policy of section 27.4 admits no change to a pod's spec |

Role-based access control cannot express the right-hand column: its verbs are whole-object (`patch` on `nodes` is every field of every node). The Kubernetes admission policy language can, and section 27.4 uses it.

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With it, the governor's token is worth, to an attacker, what it is worth to the governor: the ability to mark a machine "prefer not" and to mark a pod "first to go".

## 27.2 The image: built from the verified copy, described, scanned, signed

1. **Build from the verified copy** (chapter 33), with the base images pinned by digest rather than by tag:

```bash python3 verify.py # VERIFICATION: PASS, on the commit being built docker build -t <registry>/omni-compass:<version> -f deploy/Dockerfile . docker build -t <registry>/omni-compass-cloud:<version> -f deploy/Dockerfile.cloud \

```
  --build-arg BASE=<registry>/omni-compass:<version> .
```

```

Pin `python:3.12-slim` and `registry.k8s.io/kubectl` by digest in a copy of `deploy/Dockerfile` kept in the company's own repository (`FROM python:3.12-slim@sha256:<digest>`), so that a rebuild of the same commit yields the same layers. Tag every image with the engine version and the commit; never deploy `latest`.

2. **Describe it** with a software bill of materials, in SPDX or CycloneDX: `syft <registry>/omni-compass-cloud:<version> -o spdx-json > sbom.spdx.json`. Keep the bill with the installation record.
3. **Scan it** for known vulnerabilities before it is pushed and on a schedule after: `trivy image <registry>/omni-compass-cloud:<version>` or `grype <registry>/omni-compass-cloud:<version>`. The image holds a Python runtime, its packages, `kubectl`, `bash` and `jq`; a finding in any of them is handled under the company's own vulnerability policy, by rebuilding on a patched base, never by editing the engine.
4. **Sign it** in the registry, so that admission can prove where it came from: with Sigstore's `cosign` (`cosign sign --key <key> <registry>/omni-compass-cloud@sha256:<digest>`, or keyless signing bound to the company's build identity), or with Notation and the cloud's key service (Azure Key Vault, Google Cloud KMS, AWS Signer). Sign the digest, not the tag.
5. **Push to the company's private registry** (Azure Container Registry, Google Artifact Registry, Amazon ECR), with tag immutability turned on, and pull from it only.

## 27.3 Admitting only the signed image, and only the restricted profile

**Only the signed image.** Each provider offers an admission control that refuses an unsigned or wrongly signed image:

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| Provider | Admission control for image signatures |
|---|---|
| Azure (AKS) | Image Integrity (Ratify with Azure Policy), verifying Notation signatures |
| Google (GKE) | Binary Authorization, with an attestor bound to the company's signing key |
| Amazon (EKS) | Kyverno's `verifyImages` rule or the Sigstore policy controller, verifying cosign or Notation signatures |
| Any cluster | Kyverno `verifyImages`, the Sigstore policy controller, or Gatekeeper with Ratify |

Scope the rule to the `omni-compass` namespace at least; the governor's pod then cannot be replaced by a pod running an image the company did not build and sign.

**The restricted Pod Security Standard.** The governing Deployment meets the `restricted` profile of the Kubernetes Pod Security Standards as shipped: it runs as a non-root user, forbids privilege escalation, drops every Linux capability, uses the runtime's default seccomp profile, mounts only `emptyDir` volumes (or a persistent volume claim, section 21.4) and has a read-only root filesystem. Enforce the profile on its namespace, so that no later edit can loosen it:

```
kubectl label namespace omni-compass \
  pod-security.kubernetes.io/enforce=restricted pod-security.kubernete
    ↪ s.io/enforce-version=latest
```

On OpenShift the security context constraints of section 26.3 play this part.

## 27.4 Narrowing the writes below the role: an admission policy

A `ValidatingAdmissionPolicy` (Kubernetes 1.30 and later, which every current managed Kubernetes version satisfies) evaluates rules written in the Common Expression Language (CEL) against every write a chosen identity makes, and refuses a write that breaks them, after role-based access control has allowed it. The two policies below bind the governor's service account, and only it, to the writes the cloud mode makes: on a node, its own idle taint and nothing else; on a pod, its own deletion-cost mark and nothing else.

```
# The governor's writes on machines: its own idle taint (PreferNoSched
    ↪ ule), nothing else.
apiVersion: admissionregistration.k8s.io/v1
kind: ValidatingAdmissionPolicy
metadata: {name: omni-compass-nodes}
spec:
```

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```
failurePolicy: Fail
matchConstraints:
  resourceRules:
    - {apiGroups: [""], apiVersions: ["v1"], operations: ["UPDATE"],
  ↪  resources: ["nodes"]}
matchConditions:

  - name: the-governor
    expression: "request.userInfo.username == 'system:serviceaccount
  ↪ :omni-compass:omni-compass'"
validations:
  - expression: >-
      has(object.metadata.labels) == has(oldObject.metadata.labels)

  ↪ &&
      (!has(object.metadata.labels) || object.metadata.labels == old
  ↪ Object.metadata.labels)
    message: "the governor changes no label of a machine"
  - expression: >-
      has(object.metadata.annotations) == has(oldObject.metadata.ann

  ↪ otations) &&
      (!has(object.metadata.annotations) || object.metadata.annotati
  ↪ ons == oldObject.metadata.annotations)
    message: "the governor changes no annotation of a machine"
  - expression: >-
      (has(object.spec.unschedulable) && object.spec.unschedulable)

  ↪ ==
      (has(oldObject.spec.unschedulable) && oldObject.spec.unschedul
  ↪ able)
    message: "the governor never cordons or uncordons a machine"
  - expression: >-
      (!has(object.spec.taints) || object.spec.taints.all(t,

         (t.key == 'omnicompass.io/idle' && t.effect == 'PreferNoSch
  ↪ edule') ||
         (has(oldObject.spec.taints) && oldObject.spec.taints.exists
  ↪ (o, o.key == t.key && o.effect == t.effect)))) &&
      (!has(oldObject.spec.taints) || oldObject.spec.taints.all(o, o
  ↪ .key == 'omnicompass.io/idle' ||
```

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```
          (has(object.spec.taints) && object.spec.taints.exists(t, t.
    ↪ key == o.key && t.effect == o.effect))))
      message: "the governor adds or removes no taint but its own omni
    ↪ compass.io/idle:PreferNoSchedule"
---
apiVersion: admissionregistration.k8s.io/v1

kind: ValidatingAdmissionPolicyBinding
metadata: {name: omni-compass-nodes}
spec: {policyName: omni-compass-nodes, validationActions: [Deny]}
---
# The governor's writes on pods: its own deletion-cost mark, nothing e
    ↪ lse.

apiVersion: admissionregistration.k8s.io/v1
kind: ValidatingAdmissionPolicy
metadata: {name: omni-compass-pods}
spec:
  failurePolicy: Fail
  matchConstraints:

    resourceRules:
      - {apiGroups: [""], apiVersions: ["v1"], operations: ["UPDATE"],
    ↪  resources: ["pods"]}
  matchConditions:
    - name: the-governor
      expression: "request.userInfo.username == 'system:serviceaccount

    ↪ :omni-compass:omni-compass'"
  validations:
    - expression: "object.spec == oldObject.spec"
      message: "the governor changes nothing in a pod's spec"
    - expression: >-
        has(object.metadata.labels) == has(oldObject.metadata.labels)

    ↪ &&
        (!has(object.metadata.labels) || object.metadata.labels == old
    ↪ Object.metadata.labels)
      message: "the governor changes no label of a pod"
    - expression: >-
        (!has(object.metadata.annotations) || object.metadata.annotati
```

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```
    ↪ ons.all(k,
           k == 'controller.kubernetes.io/pod-deletion-cost' ||
           (has(oldObject.metadata.annotations) && k in oldObject.meta
    ↪ data.annotations &&
            oldObject.metadata.annotations[k] == object.metadata.annot
    ↪ ations[k]))) &&

        (!has(oldObject.metadata.annotations) || oldObject.metadata.an
    ↪ notations.all(k,
           k == 'controller.kubernetes.io/pod-deletion-cost' ||
           (has(object.metadata.annotations) && k in object.metadata.a
    ↪ nnotations)))
      message: "the governor changes no annotation of a pod but contro

    ↪ ller.kubernetes.io/pod-deletion-cost"
---
apiVersion: admissionregistration.k8s.io/v1
kind: ValidatingAdmissionPolicyBinding
metadata: {name: omni-compass-pods}
spec: {policyName: omni-compass-pods, validationActions: [Deny]}
```

**Prove the policies before the governor relies on them.** A policy is proved the way the grant is (section 15.4): by asking the API server, as the governor, to do what the policy forbids and what it allows, and reading the answers. The implementer's own account needs the right to impersonate the service account, which a cluster administrator has:

```
SA=system:serviceaccount:omni-compass:omni-compass; N=<a work machine>
    ↪ ; P=<a pod of the service>; NS=<its namespace>
kubectl --as=$SA label node $N omni-test=1
    ↪       # refused: changes no label of a machine
kubectl --as=$SA cordon $N
    ↪       # refused: never cordons

kubectl --as=$SA taint node $N omni-test=1:NoSchedule
    ↪       # refused: no taint but its own
kubectl --as=$SA taint node $N omnicompass.io/idle=true:PreferNoSchedu
    ↪ le    # admitted
kubectl --as=$SA taint node $N omnicompass.io/idle:PreferNoSchedule-
    ↪       # admitted
```

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```
kubectl --as=$SA label pod $P -n $NS omni-test=1
    ↪        # refused: changes no label of a pod
kubectl --as=$SA annotate pod $P -n $NS controller.kubernetes.io/pod-d
    ↪ eletion-cost=-1000 --overwrite   # admitted
kubectl --as=$SA annotate pod $P -n $NS controller.kubernetes.io/pod-d
    ↪ eletion-cost-                    # admitted
```

Each refusal names the policy and its message. Keep the eight answers with the installation record beside the grant's proof. Run the drill in a quiet hour: the two admitted taint commands park and wake the machine `$N` for a moment, and the two admitted annotations mark and unmark one pod.

**What `failurePolicy: Fail` means here.** If the policy itself cannot be evaluated, the governor's write is refused, never admitted. A refused write is recorded as `refused` in the governor's audit (section 21.4); a refused park leaves a machine in service, and a refused wake leaves a machine parked, which never blocks a pod. The policy can therefore stop the governor from saving, never make it harm.

The cloud mode needs nothing the policies forbid: the shipped machine script parks and wakes machines with the idle taint alone, marks pods with the deletion-cost annotation alone, and never cordons or uncordons a machine (section 29.1).

## 27.5 The network: two endpoints

The governor's pod talks to two endpoints: the cluster's API server (through `kubectl`, from the controller and the watchdog) and the service it measures (from the probe). It receives no connection at all. A `NetworkPolicy` can hold it to exactly that, where the cluster's network plugin enforces network policy (Azure Network Policy Manager or Cilium on AKS, GKE Dataplane V2 or Calico on GKE, the Amazon VPC CNI's network policy agent or Calico on EKS):

```
apiVersion: networking.k8s.io/v1
kind: NetworkPolicy
metadata: {name: omni-compass, namespace: omni-compass}
spec:
  podSelector: {matchLabels: {app: omni-compass}}
  policyTypes: [Ingress, Egress]
  ingress: []                                    # nothing connects to
    ↪ the governor
  egress:
    - to:                                        # the cluster's DNS
        - namespaceSelector: {matchLabels: {kubernetes.io/metadata.nam
    ↪ e: kube-system}}
```

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```
        podSelector: {matchLabels: {k8s-app: kube-dns}}
    ports: [{protocol: UDP, port: 53}, {protocol: TCP, port: 53}]
  - to:                                       # the API server: its
  ↪ address from `kubectl get endpoints kubernetes`
      - ipBlock: {cidr: <api-server-address>/32}
    ports: [{protocol: TCP, port: 443}]

  - to:                                       # the measured service
  ↪ , for the probe
      - namespaceSelector: {matchLabels: {kubernetes.io/metadata.nam
  ↪ e: <namespace>}}
        podSelector: {matchLabels: {<the service's selector>}}
    ports: [{protocol: TCP, port: <the service's target port>}]
```

Three details decide whether this policy works on a given cluster: the API server's address, which on a managed cluster is outside the pod network and is read from `kubectl get endpoints kubernetes -n default` (and some providers translate it, so test from the pod); the DNS pods' label, which differs by provider (`k8s-app: kube-dns` on all three as of this writing); and the measured service's pods' labels and target port. Prove the policy as the grant is proved: from the governor's pod, the API server and the service answer, and nothing else does (`kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass -c probe -- python -c "import urllib.request; urllib.request.urlopen('https://example.com', timeout=5)"` must fail).

## 27.6 The API server's own record of every write

The governor's audit records every write it makes; the API server's audit log records every write it receives. Read together, they prove that the governor wrote nothing it did not record, and that nothing wrote as the governor that was not the governor. Turn the control plane's audit log on, and filter it by the service account `system:serviceaccount:omni-compass:omni-compass`:

| Provider | The API server's audit log |
|---|---|
| Azure (AKS) | diagnostic settings on the cluster, category `kube-audit` (or `kube-audit-admin` for writes only), to a Log Analytics workspace |
| Google (GKE) | Cloud Audit Logs, Admin Activity (always on) for writes, in Cloud Logging |
| Amazon (EKS) | control plane logging, log type `audit`, to CloudWatch Logs |

Every `patch` on a node or a pod by the service account must match a `write` record in the governor's audit within the same few seconds, with the same object; every `write` record that is not marked `"dry_run": true` must match a patch. A patch by the service account with no `write` record behind it is a security incident: the token was used by something other than the governor.

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## 27.7 The token, and no other secret

The governor holds no secret of any kind: no cloud credential (section 15.5), no password, no key; its role reads no `Secret` object. Its only credential is the Kubernetes service-account token that the kubelet projects into its pod, short-lived and rotated by the kubelet, bound to the pod's lifetime. No person and no other workload uses the `omni-compass` service account; a request by it from anywhere but the governor's pod is visible in the API server's audit log (section 27.6) by its source address and its user agent.

## 27.8 The hardening record

| Item | Evidence kept |
|---|---|
| The image | its digest, its software bill of materials, its last scan, its signature |
| Admission | the signature rule and the namespace's Pod Security label |
| The writes | the two admission policies, and the eight answers of their proof |
| The network | the network policy and the proof that only the two endpoints answer |
| The record | the API server's audit log turned on, and one quarter's cross-check against the governor's audit |

CHAPTER 28

# Rolling Out Across a Fleet: Many Clusters, Many Services, GitOps

Section 21.7 sets the rule for a fleet: one governor per cluster, rolled out cluster by cluster through the phases of section 14.3, with a paired receipt on at least one cluster of each kind. This chapter is the practice behind the rule: how the governor's configuration is kept as code, what differs from cluster to cluster and what must not, how a continuous-delivery controller interacts with the OFF switch, and how a fleet of audits is read as one.

## 28.1 The unit of rollout

| Unit | Rule |
|---|---|
| The cluster | one governor, one feed, one line, one set of governed pools; never one governor for several clusters, never two governors on one cluster |
| The kind | clusters on the same provider, machine families, autoscaler profile and service class; one paired receipt per kind decides whether the kind may govern |

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| Unit | Rule |
|---|---|
| The engine version | one engine version across the fleet at a time, apart from the wave that is upgrading; a receipt is read only against the version it was made on (chapter 13) |
| The wave | an ordered group of clusters that moves from one phase to the next together, after the wave before it has run a full cycle of its load without a fault |

A conventional order of waves is: one non-production cluster of the kind; one production cluster with the smallest blast radius; a tenth of the kind; the rest. Each wave starts at phase 3 (watch), never at phase 6, even when the kind already has a receipt: watching on a new cluster shows that its feed, its line and its pools are what the receipt assumed.

## 28.2 What differs from cluster to cluster, and what must not

| Setting | Per cluster | Why |
|---|---|---|
| `TARGET_URL` (the probe), or the adapter's source | yes | the service's address in that cluster |
| `--slo-ms` | per service, usually the same across clusters | the service owner's line; a cluster with a different line is a different kind |
| `--max-nodes` | yes | the sum of that cluster's work pools' autoscaler maxima |
| `--min-nodes` and `MIN_NODES` | per kind | the floor, at least the zones the service needs serving |
| `WORKER_SEL` | per kind | the label of the governed pools, `omni-role=work` by convention |
| The image digest | **never** | one engine version, one build, one signature |
| `--mode`, `--law`, `--dial`, `--sensed`, `--interval`, `--floor-interval`, `--max-node-step`, the node commands | **never** | the cloud mode as section 20.3 writes it; a cluster that differs is not in the cloud mode and its receipt is its own |

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## 28.3 The configuration as code

The repository's manifests are the starting point, not the company's deployable unit. Two of them cannot be applied together as written: `deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml` carries the identity (the namespace, the service account, the watch role and its binding) and the watch Deployment, and `deploy/install/omni-compass-cloud.yaml` carries the governing Deployment under the same name. In the company's own configuration repository, split the first file into its identity half and its watch half, and keep a base for each phase:

```
omni-compass/
  base/identity/        namespace, service account, watch role and bin
    ↪ ding (from deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml)
  base/watch/           the watch Deployment (from deploy/install/omni
    ↪ -compass.yaml)
  base/govern/          rbac-machines.yaml, omni-compass-cloud.yaml, t
    ↪ he network policy and admission policies (chapter 27)
  overlays/<cluster>/   kustomization.yaml: identity + watch, or ident
    ↪ ity + govern, and this cluster's settings
```

An overlay for one cluster in phase 6:

```
# overlays/aks-eastus-prod-1/kustomization.yaml
apiVersion: kustomize.config.k8s.io/v1beta1
kind: Kustomization
resources: [../../base/identity, ../../base/govern]
images:
  - name: omni-compass-cloud              # the image name in the mani
    ↪ fest, without its tag
    newName: <registry>/omni-compass-cloud
    digest: sha256:<the signed digest>
patches:
  - target: {kind: Deployment, name: omni-compass}
    patch: |-
      - op: replace
        path: /spec/template/spec/containers/1/env/0/value
        value: http://checkout.shop.svc.cluster.local/
      - op: replace
        path: /spec/template/spec/containers/0/args
        value: ["--mode", "nodepool", "--law", "compass", "--dial", "s
```

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```
    ↪ ave", "--sensed", "none/none",
                "--active-nodes-only", "--interval", "15", "--floor-in
    ↪ terval", "5",
                "--min-nodes", "3", "--max-nodes", "24", "--max-node-s
    ↪ tep", "1",
                "--node-scale-cmd", "bash /app/scripts/kind_nodepool.s
    ↪ h {n}",
                "--node-restore-cmd", "bash /app/scripts/kind_nodepool
    ↪ .sh 100000",
                "--latency-file", "/feed/latency.csv", "--slo-ms", "40
    ↪ 0",
                "--closure", "/app/law/closure.json",
                "--audit", "/var/log/omni/audit.jsonl", "--kill-file",
    ↪  "/tmp/omni.kill"]
```

The patch replaces the governor's whole command line rather than single arguments, so that the line in Git is the line that runs, readable in one place; its absence of `--dry-run` is the change that the phase-6 change record approves (section 24.1). The containers are addressed by position (0 the governor, 1 the probe, 2 the watchdog), as the manifest orders them; `MIN_NODES` in the governor's and the watchdog's environment must be patched to the same floor as `--min-nodes`.

## 28.4 Continuous delivery and the OFF switch

A continuous-delivery controller that keeps the cluster equal to Git (Argo CD with automated sync and self-heal, Flux with its default reconciliation) undoes a change made directly in the cluster. Two of the OFF switch's forms (section 20.3) are such changes, and the holder must know what the controller will do with them:

| OFF form | What a self-healing controller does | What the installation does about it |
|---|---|---|
| Scale to zero (`kubectl scale ... --replicas=0`) | puts the replica count back to Git's 1 within its reconciliation interval, and the governor starts again | either the OFF switch of record is a commit to Git (`replicas: 0`), or the controller is told to leave the replica count alone: in Argo CD an `ignoreDifferences` entry on the Application for `/spec/replicas` of the `omni-compass` Deployment; in Flux, `flux suspend` |

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| OFF form | What a self-healing controller does | What the installation does about it |
|---|---|---|
| | | `kustomization <name>` as the first step of the drill |
| The kill file | nothing: the file is in the pod's `/tmp`, which Git does not describe | none needed; but a pod replaced for any reason, including a sync that changes the pod template, starts ON |
| Revoke the grant (`kubectl delete clusterrolebinding omni-compass-machines`) | applies the binding again from Git | revoke in Git, or suspend the controller for the binding first |

Write the chosen form into the runbook and drill it as it is written (section 21.3). A drill on a GitOps cluster that scales to zero and then watches the controller start the governor again has found the fault this section exists to prevent.

**Other reconcilers of the same objects.** The governor writes two things: a taint on a node and an annotation on a pod. A tool that reconciles node taints to a declared list (some node-management controllers, some provider settings applied to a pool) removes the governor's `omnicompass.io/idle` taint, and a tool that reconciles pod annotations would remove the deletion-cost mark; either is a second writer of the governor's setting (section 21.8) and shows as a `proprioception` drift that does not close. Exclude the key from that tool's reconciliation, or leave that pool ungoverned. Pods are created by their controllers, not by Git, so a continuous-delivery controller never sees the deletion-cost mark.

## 28.5 Many services on one cluster

The cloud mode governs machines, and machines are shared. Where several services run on the governed pools, the governor's single feed must speak for all of them (section 19.6): the feed of the service most sensitive to a lost machine, or an adapter that writes the worst of the services' own percentiles against their own lines. Three practical rules follow:

1. **Govern a pool, not a service.** Label `omni-role=work` on the pools whose machines the feed speaks for, and leave pools that serve other services unlabelled. A pool dedicated to one service (a node pool with a taint the service tolerates) is the simplest case and the cleanest receipt.
2. **One line per pool.** If two services on the same pool have lines that cannot be scaled to one, they are not governed together: split the pool, or govern only by the stricter line.
3. **Batch and stateful work.** Pods that the cluster autoscaler will not move (section 25.4) pin their machines; the governor may park such a machine, but it empties only when those pods end. A pool that

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carries long jobs and serving pods together gives the governor little to give back, honestly; the receipt shows it as EVEN on the bill.

## 28.6 Regions, zones and failover

Each region's clusters are separate units. A governor in one region never reads another region's feed, and a regional failover (traffic moved from one region's clusters to another's) is, to each governor, a change in its own service's load: the receiving region's governor sees its line approach and wakes what it parked; the sending region's governor sees the load fall and, after its trials, parks what the trough allows. Two settings deserve attention in a region that must be able to absorb another's traffic at once:

- **The floor.** A region that must carry a failover without waiting for the cloud to create machines sets its floor (`--min-nodes`) to the machines the failover needs at its first minute, not to the trough's need; the bill's room then starts above that floor (section 25.2).
- **The zones.** The governor does not read zones, and the machine script chooses which machines to park by the work on them. A service that needs a minimum number of serving machines in every zone keeps that minimum through its own pods' topology spread constraints and a floor of at least that number times the zones; the `PreferNoSchedule` taint never prevents a pod from landing on a parked machine in the zone it needs.

## 28.7 Reading a fleet's audits as one

Every governor writes its own audit (section 21.4); a fleet's audits become one record when the log collector adds the cluster's name to every line on its way to the log store (Fluent Bit's Kubernetes filter, the Azure Monitor agent, Google Cloud's logging agent and the CloudWatch agent each attach the cluster's identity, or can be configured to). Four fleet views answer most questions:

| View | From | Shows |
|---|---|---|
| Machines parked, by cluster and hour | `write` records with `why` = `node pool size` | where and when the fleet gives machines back |
| Trials refused or abandoned, by cluster | `verdict` records | clusters whose feed is thin or whose service is short of machines |
| Blind and error decisions, by cluster | `authority` records' `senses`, and `error` records | clusters with a feed or API problem |
| Drift that does not close, by cluster | `authority` records' `proprioception` | clusters with a second writer |

The fleet's bill is read from the provider's own billing records by cluster and pool (section 23.5), never summed from receipts: a receipt is a controlled comparison on a day, and a bill is the fleet's actual cost over a period.

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## 28.8 Upgrading a fleet

An engine upgrade moves through the fleet in the same waves as the first installation (section 21.6 for one cluster): each wave watches on the new version for a full cycle of its load, a paired receipt on the new version decides each kind, and only then does the wave govern on it. During the upgrade the fleet runs two versions, and every audit line, dashboard and receipt names the version it came from (`python3 tools/omni_version.py` on the build, the image tag in the cluster). The rollback of a wave is the rollback of one cluster repeated (section 21.6), safe at any moment because the governor carries no state between processes beyond the marks it reads back from the cluster.

CHAPTER 29

# Failure Modes and the Drill Book

Every component of an installation fails eventually: the governor's process, its pod, the machine under it, its feed, the API server it talks to, the service it measures, and the other controllers that share the cluster with it. This chapter lists each failure an implementer should expect, what the governor does when it happens, what the audit and the cluster show, and what the operator does. Section 29.2 turns the most important ones into drills, each with the command that causes the failure on purpose, so that the first time the on-call engineer sees it is not the night it happens.

The design rule behind every row is the same, and it is worth stating once: **a failure of the governor never leaves a pod without a place to run.** A parked machine carries a `PreferNoSchedule` taint, which the scheduler treats as a preference and never as a refusal, so the worst a dead or blind governor can leave behind is machines that are still in the cluster, still Ready and still usable, with a mark asking new pods to go elsewhere first.

## 29.1 What fails, what the governor does, and what you do

| Failure | What the governor does | What you see | What you do |
|---|---|---|---|
| The governor's process is killed (out of memory, a signal) | nothing; the watchdog in the same pod finds the process gone within 10 seconds and runs the governor's recorded restore, waking every parked machine and | the watchdog's `handed back` record; the container's restart count rises; the restarted governor's first decisions | find why it died (`kubectl describe pod`, the container's last state); an out-of-memory kill means the limit is too low for the cluster's size |

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| Failure | What the governor does | What you see | What you do |
|---|---|---|---|
| | removing its marks; the kubelet restarts the governor's container | | |
| The governor hangs | its lease stops being renewed; after five decision periods (300 seconds at the cloud mode's 60) the watchdog kills it and runs the restore | the watchdog's record with `hung: true` | as above |
| The governor's pod is deleted or evicted gracefully (a drain of the system pool, an upgrade, `kubectl delete pod`) | on `SIGTERM` it hands every setting back, reads each back and exits; the Deployment starts a new pod, which starts ON | the audit record `master switch: OFF; every setting handed back; exiting`, then a new pod's first decisions | nothing, unless the new pod cannot be placed |
| The machine under the governor fails abruptly | nothing can act for it at that moment; the parked machines stay parked, which blocks no pod; the Deployment starts a new pod on another system machine, which begins from the cluster as it finds it | the pod rescheduled; if the system pool has one machine, the pod waits for the provider's repair | run the system pool on at least two machines in production, so the governor's pod always has somewhere to go |
| The feed stops (the probe's container dies, the adapter stops writing) | after twice its window with no new row the governor reads the feed as blind: it gives nothing back, treats the reading as past its wall, and wakes a parked machine each decision while the sense stays blind | `authority` records whose `senses.blind` names `latency`, with a growing `latency_age_s`; the probe container's restarts | restore the feed (section 19.3 on a probe restart); the governor resumes on its own |

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| Failure | What the governor does | What you see | What you do |
|---|---|---|---|
| The service stops answering (every request fails) | no served row means no reading: blind, as above | as above, and the service's own alert | the service's own incident; the governor has already stopped giving back and is waking what it parked |
| The feed lies (a reading that does not track the service) | the governor cannot know; it acts on the reading it is given | the dashboard's two response-time lines disagree (section 23.3) | turn the governor OFF until the feed is fixed; this is why the feed is checked before the governor watches (section 19.5) |
| The API server is unreachable or throttling | each decision that cannot read the cluster writes an `error` record (with the count of consecutive failures) and changes nothing; the fast checks record their own errors | `error` records; the provider's own control-plane status | nothing on the governor's side: it resumes when the API answers; parked machines stay usable meanwhile |
| A write is refused (the role, an admission policy, a conflict) | the command's failure is recorded as `refused` with its exit code; with `--max-nodes` set, as the cloud manifest sets it, the governor's top is unchanged, and it issues the count again at its next decision while the machines in service differ from it | `refused` records | read the reason; a policy refusal of a write the cloud mode needs means the policy is wrong (chapter 27); a role refusal means the grant is missing (chapter 15) |
| A person cordons a governed machine (maintenance) | the machine script leaves a machine someone else cordoned alone: it never uncordons it, never counts it in service or parked, and removes its own idle mark from it, if | the machine `SchedulingDisabled`; a `proprioception` drift while the cordoned machine still carries work | none needed; for a long maintenance, also remove the machine's `omni-role=work` label so the governor no longer sees it at all, and put the label back |

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| Failure | What the governor does | What you see | What you do |
|---|---|---|---|
| | any | | afterwards |
| The provider upgrades the cluster or a node pool (cordon, drain, surge machines) | as for a cordon; surge machines join open and are counted | the upgrade's own events | scale the governor to zero before the upgrade starts (its hand-back wakes everything) and back to one when the upgrade completes, so the upgrade runs exactly as it does without the governor |
| The cluster autoscaler deletes a parked, empty machine | nothing; that is the saving (section 25.1) | the machine gone; the next decision counts one fewer | nothing |
| The cluster autoscaler adds machines | they join open; the governor counts them at its next read | new machines | nothing |
| A spot or preemptible machine is reclaimed | as a machine failure; parked or open, it is gone | the provider's eviction notice | nothing on the governor's side |
| A descheduler evicts pods from parked machines | nothing; the descheduler is a second actor on the same machines | pods moved off machines with the `omnicompass.io/idle` taint | exclude the taint: the descheduler's `RemovePodsViolatingNodeTaints` plugin acts on `PreferNoSchedule` taints only when told to, and takes an `excludedTaints` list |
| Someone else removes the governor's taint, or uncordons a parked machine | the machine counts as open at the next decision; the governor may park it again | a `proprioception` drift; machines parked and unparked repeatedly | find the other writer (section 21.8); until there is one writer, turn the governor OFF |

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## 29.2 The drills

Each drill is run first on a non-production cluster, then in production in a quiet hour, by the people who will handle the failure for real, with the result recorded as the OFF switch drill is (section 21.3). The pass condition of every drill is the same: no pod waited for a place, no alert minute was caused, every setting was back at the operator's within the stated time, and the audit and the cluster show what this chapter says they show.

**Drill 1: the governor's process killed outright.** The watchdog's hand-back is the lease (section 21.2), and this is its test. From the watchdog's container, which shares the governor's process namespace, send `SIGKILL` to every governor the lease registry lists:

```
kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass -c watchdog -- python
    ↪  -c "
import glob, json, os, signal
for f in glob.glob('/tmp/omni-compass/running/*.json'):
    os.kill(json.load(open(f))['pid'], signal.SIGKILL)"
kubectl -n omni-compass logs deploy/omni-compass -c watchdog --tail=5
    ↪      # the 'handed back' record, ok: true
kubectl get nodes -l omni-role=work -o custom-columns=NAME:.metadata.n
    ↪ ame,TAINTS:.spec.taints[*].key
```

Pass: within 30 seconds of the kill, no `omnicompass.io/idle` taint remains, the watchdog's record reads `ok: true`, and the governor's container has restarted and is deciding again.

**Drill 2: the pod deleted.** `kubectl -n omni-compass delete pod -l app=omni-compass`. Pass: the old pod's audit ends with the hand-back; every parked machine is woken before it exits (within the 60-second grace period); the new pod is deciding within two minutes.

**Drill 3: the feed stopped.** Pause the probe without touching the service or replacing the pod: from the watchdog's container, which shares the pod's process namespace, stop the probe's process, and later let it continue:

```
PAUSE='import os, signal, sys
for p in os.listdir("/proc"):
    if p.isdigit() and b"latency_probe.py" in open("/proc/%s/cmdline"
    ↪ % p, "rb").read():
        os.kill(int(p), getattr(signal, sys.argv[1]))'
kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass -c watchdog -- python
```

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```
    ↪  -c "$PAUSE" SIGSTOP    # the feed stops
# ... three decision periods later ...
kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass -c watchdog -- python
    ↪  -c "$PAUSE" SIGCONT    # the feed resumes
```

Pass: within three decision periods every `authority` record shows the feed blind; no machine is parked while it is blind; parked machines are woken one per decision; after `SIGCONT` the feed's rows resume on the same clock and the governor reads it again.

**Drill 4: a write refused.** With the admission policies of section 27.4 in place, refuse the governor's next write by binding a policy that denies every node update from its service account for the drill's duration (a copy of `omni-compass-nodes` whose only validation is `false`). Pass: `refused` records appear; no other record changes; the service is untouched; when the drill policy is removed, the next decision's write lands.

**Drill 5: a maintenance cordon.** Cordon one parked machine and one open machine (`kubectl cordon <name>`). Pass: the governor's next decisions neither uncordon nor count either of them; the parked one loses its `omnicompass.io/idle` taint; the OFF switch drill run now leaves both cordoned. Uncordon them afterwards.

**Drill 6: the OFF switch under continuous delivery.** On a cluster whose governor is deployed by Argo CD or Flux, run the OFF switch drill exactly as the runbook writes it (section 28.4). Pass: the governor stays off until the holder turns it on, and the delivery controller does not start it again.

## 29.3 What the drill book is for

The drills prove three claims the installation makes to the people who run the cluster: that the governor can always be stopped, that its failure never strands a pod, and that every failure is visible in the audit with its cause. The records of the drills, kept with the installation record (section 15.7), are the evidence a reviewer asks for under "how do you know it fails safe?" (section 24.3), and the quarterly repetition of drills 1, 2 and 6 is part of day two (Appendix J).

CHAPTER 30

# A Complete Installation, Start to Finish

The chapters of this part each take one step in depth. This chapter is the whole path at once, on Azure Kubernetes Service, as one engineer would run it: every command in order, what each should print, and the gate each must pass. The same sequence runs on Google Kubernetes Engine and Amazon EKS with the provider commands of chapters 17 and 18 in place of the Azure ones; every Kubernetes command is the same on all three. The example service is a web shop's checkout, `checkout` in the namespace `shop`, with a line of

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400 ms at the 95th percentile, written down by its owner. Every value in angle brackets is the installation's own.

## 30.1 Day 0: the copy, the cluster and the service

```
# The copy (phase 0, chapter 33)
git clone <the licensed repository> omni-compass && cd omni-compass
python3 verify.py                        # ends: VERIFICATION: PASS
python3 tools/omni_version.py            # prints the engine version: r
    ↪ ecord it with the commit
git rev-parse HEAD

# The cluster (phase 1, section 16.2): a system pool of two machines,
    ↪ one work pool under the autoscaler
RG=shop-prod-rg; NAME=shop-prod; LOC=eastus; SIZE=Standard_D4s_v5
az group create -n $RG -l $LOC -o none
az aks create -g $RG -n $NAME -l $LOC --tier standard --node-count 2 -

    ↪ -node-vm-size Standard_D2s_v5 \
  --nodepool-name system --nodepool-taints CriticalAddonsOnly=true:NoS
    ↪ chedule --nodepool-labels omni-role=system \
  --cluster-autoscaler-profile scale-down-unneeded-time=10m scale-down
    ↪ -delay-after-add=10m scan-interval=10s \
  --generate-ssh-keys -o none

az aks nodepool add -g $RG --cluster-name $NAME -n work0 --mode User -
    ↪ -node-vm-size $SIZE --labels omni-role=work \
  --node-count 3 --enable-cluster-autoscaler --min-count 3 --max-count
    ↪  12 -o none
az aks get-credentials -g $RG -n $NAME
kubectl get nodes -L omni-role               # 2 system, 3 work
```

The system pool has two machines (section 29.1: the governor's pod must always have somewhere to go). The work pool's floor is 3 because the checkout spreads across three zones; its top is 12, the operator's cost ceiling. **Gate:** a test Deployment scaled past the pool and back shows Azure adding and deleting a machine (section 16.2).

The service's own autoscaler is the operator's and stays so: `kubectl -n shop get hpa checkout` shows its target, minimum and maximum, which are written into the installation record (section 15.7).

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## 30.2 Day 1: identity, image and watch

```
# Identity (phase 2, chapter 15): the namespace, the service account,
    ↪ the watch role; the restricted profile
kubectl apply -f deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml
kubectl label namespace omni-compass pod-security.kubernetes.io/enforc
    ↪ e=restricted
for verb in get list; do for r in nodes pods horizontalpodautoscalers

    ↪ deployments; do
  echo "$verb $r: $(kubectl auth can-i $verb $r --as=system:serviceacc
    ↪ ount:omni-compass:omni-compass -A)"; done; done
kubectl auth can-i patch nodes --as=system:serviceaccount:omni-compass
    ↪ :omni-compass       # no (not yet granted)

# The images (section 16.4), built from the verified copy and tagged w
    ↪ ith the version and the commit
ACR=shopprodacr; V=<version>-<commit>
az acr create -g $RG -n $ACR --sku Standard -o none && az aks update -
    ↪ g $RG -n $NAME --attach-acr $ACR -o none
az acr build -r $ACR -t omni-compass:$V -f deploy/Dockerfile .

az acr build -r $ACR -t omni-compass-cloud:$V -f deploy/Dockerfile.clo
    ↪ ud --build-arg BASE=$ACR.azurecr.io/omni-compass:$V .

# Watch (phase 3, section 16.5)
kubectl -n omni-compass set image deployment/omni-compass controller=$
    ↪ ACR.azurecr.io/omni-compass:$V

kubectl -n omni-compass rollout status deployment/omni-compass
kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass -- tail -n 3 /var/log
    ↪ /omni/audit.jsonl
```

The last command prints `decision` records, one a minute, each with `nodes_observed` and `nodes_recommended`, and no `write` record. **Gate:** at least one full cycle of the checkout's load watched (a week, because the shop's peak is weekly), and the platform owner agrees with what the governor would have done.

## 30.3 Day 2: the feed and the line

The checkout has one representative endpoint, so the probe is the feed (section 19.3). Its URL and the line go into the installation record, signed by the service owner. Before governing, the feed is checked on its own

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(section 19.5): the probe is run beside the watch Deployment for an hour, and its rows advance every five seconds, its 95th percentile tracks the shop's own monitoring of the same endpoint, and a stopped endpoint shows as failed rows.

At the same time the room is measured (chapter 25): two weeks of the sampling loop of section 25.3, from which the plan records where the room lives (here: the nights and the hours after the weekday peak), the billable room (the shop holds no reservation on this machine family) and the load the paired run will carry: a replay of one recorded day of checkout traffic, compressed no further than the autoscaler's ten-minute profile allows.

## 30.4 Days 3 to 7: the paired run

The paired run (phase 5, section 16.6) builds two identical clusters for each repetition, one native and one with Omni-Compass on top in the cloud mode, drives the same recorded day through both, and deletes both. Its receipt is read row by row (section 20.6), and before the installation proceeds it must show: the bill and the machine-hours reading GAIN or EVEN; response time, failed requests and alert minutes reading EVEN or GAIN; HPA replicas equal to native's within the noise. A LOSS row stops the installation until its cause is found in the wiring and the run is repeated (section 5.5). The receipt is signed by the service owner and by finance.

## 30.5 Day 8: hardening

```
# The admission policies (section 27.4) and their proof: eight answers
    ↪ , kept with the record
kubectl apply -f omni-compass-policies.yaml
SA=system:serviceaccount:omni-compass:omni-compass
kubectl --as=$SA label node <work machine> omni-test=1          # refu
    ↪ sed by omni-compass-nodes

# ... the remaining seven commands of section 27.4 ...

# The network policy (section 27.5), with this cluster's API server ad
    ↪ dress and the checkout's labels and port
kubectl get endpoints kubernetes -n default -o jsonpath='{.subsets[0].
    ↪ addresses[0].ip}'
```

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```
kubectl apply -f omni-compass-netpol.yaml

# The API server's own audit log to the workspace the platform team re
    ↪ ads (section 27.6)
az monitor diagnostic-settings create --name aks-audit --resource $(az
    ↪  aks show -g $RG -n $NAME --query id -o tsv) \
  --workspace <log-analytics-workspace-id> --logs '[{"category":"kube-
    ↪ audit-admin","enabled":true}]'
```

The image's signature rule (section 27.3) is applied by the platform team's existing admission control; the cloud image's digest is the one it allows in the `omni-compass` namespace.

## 30.6 Day 9: govern, with the dry run first

The governing manifest is the repository's, with this cluster's settings, a persistent volume for the audit, and the probe pointed at the checkout. Kept in the company's configuration repository as an overlay (section 28.3), its patch for this cluster is:

```
# The audit on a persistent volume (section 21.4) instead of the manif
    ↪ est's emptyDir
apiVersion: v1
kind: PersistentVolumeClaim
metadata: {name: omni-audit, namespace: omni-compass}
spec: {accessModes: [ReadWriteOnce], storageClassName: managed-csi, re
    ↪ sources: {requests: {storage: 5Gi}}}
---
# patch on Deployment omni-compass (JSON 6902)
- {op: replace, path: /spec/template/spec/volumes/0, value: {name: aud
    ↪ it, persistentVolumeClaim: {claimName: omni-audit}}}
- {op: replace, path: /spec/template/spec/containers/1/env/0/value, va
    ↪ lue: "http://checkout.shop.svc.cluster.local/"}
- {op: replace, path: /spec/template/spec/containers/0/env/1/value, va
    ↪ lue: "3"}     # MIN_NODES, the governor
- {op: replace, path: /spec/template/spec/containers/2/env/1/value, va
    ↪ lue: "3"}     # MIN_NODES, the watchdog
```

and the governor's command line, written whole (section 28.3), carries `--min-nodes 3 --max-nodes 12 --slo-ms 400` and, for the first day, `--dry-run`. Then:

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```
kubectl apply -f deploy/install/rbac-machines.yaml              # the
    ↪ machines role (section 15.3), approved in the change record
kubectl -n omni-compass delete deployment omni-compass           # the
    ↪  watch Deployment goes; the governing one replaces it
kubectl apply -k overlays/shop-prod                              # the
    ↪  governing Deployment, with --dry-run

kubectl -n omni-compass get pod -l app=omni-compass              # REA
    ↪ DY 3/3: governor, probe, watchdog
kubectl auth can-i patch nodes --as=system:serviceaccount:omni-compass
    ↪ :omni-compass       # yes
```

A day of the dry run's audit is read: every `write` record is marked `"dry_run": true` and asks for a count between 3 and the machines that exist, one from the last (Appendix J, phase 6). Then the change record's approved commit removes `--dry-run` from the overlay, the delivery controller applies it, and the first real write is read when it comes: a `verdict` record with `step allowed`, then a `write` record with `why: node pool size`, then the next decision's `authority` record, whose `proprioception` shows that the command landed. In the cluster, one work machine now carries the `omnicompass.io/idle:PreferNoSchedule` taint.

**Gate:** the OFF switch drilled by its holder in the form the runbook names (section 21.3, section 28.4 for a GitOps cluster): every parked machine woken and every mark removed within 60 seconds; the drill recorded.

## 30.7 Day 10 onward: the first month

| When | What is read | Expected |
|---|---|---|
| Every morning, first week | the dashboard of section 23.3 | machines parked overnight and woken before the morning's rise; the two response-time lines agree; no blind decisions |
| Each weekly peak | alert minutes on the checkout's line | none caused by the governor; any alert minute is traced with section 23.7 to its cause |
| End of week one | the drills of section 29.2, numbers 1, 2, 3 and 5 | each passes as written |
| End of month one | the provider's billing records for the work pool (section 23.5) against the same weeks before installation, with requests served beside them | machine-hours lower in the hours the plan found room (chapter 25); higher only where traffic was higher |

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| When | What is read | Expected |
|---|---|---|
| End of month one | the API server's audit against the governor's (section 27.6) | every patch by the service account matched by a `write` record |
| Every quarter | the OFF switch and drills 1, 2 and 6; the engine version against the receipts kept | as Appendix J, phase 7 |

## 30.8 What the installation record holds at the end

The record of section 15.7, complete: the verification receipt and the engine version and commit; the image digests, the software bill of materials, the scan and the signature; the grant as applied and its proof; the admission policies and their eight answers; the network policy and its proof; the line and its signature; the room and the plan; the paired receipt, signed; the governing command line as it runs; the change records of phases 2 and 6; and the records of every OFF switch drill and every failure drill. An installation whose record is complete can be audited by a person who was not there, which is the standard this manual holds every installation to.

CHAPTER 31

# Questions an Implementer Asks

The questions below are the ones platform teams ask in the first week, answered from the wiring as it stands. Each answer points to the section that holds the detail.

**Does Omni-Compass replace our cluster autoscaler or our HPA?** No. It sits on top of both and never replaces either (section 1.1). In the cloud mode it moves neither: the HPA keeps the operator's target, and the cluster autoscaler keeps making and deleting machines on its own schedule; the governor parks and wakes machines between them (chapter 20).

**Can it make our bill bigger?** In the cloud mode, no: it moves no pod autoscaler, so the pods are native's; it never asks the cloud for a machine, so the machines are native's or fewer. The bill can only fall or stay (section 20.1). Outside the cloud mode, on machines already paid for, the max may spend resource to buy work; that spending is shown as power given beside the work it bought, and it is never used in a cloud.

**Can it wake our on-call engineer?** It is built so that it should not: it acts on the reading as it climbs toward the line, a breach wakes a parked machine at the next decision, and nothing is given back while the line is at risk. The receipt counts alert minutes in both arms (section 20.6), and the aim in a cloud is none on the omni side; an alert minute there is a fault to find, never a cost to accept.

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**How fast does it act?** Its fast checks run every 5 seconds (a machine for pods that wait, a parked machine woken), three times as fast as the HPA's own 15-second check; its full decision runs every 15 seconds, the HPA's own pace (section 3.4). Native's own checks run underneath, untouched, whatever the governor's period.

**What happens if the governor crashes?** Nothing harmful. The watchdog puts every setting back from the records on the objects themselves (section 21.2); a parked machine never blocks a pod even before that, because its taint is `PreferNoSchedule`; and the native controllers carry the service as they did before the governor was installed.

**Does it need cloud credentials?** Not in the cloud mode (section 15.5). It acts through the Kubernetes API with a service account that can read the cluster and patch nodes and pods, and nothing else.

**Does it work with Karpenter, KEDA, the Vertical Pod Autoscaler or a descheduler?** Karpenter: yes, in place of the cluster autoscaler; consolidation removes a parked machine once it is empty (section 18.2). KEDA: yes; KEDA drives the HPA, and in the cloud mode the governor does not touch the HPA at all. The Vertical Pod Autoscaler: yes, if it does not also act on the nodes; it changes requests, which the governor reads. A descheduler that uncordons or rebalances nodes is a second writer of the setting the governor moves, and must be configured to leave tainted nodes alone (section 21.8).

**Can two governors run on one cluster for high availability?** No. One writer per setting is a rule (section 6.2), and the watchdog, not a second governor, is the availability story (section 21.2).

**How much does the governor itself cost?** One pod: a request of 50 millicores and 128 MiB, a limit of 500 millicores and 256 MiB, plus a probe container of 10 millicores and 32 MiB. Every receipt reports the governor's own processor use (the row "Omni's own CPU (cores), mean").

**What does it log, and is any of it sensitive?** Object names, counts, response-time statistics, its decisions and its reasons (section 21.4). No request payload and no personal data, which it never sees.

**Can we tune it?** The factory tune is the engine as shipped (section 4.1); an installation writes the settings of section 3.4 (the line, the floor, the dial, the ceiling of a growing lever) from its own system. A changed tune is the installation's own configuration, and its receipts are its own (section 4.7).

**How do we know it is working?** The audit shows every decision and every write with its reason; the receipt of a paired run on the company's own cluster shows what it did against native, row by row, read GAIN, EVEN or LOSS (chapters 11 and 11). An installation whose receipt it has not seen is not yet an installation.

**What if our receipt shows a LOSS?** Suspect the wiring first (section 5.5): the feed, the line, the grant, the autoscaler profile, a second writer. Fix it and run the receipt again. A LOSS is never accepted and never cut from the receipt.

**What do we need to keep for an audit by our own risk team?** The installation record of section 15.7: the engine version and verification receipt, the grant and its proof, the governor's command line, the signed line, the audit, and every drill of the OFF switch.

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**Can we run it on our own machines, not a cloud?** Yes: chapter 8 wires every stack the governor knows, from a cluster on the company's own racks to a data center's cooling and power. There, the machines are already paid for, and the max (the most work from the same machines) is the default.

PART SEVEN

# License and Your Copy

*The terms the software and this manual are licensed under, and how to verify a copy before it is installed.*

CHAPTER 32

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(Appendix S) and the security policy (Appendix T); the disclosures, declarations and disclaimers stand in the front matter. Where a paper and this chapter differ, the paper governs.

CHAPTER 33

# Verifying Your Copy

Before a copy is installed anywhere, and again after every upgrade, it is checked in three ways, and an installation proceeds only when all three pass:

1. **The whole check.** `python3 verify.py` runs every test and every fingerprint check and ends with `VERIFICATION: PASS` or `FAIL`. A copy that fails it is not installed.
2. **The engine version.** `python3 tools/omni_version.py` prints the engine version the copy carries, or every file that differs from it. Receipts made on one version are never read against another (chapter 13).
3. **The seal and the manifest.** `python3 tools/seal.py --check` confirms that every sealed file is the file that was sealed, and the release manifest (`RELEASE_MANIFEST.json`) names the commit, the engine and the verification receipt the copy was released with. A copy whose files do not match its manifest is not the release it claims to be.

A reader holding any one of the three can tell whether the files in front of them are the files a receipt was made on. Every copy, export or printout carries the legal notice at its head and foot, with `LICENSE`, `NOTICE` and `DISCLOSURES.md` beside it.

# Back Matter

BACK MATTER

# Glossary

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Authority | how far the governor lets a muscle move this decision; adding is always allowed, giving back needs calm and a clean service record (chapter 6) |

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| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Band | a reading's or a knob's safe range |
| Card | a muscle's own settings, found for it and kept only where it was never behind native; the factory tune for that muscle (section 4.3) |
| Dial | max (the default) or save (the tune-down), the same switch on every governor (section 4.2) |
| Factory tune | the engine as The Omni-Compass LLC tuned and ships it: every muscle on its own card or the engine's setting (section 4.1) |
| Line | the limit the service must meet, from the operator's own objectives (`--slo-ms`) |
| Engine version | the engine as fingerprinted file by file; a receipt belongs to the version its commit carries (chapter 13) |
| Compass | the band seen as a position from 0 (calm) to 1 (the line), with a 5% cushion at each edge and the centre where the reading is held (section 4.4) |
| EVEN | Equalized, Verified baseline, Equilibrium, Neutral: native and Omni could not be told apart (the same, or no difference beyond the noise); the key, front matter |
| GAIN | Growth, Advantage, Improvement, Net-positive: a gauge moved the way its declared aim asks, against native; a resource cut is a GAIN; the key, front matter |
| GAIN in all three of our runs | the same sign in all three runs (A, B, C), every 95% interval clear of zero, and that sign a GAIN for the gauge's aim |
| LOSS | Leakage, Off-track, Setback, Subpar: a gauge moved against its declared aim (less work, a longer wait, more misses); it should never appear, and where it does it is shown, its cause found and fixed; the key, front matter |
| Power given | a resource spent or held that rose: what Omni put in to buy the work and speed beside it; shown, never called a loss |
| Cover | a knob's hard range; every write is clipped to it |
| Cushion | the 5% at each edge of the compass, 10% in all |
| DEX-YLL-1 | the company's number, 1-888-DEX-YLL-1, read in order as the engine runs: DEX, Data Exchange (the input, the two-way plug); YLL, Yield Limit Line (the boundary: every muscle up to its own yield limit, never past it); 1, one closed loop (the output; in code 1 is |

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| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| | true, in science 1 is unity) |
| Fail up | the return to full capacity the moment service crosses the wall or a sense goes blind |
| Governor | the process that reads, decides and writes; Omni-Compass |
| Muscle | any machine, service or controller Omni-Compass reads and sets |
| Native | the system as it runs without Omni-Compass |
| No difference beyond the noise | an interval over zero in at least one run: native and omni could not be told apart; the result, stated as such |
| Plug | the two-way connection to one muscle: read, write, read back, restore |
| Pool (Azure) | one machine family under Azure's autoscaler with its own ceiling; several pools make the fleet |
| Profile | service (the default) or batch: what the pedals do with a pile of work (section 4.5) |
| Race | full speed at once while work waits, so a burst is never served slowly |
| Yield limit line | a muscle's own limit, read live: Omni-Compass takes it right up to the line and never past it, as an engineer loads a material up to its yield limit, the most it carries and still springs back unharmed |
| Speed floor | the clock a card reaches on its own while busy, learned from its own meter; the governor never sets the ceiling under it |
| Receipt | the paired record of native against Omni-Compass for one run |
| Snapshot | a knob's value read once before the first write; the restore point |
| The runs disagree | runs clear of the noise point different ways; the test is unstable on that measure and is looked into |
| Wire check | the test that proves every wire follows, reads back and returns before anything runs |
| Work per energy | work done divided by energy used |
| Work inside the line | the requests, transactions or messages a second answered within the response line; the product number on every real stack |
| One pedal | push for more, lift off for less, idle (the pedal lifted all the way), reset (everything back to native): how the governor moves capacity under autopilot |

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| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Cruise | every machine in service while work waits for a place, held without second-guessing until the line has been empty for two decisions |
| Idle at once | the work done and demand at zero: the pedal lifted all the way in one move, every safety check still holding |
| Kill switch | security only: one switch in a human hand that turns every governor on the machine off at once; never the reset |
| Lease | the record every governor renews each decision; a lease older than its limit, or a dead process, makes the watchdog hand back for it |
| Watchdog | the service beside the governors that hands back for any governor that died or hung without doing it itself |
| Verdict, paired trial | the trial on the muscle itself that allows a slow knob to move only where the cost is within 2%; "left native" where no step passes (section 1.2) |
| Tuning case | the one workload or case the rules were fixed on; shown in every receipt and never counted |
| Untouched case | a workload or case the rules were applied to unchanged; the judged rows |
| Amendment | a change to the written rules of a paired run after they were written, with its time and reason; one made after a result was seen says so |
| Dwell | the seconds after a knob moves during which the law will not move it back |
| Notch | the smallest step a knob moves in one decision (one consumer, 8 MB of cache, one tap) |
| Evidence class P, L, S | a physical meter; live software with no meter; a model (chapter 12) |
| Handed back | the knob read back at the operator's value at the end of an arm; every receipt says whether every arm was |
| Working set | the records a workload actually touches over a window; a cache benchmark measures nothing unless the working set reaches the cache |
| Full-cache gate | the MongoDB and Redis rule: slow reads grow the cache only while the cache is full (nine tenths used), because a miss in a cache with room to spare is not the cache's to mend |

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| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Buffer pool | InnoDB's cache of table and index pages, the one memory setting every MySQL operator sizes; resized online by the server in whole chunks |
| Chunk | the unit in which MySQL resizes its buffer pool (128 MB as shipped); the knob's notch on that stack |
| Page cache | the operating system's own cache of file contents; where the data fits in it, a storage-engine miss is a read from memory and a decompression, not a disk read, and the gain available to the cache knob is smaller |
| Cloud mode | the governor on top of a public cloud's cluster at the tune-down, moving machines alone: no pod autoscaler moved, no processor conveyed, no power capped, no machine asked for; the bill can only fall or stay (chapter 20) |
| Parked machine | a machine the governor has closed to new work with the taint `omnicompass.io/idle:PreferNoSchedule`; it stays Ready and usable, its pods are marked first to go, and the cloud's autoscaler deletes it once it is empty |
| Taint, `PreferNoSchedule` | a mark on a machine that the scheduler treats as a preference against placing new pods there, never as a refusal; the only taint the governor writes |
| Cordon | a machine marked unschedulable (`kubectl cordon`), by a person, an upgrade or a repair; the governor never cordons or uncordons a machine, and leaves a cordoned machine alone |
| Pod deletion cost | the annotation `controller.kubernetes.io/pod-deletion-cost`, by which a ReplicaSet removes the lowest-cost pods first when it scales down; the governor marks a parked machine's pods with it so that they leave first |
| Cluster autoscaler | the cloud's own controller that adds a machine when pods cannot be placed and deletes a machine that has been unneeded for its configured time; native, never changed by the governor (Karpenter plays the same part on Amazon) |
| HorizontalPodAutoscaler (HPA) | the Kubernetes controller that sets a service's replica count from its pods' measured use against a target; native, and in the cloud mode never moved |

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| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Room | the machine-hours a pool holds above what its pods' requests need; the upper bound on any machine lever's saving, measured before any run (section 25.2) |
| Billable room | the room above the machines a commitment already pays for: the part of the room that can reach the bill (section 25.2) |
| Feed | the file of rows `elapsed_seconds,latency_ms,ok` the governor reads its response times from: the probe's, or an adapter's (chapters 19 and 23) |
| Blind | a sense with no fresh reading (the feed silent for twice its window, or no served request in it); the governor gives nothing back while any sense is blind |
| Lease | the record each governor renews every decision; a lease out of date, or a process gone, makes the watchdog hand back for it (section 21.2) |
| Watchdog | the process that hands every setting back for a governor that died or hung; in a cluster, a container in the governor's own pod (section 21.2) |
| Proprioception | the governor's reading of whether its last command landed: the drift between the machines it commanded and the machines in service, in each `authority` record |
| Dry run | `--dry-run`: the governor decides and records every command it would run, marked `"dry_run": true`, and writes none |
| Admission policy | a rule the API server applies to every write after the role allows it; section 27.4 binds the governor's writes to its own taint and its own pod mark |
| System pool | the pool of machines that carries the cluster's add-ons and the governor, tainted so no workload lands there, never governed |
| Work pool | a pool labelled `omni-role=work`, under the cloud's autoscaler, whose machines the governor may park |
| OFF switch of record | the form of the OFF switch the runbook names for a cluster: scaling the governor to zero, or a commit to Git where continuous delivery reconciles it (sections 21.3 and 28.4) |

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APPENDIX

# Appendix A. Command Reference

| Task | Command | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Verify the copy | `python3 verify.py` (ends `VERIFICATION: PASS`) | | | |
| Which engine version a checkout or a commit carries | `python3 tools/omni_version.py [--commit <sha>]` | | | |
| Seal check | `python3 tools/seal.py --check` | | | |
| Evaluate without touching anything: the organisms, modelled | `python3 tools/run_scale.py --runs N --scale K --out <dir>` | | | |
| Evaluate without touching anything: the two-wire card, modelled | `python3 tools/run_gpu_card.py <dir>` | | | |
| Kubernetes, watch (read-only) | `kubectl apply -f deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml` (it runs `--mode observe`) | | | |
| Kubernetes, govern | `python3 -m omni_controller.controller --mode target | nodepool --latency-file <feed> --slo-ms <line> [--law compass] [--dial max | save ]` | | |
| A response-time feed against any HTTP endpoint | `python3 scripts/latency_probe.py <url> <out.csv>` | | | |

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| Task | Command | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| GPU wire check | `sudo python3 tools/gpu_wire_check.py --gpu 0` (must end `WIRED RIGHT`) | | | |
| GPU governor, two wires | `sudo python3 -m omni_controller.gpu_compass --mode watch | cap --gpus 0 --latency-file <feed> --slo-ms <line> [--dial max | save ]` | |
| GPU, the whole paired run in one command | `sudo nohup bash scripts/gpu_rented_run.sh > run.log 2>&1 &` | | | |
| The processor's clock under its meter, the paired run | `sudo bash scripts/cpu_power_run.sh` | | | |
| Kubernetes paired runs, then the receipt | `scripts/kind_paired.sh`, then `python3 tools/live_reps.py <dir>` | | | |
| The three-run table (Kubernetes, cloud) | `python3 tools/confirm_abc.py "<title>" <run A dir> <run B dir> <run C dir> --out <table.md>` | | | |
| The three-run table (pooler, broker, cache, storage engine, buffer pool) | `tools/pgbench_abc.py`, `tools/kafka_abc.py`, `tools/redis_abc.py`, `tools/ycsb_abc.py`, `tools/sysbench_abc.py`, the same arguments | | | |
| OFF, one muscle (Kubernetes) | `touch /tmp/omni.kill` | | | |
| OFF, one card | `sudo touch /tmp/omni-gpu-kill` | | | |
| The whole harness OFF, ON, status, watchdog | `python3 tools/omni_switch.py off | on | status | watchdog ` |

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| Task | Command | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cloud mode: the machines role, then the governing Deployment (dry run first) | `kubectl apply -f deploy/install/rbac-machines.yaml`, then `kubectl apply -f deploy/install/omni-compass-cloud.yaml` (chapter 20) | | | |
| Cloud mode: the cloud image | `docker build -f deploy/Dockerfile.cloud --build-arg BASE=<registry>/omni-compass:<version> -t <registry>/omni-compass-cloud:<version> .` | | | |
| Cloud mode: OFF, the switch of record | `kubectl -n omni-compass scale deployment/omni-compass --replicas=0` (section 21.3) | | | |
| Cloud mode: OFF from inside the pod | `kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass -c controller -- touch /tmp/omni.kill` | | | |
| Cloud mode: the grant, as the governor sees it | `kubectl auth can-i <verb> <resource> --as=system:serviceaccount:omni-compass:omni-compass -A` (section 15.4) | | | |
| Cloud mode: machines parked now | `kubectl get nodes -l omni-role=work -o custom-columns=NAME:.metadata.name,TAINTS:.spec.taints[*].key` | | | |

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| Task | Command | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cloud mode: the last decisions | `kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass -c controller -- tail -n 20 /var/log/omni/audit.jsonl` | | | |
| Planning: the room on a cluster | the sampling loop and the arithmetic of section 25.3 | | | |
| A feed from the company's own Prometheus | `python3 tools/prom_feed.py --prometheus <url> --served <q> --failed <q> --quantile <q> --out <feed>` (section 23.8) | | | |
| The paired run on a cloud, from GitHub | the `aks-metered`, `gke-metered` or `eks-metered` workflow (Appendix N) | | | |

APPENDIX

# Appendix B. The Files an Installation Touches

| Path | What it is for |
|---|---|
| `verify.py`, `tools/omni_version.py`, `tools/seal.py`, `RELEASE_MANIFEST.json` | checking the copy before it is installed (chapter 33) |
| `deploy/Dockerfile` | the container image: non-root, read-only root filesystem, no Linux capabilities |
| `deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml` | the watch-mode install with a read-only identity (level 1) |

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| Path | What it is for |
|---|---|
| `deploy/install/rbac-machines.yaml` | the cloud mode's machines role: patch nodes and patch pods, nothing else (section 15.3) |
| `deploy/install/omni-compass-cloud.yaml` | the cloud mode's governing Deployment: the governor, its probe and its watchdog in one pod, shipped with `--dry-run` (chapter 20, Appendix I) |
| `deploy/Dockerfile.cloud` | the cloud image: the shipped image with `jq`, the machine script, the probe, the Prometheus feed adapter and the switch tool |
| `scripts/kind_nodepool.sh` | the machine script: keeps `{n}` machines in service by the idle taint alone; never creates, deletes, cordons or uncordons a machine, and never moves a pod |
| `tools/prom_feed.py` | the response-time feed from the company's own Prometheus (section 23.8) |
| `deploy/rbac-target.yaml`, `deploy/kind/rbac-omni.yaml` | the permissions of levels 2 and 3, exactly the verbs each level needs |
| `scripts/latency_probe.py` | the response-time feed against any HTTP endpoint |
| `scripts/kind_paired.sh`, `tools/live_reps.py`, `tools/confirm_abc.py` | the paired runs, the receipt and the three-run table on Kubernetes |
| `tools/gpu_wire_check.py`, `scripts/gpu_rented_run.sh`, `tools/gpu_workload.py` | the card's wire check, its paired run, and a workload that writes the card's own time per request |
| `scripts/cpu_power_run.sh` | the processor's paired run on bare metal |
| `tools/omni_switch.py` | the master switch, the status and the watchdog (chapter 9) |
| `realms/catalog_v5.csv`, `realms/muscle_cards_v5.csv`, `docs/MUSCLE_CATALOG.md` | every muscle, its wiring and its own card (Appendix E) |
| `docs/AZURE_SETUP.md`, `docs/GOOGLE_SETUP.md`, `docs/AMAZON_SETUP.md` | each cloud's account and its secrets, click by click (Appendices F to H) |
| `.github/workflows/aks-metered.yml`, `gke-metered.yml`, `eks-metered.yml`, `aks-metered-full.yml` | the paired runs on each cloud, from GitHub (Appendix N) |

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| Path | What it is for |
|---|---|
| `LICENSE`, `NOTICE`, `DISCLOSURES.md`, `SECURITY.md` | the license, the notices, every declaration and disclaimer, and how to report a security issue |

APPENDIX

# Appendix C. The Gauges

Every gauge in a receipt, where it comes from, and whether it is measured or modelled:

| Gauge | Source | Measured or modelled | Its aim |
|---|---|---|---|
| work inside the response line (requests, transactions or messages a second answered within the line) | the probe's own records, pgbench's log, the consumers' records, the application's records | measured | higher; the product number |
| response time, mean, median, 95th and 99th percentile | the same | measured | lower |
| time over the response line (share of samples) | the same, against the written line | measured | lower |
| failed requests, lost messages | the same | measured | lower; any increase is marked |
| alert minutes: whole minutes whose 95th percentile, failed requests counted over, was over the line | the probe's own records, minute by minute | measured | lower: the minutes an on-call page would be open |
| settings commands the governor wrote on its own | the governor's audit | measured | shown, not judged (no person touched either arm) |

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| Gauge | Source | Measured or modelled | Its aim |
|---|---|---|---|
| the governor's additions decided while the service was still inside its line (% of its additions) | the governor's audit | measured | shown, not judged |
| worker machines in service, mean; node-hours | the cluster's own node records every 15 s | measured (machine-hours on a local cluster; the provider's own count in a cloud) | lower; a rise is power given |
| compute bill at list price | the provider's own machine count × list price per family | measured (a real bill) | lower; a rise is power given |
| energy (Wh), the standby model (in the receipts, "parked-worker energy": a parked machine still drawing its idle power) | a declared formula over the machines in service | **modelled**, said so on every line | lower; a rise is power given |
| energy, the machine's own meter | the processor's RAPL counters, a card's own power reading, a site meter | measured (class P) | lower; a rise is power given |
| host CPU busy; host CPU-seconds; CPU-seconds per 1,000 units inside the line | `/proc/stat` of the real machine under the run | measured | lower |
| Omni's own CPU (cores), mean | the governor's audit (its process and every command it ran) | measured | shown beside the receipt |
| connections held open, consumers running, memory ceiling held, cache size held | the pooler's, the group's, the cache's and the server's own reports | measured | lower; a rise is power given |
| cache hit rate; consumer lag | Redis's INFO; the consumers' records | measured | higher; lower |

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| Gauge | Source | Measured or modelled | Its aim |
|---|---|---|---|
| pages read into a cache, the cache's miss share | the server's own counters | measured | shown, not judged |
| HPA replicas, pods started, pod start wait | the API server's own records | measured | shown, not judged except pod start wait (lower) |
| pods waiting for a place (pending), mean | the API server's own pod records | measured | lower: work with no machine to run on |
| CPU limits conveyed; conveyance holds (`convey: held`); quota lines (`quota`) | the governor's audit | measured | shown, not judged: what the processor lever did and what held it (section 6.5) |
| seconds from a kill to every setting back at the operator's | the harness polling the system once a second from the kill | measured | lower; past 60 s marked; never, INVALID |
| handed back (every arm) | the knob read back at the end of the arm | measured | yes in every arm, or the run is invalid |

**Three rules for reading any gauge in this appendix.** A measured gauge is one the system under test, or the host's own kernel, reported about itself; a modelled gauge is one computed from a declared formula over measured inputs, and every receipt says which it is on the line itself. A resource gauge (machines, connections, consumers, memory, cache) is always read against an aim of lower, even where the governor's purpose was to add the resource to buy service, so that a gain bought with a resource is shown as power given in the same receipt. And a gauge marked "shown, not judged" never enters a reading; it is there so that a reader can see what the governor did (how often it moved, how many pages it read, how many pods it started), not to be counted for or against it.

APPENDIX

# Appendix D. Troubleshooting

| Symptom | Cause | Fix |
|---|---|---|
| Wire check `FAIL 3 up wire (lock)` | the driver or VM refuses clock locking | use bare metal or full passthrough; or run the one-wire governor |

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| Symptom | Cause | Fix |
|---|---|---|
| Wire check `FAIL 3 up wire (follows down)` | the card ignores the ceiling | update the driver; check for another management agent holding clocks |
| Wire check `FAIL 4 down wire` | the power limit is refused or capped by the board | check `nvidia-smi -q -d POWER`; run as root |
| `another copy of this test is already running` | a second copy was started | wait for the first or reboot; start once |
| `something else is using the GPU` | another process holds the card | stop it; the paired run must run alone |
| Governor exit 5 | another writer changed a knob | find the other controller; Omni-Compass left its value alone (section 6.2) |
| Governor exit 3 | a restore did not read back | restore by hand (`nvidia-smi -rgc`, `-pl <start>`); investigate before running again |
| `decision failed (n in a row)` | the cluster API is unreachable | turn it OFF; native runs on |
| Energy saved but p95 slower than native | the card served bursts below its own clock, or the lid sat under its own draw | read section 5.5; in the audit compare `telemetry.clock_mhz` while busy with `native_busy_clock_mhz`, and `want_w` with `native_busy_draw_w` |
| Fail-up in most decisions | `--slo-ms` set too low for the workload, or a stale feed read as blind | set `--slo-ms` from the workload's own target; check the feed's age (section 6.3) |
| No saving at all, service unchanged | the card is saturated almost all the time (it races), or the dial is at the max | expected: the max spends where it buys work; the tune-down (section 4.2) saves in the quiet stretches |
| Kubernetes: no machine ever given back | the dial is at the max (no machine below the cluster's own is given back), or the release gate refuses (its reason is in the audit) | expected at the max; at the tune-down read `node_gate.reason` in the audit and check `--slo-ms` and the latency feed |

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| Symptom | Cause | Fix |
|---|---|---|
| A pooler's clock reads calm while users wait | the pooler cannot see a client waiting behind its own schedule | wire the queue share beside the service time and read the larger (section 8.2) |
| Broker: consumers climb to the cover and stay | messages wait at every step (the producer is past the group's capacity) | check the offered rate against the group's measured capacity in the run's log |
| Cache: the ceiling grows while little memory is used | cold misses read as pressure | the full-cache gate is the rule (used ≥ 90% of the ceiling); check `used_mb` beside `maxmemory_mb` in the run's log |
| Cache: the ceiling never grows | the working set fits the operator's ceiling | expected: a cache that fits has nothing for the ceiling to mend, and the row reads inside the noise |
| Storage-engine cache: the cache never fills, whatever the load, and omni reads as a free memory saving | the requests concentrate on a few hot records, or the run asks for records the load did not write, so the reads are served from the index | a result that flatters the governor is the first thing to suspect: check the bytes in the cache against its size; draw requests over the whole key space and use the same key order in load and run; a knob with nothing to do is not a saving |
| Storage-engine cache or buffer pool: the governor only ever reads calm | the line is set far above the stack's own latencies | set the line on the tuning case's own figures so that a hit is calm and a full-cache miss is slow, and write the figures down before any counted run |
| Buffer pool: not handed back at the end of an arm | the server was still carrying out a shrink and ignored the restore | the plug waits for the resize and writes again (section 8.8); check the restore record in the arm's receipt |
| A three-run table heads itself with a warning | a run's commit is not the engine version it claims, or the three are not separate runs | run `tools/omni_version.py --commit <sha>` on each; make the table only from runs on one engine version |

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| **Cloud: the governor's pod shows `2/3` or restarts its watchdog** | **the pod was applied without `shareProcessNamespace: true`, or the watchdog lacks the shared `/tmp`** | **apply the manifest as shipped (Appendix I); a watchdog that cannot see the governor's process judges it dead and hands back over it (section 21.2)** |
|---|---|---|
| Cloud: parked machines are woken every few seconds, then parked again | the watchdog runs in a separate pod, or a second governor runs on the cluster | one governor, its watchdog in its own pod (section 21.2); `kubectl get pods -A -l app=omni-compass` must list exactly one pod |
| Cloud: the pod is refused at admission with a Pod Security message | the namespace enforces a profile the pod does not meet, or a later edit loosened the pod | the shipped pod meets `restricted` (section 27.3); compare the applied pod with Appendix I |
| OpenShift: the pod is refused with `unable to validate against any security context constraint` | `restricted-v2` refuses the fixed user 10001 | grant `nonroot-v2` to the service account (section 26.3) |
| Cloud: every decision shows the feed blind | the probe cannot reach the service (its URL, a network policy, the service's port), or the adapter's queries return nothing | `kubectl -n omni-compass logs deploy/omni-compass -c probe` (or `-c feed`); test the URL from the pod; check the network policy (section 27.5) and, for the adapter, run each query in the metrics system's own console |
| Cloud: `trial abandoned (too little work)` in most `verdict` records | the feed is thinner than twenty rows a minute, or the service is idle | densify the feed (section 23.1); at an idle service, nothing is given back on trial, by design |
| Cloud: `step refused: the muscle is slower there` in most `verdict` records | the service is slower without the machine | the governor is right to keep it; the pool has no room at this load (section 25.2) |
| Cloud: the governor parks nothing for days and its trials are never begun | the pool already holds only what the pods' requests need with the governor's spare, or the floor is the pool | read N[gov] from the room sampler (section 25.3); EVEN on the bill is then the honest receipt |

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| **Cloud: the governor's pod shows `2/3` or restarts its watchdog** | **the pod was applied without `shareProcessNamespace: true`, or the watchdog lacks the shared `/tmp`** | **apply the manifest as shipped (Appendix I); a watchdog that cannot see the governor's process judges it dead and hands back over it (section 21.2)** |
|---|---|---|
| Cloud: `refused` records with code 1 on every park | the machines role is not bound, or an admission policy refuses the taint | `kubectl auth can-i patch nodes --as=system:serviceaccount:omni-compass:omni-compass`; the policy's message names the rule (section 27.4) |
| Cloud: a parked machine is never deleted though its pods are gone | the cluster autoscaler's unneeded time is long, a DaemonSet or a pod it will not move remains, or a PodDisruptionBudget allows no disruption | read the autoscaler's own status (its config map or events, `kubectl -n kube-system describe configmap cluster-autoscaler-status`) for the machine's reason (section 25.4) |
| Cloud: the audit is empty after a restart | the audit was on the pod's `emptyDir` | mount a persistent volume at `/var/log/omni` and ship the file (section 21.4) |
| Cloud: the governor starts again minutes after it was scaled to zero | a continuous-delivery controller restored Git's replica count | make the OFF switch a Git change, or tell the controller to ignore the replica count (section 28.4) |
| Cloud: HPA replicas differ from native's in a cloud receipt | an autoscaler was moved, which the cloud mode never does | check the command line for `--sensed none/none` and the absence of `--cap-deployments` and `--power-cmd` (section 20.3); a run with them is not in the cloud mode |
| Cloud: the cloud image build fails at `FROM` | the base image argument was not given | pass `--build-arg BASE=<registry>/omni-compass:<version>` (section 20.4) |

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APPENDIX

# Appendix E. The Muscles: What Each Is For, and How It Is Wired

A **muscle** is one setting on one machine that already has its own control: a replica target, a node pool's size, a GPU's clock ceiling, a chiller's setpoint, a battery's reserve, a joint's effort. Omni-Compass does not replace that control. It reads the machine's meters and, at its default, the max, moves the setting the machine already accepts toward the machine's own limit for the most work, never past it and never below native, through a plug that reads the setting once before the first write, reads back every write, steps aside if another controller moves it, and walks it back to native at the end. A knob native already runs at the top of its range is at its limit on native and is left there.

This chapter lists all 1107 muscles of the v5 catalog (`realms/catalog_v5.csv`); each run records its engine separately. For each one it says what kind of machine it is, which of the four kinds of knob it is, what Omni-Compass reads and does with it, how such a muscle is reached in a real stack, and which organisms it belongs to. The plants behind the benchmark numbers are models of these machines (evidence class **S**); a muscle in this list is wired on a real system only through the levels and the checks of the manual (chapters 4 and 6). See `DISCLOSURES.md`.

## E.1 How to read an entry

**The four kinds of knob.**

- **capacity**: how much of the machine is in service (replicas, instances, units, speed). At the max Omni-Compass pushes it to the machine's own limit for the most work, never past it and never below native.
- **admission**: what is let in (queues, rate limits, admission control). Native already lets everything in: the knob is at its limit on native, and Omni-Compass reads it and leaves it native.
- **power**: the power share or limit the machine may draw. Native already runs it at full: at its limit on native, read and left native.
- **setpoint**: the target the machine's own loop holds (a temperature, a reserve, a process value). At the max a room is cooled ahead of the heat and a battery's charge is held for its line, inside the safe band, never behind native on its line.

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**The five kinds of plant.** Every muscle is modelled on one of five plants, each with its own service reading and lever:

| Plant | What it is | What Omni-Compass reads | What Omni-Compass moves |
|---|---|---|---|
| `compute_pool` | a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs | how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half) | the capacity it may use: its replica or instance count (through its autoscaler's target or floor), its power share, or one unit given back through the release gate |
| `thermal_zone` | a data hall or building zone cooled by chillers, air handlers or fans | its temperature against its limit | its supply setpoint (colder is more cooling), its power share, or one cooling unit given back when the room has margin |
| `energy_storage` | a battery, UPS or microgrid store with a load and a grid connection | its draw on the grid connection and its reserve | its reserve setpoint (how much charge it holds back); its power limit is left native |
| `motion_axis` | a motor-driven axis: a robot joint, a flight-control surface, a reaction wheel, a traction motor | its tracking error and its load | its speed and effort share, or its power share |
| `process_loop` | a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint | how far the process sits from its band | its setpoint within its safe band, its actuator range, or its power share |

**Every muscle its own card.** The brain is one, its settings each muscle's own. A muscle's card holds the settings the max uses for that muscle (a machine pool: how full it runs on its forecast before it calls for more, and how many decisions of history it reads; a battery: how many wobbles of margin it keeps under its line, and, wired by its power, how long it reads its line before it holds and how much of it it keeps clear). The cards were found by an automatic search over every muscle on the development seeds, today's global setting always one of the choices, and kept only where the card beat the global setting beyond the noise on two separate sets of seeds and on no seed under any load fell behind native: never over its line more often, never less work, never its line cleared later (`tools/tune_cards.py`, `realms/muscle_cards_v5.csv`, `results/cards_v5/`). Inside a body, a battery wired by its power keeps the body's own margins on its line. 364 muscles carry a card of their own; every other muscle runs the global setting (machines started at 95% full, the last 20 decisions read, 3.09 wobbles of margin on a battery's line, 5% of it kept clear). Each muscle's card is in the last column of its family's table.

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**The organisms.** The 1107 muscles build seven organisms: the spine (267 muscles, every muscle that sits in all four realms: the base every stack runs on, as an operating system is the base of every program), each of the four realms (every muscle whose realm list includes it, the spine among them), the four stacked with every duplicate kept (1,908), and the whole tower with every muscle once (1107). Each is run native and with Omni-Compass on top of native (`docs/THE_SPINE.md`, `docs/REALMS.md`).

| Organism | Muscles |
|---|---|
| The spine, the muscles every stack runs on | 267 |
| Compute / AI / Cloud | 540 |
| Physics / Robotics / Autonomous | 404 |
| Energy / Facility / Industrial | 480 |
| Distribution / Specialized | 484 |
| The four stacked, every duplicate kept | 1,908 |
| The whole tower, every muscle once | 1107 |

**How a muscle is reached in a real stack.** The class of machine decides the wire:

| Class of machine | What it is | The wire in a real stack |
|---|---|---|
| `batch` | batch and queued jobs | the job queue (Kubernetes Jobs, Slurm, Spark) |
| `batch_reactor` | a GMP batch reactor, fermenter or food process | the batch control system (ISA-88, OPC UA) |
| `building` | a building zone | the building management system |
| `chamber` | a controlled chamber (clean room, kiln, reactor) | the PLC or DCS |
| `clinical` | clinical systems: imaging archives, records, interface engines, monitoring gateways | the application's own scaling and admission settings (Kubernetes, the vendor console) |
| `commerce` | a customer-facing service with bursts | the Kubernetes API |
| `cpu_host` | a CPU host whose clock and power can be set | Linux cpufreq and RAPL |
| `data_hall` | a data hall cooling plant | the building management system (BACnet, Modbus) or its command line |
| `database` | a database cluster | the database operator (replicas, connection pools) |

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| Class of machine | What it is | The wire in a real stack |
|---|---|---|
| `district_heat` | a district heating or cooling network | the network control system and substation controllers (Modbus, M-Bus) |
| `elevator_hoist` | an elevator or escalator drive and its group control | the lift controller and destination dispatch (modelled only) |
| `ev_traction` | an electric vehicle traction motor | the vehicle's motor controller (CAN; modelled only) |
| `fabric` | a high-speed fabric (RDMA, DPU, SmartNIC) | the fabric manager's API |
| `facility` | a facility battery behind the meter | the energy management system |
| `feeder_voltage` | a distribution feeder's voltage | the distribution management system (IEC 61850, DNP3; modelled only) |
| `flight_axis` | a flight-control axis | the flight controller (modelled only) |
| `gpu` | GPU serving with a response-time target | nvidia-smi (clock ceiling and power limit) or the serving autoscaler |
| `gpu_batch` | GPU training and batch work | nvidia-smi, the job scheduler's pause and resume |
| `hospital` | a hospital's critical rooms (operating rooms, isolation, pharmacy, imaging suites) | the hospital's building management system (BACnet) |
| `inverter` | a plant of grid-support inverters or wind turbines | the plant controller and inverter settings (SunSpec, IEC 61850, IEEE 1547) |
| `irrigation` | pumps, pressure and climate on a farm or in a greenhouse | the pump station controller, the pivot panel or the climate computer (Modbus, the vendor cloud) |
| `marine_propulsion` | a ship's propulsion shaft and power plant | the vessel automation and power management system (modelled only) |
| `microgrid` | a microgrid battery and loads | the inverter or energy management system (IEEE 2030.5, SunSpec, OpenADR) |
| `mill` | a grinding, flotation or materials-handling circuit | the plant DCS or PLC (OPC UA) |
| `network` | network routing and switching | the network controller (SDN, routing API) |

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| Class of machine | What it is | The wire in a real stack |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | a fleet of machines or VMs that boot in minutes | the node pool's size command (Karpenter, Cluster Autoscaler, MachineSet, cloud ASG) |
| `pipeline` | a pipeline segment with its compressors, pumps and valves | pipeline SCADA (DNP3, Modbus, OPC UA) |
| `port` | a container terminal's cranes and vehicles taking moves | the terminal operating system and fleet controllers |
| `process` | an industrial process loop | the PLC or DCS (OPC UA, EtherNet/IP, PROFINET) |
| `qpu` | a quantum or specialised accelerator queue | the accelerator's job queue |
| `rail_traction` | a train's traction and auxiliary systems | the train control and management system and ATO (modelled only) |
| `ran` | a radio access network cell or site | the RAN controller (O-RAN interfaces) |
| `reaction_wheel` | a spacecraft reaction wheel | the attitude controller (modelled only) |
| `robot_fleet` | a fleet of robots or vehicles taking tasks | the fleet manager's dispatch API |
| `robot_joint` | a robot joint servo | the robot controller (ROS 2, EtherCAT, the drive's fieldbus) |
| `server` | an application service on servers or pods | the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize) |
| `storage` | block, file or object storage | the storage system's QoS and tiering API |
| `turbine` | a generating unit's governor, boiler or excitation loop | the plant DCS and governor (OPC UA, IEC 61850; modelled only) |
| `ups` | an uninterruptible power supply | the UPS and PDU management interface (SNMP, Modbus) |
| `water` | a water or pumping process | the SCADA system (Modbus, DNP3) |
| `workflow` | a workflow or pipeline engine | the workflow engine's concurrency settings |

Wires marked *modelled only* exist as plants in the benchmark and are not built for live use.

**How to wire any muscle on your own stack (the plug, chapter 4).** Every muscle below is wired the same way: Omni-Compass never replaces the native controller; it reads the controller's own meters (the wire out) and writes the one setting the controller already accepts (the wire in), through a plug that (1) reads the setting

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once before the first write and records it, (2) reads back every write and stops writing if another writer moved the setting, (3) renews a lease every decision so a dead governor's settings walk back to native by themselves, and (4) restores the recorded setting at the end. Each family's entry says which native controller owns its muscles, where the reading is tapped, where the setting is written, how it is restored, and whether that wire has run live in this repository or only on a model (`docs/wiring_recipes.csv`). The muscle's name is the setting's own name on that controller. Where the entry says *modelled only*, the plant exists in the benchmark and the wire is written against the controller's documented interface, not yet run on the machine.

## E.2 The spine: 267 muscles in all four realms, an organism of its own

The machines every realm stands on: servers, machines, GPUs and CPUs, network, storage, observability, security, cooling and electrical distribution. The spine is the seventh organism (`spine`, the base every stack runs on, run native and with Omni-Compass on top like the other six; `docs/THE_SPINE.md`), and each spine muscle is also part of every realm's organism, counted once in the tower and four times in the stack.

### *E.2.1 Cloud VM & Capacity (21 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `node` (a fleet of machines or VMs that boot in minutes), reached through the node pool's size command (Karpenter, Cluster Autoscaler, MachineSet, cloud ASG). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the cloud's autoscaling group or scale set: AWS Auto Scaling, Azure VMSS, GCP MIG.
- **Wire out (read):** group size, instance states, the target-tracking metric (the cloud's API and monitoring).
- **Wire in (write):** desired capacity, min and max, the target-tracking policy's target, through the cloud CLI or SDK.
- **Restore:** the group's desired, min, max and policy recorded once; restored from it.
- **Run live?** live on AKS through the node pool (family 5); the cloud SDK path itself is written, not yet run live.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 97 | vm count | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 98 | vm size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 99 | vm start stop | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 100 | vm migrate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 101 | instance family | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 102 | asg min | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 103 | asg max | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 104 | spot mix | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 105 | reservation mix | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 106 | zone selection | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 107 | region selection | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 108 | architecture selection | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 109 | accelerator selection | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 110 | boot disk class | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 111 | placement group | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 112 | interruption response | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1038 | target tracking policy | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1039 | scaling cooldown warmup | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 1114 | vm cpu cap by priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1120 | predictive scaling | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1121 | instance refresh | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

### *E.2.2 Container Resources (25 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

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- **Native controller:** the pod's own resource requests and limits (the Deployment template) and, where it runs, the VPA, Goldilocks or CruiseKube recommender.
- **Wire out (read):** each pod's CPU use (kubectl top), its request and limit, the node's allocatable CPU (Kubernetes API).
- **Wire in (write):** the running pod's CPU limit in place through pods/resize (no restart); the template is never changed, so no rollout.
- **Restore:** the operator's limit recorded in an annotation before the first write; every pod returned to it.
- **Run live?** live: omni_controller/muscles.py convey() (conveyance); KEDA and Goldilocks tables.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 33 | cpu request | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 34 | cpu limit | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 35 | memory request | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 36 | memory limit | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 37 | ephemeral storage | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 38 | hugepages | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 39 | io weight | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 40 | pids limit | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 41 | memory high | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 42 | memory reclaim | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 43 | swap limit | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 44 | cgroup io max | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 45 | cpu weight | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 46 | cpu quota | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 47 | cpuset | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 48 | runtime class | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1017 | in place resize | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 1019 | namespace quota | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1020 | default limits | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1022 | memory hard limit | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1023 | memory protection | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1024 | io latency target | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1025 | freeze | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 2176 | cruisekube request rightsizing | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 2177 | goldilocks vpa request recommendation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

### *E.2.3 Host CPU & Memory (26 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `cpu_host` (a CPU host whose clock and power can be set), reached through Linux cpufreq and RAPL. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

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- **Native controller:** the Linux kernel's own governors: cpufreq (schedutil or the processor driver), RAPL, cpuidle, the memory manager.
- **Wire out (read):** /sys/devices/system/cpu/cpufreq (frequencies and governor), /sys/class/powercap intel-rapl energy counters, /proc/stat busy share, /proc/pressure.
- **Wire in (write):** scaling_max_freq per policy and the RAPL package power limit through sysfs (root); on Kubernetes through the Kubernetes Power Manager's PowerProfile or EAR's policy.
- **Restore:** the governor's files snapshotted once and restored byte for byte (tools/run_cpu_power.py --restore).
- **Run live?** written and tested on the modelled machine (tools/run_cpu_power.py, cpu-power.yml); GitHub's machines are virtual and cannot write the governor: the live run needs a real Linux machine.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 113 | cpufreq min | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 114 | cpufreq max | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 115 | rapl package power | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 116 | uncore frequency | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 117 | energy perf preference | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 118 | cpu idle policy | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 119 | memory bandwidth | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 120 | numa balance | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 121 | irq affinity | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 122 | llc allocation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 123 | memory pressure gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 124 | page reclaim rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 125 | transparent hugepages | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 126 | core online offline | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 127 | thermal throttle policy | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 128 | host power profile | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1040 | frequency governor | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1041 | turbo boost | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 1042 | dram power limit | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1043 | swappiness reclaim | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 1112 | core packing | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1115 | per pod cpu frequency range and c state access | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1116 | uncore frequency per node | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 2174 | ear cpu frequency policy | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2175 | ear global energy budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 2178 | k8s power manager core profile | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

### *E.2.4 Kubernetes Placement & Scheduling (21 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** kube-scheduler and its profiles, the descheduler, PriorityClasses, scheduling gates.
- **Wire out (read):** pods pending and their reasons, node fill, topology spread (Kubernetes API).
- **Wire in (write):** a pod's or deployment's placement fields (nodeSelector, affinity, topologySpreadConstraints, priorityClassName, schedulingGates) by kubectl patch, or the scheduler's profile.
- **Restore:** the fields as they stood before the first write, restored field by field.
- **Run live?** modelled; the API path is the same kubectl patch the live controller uses for the HPA.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 49 | node selector | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 50 | node affinity | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 51 | pod anti affinity | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 52 | topology spread | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 53 | numa placement | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 54 | gpu topology | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 55 | storage locality | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 56 | network locality | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 57 | taint toleration | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 58 | priority class | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 59 | preemption policy | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 60 | device claim | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 61 | failure domain spread | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 62 | scheduler backoff | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 63 | gang admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 64 | deschedule | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1026 | scheduler scoring strategy | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1027 | scheduler plugin weights | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1028 | scheduling gates | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1029 | cpu manager | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 2179 | peaks power aware placement | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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### *E.2.5 Kubernetes Workload Scaling (32 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the HorizontalPodAutoscaler, KEDA ScaledObject or VPA that owns the workload's scale.
- **Wire out (read):** the HPA's current and desired replicas, the Deployment's ready replicas (Kubernetes API, metrics-server), the service's response time from the probe.
- **Wire in (write):** the HPA's target (spec.metrics averageUtilization) and floor (minReplicas) by kubectl patch; KEDA through its ScaledObject, so the add-on keeps its own loop.
- **Restore:** the operator's target and range recorded in an annotation before the first write, restored from it, annotation removed.
- **Run live?** live: scripts/kind_bench.sh and omni_controller (HPA target, KEDA, Goldilocks, CruiseKube), three-run tables in results/live.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 17 | replicas | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 18 | hpa cpu target | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 19 | hpa memory target | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 20 | hpa custom target | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 21 | vpa apply | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 22 | scale to zero | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 23 | keda threshold | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 24 | rollout rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 25 | max surge | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 26 | max unavailable | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 27 | deployment pause resume | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 28 | rollout abort | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 29 | pod eviction | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 30 | pdb policy | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 31 | scheduler queue priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 32 | api priority fairness | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1001 | hpa min replicas | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1002 | hpa max replicas | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 1003 | hpa scale down stabilisation window | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 1004 | hpa scale up stabilisation window | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1005 | hpa scaling rate policies | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1006 | hpa policy selection | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1007 | hpa tolerance | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | needs at once | | |
| 1008 | hpa sync period | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1009 | vpa minmax allowed resources | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 1010 | keda polling interval | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1011 | rollout progress deadline | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1012 | rollout readiness delay | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 1014 | unhealthy pod eviction policy | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1015 | graceful termination | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 1016 | probes | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 2172 | kepler energy target autoscaling | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

### *E.2.6 GPU Hardware (22 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `gpu` (GPU serving with a response-time target), reached through nvidia-smi (clock ceiling and power limit) or the

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serving autoscaler. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the card's own firmware limits through NVML and nvidia-smi (power limit, application clocks, MIG, compute mode).
- **Wire out (read):** nvidia-smi --query-gpu (clocks, power draw, temperature, utilisation, memory), the serving response time from the probe.
- **Wire in (write):** nvidia-smi -pl (power limit), -lgc/-rgc (clock ceiling and reset), -ac (application clocks), -mig and -c (modes), per card.
- **Restore:** every limit read once at start (the snapshot line in the GPU audit) and restored by the same commands at the end or on the lease.
- **Run live?** live: omni_controller/gpu_governor.py and scripts/gpu_paired.sh on a rented A10 (results/gpu); the new card runs wait on Lambda by the founder's order.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 129 | gpu allocate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 130 | gpu power limit | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 131 | gpu sm clock | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 132 | gpu memory clock | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 133 | gpu persistence mode | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 134 | gpu compute mode | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 135 | mig mode | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 136 | mig geometry | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 137 | gpu timeslice | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 138 | gpu mps | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 139 | gpu quarantine | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 140 | gpu reset | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 141 | gpu thermal limit | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 142 | gpu ecc response | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 143 | gpu job power budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1044 | application clocks | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1045 | gpu temperature target | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 1117 | sync boost | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 1118 | target clocks | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 2173 | climatik inference power cap | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2180 | adaptive gpu power cap | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 2181 | nvidia platform power budget | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

### *E.2.7 Node Fleet & Karpenter-Class Control (24 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `node` (a fleet of machines or VMs that boot in minutes), reached through the node pool's size command (Karpenter, Cluster Autoscaler, MachineSet, cloud ASG). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the cluster's own node autoscaler: Karpenter (NodePool), the Cluster Autoscaler, a MachineSet, a cloud node pool.
- **Wire out (read):** ready and schedulable workers, pending pods, allocatable and used CPU (Kubernetes API), the autoscaler's status ConfigMap.
- **Wire in (write):** the pool's size through the operator's own command (--node-scale-cmd: az aks nodepool scale, gcloud container clusters resize, eksctl scale nodegroup, kubectl scale machineset, a Karpenter NodePool limit); a machine parked by taint and drain, never deleted by Omni-Compass.
- **Restore:** the pool's starting count recorded once; every parked machine untainted and the pool restored to it at the end or on the lease.
- **Run live?** live: omni_controller nodepool mode on kind and on AKS (results/live/V1_AKS_*, the capacity and steady tables).

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 65 | node desired | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 66 | node pool min | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 67 | node pool max | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 68 | node provision | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 69 | node cordon | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 70 | node drain | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 71 | node consolidate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 72 | node replace | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 73 | node shutdown | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 74 | node power on | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 75 | nodepool weight | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 76 | disruption budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 77 | consolidation policy | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 78 | consolidate after | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 90% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 79 | expire after | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 80 | capacity class | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1030 | scale down utilisation threshold | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1031 | scale down unneeded time | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1032 | scale down delay after add | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 1033 | expander | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1034 | node pool limits | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1035 | kubelet eviction thresholds | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1036 | kubelet reserved resources | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1037 | max pods per node | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

### *E.2.8 Network Routing & Switching (19 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `network` (network routing and switching), reached through the network controller (SDN, routing API). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

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- **Native controller:** the network controller: the load balancer's weights, the SDN controller, the NIC's ethtool and tc settings.
- **Wire out (read):** link utilisation, drops, queue latency (SNMP, the controller's API, ethtool -S).
- **Wire in (write):** LB and route weights through the controller's API; rate limits and queue disciplines through tc; NIC queues through ethtool.
- **Restore:** every weight and setting recorded; restored with the same commands.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 225 | lb weight | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 226 | route weight | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 227 | rate limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 228 | bandwidth limit | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 229 | qos class | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 230 | connection limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 231 | failover route | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 232 | nic rate limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 233 | nic queue count | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 234 | queue discipline | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 235 | congestion control | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 236 | egress budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 237 | ingress budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 238 | ecmp weight | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 239 | path selection | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 240 | network isolation | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1046 | nic interrupt coalescing | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1047 | nic ring size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1048 | port link power | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

### *E.2.9 Observability & Telemetry (9 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the collector's own configuration: the OpenTelemetry Collector, Prometheus scrape and remote-write settings.
- **Wire out (read):** dropped samples, queue depth, memory, cardinality (the collector's self-metrics).

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- **Wire in (write):** the collector's batch, queue and memory limits and scrape intervals through its config reload.
- **Restore:** the config recorded; reloaded from it.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 373 | collector memory limit | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 374 | export concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 376 | cardinality budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 377 | retention window | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 378 | remote write queue | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 379 | telemetry shed | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1053 | metric scrape interval | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1054 | batching | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1119 | per pod energy attribution | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |

### *E.2.10 Reliability, Security & Recovery (12 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

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- **Native controller:** the platform's own recovery and security controls: rollout and rollback, PodDisruptionBudgets, the security hold, a kill switch.
- **Wire out (read):** error rate, rollout status, the security hold (a ConfigMap key), the kill file.
- **Wire in (write):** rollout pause and undo by kubectl; the security hold read, never written; the kill switch (tools/omni_switch.py) is a human's.
- **Restore:** every write recorded and undone on the lease.
- **Run live?** live in part: the security hold and kill switch run in every Kubernetes benchmark (omnicompass/master.py).

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 385 | restart | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 386 | rollback | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 388 | traffic divert recovery | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 389 | degraded mode | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 390 | actuator freeze | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 391 | workload isolate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 393 | credential rotation gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 394 | policy enforcement | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 395 | rate abuse gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 396 | fault domain isolate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 397 | backup trigger | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 400 | kill switch | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

### *E.2.11 Storage Block/File/Object (20 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `storage` (block, file or object storage), reached through the storage system's QoS and tiering API. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the storage system's QoS and tiering: Ceph (ceph osd pool set, QoS), a cloud volume's IOPS class, S3 lifecycle.
- **Wire out (read):** IOPS, throughput, latency and queue depth from the storage system's metrics.
- **Wire in (write):** volume IOPS and throughput limits, replica counts and tiering through the storage API or CSI VolumeAttributesClass.
- **Restore:** the volume's class and limits recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 257 | volume size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 258 | iops limit | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 259 | throughput limit | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 260 | replica count | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 261 | storage tier | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 262 | volume placement | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 263 | snapshot trigger | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 264 | rebalance | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 265 | recovery rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 266 | backfill rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 267 | compaction pressure | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 268 | cache allocation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 269 | object replication | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 270 | erasure code profile | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 271 | storage admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 272 | degraded storage gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1049 | scrub schedule | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 1050 | io scheduler | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1051 | disk power spin down | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1052 | lifecycle tiering | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

### *E.2.12 Cooling, Chillers & Thermodynamics (18 muscles)*

Each is a data hall or building zone cooled by chillers, air handlers or fans; its class is `data_hall` (a data hall cooling plant), reached through the building management system (BACnet, Modbus) or its command line. Omni-Compass reads its temperature against its limit. It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the building management system and the chiller plant's own supervisory controller (BACnet, Modbus).
- **Wire out (read):** supply and return temperatures, chiller load, fan and pump speeds, rack inlet temperatures (BACnet reads).
- **Wire in (write):** supply-air and chilled-water setpoints, fan and pump speeds within their safe bands by BACnet write; the plant's own staging keeps control.
- **Restore:** every setpoint read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled (the data-hall plant); the BACnet path is written.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 545 | supply air temperature | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 546 | return air target | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 547 | coolant supply temperature | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 548 | coolant flow | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 549 | pump speed | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 550 | fan speed | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 551 | chiller setpoint | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 552 | compressor authority | power | at its limit on native (the site envelope at full): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 553 | cooling tower fan | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 554 | cooling capacity | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 555 | rack thermal budget | power | at its limit on native (the site envelope at full): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 556 | gpu thermal envelope | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 557 | cpu thermal envelope | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 558 | thermal workload migrate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 559 | thermal load shed | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1055 | server fan speed | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1056 | economiser | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1122 | chiller plant supervisory control rl with safety layer | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

### *E.2.13 PDU, UPS & Electrical Distribution (18 muscles)*

Each is a battery, UPS or microgrid store with a load and a grid connection; its class is `ups` (an uninterruptible power supply), reached through the UPS and PDU management interface (SNMP, Modbus). Omni-Compass reads its draw on the grid connection and its reserve. It belongs to every organism.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the UPS and PDU management interfaces (SNMP, Modbus) and the servers' BMC power caps (IPMI DCMI, Redfish).
- **Wire out (read):** load per branch, UPS mode and charge, power per server (SNMP, Redfish).
- **Wire in (write):** server and rack power caps through Redfish or DCMI; UPS charge rate and mode through SNMP; breakers never written.
- **Restore:** every cap and mode read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 529 | server power cap | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 530 | rack power cap | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 531 | pdu branch power limit | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 532 | pdu outlet control | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 534 | ups operating mode | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 535 | ups charge rate | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 536 | ups discharge rate | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 537 | phase balance | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 538 | load transfer | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 539 | reactive power target | setpoint | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 540 | voltage target | setpoint | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | 0.25 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 541 | generator dispatch | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 542 | electrical isolation | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 543 | breaker trip gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1057 | ups shutdown battery test | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 1110 | hierarchical power budget row pdu switchboard controllers | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |
| 1111 | priority aware capping throttle low priority first | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1113 | power oversubscription with prediction | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | the spine; all four realms; stack; tower | global |

## E.3 Realm: Compute / AI / Cloud (273 muscles of its own, 540 in its organism with the spine)

### *E.3.1 AI Inference Serving (24 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `gpu` (GPU serving with a response-time target), reached through nvidia-smi (clock ceiling and power limit) or the serving autoscaler. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the serving engine's own autoscaler and batcher (vLLM, Triton, KServe, Ray Serve): replicas, batch size, concurrency, KV cache.
- **Wire out (read):** queue depth, tokens per second, p95 latency, KV-cache use from the server's /metrics.
- **Wire in (write):** the server's replica count or KServe/Knative autoscaling target, max_num_seqs and KV-cache budget through its API or its ConfigMap.
- **Restore:** the serving spec recorded once; restored to it.
- **Run live?** live in part: GPU serving under the card governor (results/gpu); the vLLM run is ready and waits on Lambda.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 161 | model replicas | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 162 | model route weight | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 163 | model load | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 164 | model unload | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 165 | model instance count | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 166 | continuous batching | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 167 | max batch size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 168 | batch queue delay | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 169 | inference concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 170 | inference max tokens | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 171 | kv cache budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 172 | prefix cache budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 173 | speculative decode budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 174 | model precision | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 175 | inference priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 176 | inference slo gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 1058 | autoscaling target concurrency qps | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 1059 | scale to zero panic window | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 1060 | request priority levels | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 1061 | kv cache swap space | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 1062 | chunked prefill | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 1063 | tensor parallel degree | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1064 | disaggregated prefill decode | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1065 | lora adapter load | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

### *E.3.2 AI Training (18 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `gpu_batch` (GPU training and batch work), reached through nvidia-smi, the job scheduler's pause and resume. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the training job's launcher and scheduler (Kubeflow, Ray Train, Slurm, torchrun).
- **Wire out (read):** step time, GPU utilisation, checkpoint cadence, stragglers (the job's metrics).

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- **Wire in (write):** the job's worker count (elastic training), batch sizes and checkpoint interval through the launcher's API or the job spec.
- **Restore:** the job spec recorded; the next run launched from it.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 177 | training workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 178 | global batch size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 179 | microbatch size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 90% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 180 | gradient accumulation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 181 | data parallelism | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 182 | tensor parallelism | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 183 | pipeline parallelism | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 184 | expert parallelism | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 185 | checkpoint interval | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 186 | checkpoint trigger | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 187 | training preempt | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 188 | training gang size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 189 | elastic worker count | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 90% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 190 | straggler mitigation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 191 | training precision | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 192 | compute comm overlap | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1066 | activation checkpointing | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 1067 | dataloader workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

### *E.3.3 Cross-Cluster, Multi-Region & Edge (18 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `node` (a fleet of machines or VMs that boot in minutes), reached through the node pool's size command (Karpenter, Cluster Autoscaler, MachineSet, cloud ASG). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the global load balancer and the fleet manager (Karmada, Fleet, the cloud's global LB).
- **Wire out (read):** per-region latency, capacity and cost, pending work (the global LB's and clusters' metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** region and cluster weights and quotas through the global controller's API.

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- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 609 | multi cluster dispatch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 610 | region dispatch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 611 | zone dispatch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 612 | edge dispatch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 613 | cloud capacity class | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 614 | workload migrate region | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 615 | data residency gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 616 | latency region gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 617 | cost region gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 618 | carbon region gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 619 | global failover | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 620 | federation quota | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 621 | cross cluster replication | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 622 | edge offload | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 623 | global admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5128 | edge site node pool | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| V5-5129 | edge inference gpu clocks | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5130 | edge sync interval | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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### *E.3.4 DPU SmartNIC & Programmable IO (12 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `fabric` (a high-speed fabric (RDMA, DPU, SmartNIC)), reached through the fabric manager's API. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the DPU's own management (NVIDIA DOCA, the SmartNIC's SDK) and SR-IOV.
- **Wire out (read):** per-function rates, flow-steering hits, DPU CPU and memory (the DPU's counters).
- **Wire in (write):** rate limits, QoS groups and VF counts through the DPU management API.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0021 | dpu pf tx rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0022 | dpu vf tx rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0023 | dpu sf tx rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0024 | dpu bandwidth share | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0025 | dpu qos group | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0026 | sriov vf count | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0027 | smartnic flow steering | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| AUDIT-0028 | smartnic offload enable | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0029 | dpu cpu budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0030 | dpu memory budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0031 | dpu service placement | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0032 | dpu failover | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |

### *E.3.5 Distributed Cluster Managers (15 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `batch` (batch and queued jobs), reached through the job queue (Kubernetes Jobs, Slurm, Spark). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the cluster manager's scheduler: YARN, Mesos, Nomad, Ray.
- **Wire out (read):** queue lengths, resource reservations, preemptions (the manager's API).
- **Wire in (write):** quotas, reservations and preemption settings through the manager's API.
- **Restore:** recorded once, restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 209 | task admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 210 | task priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 211 | resource reservation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 212 | cluster quota | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 213 | task preemption | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 214 | binpack pressure | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 215 | spread pressure | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 216 | gang schedule | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 90% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 217 | worker allocation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 218 | maintenance evacuation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 90% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 219 | oversubscription | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 220 | resource reclaim | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 221 | queue fairness | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 222 | deadline pressure | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 223 | scheduler retry | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

### *E.3.6 GPU Fabric & RDMA (18 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `fabric` (a high-speed fabric (RDMA, DPU, SmartNIC)), reached through the fabric manager's API. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the fabric manager and the collective library (NVIDIA Fabric Manager, NCCL settings, RDMA CM).
- **Wire out (read):** link and NVSwitch counters (nvidia-smi nvlink, DCGM), collective time per step from the training job.
- **Wire in (write):** NCCL environment and the job's rank placement at launch; RDMA QoS through the fabric manager's API.
- **Restore:** the launch settings recorded; the next job launched with the originals.
- **Run live?** modelled; written against NCCL and Fabric Manager documentation.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 145 | nvlink placement | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | needs at once | | |
| 146 | nvswitch route | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 147 | gpu fabric quarantine | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 148 | rdma bandwidth | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 149 | rdma route | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 150 | nic affinity | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 151 | collective concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 152 | collective algorithm | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 153 | collective chunk size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 154 | rank placement | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 155 | gpudirect policy | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 156 | congestion response | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 157 | rail selection | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 158 | fabric failover | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 159 | communication priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 160 | fabric isolation | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 1068 | collective protocol | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1069 | nic hca selection | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |

### *E.3.7 HPC & Distributed Compute (19 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `batch` (batch and queued jobs), reached through the job queue (Kubernetes Jobs, Slurm, Spark). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the batch scheduler: Slurm (scontrol, sacctmgr), PBS, LSF.
- **Wire out (read):** queue depth, node states, job wait times, power per node (sacct, sinfo, the power plugin).
- **Wire in (write):** partition limits, job priority and fair-share factors, node power-saving settings through scontrol and the scheduler config.
- **Restore:** the scheduler's settings recorded; restored with the same commands.
- **Run live?** modelled; EAR (family 8) is the live energy path on HPC.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 193 | job slots | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 194 | mpi ranks | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 195 | rank mapping | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 196 | node allocation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 197 | job walltime | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 198 | job priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 199 | job preemption | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 200 | checkpoint restart | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 201 | parallel io budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 202 | collective budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 203 | accelerator share | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 204 | cpu gpu ratio | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 205 | memory per rank | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 206 | scratch budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 207 | scheduler fair share | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 208 | backfill policy | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 1070 | node power saving | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 1071 | cpu frequency per job | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 1072 | partition limits | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

### *E.3.8 Kubernetes Dynamic Device Allocation (8 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `gpu` (GPU serving with a response-time target), reached through nvidia-smi (clock ceiling and power limit) or the serving autoscaler. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

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- **Native controller:** Kubernetes DRA: DeviceClass, ResourceClaim, ResourceSlice.
- **Wire out (read):** claims pending, devices allocated and tainted (the Kubernetes API).
- **Wire in (write):** DeviceClass selectors and claim capacity by kubectl apply; devices tainted, never removed.
- **Restore:** the objects recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled; the API path is kubectl.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0001 | dra device class selection | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| AUDIT-0002 | dra claim capacity | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| AUDIT-0003 | dra claim sharing | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| AUDIT-0004 | dra device taint | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0005 | dra device eviction | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0006 | dra binding readiness | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| AUDIT-0007 | dra binding failure response | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| AUDIT-0008 | dra device configuration | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

### *E.3.9 OpenShift & Machine API (9 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `node` (a fleet of machines or VMs that boot in minutes), reached through the node pool's size command (Karpenter, Cluster Autoscaler, MachineSet, cloud ASG). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** OpenShift's Machine API operators: MachineHealthCheck, MachineConfigPool, the Cluster Version Operator.

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- **Wire out (read):** machine phases, MCP status and pause, degraded counts (the OpenShift API).
- **Wire in (write):** MachineHealthCheck maxUnhealthy, MachineConfigPool paused and maxUnavailable by oc patch.
- **Restore:** the fields recorded before the first write, restored from the record.
- **Run live?** modelled; written against the documented OpenShift API, not yet run live.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 85 | machine remediation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 88 | machine health gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 89 | mcp pause | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 90 | mcp max unavailable | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 91 | node config rollout | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 92 | operator reconcile budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 93 | cluster version pacing | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 94 | infra machine admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 95 | machine failure domain | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

### *E.3.10 Quantum Computing Control Simulation (16 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `qpu` (a quantum or specialised accelerator queue), reached through the accelerator's job queue. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the quantum control stack's job queue and pulse schedules (Qiskit Runtime, the vendor's control software).
- **Wire out (read):** queue depth, calibration drift, error rates (the stack's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** shot allocation, circuit admission and scheduling through the stack's API; pulse parameters never written live.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.

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- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 593 | qubit mapping | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 594 | circuit admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 595 | shot allocation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 596 | circuit scheduling | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 597 | gate scheduling | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 598 | pulse amplitude | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | needs at once | | |
| 599 | pulse duration | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 600 | pulse phase | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 601 | pulse frequency | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 602 | coupling control | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 603 | reset scheduling | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 604 | measurement scheduling | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 605 | dynamical decoupling | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 606 | noise aware routing | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 607 | error mitigation budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 608 | quantum queue priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

### *E.3.11 Work Admission & Demand Shaping (19 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

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- **Native controller:** the service's own admission layer: its API gateway, queue or admission controller (Envoy, NGINX, Kong, a job queue's concurrency setting).
- **Wire out (read):** queue depth, requests in flight and the response-time line from the gateway's or queue's metrics (Prometheus, the admin API).
- **Wire in (write):** the gateway's or queue's concurrency and rate settings (the limit named by the muscle) through its admin API or its config object.
- **Restore:** snapshot of each limit once before the first write; every limit restored from it.
- **Run live?** at its limit on native: read and left native in every run (nothing is paced or turned away); the wire is read-only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | api concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 2 | queue concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 3 | queue backpressure | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 4 | job admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 5 | batch admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 6 | inference admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 7 | load shed | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 8 | priority gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 9 | tenant admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 10 | burst limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 11 | deadline admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 12 | work budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 13 | request queue limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 14 | retry admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 15 | background work gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 16 | maintenance work gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 1074 | request concurrency limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 1123 | adaptive concurrency limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| 1124 | priority request queue under limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

### *E.3.12 Linux Kernel & OS Control (20 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `cpu_host` (a CPU host whose clock and power can be set), reached through Linux cpufreq and RAPL. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the Linux kernel's own tunables: cgroup v2 files, /proc/sys/vm and net, the cpufreq and cpuidle governors, the I/O scheduler.
- **Wire out (read):** /sys/fs/cgroup, /proc/pressure, /proc/vmstat, /sys/block queue stats, the frequency files.
- **Wire in (write):** cgroup cpu.weight, cpu.max and memory.high; sysctl vm and net keys; scaling_max_freq, through sysfs and sysctl (root).
- **Restore:** every file snapshotted once and restored byte for byte.
- **Run live?** the CPU frequency path is written (tools/run_cpu_power.py); the other knobs are registered and queued, they need a real Linux machine.

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5001 | cgroup cpu weight | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5002 | cgroup cpu quota | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5003 | cgroup memory high | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5004 | cfs scheduler latency | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5005 | cpufreq dvfs governor | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5006 | transparent hugepages | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5007 | io scheduler depth | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| V5-5008 | numa auto balancing | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5009 | dirty ratio writeback | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5010 | vm swappiness | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5011 | tcp buffer autotune | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| V5-5012 | block nr requests | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5013 | ksm memory dedup | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5014 | net rx coalesce | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| V5-5015 | cpu cstate governor | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5016 | zswap pool fraction | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5017 | page cache reclaim | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5018 | irqbalance affinity | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| V5-5019 | net qdisc codel target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5020 | hugepage pool reserve | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

### *E.3.13 Serverless & Functions (FaaS) (9 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

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**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the function platform's concurrency settings (Knative autoscaling annotations, AWS Lambda concurrency, OpenFaaS).
- **Wire out (read):** concurrency, cold starts, queue waits (the platform's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** provisioned and reserved concurrency, scale-to-zero windows through the platform's API or annotations.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5021 | fn concurrency limit | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5022 | fn provisioned concurrency | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5023 | fn scale to zero idle | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5024 | fn memory size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5025 | fn prewarm pool | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5026 | fn reserved concurrency | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5027 | fn burst admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5028 | fn snapstart restore | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| V5-5029 | fn timeout budget | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |

### *E.3.14 Virtualization & Hypervisor (9 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `cpu_host` (a CPU host whose clock and power can be set), reached through Linux cpufreq and RAPL. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

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- **Native controller:** the hypervisor's management API (libvirt, vSphere, Hyper-V).
- **Wire out (read):** vCPU steal, balloon state, migration load (the hypervisor's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** vCPU allocation, ballooning and migration pacing through the management API.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5030 | vcpu allocation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5031 | memory ballooning | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5032 | vm overcommit density | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| V5-5033 | live migration pacing | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5034 | numa vcpu pinning | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5035 | sriov vf allocation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5036 | vgpu partition | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| V5-5037 | vm memory dedup ksm | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5038 | hypervisor cpu pinning | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

### *E.3.15 Gut: Data-plane Intake & Waste (8 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `process` (an industrial process loop), reached through the PLC or DCS (OPC UA, EtherNet/IP, PROFINET). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the data plane's own intake pacing and compaction settings (the ingress, the queue, the store's compactor).

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- **Wire out (read):** intake rate, backpressure, compaction debt, dead-letter depth (the components' metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** pacing, drain rates and compaction budgets through each component's settings API.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5045 | ingress intake pacing | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5046 | dead letter retry cap | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5047 | gc compaction pacing | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5048 | ttl eviction waste | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5049 | backpressure threshold | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5050 | queue drain rate | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5051 | retry budget window | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5052 | compaction debt drain | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

### *E.3.16 Skin: Perimeter & Admission (5 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the perimeter's own controls: the WAF, the DDoS shield, the TLS terminator.
- **Wire out (read):** request admission, inspection sampling, session cache hit rate (the perimeter's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** token-bucket rates, sampling and session cache size through the perimeter's API; blocking rules never loosened.

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- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5053 | rate limit token bucket | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5054 | connection admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5055 | waf inspection sampling | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5056 | tls session cache | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5057 | ddos shield admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

### *E.3.17 Media Streaming & CDN (14 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `process` (an industrial process loop), reached through the PLC or DCS (OPC UA, EtherNet/IP, PROFINET). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the streaming stack's transcoder pools, packager and CDN settings.
- **Wire out (read):** transcode queue, GPU clocks, buffer health, origin load (the stack's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** worker pools, bitrate-ladder cap and cache TTLs through the stack's API; GPU clocks through nvidia-smi (family 9).
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled; the GPU path is live (family 9).

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5072 | abr bitrate ladder cap | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5073 | player buffer target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5074 | transcoder worker pool | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| V5-5075 | live transcode gpu clocks | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5076 | vod transcode batch power | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5077 | packager workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| V5-5078 | origin shield cache size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5079 | edge cache ttl | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5080 | segment duration target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5081 | cdn request coalescing | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5082 | drm license server pool | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| V5-5083 | thumbnail sprite batch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5084 | media ingest admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5085 | encoder lookahead frames | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |

### *E.3.18 Game Servers & Real-Time Interactive (12 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod

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resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** Agones Fleets and the matchmaker, the game node pool.
- **Wire out (read):** allocated and ready servers, matchmaking waits, tick rate (Agones and the matchmaker's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** Fleet replicas and buffer sizes by kubectl patch; matchmaking admission through its API.
- **Restore:** the Fleet spec recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled; the API path is kubectl patch.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5086 | agones fleet buffer size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5087 | agones fleet min replicas | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| V5-5088 | agones fleet max replicas | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5089 | game server tick rate | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5090 | players per server cap | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5091 | matchmaking admission rate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5092 | matchmaking wait window | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5093 | relay server pool | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5094 | voice chat mixer pool | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5095 | game node pool autoscaler | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5096 | replay render batch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5097 | cloud gaming gpu clocks | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

### *E.3.19 Blockchain & Ledger Nodes (10 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `storage` (block, file or object storage), reached through the storage system's QoS and tiering API. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the node's configuration (cache sizes, peer limits, mempool) and its host's power profile.
- **Wire out (read):** block relay latency, mempool size, peer counts, validation backlog (the node's RPC).
- **Wire in (write):** cache and pool sizes through the node's config and RPC; the host's power profile through family 8.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5098 | node db cache size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | needs at once | | |
| V5-5099 | mempool max size | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5100 | max peer connections | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5101 | script validation threads | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5102 | block relay admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5103 | rpc work queue depth | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5104 | utxo cache flush interval | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5105 | indexer batch workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5106 | archive node storage tier | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5107 | validator host power profile | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

### *E.3.20 CI/CD & Build Farms (10 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `batch` (batch and queued jobs), reached through the job queue (Kubernetes Jobs, Slurm, Spark). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Compute / AI / Cloud.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the runner scale set (actions-runner-controller, GitLab runners) and the build cache.
- **Wire out (read):** jobs queued, runners busy, cache hit rate (the controller's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** min and max runners, build concurrency and cache size by kubectl patch of the scale set.
- **Restore:** the scale set spec recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled; the API path is kubectl patch.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5108 | runner scale set min runners | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5109 | runner scale set max runners | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| V5-5110 | build concurrency limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5111 | build cache size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5112 | test shard parallelism | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| V5-5113 | job queue admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5114 | artifact retention ttl | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Compute; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5115 | build node cpu frequency | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Compute; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5116 | remote execution workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| V5-5117 | warm runner pool | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Compute; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

# E.4 Realm: Physics / Robotics / Autonomous (137 muscles of its own, 404 in its organism with the spine)

## *E.4.1 Automotive EV & Mobile Powertrain (14 muscles)*

Each is a motor-driven axis: a robot joint, a flight-control surface, a reaction wheel, a traction motor; its class is `ev_traction` (an electric vehicle traction motor), reached through the vehicle's motor controller (CAN; modelled only). Omni-Compass reads its tracking error and its load. Its home realm is Physics / Robotics / Autonomous.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the vehicle's motor and battery controllers (CAN, the OEM's diagnostic interface).
- **Wire out (read):** torque, speed, state of charge, temperatures (CAN signals).
- **Wire in (write):** torque, regeneration and charge limits within the OEM's envelope.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1083 | state of charge limits | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 1084 | smart charging schedule | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0045 | traction torque limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0046 | regen braking level | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0047 | battery charge limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0048 | battery discharge limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0049 | battery thermal target | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0050 | motor thermal limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0051 | vehicle speed envelope | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0052 | energy recovery target | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0053 | auxiliary power budget | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0054 | fast charge current | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0055 | fast charge voltage | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0056 | vehicle safe state | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |

### *E.4.2 Aviation & Autonomous Flight (28 muscles)*

Each is a motor-driven axis: a robot joint, a flight-control surface, a reaction wheel, a traction motor; its class is `flight_axis` (a flight-control axis), reached through the flight controller (modelled only). Omni-Compass reads its tracking error and its load. Its home realm is Physics / Robotics / Autonomous.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the flight controller's own parameters: PX4 (MPC_XY_VEL_MAX, MPC_Z_VEL_MAX_UP, MPC_ACC_HOR, MC_ROLLRATE_MAX) and ArduPilot (WPNAV_SPEED, ATC_ACCEL_R_MAX), the battery failsafe.
- **Wire out (read):** mission progress, battery state, tracking error and near-miss distance over MAVLink telemetry.
- **Wire in (write):** the speed, acceleration and rate parameters over MAVLink PARAM_SET within the autopilot's own limits; failsafes and geofence never loosened.
- **Restore:** every parameter read (PARAM_REQUEST_READ) once and written back at the end.
- **Run live?** modelled: the swarm cells (results/live/V3_SWARM.md); the MAVLink path is written, not yet flown.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 481 | throttle envelope | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 482 | attitude target | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 483 | attitude rate target | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 484 | velocity target | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 485 | altitude target | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 486 | waypoint authority | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 487 | flight hold | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 488 | return to home | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 489 | land action | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 490 | mission admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 491 | geofence response | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 492 | failsafe selection | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 493 | battery reserve threshold | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 494 | actuator saturation envelope | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 495 | flight mode transition | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 496 | flight termination safe state | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 1079 | attitude rate gains | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 1080 | horizontal speed limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 1081 | vertical speed limits | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1082 | acceleration jerk limits | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5143 | px4 mpc xy vel max | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5144 | px4 mpc z vel max up | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5145 | px4 mpc acc hor | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5146 | px4 mc rollrate max | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5147 | ardupilot wpnav speed | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5148 | ardupilot atc accel r max | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5149 | drone battery failsafe reserve | setpoint | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Physics; stack; tower | 1.5 wobbles of margin on its line |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5150 | swarm formation spacing | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |

### *E.4.3 Robotics Fleet & Warehouse Automation (17 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `robot_fleet` (a fleet of robots or vehicles taking tasks), reached through the fleet manager's dispatch API. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Physics / Robotics / Autonomous.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the fleet manager's dispatch and charging rules (Open-RMF, the vendor fleet manager).
- **Wire out (read):** tasks waiting, robots active and charging, battery states (the fleet API).
- **Wire in (write):** active robot count, charge thresholds and zone admission through the fleet API.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 449 | robot dispatch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 450 | task assignment | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 451 | traffic reservation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 452 | robot route | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 453 | charging dispatch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 454 | battery reserve | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 455 | elevator request | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 456 | door request | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 457 | conveyor speed | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 458 | agv speed | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 459 | warehouse zone admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 460 | robot quarantine | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 461 | fleet failover | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 462 | human safe stop | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 463 | fleet concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5151 | amr fleet charge threshold | setpoint | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Physics; stack; tower | 1.5 wobbles of margin on its line |
| V5-5152 | amr fleet active robots | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Physics; stack; tower | global |

### *E.4.4 Robotics Motion Control (26 muscles)*

Each is a motor-driven axis: a robot joint, a flight-control surface, a reaction wheel, a traction motor; its class is `robot_joint` (a robot joint servo), reached through the robot controller (ROS 2, EtherCAT, the drive's fieldbus). Omni-Compass reads its tracking error and its load. Its home realm is Physics / Robotics / Autonomous.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the robot's own controller: ros2_control and MoveIt parameters, the drive's limits over EtherCAT or the vendor fieldbus.
- **Wire out (read):** joint tracking error, effort, temperature, cycle time (joint_states, the drive's registers).
- **Wire in (write):** velocity and acceleration scaling, trajectory tolerances and controller rates through ROS 2 parameters (ros2 param set) or the drive's limit registers; never past the manufacturer's limits.
- **Restore:** every parameter read once (ros2 param get) and restored (ros2 param set).
- **Run live?** modelled: MuJoCo (results/live/V3_MUJOCO.md); the ROS 2 path is written, not yet run on a physical arm.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 433 | joint position | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday | Physics; stack; | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | tower | |
| 434 | joint velocity | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 435 | joint acceleration | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 436 | joint effort | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 437 | cartesian velocity | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 438 | trajectory speed | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 439 | trajectory acceleration | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 440 | jerk limit | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 441 | collision margin | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 442 | force limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 443 | gripper force | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 444 | locomotion speed | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 445 | steering angle | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | | |
| 446 | braking force | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 447 | balance correction | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 1076 | trajectory tolerances | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 1077 | velocity acceleration scaling | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 1078 | controller update rate | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5135 | ros2 executor threads | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native | Physics; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| V5-5136 | ros2 qos history depth | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5137 | ros2 control loop rate | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5138 | humanoid balance margin | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5139 | humanoid gait speed | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5140 | humanoid joint torque limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5141 | humanoid step height | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5142 | manipulator payload speed scaling | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | everyday speed) | | |

### *E.4.5 Spacecraft & Flight Software (14 muscles)*

Each is a motor-driven axis: a robot joint, a flight-control surface, a reaction wheel, a traction motor; its class is `reaction_wheel` (a spacecraft reaction wheel), reached through the attitude controller (modelled only). Omni-Compass reads its tracking error and its load. Its home realm is Physics / Robotics / Autonomous.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the flight software's command and mode tables (cFS, F Prime).
- **Wire out (read):** attitude error, wheel speeds, power and thermal state from telemetry.
- **Wire in (write):** payload duty cycle, communication allocation and wheel allocation through commands; safe modes never commanded.
- **Restore:** the command table recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 497 | space command admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 499 | flight task schedule | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 500 | space mode transition | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 501 | payload duty cycle | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 502 | communication allocation | capacity | at its limit on native (its everyday speed is the machine's limit): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 503 | space power budget | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 504 | space thermal command | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 505 | attitude command envelope | capacity | at its limit on native (its everyday speed is the machine's limit): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 506 | reaction wheel allocation | capacity | at its limit on native (its everyday speed is the machine's limit): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 507 | rcs authority | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 508 | safe mode transition | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 509 | watchdog recovery | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 510 | instrument activation | capacity | at its limit on native (its everyday speed is the machine's limit): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 511 | fault isolation | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |

### *E.4.6 Rail Traction & Train Control (14 muscles)*

Each is a motor-driven axis: a robot joint, a flight-control surface, a reaction wheel, a traction motor; its class is `rail_traction` (a train's traction and auxiliary systems), reached through the train control and management system and ATO (modelled only). Omni-Compass reads its tracking error and its load. Its home realm is Physics / Robotics / Autonomous.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the train control and management system and ATO.
- **Wire out (read):** speed, traction effort, timetable margin, auxiliary power (TCMS telemetry).
- **Wire in (write):** traction and coasting targets within the ATO's envelope.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2054 | traction effort limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2055 | regenerative braking share | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2056 | coasting speed target | capacity | at its limit on native (its everyday speed is the machine's limit): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2057 | dwell time schedule | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2058 | hvac duty cycle | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2059 | train auxiliary power budget | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2060 | platform approach speed | capacity | at its limit on native (its everyday speed is the machine's limit): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2061 | acceleration rate setpoint | capacity | at its limit on native (its everyday speed is the machine's limit): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2062 | wheel slip protection mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2063 | traction motor thermal derate | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2064 | catenary voltage limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2065 | timetable recovery margin | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2066 | headway target | capacity | at its limit on native (its everyday speed is the machine's limit): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2067 | door release hold | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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### *E.4.7 Marine Propulsion & Vessel Automation (12 muscles)*

Each is a motor-driven axis: a robot joint, a flight-control surface, a reaction wheel, a traction motor; its class is `marine_propulsion` (a ship's propulsion shaft and power plant), reached through the vessel automation and power management system (modelled only). Omni-Compass reads its tracking error and its load. Its home realm is Physics / Robotics / Autonomous.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the vessel's automation and power management system.
- **Wire out (read):** shaft speed and power, fuel rate, engine load (the automation system).
- **Wire in (write):** shaft speed and power limits, engine staging within the manufacturer's envelope.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2068 | shaft speed target | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2069 | propeller pitch limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2070 | shaft power limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2071 | bow thruster duty | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2072 | ballast pump mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2073 | engine load sharing setpoint | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2074 | slow steaming speed target | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2075 | auxiliary engine staging | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2076 | shore power mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2077 | hotel load budget | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2078 | trim target | capacity | its own peak speed while tasks wait, back to its everyday speed near its heat limit or when its tracking strains (alone; inside a body, its everyday speed) | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2079 | rudder rate limit | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |

### *E.4.8 Elevators & Vertical Transport (12 muscles)*

Each is a motor-driven axis: a robot joint, a flight-control surface, a reaction wheel, a traction motor; its class is `elevator_hoist` (an elevator or escalator drive and its group control), reached through the lift controller and destination dispatch (modelled only). Omni-Compass reads its tracking error and its load. Its home realm is Physics / Robotics / Autonomous.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the lift controller and destination dispatch.
- **Wire out (read):** calls waiting, car positions, drive temperature (the controller).
- **Wire in (write):** speed and dispatch modes within the manufacturer's limits; safety modes never written.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2146 | hoist speed target | capacity | at its limit on native (its everyday speed is the machine's limit): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2147 | acceleration limit | capacity | at its limit on native (its everyday speed is the machine's limit): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2148 | regen drive mode | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2149 | standby power mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2150 | destination dispatch schedule | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2151 | car parking mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2152 | door dwell hold | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2153 | escalator speed target | capacity | at its limit on native (its everyday speed is the machine's limit): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2154 | group capacity mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2155 | motor thermal derate | power | at its limit on native (full torque): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2156 | brake test schedule | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |
| 2157 | fire recall mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Physics; stack; tower | global |

## E.5 Realm: Energy / Facility / Industrial (213 muscles of its own, 480 in its organism with the spine)

### *E.5.1 Building & Critical Environment HVAC (15 muscles)*

Each is a data hall or building zone cooled by chillers, air handlers or fans; its class is `building` (a building zone), reached through the building management system. Omni-Compass reads its temperature against its limit. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

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**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the building management system (BACnet) and the AHU and zone controllers.
- **Wire out (read):** zone temperatures, airflows, duct static pressure, occupancy (BACnet reads).
- **Wire in (write):** zone setpoints, fan speeds and damper positions within their bands by BACnet write; the BMS's own sequences keep control.
- **Restore:** every setpoint read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled: CityLearn districts (results/live/V3_CITYLEARN.md); the BACnet path is written.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1094 | setpoint reset trim and respond | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 1095 | duct static pressure setpoint | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 1096 | optimal start stop | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0081 | zone temperature target | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0082 | zone airflow | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0083 | ahu fan speed | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0084 | damper position | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0085 | economizer position | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0086 | boiler setpoint | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0087 | heat pump mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0088 | humidity target | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0089 | occupancy ventilation | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0090 | building demand limit | power | at its limit on native (the site envelope at full): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0091 | thermal storage dispatch | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0092 | hvac emergency mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

### *E.5.2 Energy Storage & Microgrid (19 muscles)*

Each is a battery, UPS or microgrid store with a load and a grid connection; its class is `microgrid` (a microgrid battery and loads), reached through the inverter or energy management system (IEEE 2030.5, SunSpec, OpenADR). Omni-Compass reads its draw on the grid connection and its reserve. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the battery's or site's energy management system and inverter (SunSpec, IEEE 2030.5, OpenADR, Modbus).
- **Wire out (read):** state of charge, grid import and export, PV output, load (the EMS or inverter registers).

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- **Wire in (write):** the reserve setpoint, charge and discharge limits, import limit and curtailment through SunSpec or Modbus registers.
- **Restore:** registers read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled: CityLearn (results/live/V3_CITYLEARN.md) for the districts; the register path is written.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 513 | battery charge power | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line; reads its line 10 decisions before it holds; keeps 0% of its line clear |
| 514 | battery discharge power | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line; reads its line 3 decisions before it holds; keeps 0% of its line clear |
| 515 | battery soc reserve | setpoint | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 0.75 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 516 | grid import limit | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 517 | grid export limit | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line; reads its line 3 decisions before it holds; keeps 5% of its line clear |
| 518 | pv curtailment | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line; reads its line 3 decisions before it holds; keeps 0% of its line clear |
| 519 | ev charge power | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 520 | heat pump power | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line; reads its line 3 decisions before it holds; keeps 0% of its line clear |
| 521 | electrolyzer power | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line; reads its line 5 decisions before it holds; keeps 0% of its line clear |
| 522 | microgrid demand limit | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 523 | peak shaving | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 524 | time of use schedule | setpoint | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 1 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 525 | energy load shed | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 526 | flex load admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 527 | storage dispatch | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 528 | microgrid emergency reserve | setpoint | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 1 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 1085 | volt var | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 1086 | volt watt | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 1087 | constant power factor reactive power | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

### *E.5.3 Facility & Grid Optimization (15 muscles)*

Each is a battery, UPS or microgrid store with a load and a grid connection; its class is `facility` (a facility battery behind the meter), reached through the energy management system. Omni-Compass reads its draw on the grid connection and its reserve. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the facility's energy management system and demand-response gateway (OpenADR).
- **Wire out (read):** site power, utility signals, PUE, carbon intensity (the EMS and the utility's feed).
- **Wire in (write):** the site power budget, demand limit and battery dispatch through the EMS.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 561 | facility power budget | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line; reads its line 3 decisions before it holds; keeps 0% of its line clear |
| 562 | utility demand limit | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line; reads its line 3 decisions before it holds; keeps 0% of its line clear |
| 563 | demand response | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 564 | electricity price gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 565 | carbon intensity gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 566 | renewable dispatch | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 567 | generator start stop | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 568 | site battery dispatch | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 569 | pue target | setpoint | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 1 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 570 | cooling power budget | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line; reads its line 3 decisions before it holds; keeps 0% of its line clear |
| 571 | it power budget | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line; reads its line 3 decisions before it holds; keeps 0% of its line clear |
| 572 | rack power allocation | power | at its limit on native (full battery power): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 573 | facility peak guard | capacity | holds the charge for the line and clips only the draw that would cross it; a UPS lends only the charge above its outage floor | Energy; stack; tower | 0 wobbles of margin on its line |
| 574 | grid frequency response | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 575 | facility islanding | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

### *E.5.4 Grid Transmission & Distribution (12 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `feeder_voltage` (a distribution feeder's voltage), reached through the distribution management system (IEC 61850, DNP3; modelled only). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

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**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the distribution management system and the devices' own controllers (IEC 61850, DNP3): regulators, capacitor banks, inverters.
- **Wire out (read):** feeder voltages, loads, tap positions, inverter output (the DMS).
- **Wire in (write):** regulator and transformer taps, capacitor switching and inverter reactive power within the planning envelope; protection never written.
- **Restore:** every setting read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled: SimBench grids (results/live/V3_PANDAPOWER.md).

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0033 | capacitor bank switch | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0034 | voltage regulator tap | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0035 | transformer tap | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0036 | inverter real power | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0037 | inverter reactive power | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0038 | feeder voltage target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0039 | feeder load transfer | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0040 | distribution storage dispatch | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0041 | demand response dispatch | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0042 | frequency droop setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0043 | grid protection mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0044 | grid restoration sequence | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

### *E.5.5 Industrial PLC & Process Automation (18 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `process` (an industrial process loop), reached through the PLC or DCS (OPC UA, EtherNet/IP, PROFINET). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the PLC or DCS loop (OPC UA, EtherNet/IP, PROFINET): the setpoint and the mode of each loop.
- **Wire out (read):** the process value, setpoint, output and alarm state of each loop (OPC UA reads).
- **Wire in (write):** the loop's setpoint within its safe band and its actuator range by OPC UA write; safety interlocks are never written.
- **Restore:** every setpoint read once and restored; a value outside the band is refused by the plug.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 465 | plc cycle authority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 466 | machine cell admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 467 | valve position | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 468 | pump flow | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 469 | compressor speed | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 470 | heater power | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 471 | furnace setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 472 | pressure setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 473 | temperature setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 474 | mass flow setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 475 | tank level target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 476 | conveyor rate | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 477 | feed rate | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 478 | purge vent action | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 1088 | controller mode | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 1089 | alarm limits | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1090 | safety interlock trip | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 1091 | opc ua writes | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

### *E.5.6 Semiconductor Fab & Precision Manufacturing (13 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `chamber` (a controlled chamber (clean room, kiln, reactor)), reached through the PLC or DCS. Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the fab's MES and each tool's controller (SECS/GEM).
- **Wire out (read):** tool queues, chamber states, process values (MES and GEM).
- **Wire in (write):** lot dispatch and tool admission through the MES; chamber recipes and parameters never written outside the qualified window.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1092 | run to run control | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 1093 | idle sleep mode | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0057 | tool job dispatch | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0058 | wafer route | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0059 | chamber recipe selection | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0060 | chamber temperature | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0061 | chamber pressure | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0062 | gas flow | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0063 | rf power | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0064 | vacuum pump speed | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0065 | robot transfer rate | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0066 | lot priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0068 | tool quarantine | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

### *E.5.7 Water Wastewater & Pumping (12 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `water` (a water or pumping process), reached through the SCADA system (Modbus, DNP3). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

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**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the utility's SCADA (Modbus, DNP3) and the pump station controllers.
- **Wire out (read):** levels, pressures, flows, aeration and dosing (SCADA reads).
- **Wire in (write):** pump speeds, level and pressure targets, aeration and dosing within their bands by SCADA write; emergency shutdowns never written.
- **Restore:** every setpoint read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0069 | pump speed water | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0070 | valve position water | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0071 | reservoir level target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0072 | line pressure target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0073 | flow target water | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0074 | aeration rate | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0075 | chemical dose rate | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0076 | filtration backwash | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0077 | lift station dispatch | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0078 | leak isolation | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0079 | water demand shed | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0080 | water emergency shutdown | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

### *E.5.8 Healthcare Critical Environments (13 muscles)*

Each is a data hall or building zone cooled by chillers, air handlers or fans; its class is `hospital` (a hospital's critical rooms (operating rooms, isolation, pharmacy, imaging suites)), reached through the hospital's building management system (BACnet). Omni-Compass reads its temperature against its limit. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the hospital's building management system (BACnet) with its clinical limits.
- **Wire out (read):** room pressures, air changes, temperatures and humidity (BACnet reads).
- **Wire in (write):** setpoints within the clinical envelope by BACnet write; pressure cascades and alarms never loosened.
- **Restore:** every setpoint read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2001 | operating room air change setpoint | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2002 | isolation room pressure target | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2003 | patient room temperature setpoint | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2004 | surgical suite humidity target | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2005 | ahu supply air temperature | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2006 | pharmacy cold room setpoint | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2007 | sterile storage humidity setpoint | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2008 | imaging suite cooling capacity | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2009 | chiller plant staging | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2010 | exhaust fan capacity | capacity | left to its own staging (native already has the cooling it needs: nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2011 | ward night setback mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2012 | medical gas plant demand limit | power | at its limit on native (the site envelope at full): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2013 | emergency power load shed | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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### *E.5.9 Agriculture & Irrigation (14 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `irrigation` (pumps, pressure and climate on a farm or in a greenhouse), reached through the pump station controller, the pivot panel or the climate computer (Modbus, the vendor cloud). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the pump station controller, pivot panel or climate computer (Modbus, the vendor cloud).
- **Wire out (read):** pressure, soil moisture, temperature, flow (the controller's registers).
- **Wire in (write):** pump speed and climate setpoints within their bands by Modbus write.
- **Restore:** registers read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2026 | irrigation pump speed | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2027 | mainline pressure setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2028 | soil moisture target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2029 | pivot speed setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2030 | fertigation dose | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2031 | greenhouse temperature setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2032 | greenhouse co2 target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2033 | vent position setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2034 | grain dryer temperature setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2035 | cold storage temperature setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2036 | barn ventilation rate | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2037 | milking vacuum level setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2038 | well drawdown level target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2039 | drip zone dispatch | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

### *E.5.10 Oil & Gas Pipelines (14 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `pipeline` (a pipeline segment with its compressors, pumps and valves), reached through pipeline SCADA (DNP3, Modbus, OPC UA). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** pipeline SCADA (DNP3, Modbus, OPC UA).
- **Wire out (read):** pressures, flows, line pack, compressor states (SCADA reads).
- **Wire in (write):** pressure and flow setpoints and unit staging within the safe envelope; protection never written.
- **Restore:** every setpoint read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2040 | compressor discharge pressure setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2041 | pump station suction pressure target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2042 | line pack target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2043 | pipeline flow setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2044 | compressor unit staging | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2045 | vfd pump speed | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2046 | terminal tank level target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2047 | leak detection shutdown | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2048 | batch interface dispatch | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2049 | heater outlet temperature setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2050 | drag reducing agent dose | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2051 | valve position target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2052 | cathodic protection voltage | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2053 | pressure protection priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

### *E.5.11 Mining & Mineral Processing (14 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `mill` (a grinding, flotation or materials-handling circuit), reached through the plant DCS or PLC (OPC UA). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the plant DCS or PLC (OPC UA).
- **Wire out (read):** mill load, speed, pressures, densities, power (OPC UA reads).
- **Wire in (write):** loop setpoints within their bands by OPC UA write; shutdowns never written.

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- **Restore:** every setpoint read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2092 | sag mill load setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2093 | mill speed target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2094 | crusher gap setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2095 | flotation aeration rate | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2096 | cyclone feed pressure target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2097 | thickener underflow density target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2098 | reagent dose | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2099 | conveyor speed setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2100 | dewatering pump level target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2101 | ventilation on demand airflow | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2102 | stockpile level target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2103 | slurry pump speed | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2104 | tailings discharge shutdown | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2105 | ore blend dispatch | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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### *E.5.12 District Heating & Cooling (13 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `district_heat` (a district heating or cooling network), reached through the network control system and substation controllers (Modbus, M-Bus). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the network control system and substation controllers (Modbus, M-Bus).
- **Wire out (read):** supply and return temperatures, differential pressure, storage level (the controllers).
- **Wire in (write):** supply temperature and pressure setpoints, pump speed and staging within their bands.
- **Restore:** registers read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2106 | supply temperature setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2107 | return temperature target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2108 | differential pressure setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2109 | network pump speed | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2110 | heat pump staging | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2111 | chp dispatch | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2112 | thermal storage level target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2113 | peak boiler heater output | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2114 | substation flow limit | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2115 | peak demand shed | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2116 | outdoor reset setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2117 | cooling network supply temperature | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2118 | cooling storage level target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |

### *E.5.13 Power Generation & Turbine Control (14 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `turbine` (a generating unit's governor, boiler or excitation loop), reached through the plant DCS and governor (OPC UA, IEC 61850; modelled only). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the plant DCS and the unit's governor (OPC UA, IEC 61850).
- **Wire out (read):** unit load, frequency, pressures, temperatures (the DCS).
- **Wire in (write):** load setpoints and ramp limits within the dispatch envelope; protection and rod positions never written.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2119 | turbine speed droop setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2120 | unit load setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2121 | boiler steam pressure setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2122 | feedwater level target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2123 | agc participation limit | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2124 | excitation voltage setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2125 | hydro gate position target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2126 | combustion air ratio setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2127 | cooling water flow setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2128 | inlet guide vane position | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2129 | reserve dispatch priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2130 | turbine ramp rate limit | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2131 | emissions shutdown | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2132 | nuclear rod position target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |

### *E.5.14 Renewable Generation & Inverter Control (13 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `inverter` (a plant of grid-support inverters or wind turbines), reached through the plant controller and inverter settings (SunSpec, IEC 61850, IEEE 1547). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the plant controller and inverter settings (SunSpec, IEC 61850, IEEE 1547).
- **Wire out (read):** active and reactive power, voltage, curtailment state (SunSpec registers).
- **Wire in (write):** volt-var and volt-watt setpoints, curtailment and ramp limits by SunSpec write within the interconnection agreement.
- **Restore:** registers read once and restored.

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- **Run live?** modelled: SimBench grids solved by pandapower (results/live/V3_PANDAPOWER.md); the register path is written.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2133 | inverter volt var setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2134 | inverter volt watt setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2135 | active power curtailment | power | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2136 | plant reactive power target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2137 | wind turbine yaw offset | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2138 | pitch angle limit | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2139 | rotor speed setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2140 | inverter frequency droop setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2141 | ramp rate limit | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2142 | tracker stow mode | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2143 | string mppt voltage setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2144 | noise mode schedule | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2145 | ice detection shutdown | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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### *E.5.15 Pharmaceutical & Food Manufacturing (14 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `batch_reactor` (a GMP batch reactor, fermenter or food process), reached through the batch control system (ISA-88, OPC UA). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Energy / Facility / Industrial.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the batch control system (ISA-88, OPC UA) with the validated recipe limits.
- **Wire out (read):** process values and phase states (OPC UA reads).
- **Wire in (write):** setpoints within the validated recipe band only; a value outside it is refused by the plug.
- **Restore:** every setpoint read once and restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2158 | reactor temperature setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2159 | agitator speed setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2160 | fermenter dissolved oxygen target | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2161 | ph setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2162 | pasteurizer holding temperature setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2163 | freezer tunnel temperature setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2164 | cip cycle dispatch | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2165 | cleanroom pressure cascade setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2166 | lyophilizer shelf temperature setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2167 | chromatography flow setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2168 | steam sterilizer cycle priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2169 | oven zone temperature setpoint | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2170 | refrigerant compressor authority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |
| 2171 | batch hold quarantine | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Energy; stack; tower | global |

## E.6 Realm: Distribution / Specialized (217 muscles of its own, 484 in its organism with the spine)

### *E.6.1 Cache & Memory Services (16 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the cache's own configuration: Redis CONFIG SET, Memcached runtime settings.
- **Wire out (read):** hit rate, evictions, used memory, p95 (INFO, the cache's stats).
- **Wire in (write):** maxmemory and eviction policy by CONFIG SET; replicas and shards through the operator.
- **Restore:** the setting read once (CONFIG GET) before the first write and restored (CONFIG SET).
- **Run live?** live: tools/run_redis.py, V3_REDIS.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 305 | cache size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 306 | cache ttl | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 307 | cache eviction policy | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 308 | cache replicas | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 309 | cache sharding | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 310 | cache prefetch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 311 | cache writeback rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 312 | cache admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 313 | hot key isolation | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 314 | cache connection limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 315 | cache memory limit | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 316 | cache compression | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 317 | cache warmup | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 318 | cache failover | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 319 | cache flush rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1106 | memory size threads | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

### *E.6.2 Commerce & Payment Systems (15 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `commerce` (a customer-facing service with bursts), reached through the Kubernetes API. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the payment platform's gateway and its routing rules.
- **Wire out (read):** authorisation latency, decline and retry rates, queue depth (the platform's metrics).

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- **Wire in (write):** concurrency, timeout and route weights through the platform's admin API.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 401 | payment admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 402 | payment concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 403 | payment retry | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 404 | payment timeout | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 405 | fraud review gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 406 | authorization route | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 407 | processor route weight | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 408 | transaction queue limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 409 | idempotency window | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 410 | order reservation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 411 | inventory hold | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 412 | checkout load shed | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 413 | refund queue rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 414 | settlement batch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 415 | payment failover | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |

### *E.6.3 Data Analytics & ETL (15 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `batch` (batch and queued jobs), reached through the job queue (Kubernetes Jobs, Slurm, Spark). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** Spark's dynamic allocation and the SQL engine's slots (spark.dynamicAllocation, Flink's parallelism, warehouse slots).
- **Wire out (read):** executor count, task backlog, shuffle spill, stage times (the engine's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** dynamic allocation min and max, parallelism and slots through the engine's config at submit or its REST API.
- **Restore:** the submit settings recorded; the next job launched from them.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 338 | executor size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | longer needs at once | | |
| 339 | dynamic allocation min | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 340 | dynamic allocation max | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 341 | shuffle partitions | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 342 | shuffle bandwidth | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 343 | etl concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 344 | stage parallelism | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 345 | query slots | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 85% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 346 | spill threshold | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 347 | cache fraction | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 348 | batch interval | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 349 | stream backpressure | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 350 | data locality wait | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 351 | speculation policy | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 352 | analytics admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

### *E.6.4 Database & Transactions (19 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `database` (a database cluster), reached through the database operator (replicas, connection pools). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the database's own pooler and server settings: PgBouncer's admin console, MySQL SET GLOBAL, MongoDB setParameter, the database operator.
- **Wire out (read):** pool waits and active connections (SHOW POOLS), buffer-pool size and hit rate, cache size and evictions, p95 per statement.
- **Wire in (write):** PgBouncer default_pool_size through its console; MySQL innodb_buffer_pool_size by SET GLOBAL; MongoDB wiredTigerEngineRuntimeConfig cache_size by setParameter; replicas through the operator.
- **Restore:** the setting read once before the first write and restored; a failed read-back stops the writer.

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- **Run live?** live: tools/run_pgbench.py, run_sysbench.py, run_ycsb.py, three-run tables V3_PGBENCH, V3_SYSBENCH, V3_YCSB.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 273 | db replicas | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 275 | db memory | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 276 | db cache | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 90% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 277 | query concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 278 | read route | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 279 | shard placement | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 280 | db failover | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 281 | replication lag gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 282 | db write throttle | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 283 | db pool resize | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 284 | transaction concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 285 | lock timeout | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 286 | checkpoint rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 287 | vacuum compaction rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 1099 | parallel workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 1100 | background writer | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1101 | synchronous replication | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1102 | buffer pool | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1103 | io capacity | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

### *E.6.5 Messaging & Streaming (22 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the broker's own controls: Kafka's admin API and consumer group, RabbitMQ policies, MQTT broker settings.
- **Wire out (read):** consumer lag, messages per second, p95 end to end, broker CPU (the broker's metrics, the consumer group's offsets).
- **Wire in (write):** the consumer group's size (consumers running), quotas and partition counts through the admin API.
- **Restore:** the group's size recorded; restored at the end.
- **Run live?** live: tools/run_kafka.py, V3_KAFKA.

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 289 | partition count | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 290 | partition placement | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 291 | producer quota | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 292 | consumer quota | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 293 | broker io quota | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 294 | message retention | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 295 | queue depth limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 296 | consumer concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 297 | producer batch size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 298 | fetch batch size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 299 | rebalance rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 300 | replication factor | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 301 | retry backoff | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 302 | dead letter divert | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 303 | stream priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 304 | broker failover | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 1104 | prefetch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 1105 | memory disk alarm | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| V5-5124 | mqtt broker max connections | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| V5-5125 | mqtt max inflight messages | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5126 | mqtt session expiry | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5127 | broker cluster nodes | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

### *E.6.6 Runtime & Application (21 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the application runtime's own settings: thread pools, JVM heap and GC, worker counts, connection pools.
- **Wire out (read):** queue waits, GC pauses, worker busy share, p95 from the application's metrics.
- **Wire in (write):** worker and pool sizes through the application's admin endpoint, environment or config reload; JVM flags at restart only.
- **Restore:** the settings recorded; restored (a restart-bound setting is left native).
- **Run live?** modelled.

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 353 | worker count | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 354 | thread pool | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 355 | jvm heap | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 356 | gc budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 357 | connection pool runtime | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 358 | application cache size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 359 | runtime memory | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 360 | async concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 361 | event loop workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 362 | process count | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 363 | request timeout | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 364 | background workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 365 | runtime cpu budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 366 | runtime io budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 367 | runtime restart | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 1108 | go runtime | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 1109 | keepalive connection reuse | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5131 | dns resolver cache size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5132 | dns negative cache ttl | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5133 | mail queue concurrency | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5134 | mail retry interval | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

### *E.6.7 Search, Indexing & Vector DB (16 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the search engine's settings API: OpenSearch/Elasticsearch cluster and index settings, the vector database's config.
- **Wire out (read):** indexing and search latency, queue rejections, merge pressure (the engine's stats API).
- **Wire in (write):** index refresh interval, merge throttling, shard counts and search thread pools through the settings API.
- **Restore:** settings recorded; restored.

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- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 321 | index workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 75% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 322 | index refresh rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 323 | segment merge rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 324 | search concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 325 | search timeout | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 326 | shard count | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | longer needs at once | | |
| 327 | shard replication | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 328 | shard rebalance | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 329 | vector search k | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 330 | vector batch size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 331 | embedding workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 332 | index memory budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 333 | query route | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 60 decisions |
| 334 | hot shard isolation | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 335 | search admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 1107 | circuit breakers | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

### *E.6.8 Service Mesh & API Reliability (16 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the mesh's own policies: Istio DestinationRule and VirtualService, Linkerd ServiceProfile, Envoy filters.
- **Wire out (read):** request rate, error rate, p95 and outlier ejections from the mesh's telemetry.
- **Wire in (write):** connection pool, outlier detection, retry budget and traffic weights by kubectl patch of the policy objects.

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- **Restore:** the policy objects recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled; the API path is kubectl patch.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 241 | circuit breaker | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 242 | retry budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 243 | service timeout | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 244 | service concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 245 | connection pool | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 246 | traffic divert | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 247 | traffic mirror | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | longer needs at once | | |
| 248 | canary weight | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 249 | outlier ejection | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 250 | health threshold | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 251 | dns traffic weight | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 252 | session affinity | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |
| 253 | request hedging | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | longer needs at once | | |
| 254 | fault injection gate | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 255 | service failover | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 1097 | load balancing policy | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

### *E.6.9 Telecom RAN & Edge Radio (12 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `ran` (a radio access network cell or site), reached through the RAN controller (O-RAN interfaces). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the RAN's near-real-time RIC and O-RAN interfaces (E2, O1).
- **Wire out (read):** PRB use, connected UEs, cell load, handover rates (the RIC's KPIs).
- **Wire in (write):** scheduler weights, slice budgets and traffic steering through the RIC's xApps; transmit power within the licence.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0009 | ran connection admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0010 | ran ue handover | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0011 | ran cell traffic steering | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0012 | ran slice resource budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0013 | ran prb allocation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0014 | ran scheduler weight | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0015 | ran tx power | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AUDIT-0016 | ran antenna tilt | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0017 | ran carrier enable | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0018 | ran cell sleep | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0019 | ran du cu placement | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| AUDIT-0020 | ran fronthaul budget | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

### *E.6.10 Workflow, Logistics & Fulfillment (15 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `workflow` (a workflow or pipeline engine), reached through the workflow engine's concurrency settings. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

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- **Native controller:** the workflow engine (Temporal, Airflow, Camunda) and the fulfilment system's dispatch rules.
- **Wire out (read):** task queue depth, worker utilisation, SLA misses (the engine's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** worker rates, concurrency and retry policies through the engine's API.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 417 | workflow admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 418 | workflow worker rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 419 | task queue rate | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 420 | workflow retry | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 421 | workflow backoff | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 422 | workflow timeout | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 423 | inventory allocation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 424 | fulfillment route | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 425 | warehouse queue | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 426 | carrier selection | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 427 | dispatch priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 428 | shipment batch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 429 | route replan | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 430 | sla escalation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 431 | compensation action | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 40 decisions |

### *E.6.11 Medical Imaging & Clinical Systems (12 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `clinical` (clinical systems: imaging archives, records, interface engines, monitoring gateways), reached through the application's own scaling and admission settings (Kubernetes, the vendor console). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

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- **Native controller:** the clinical application's own scaling and admission settings (Kubernetes, the vendor console).
- **Wire out (read):** queue depths, interface backlog, reconstruction wait (the application's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** replicas, concurrency and rate limits through the Kubernetes API or the vendor console.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2014 | pacs archive tier target | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| 2015 | dicom router concurrency | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2016 | ehr application replicas | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 2017 | hl7 interface queue limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2018 | fhir api rate limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2019 | reconstruction gpu workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| 2020 | modality worklist timeout | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2021 | patient monitoring gateway capacity | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2022 | lab analyzer batch window | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2023 | telehealth session admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2024 | clinical backup window | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2025 | imaging prefetch priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

### *E.6.12 Ports & Maritime Logistics (12 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `port` (a container terminal's cranes and vehicles taking moves), reached through the terminal operating system and fleet controllers. Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

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- **Native controller:** the terminal operating system and the equipment fleet controllers.
- **Wire out (read):** moves waiting, cranes active, gate queue, equipment charge (the TOS).
- **Wire in (write):** crane and vehicle allocation, gate rate and charging windows through the TOS.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2080 | quay crane allocation | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2081 | yard crane fleet size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2082 | berth window admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2083 | truck gate rate limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2084 | horizontal transport fleet size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2085 | reefer plug power budget | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2086 | shore power connection capacity | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | hands back what it no longer needs at once | | |
| 2087 | rail mounted gantry dispatch | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2088 | container dwell priority | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2089 | vessel arrival pacing | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2090 | stacking height target | setpoint | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| 2091 | equipment charging window | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

### *E.6.13 Content Delivery & Edge Cache (6 muscles)*

Each is a regulated process: a temperature, pressure, flow, level, voltage or composition held at a setpoint; its class is `process` (an industrial process loop), reached through the PLC or DCS (OPC UA, EtherNet/IP, PROFINET). Omni-Compass reads how far the process sits from its band. Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the CDN's configuration API and the edge cache's settings.
- **Wire out (read):** hit ratio, origin load, TTLs (the CDN's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** cache TTLs, origin-shield concurrency and prefetch through the CDN API.
- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled.

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5039 | cdn cache ttl | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5040 | edge cache size | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5041 | origin shield concurrency | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5042 | prefetch aggressiveness | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5043 | tiered cache promotion | capacity | at its limit on native (the full actuator): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5044 | edge pop admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

### *E.6.14 Financial Markets & Trading Systems (14 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `server` (an application service on servers or pods), reached through the Kubernetes API (HPA target and floor, pod resize). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the trading platform's gateway, matching engine and risk settings, the colocation BMS.
- **Wire out (read):** order latency, session counts, risk-check backlog, market-data fanout (the platform's metrics).
- **Wire in (write):** thread and session pools, conflation intervals and batch sizes through the platform's configuration; risk checks never relaxed.

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- **Restore:** recorded; restored.
- **Run live?** modelled only.

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5058 | matching engine threads | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5059 | order gateway sessions | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5060 | order admission rate limit | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5061 | pre trade risk check workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5062 | market data fanout threads | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 10 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5063 | market data conflation interval | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5064 | fix session heartbeat interval | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5065 | kernel bypass poll cores | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5066 | tick store write batch | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5067 | post trade settlement workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| V5-5068 | end of day risk batch power | power | at its limit on native (the full clock): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5069 | colocation rack cooling setpoint | setpoint | cools the room ahead of the heat as it nears its limit or its cooling nears flat out; never warmer than native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5070 | backtest grid nodes | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5071 | surveillance alert queue workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

### *E.6.15 Reliability, Security & Recovery (6 muscles)*

Each is a pool of servers, pods, GPUs, links or disks serving a stream of requests or jobs; its class is `network` (network routing and switching), reached through the network controller (SDN, routing API). Omni-Compass reads how far its queue and its load sit toward the service line (queue or lateness, and load above half). Its home realm is Distribution / Specialized.

**Wire it on your stack.**

- **Native controller:** the platform's own recovery and security controls: rollout and rollback, PodDisruptionBudgets, the security hold, a kill switch.
- **Wire out (read):** error rate, rollout status, the security hold (a ConfigMap key), the kill file.
- **Wire in (write):** rollout pause and undo by kubectl; the security hold read, never written; the kill switch (tools/omni_switch.py) is a human's.
- **Restore:** every write recorded and undone on the lease.
- **Run live?** live in part: the security hold and kill switch run in every Kubernetes benchmark (omnicompass/master.py).

| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5118 | ids capture threads | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

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| # | Muscle (the setting's own name) | Knob | What Omni-Compass does with it | Organisms | Its own card |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V5-5119 | ids ring buffer size | setpoint | left native: native already holds it inside its band (nothing to win) | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5120 | ids rule group admission | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |
| V5-5121 | waf inspection workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 70% full; reads the last 20 decisions |
| V5-5122 | siem ingest pipeline workers | capacity | starts the machines the forecast needs before the rush lands and clears work waiting in line within one machine start, never fewer than native runs; hands back what it no longer needs at once | Distribution; stack; tower | machines started at 80% full; reads the last 10 decisions |
| V5-5123 | endpoint scan scheduling | admission | at its limit on native (nothing paced or turned away): read and left native | Distribution; stack; tower | global |

APPENDIX

# Appendix F. The Azure Account, Click by Click

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This connects GitHub to an Azure account so the workflow `aks-metered` can build a real Azure Kubernetes Service cluster, run native Kubernetes (with Azure's own cluster autoscaler) against the same with Omni-Compass on top, count the machines Azure bills every 15 seconds, and delete everything when it is done. The design is written before the run in `docs/K8S_COMPASS_PREREGISTRATION.md`, "The bill on a real cloud". It costs about USD 10 to 30 of Azure time; a new account's free credit usually covers it. About ten minutes, once.

## F.1 An Azure account

1. Open **azure.microsoft.com/free** and click **Start free** (or **Try Azure for free**).
2. Sign in with a Microsoft account, or make one.
3. Fill in the form. Azure asks for a card to confirm who you are; the free credit is used first.
4. When it says the account is ready, go to **portal.azure.com**.

## F.2 Azure's own terminal (nothing to install)

1. In the Azure portal, at the top of the page, click the >_ icon (Cloud Shell), to the right of the search bar.
2. If it asks, choose **Bash** (not PowerShell).
3. If it asks about storage, choose **No storage account required** (or accept the default and **Create**).
4. A black terminal opens at the bottom of the page.

## F.3 One line: a login for GitHub

Paste this line into that terminal and press **Enter**:

```
az ad sp create-for-rbac --name omni-compass-github --role contributor
    ↪  --scopes /subscriptions/$(az account show --query id -o tsv) --
    ↪ sdk-auth
```

It prints a block of text that starts with `{` and ends with `}`. Select all of it, from `{` to `}`, and copy it. That block is a password for this one purpose; never paste it anywhere but the GitHub secret below.

## F.4 Put it in GitHub

1. Open the repository on GitHub.
2. Click **Settings** (the tab at the top right of the repository, not your account settings).
3. On the left: **Secrets and variables**, then **Actions**.
4. Click **New repository secret**.
5. **Name:** `AZURE_CREDENTIALS`
6. **Secret:** paste the whole block from step 3.

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7. Click **Add secret**.

## F.5 Run it

**Actions** tab, then **aks-metered** on the left, then **Run workflow**, then the green **Run workflow** button. The defaults are the preregistered design (5 repetitions, native and native with Omni-Compass on top, 900 measured seconds, Standard_D2s_v4 in eastus, the governor at the tune-down on the machines alone: the pods exactly native's, so the bill can only fall or stay). About 6 hours on GitHub. Each cluster is deleted when its arm ends, and the resource group at the end of every repetition whatever happens, so nothing keeps billing.

If Azure answers **quota exceeded**: in the portal, search **Subscriptions**, open yours, and upgrade it to **Pay-As-You-Go** (the credit stays), or ask for a quota of 10 vCPUs for the DSv4 family in the region.

## F.6 Afterwards

The result is the job `aggregate`'s receipt: billed machine-hours and the bill at list price, native against native with Omni-Compass on top, beside response time, failures and CPU, each with its 95% interval. To remove GitHub's access when you are done: in the Azure portal search **App registrations**, open **omni-compass-github**, **Delete**; and delete the `AZURE_CREDENTIALS` secret in GitHub.

## F.7 When Azure's check says the key is not whole

Every Azure set, and the conductor's own check at no cost (the run **cloud-check azure** on the **Actions** tab), reads the shape of the login before Azure's login and says what is wrong without printing a character of it: that a box is empty, that it holds an ID where a password goes, that it was cut short, or which field is missing.

### *F.7.1 The four boxes, one value each (the simplest way)*

Since 24 October the login can be stored one value to a box, exactly as the portal shows each value, with nothing to type around it. The check builds the block from them; the boxes are read only when `AZURE_CREDENTIALS` does not hold the whole block. All four values come from the same app.

1. In the Azure portal, search **App registrations**, click **All applications**, and open the app (or **+ New registration**, name `omni-compass-github-2`, **Register**). Its **Overview** shows three numbers; skip **Object ID**.
2. On GitHub, open **https://github.com/The-Omni-Compass-LLC/The-Omni-Compass/settings/secrets/actions**. For each box below, click its pencil (or **New repository secret** if it is not listed), paste the one value, and save:
   - `AZURE_CLIENT_ID`: the app's **Application (client) ID**.
   - `AZURE_TENANT_ID`: the app's **Directory (tenant) ID**.
   - `AZURE_SUBSCRIPTION_ID`: search **Subscriptions** in the portal, open yours, copy its **Subscription ID**.

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- `AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET`: on the app, **Certificates & secrets**, **+ New client secret**, **Add**, then copy the **Value** column at once (about 40 characters; Azure shows it once). Never the **Secret ID** beside it: that is another 36-character number, not a password.

3. Let the app build machines: **Subscriptions**, yours, **Access control (IAM)**, **+ Add**, **Add role assignment**, **Privileged administrator roles**, **Contributor**, **Next**, **+ Select members**, the app's name, **Select**, **Review + assign**.
4. Leave `AZURE_CREDENTIALS` as it is or empty it; while it is not the whole block, the four boxes are used.

### *F.7.2 The one box, the whole block*

A set already running keeps the key it started with: on 24 October the steady set started on 19 October was still signing in at every repetition while new runs read 88 characters in the box (the size of a storage account's access key, not the block). So make the new block under a new name, which leaves the login a running set still uses untouched; running the line of section F.3 with its old name again can replace that login's password, and a repetition that cannot sign in at its end cannot delete what it built.

1. In the Azure portal, click >_ (Cloud Shell) and choose **Bash**, as in section F.2.
2. Paste this line and press **Enter** (the line of section F.3 with the name `omni-compass-github-2`). It prints a new block that starts with `{` and ends with `}`:

```bash az ad sp create-for-rbac --name omni-compass-github-2 --role contributor --scopes /subscriptions/$(az account show --query id -o tsv) --sdk-auth ```

3. Select all of it, from `{` to `}`, and copy it.
4. On GitHub, open the repository, then **Settings**, then **Secrets and variables**, then **Actions**.
5. Beside `AZURE_CREDENTIALS`, click the pencil (**Update**).
6. Paste the whole block as the new value and click **Update secret**.
7. Once no Azure set is running (the **Actions** tab shows no run named `aks-metered` in progress or queued), the older login may be retired: in the Azure portal search **App registrations**, open **omni-compass-github**, and click **Delete**. Nothing in the repository names it.

The conductor runs Azure's check again within the hour, and the sets start on their own once it passes. Nothing is built and nothing is billed while it fails.

## F.8 The second way in: the sign-in without a password (OIDC)

Since 23 October, evening, the repository also holds a sign-in with no password at all: three IDs (`AZURE_CLIENT_ID`, `AZURE_TENANT_ID`, `AZURE_SUBSCRIPTION_ID`) and a rule in Azure that trusts this repository's own runs. The inventory (`azure-inventory.yml`) uses it. On 24 October it was refused: Azure answered that no trust rule matched the name GitHub presented (`AADSTS700213`), because

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```

GitHub now presents this repository by its ID numbers, and the rule in Azure names it the older way. One rule with the exact name makes it work:

1. In the Azure portal, search **App registrations** and open the app whose **Application (client) ID** is the one stored as `AZURE_CLIENT_ID`.
2. Click **Certificates & secrets**, then the tab **Federated credentials**, then **+ Add credential**.
3. **Federated credential scenario**: choose **Other issuer**.
4. **Issuer**: `https://token.actions.githubusercontent.com`
5. **Subject identifier** (type it exactly, or copy it from this page): `repo:The-Omni-Compass-LLC@334396871/The-Omni-Compass@1390458092:ref:refs/heads/main`
6. **Name**: `github-main`. Leave **Audience** at `api://AzureADTokenExchange`. Click **Add**.
7. The app needs a role on the subscription: **Subscriptions**, the subscription, **Access control (IAM)**, **Add role assignment**, **Reader** for the inventory.

The benchmark sets keep the key of section F.3. A sign-in without a password holds for about an hour and cannot renew itself inside a job, while one Azure repetition runs about 70 minutes and must still be signed in at its end to delete what it built; a lapsed sign-in there could leave machines running and billing. So the sets, and Azure's $0 check that clears them, sign in with a password: `AZURE_CREDENTIALS` whole, or the four boxes of section F.7.1 (the three IDs here and `AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET`), and nothing is started while neither is whole.

APPENDIX

# Appendix G. The Google Cloud Account, Click by Click

**Status (24 October): not yet run, its queue switched off.** The key has not been stored whole. Everything here stays ready, wired as Azure's sets run (the same harness and 60 s beat, 100 paired repetitions a set under the stopping rule, the $0 check first); the founder switches it on once the key is stored whole (section G.4), and nothing is built or billed before.

This connects GitHub to a Google Cloud account so two workflows can run the same tests Azure runs:

- `gke-metered`: a real Google Kubernetes Engine cluster, native Kubernetes (with Google's own cluster autoscaler) against the same with Omni-Compass on top, the machines Google bills counted every 15 seconds, the organisms with the cluster inside at 1, 10 and 100 copies (`organism`, `organism_scale`), everything deleted at the end; every set at the tune-down with the governor on the

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machines alone, so the bill can only fall or stay. The same design as Azure's `aks-metered` (`docs/K8S_COMPASS_PREREGISTRATION.md`).

- `cloud-organism` with `cloud` = `gcp`: the big organisms (the whole tower and the four stacked, the real cluster inside, at 100 copies) on one rented 8-processor machine, the same test Azure's `big-organism-detached` runs. With `test` = `direct` the same button runs Omni direct's three arms instead (native, Omni on native and Omni direct, no Kubernetes; `docs/OMNI_V18.md`), `reps` runs on the one machine; it starts only on the founder's word.

About fifteen minutes, once. New accounts get **$300 of free credit for 90 days**; Google does not charge the card during the free trial.

## G.1 A Google Cloud account with the free credit

1. On the laptop, open **cloud.google.com/free** and click **Get started for free**.
2. Sign in with a Google account (a Gmail address works), or make one.
3. Choose the country, tick the terms, click **Continue**.
4. Enter a card. Google uses it to confirm who you are; the $300 credit is used first.
5. Click **Start my free trial**. The Google Cloud console opens (**console.cloud.google.com**).
6. **Turn on the full account** (the credit stays and is still used first; the free trial otherwise limits how many machines run at once and refuses GPUs): at the top of the console click **Activate** (or open the menu ☰, **Billing**, then **Upgrade** / **Activate full account**) and confirm.

## G.2 A project for Omni-Compass

1. At the top left of the console, click the project picker (next to "Google Cloud").
2. Click **New project**. Name: `omni-compass`. Click **Create**.
3. When it is made, pick it in the project picker. Under the name you see its **Project ID** (for example `omni-compass-123456`). Write it down: it is the second secret below.

## G.3 Google's own terminal (nothing to install)

1. At the top right of the console, click the >_ icon (**Activate Cloud Shell**).
2. A terminal opens at the bottom of the page. If it asks to authorize, click **Authorize**.

## G.4 One paste: a login for GitHub

Paste this whole block into that terminal and press **Enter** (it takes about a minute). It is safe to paste again: a login already made is kept, and a fresh key is made each time.

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```
P=$(gcloud config get-value project)
gcloud services enable container.googleapis.com compute.googleapis.com
    ↪  iam.googleapis.com
gcloud iam service-accounts create omni-compass-github --display-name
    ↪ "Omni-Compass GitHub"
for r in roles/container.admin roles/compute.admin roles/iam.serviceAc
    ↪ countUser; do
  gcloud projects add-iam-policy-binding "$P" --member "serviceAccount
    ↪ :omni-compass-github@$P.iam.gserviceaccount.com" --role "$r" --q
    ↪ uiet >/dev/null
done
gcloud iam service-accounts keys create key.json --iam-account "omni-c
    ↪ ompass-github@$P.iam.gserviceaccount.com"
cloudshell download key.json
```

The browser asks to download **key.json**: click **Download**. Never copy the key from the terminal's screen: a block that long is cut short when it is selected there (on 18 October the stored key ended part of the way through, and every Google set failed at the login). Then:

1. On the laptop, open the **Downloads** folder, right-click **key.json**, **Open with**, **Notepad** (on a Mac: **TextEdit**).
2. Press **Ctrl+A** (select all), then **Ctrl+C** (copy). The whole file is about 2,300 characters, from `{` to `}`.
3. Back in Cloud Shell, type `rm key.json` and press **Enter**; on the laptop, delete **key.json** from **Downloads** once the secret below is saved.

That file is a password for this one purpose: never paste it anywhere but the GitHub secret below. (If the project picker showed no project, run `gcloud config set project YOUR-PROJECT-ID` first.)

**A new key file by clicks alone** (once the paste above has run, the login exists and only its key is needed again):

1. In the console menu ☰, **IAM & Admin**, then **Service Accounts**.
2. Click **omni-compass-github@…** (the address ends `.iam.gserviceaccount.com`).
3. Open the **Keys** tab, click **Add key**, then **Create new key**, choose **JSON**, click **Create**. The browser downloads the key file (its name is the Project ID and some letters, ending `.json`).
4. Open that file in Notepad as in step 1 above, **Ctrl+A**, **Ctrl+C**, and store it as below. On the same **Keys** tab, an older key can be deleted with its bin icon.

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## G.5 Put the two secrets in GitHub

1. Open the repository on GitHub, click **Settings** (the repository's tab, at the top right), then on the left **Secrets and variables**, then **Actions**.
2. **New repository secret** (or, when it is already there, the pencil beside it: **Update**). Name: `GCP_CREDENTIALS`. Secret: click in the box, **Ctrl+V** (the whole file from step 4). **Add secret** (or **Update secret**).
3. **New repository secret**. Name: `GCP_PROJECT`. Secret: the Project ID from step 2. **Add secret**.

That is all. Within the hour the conductor runs Google's check at no cost (**Actions**, **cloud-check**, the run titled `cloud-check google`): the key's shape (only its length and missing parts are ever printed, never a character of it), the login, the machine type and every quota a set needs. When it passes, the sets start on their own on the engine that stands (branch `main`; `v11` is kept in step with it), and no result goes up before it has been read. When it fails, it says which of these to fix, and nothing is built or billed.

## G.6 Google's limits (quotas)

A set needs, at once, 5 machines of 2 processors (10 processors), their 5 boot disks of 100 GB (500 GB of solid-state disk) and 6 external addresses in `us-central1`. The check reads each of Google's limits and names any that is short:

- **CPUS_ALL_REGIONS 8**: the free trial (8 processors at once). Activate the full account: at the top of the console click **Activate** (or ☰, **Billing**, **Activate full account**) and confirm. The $300 credit stays and pays first.
- **Any other limit short** (`CPUS`, `SSD_TOTAL_GB`, `IN_USE_ADDRESSES`): ☰, **IAM & Admin**, **Quotas & System Limits**; search the name the check printed, tick it (region `us-central1` where it asks), **Edit**, ask for what the check said is needed or more, **Submit**. Google usually answers within minutes to a day. The set is never shrunk to fit.

## G.7 What it costs

Google's list prices (us-central1, on demand): a worker of the Kubernetes test (`e2-standard-2`) about $0.067 an hour, up to 4 workers an arm, about $5 to $15 for a full five-repetition set; the big-organism machine (`e2-standard-8`) about $0.27 an hour, about $10 for its 39-hour ceiling. All of it comes out of the $300 credit first. Every cluster and machine is deleted when its run ends, whatever happens.

## G.8 Afterwards

To remove GitHub's access: in the console menu ☰ **IAM & Admin**, **Service Accounts**, tick **omni-compass-github**, **Delete**; and delete the two secrets in GitHub.

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APPENDIX

# Appendix H. The Amazon Web Services Account, Click by Click

**Status (24 October): not yet run, its queue switched off.** The account is on Amazon's Free plan, which Amazon will not raise before the $100 credit is spent or the account is six months old. Everything here stays ready, wired as Azure's sets run (the same harness and 60 s beat, 100 paired repetitions a set under the stopping rule, the $0 check first); the founder switches it on once the account is on the Paid plan (section H.2), and nothing is built or billed before.

This connects GitHub to an Amazon Web Services (AWS) account so two workflows can run the same tests Azure runs:

- `eks-metered`: a real Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service cluster, native Kubernetes (with its own cluster autoscaler) against the same with Omni-Compass on top, the machines Amazon bills counted every 15 seconds, the organisms with the cluster inside at 1, 10 and 100 copies (`organism`, `organism_scale`), everything deleted at the end; every set at the tune-down with the governor on the machines alone, so the bill can only fall or stay. The same design as Azure's `aks-metered` (`docs/K8S_COMPASS_PREREGISTRATION.md`).
- `cloud-organism` with `cloud` = `aws`: the big organisms (the whole tower and the four stacked, the real cluster inside, at 100 copies) on one rented 8-processor machine, the same test Azure's `big-organism-detached` runs. With `test` = `direct` the same button runs Omni direct's three arms instead (native, Omni on native and Omni direct, no Kubernetes; `docs/OMNI_V18.md`), `reps` runs on the one machine; it starts only on the founder's word.

About fifteen minutes, once. New accounts get **$100 of credit at sign-up and up to $100 more** for trying services, used before the card.

## H.1 An AWS account

1. On the laptop, open **aws.amazon.com/free** and click **Create a Free Account** (or **Create an AWS account**).
2. Enter an e-mail address and an account name (`Omni-Compass`), click **Verify email address**, and type the code Amazon e-mails you.

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3. Choose a password for the root user.
4. Contact information: **Business** (The Omni-Compass LLC) or **Personal**, the address and phone.
5. **Choose the Paid plan** if Amazon asks you to pick a plan. Your credits still pay first; the Free plan blocks services these tests need (the Kubernetes service among them).
6. Enter a card, then confirm the phone number with the code Amazon sends.
7. Support plan: **Basic support - Free**. Click **Complete sign up**, then **Go to the AWS Management Console** and sign in as the root user.

## H.2 An account already on the Free plan: move it to the Paid plan

An account that chose the Free plan cannot run these tests: Amazon puts a policy above every login of the account that refuses every machine read and every machine (on 18 October each Amazon set stopped there, at no cost, with "explicit deny in a service control policy"). Moving to the Paid plan removes it; the credits stay and still pay first.

1. Sign in to the console as the root user (the e-mail and password of step 1).
2. At the top of the console click **Upgrade plan** (beside the Free plan's credit and days left), or search **Billing and Cost Management**, open it, and click **Upgrade plan** on its home page.
3. Read the page, and click **Upgrade to paid plan** (or **Upgrade plan**) to confirm.

Nothing else changes: the login made for GitHub (step 2) and the two secrets (step 3) stay as they are. Within the hour the conductor's check reads the account again and the sets start on their own.

## H.3 A login for GitHub (an IAM user)

1. In the search bar at the top of the console type **IAM** and open it.
2. On the left, **Users**, then **Create user**. User name: `omni-compass-github`. Do **not** tick console access. **Next**.
3. **Attach policies directly**. Tick **AdministratorAccess** (the tests build whole Kubernetes clusters, which needs EKS, EC2, CloudFormation and roles; this user is used only by GitHub, and you delete it when the tests are done). **Next**, **Create user**.
4. Click the new user **omni-compass-github**, open the **Security credentials** tab, and under **Access keys** click **Create access key**.
5. Choose **Application running outside AWS** (or **Other**), **Next**, **Create access key**.
6. The page shows an **Access key** (starts with `AKIA`) and a **Secret access key**. Keep the page open for the next step; the secret is shown only once. These two are passwords for this one purpose: never paste them anywhere but GitHub.

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## H.4 Put the two secrets in GitHub

1. Open the repository on GitHub, click **Settings** (the repository's tab, at the top right), then on the left **Secrets and variables**, then **Actions**.
2. **New repository secret**. Name: `AWS_ACCESS_KEY_ID`. Secret: the Access key. **Add secret**.
3. **New repository secret**. Name: `AWS_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY`. Secret: the Secret access key. **Add secret**.

That is all. Within the hour the conductor runs Amazon's check at no cost (**Actions**, **cloud-check**, the run titled `cloud-check amazon`): the keys log in, the account can read and rent machines (not the Free plan), the instance type is offered and the processor quota holds a set. When it passes, the sets start on their own on the engine that stands (branch `main`; `v11` is kept in step with it), and no result goes up before it has been read. When it fails, it says which of these to fix, and nothing is built or billed.

## H.5 What it costs

Amazon's list prices (us-east-1, on demand): a worker of the Kubernetes test (`m5.large`) about $0.096 an hour, up to 4 workers an arm, plus about $0.10 an hour for each cluster's control plane, about $10 to $25 for a full five-repetition set; the big-organism machine (`m6i.2xlarge`) about $0.38 an hour, about $15 for its 39-hour ceiling. The credits pay first. Every cluster and machine is deleted when its run ends, whatever happens.

A set needs 10 processors at once (5 machines of 2). New accounts can start with less. When the check finds the quota short it asks Amazon for the increase itself (once; it waits for Amazon's answer before asking again), and Amazon usually answers within a day. To ask by hand: in the console search **Service Quotas**, open **Amazon Elastic Compute Cloud (Amazon EC2)**, **Running On-Demand Standard (A, C, D, H, I, M, R, T, Z) instances**, **Request increase at account level**, ask for 64, **Request**. The set is never shrunk to fit.

## H.6 Afterwards

To remove GitHub's access: in IAM, **Users**, tick **omni-compass-github**, **Delete**; and delete the two secrets in GitHub.

APPENDIX

# Appendix I. The Install Manifests

Every file an installation applies or builds, printed in full from the repository: the watch install (namespace, service account, the read-only role and the watch Deployment), the cloud mode's grant and its governing

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Deployment, the pod-target grant of level 2 (never in the cloud mode), and the two container images. Each file carries the legal notice at its head; the `<...>` values are the installation's own.

## I.1 `deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml`

*60 lines.*

```
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    ↪ .md.

# All patents, copyrights and trademarks filed in the USA. www.omni-co
    ↪ mpass.com
# Omni-Compass: one-file install. Stage 1 (shadow): read-only identity
    ↪ , observe mode. It cannot write to the cluster.
# Image: build with `docker build -f deploy/Dockerfile -t <registry>/o
    ↪ mni-compass:<tag> .` and set it below.

# Reset, any time: kubectl -n omni-compass exec deploy/omni-compass --
    ↪  touch /tmp/omni.kill
# Promote to stage 2/3 only by the steps in docs/WIRING_GUIDE.md (each
    ↪  adds exactly the permissions that stage needs).
apiVersion: v1
kind: Namespace

metadata: {name: omni-compass}
---
apiVersion: v1
kind: ServiceAccount
metadata: {name: omni-compass, namespace: omni-compass}
---

apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
kind: ClusterRole
metadata: {name: omni-compass-observe}
rules:
  - apiGroups: [""]
    resources: [nodes, pods, configmaps]
```

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```
    verbs: [get, list]
  - apiGroups: [metrics.k8s.io]
    resources: [nodes, pods]
    verbs: [get, list]
  - apiGroups: [autoscaling]
    resources: [horizontalpodautoscalers]
    verbs: [get, list]
  - apiGroups: [apps]
    resources: [deployments]
    verbs: [get, list]
---
apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
kind: ClusterRoleBinding
metadata: {name: omni-compass-observe}
roleRef: {apiGroup: rbac.authorization.k8s.io, kind: ClusterRole, name
    ↪ : omni-compass-observe}
subjects: [{kind: ServiceAccount, name: omni-compass, namespace: omni-
    ↪ compass}]
---
apiVersion: apps/v1
kind: Deployment
metadata: {name: omni-compass, namespace: omni-compass, labels: {app:
    ↪ omni-compass}}
spec:
  replicas: 1
  selector: {matchLabels: {app: omni-compass}}
  template:
    metadata: {labels: {app: omni-compass}}
    spec:
      serviceAccountName: omni-compass
      securityContext: {runAsNonRoot: true, runAsUser: 10001, seccompP
    ↪ rofile: {type: RuntimeDefault}}
      containers:
        - name: controller
          image: omni-compass:local            # <- your registry imag
    ↪ e
```

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```
          args: ["--mode", "observe", "--interval", "60", "--closure",
    ↪  "/app/law/closure.json",
                "--audit", "/var/log/omni/audit.jsonl", "--kill-file"
    ↪ , "/tmp/omni.kill"]
          resources: {requests: {cpu: 50m, memory: 128Mi}, limits: {cp
    ↪ u: 500m, memory: 256Mi}}

          securityContext: {allowPrivilegeEscalation: false, readOnlyR
    ↪ ootFilesystem: true, capabilities: {drop: [ALL]}}
          volumeMounts: [{name: audit, mountPath: /var/log/omni}, {nam
    ↪ e: tmp, mountPath: /tmp}]
        volumes: [{name: audit, emptyDir: {}}, {name: tmp, emptyDir: {}}
    ↪ ]
```

## I.2 deploy/install/rbac-machines.yaml

*25 lines.*

```
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    ↪ .md.

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    ↪ mpass.com
# The cloud mode's grant (the Operator's Manual, section 14.3): the wa
    ↪ tch role of omni-compass.yaml plus two verbs. Park a
# machine (a PreferNoSchedule taint) and wake it (remove the taint, un
    ↪ cordon): patch nodes. Mark a parked machine's pods

# first to go (the pod-deletion-cost annotation): patch pods. Nothing
    ↪ else: no delete, no eviction, no autoscaler write,
# no pod resize, no cloud credential.
apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
kind: ClusterRole
metadata: {name: omni-compass-machines}
```

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```
rules:
  - apiGroups: [""]
    resources: [nodes]
    verbs: [patch]
  - apiGroups: [""]
    resources: [pods]
    verbs: [patch]
---
apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
kind: ClusterRoleBinding
metadata: {name: omni-compass-machines}
roleRef: {apiGroup: rbac.authorization.k8s.io, kind: ClusterRole, name
    ↪ : omni-compass-machines}
subjects: [{kind: ServiceAccount, name: omni-compass, namespace: omni-
    ↪ compass}]
```

## I.3 deploy/install/omni-compass-cloud.yaml

*68 lines.*

```
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    ↪ mpass.com
# The cloud mode (the Operator's Manual, chapter 19): Omni-Compass on
    ↪ top at the tune-down, on the machines alone. It moves
# no pod autoscaler (--sensed names no service), conveys no processor
    ↪ and caps no power; it parks only machines the
```

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```
# cloud's autoscaler already made, after its own trial, and wakes them
    ↪  on a breach. Apply after omni-compass.yaml (the
# namespace, the service account and the watch role) and rbac-machines
    ↪ .yaml. It ships with --dry-run: it decides and
# writes nothing until that line is removed. Set the image (<registry>
    ↪ /omni-compass-cloud:<version>), TARGET_URL (the

# service's URL) and --slo-ms (the service's line), and --max-nodes (t
    ↪ he work pools' top). Three containers in one pod:
# the governor, the probe (its response-time feed) and the watchdog (i
    ↪ ts lease), sharing one process namespace.
apiVersion: apps/v1
kind: Deployment

metadata: {name: omni-compass, namespace: omni-compass, labels: {app:
    ↪ omni-compass}}
spec:
  replicas: 1                          # one writer: never more than o
    ↪ ne
  strategy: {type: Recreate}           # never two governors at once,

    ↪ even during a rollout
  selector: {matchLabels: {app: omni-compass}}
  template:
    metadata: {labels: {app: omni-compass}}
    spec:
      serviceAccountName: omni-compass

      shareProcessNamespace: true          # the watchdog sees the gov
    ↪ ernor's process (the lease, chapter 20.2)
      terminationGracePeriodSeconds: 60    # room for the hand-back on
    ↪  SIGTERM: every parked machine woken, read back
      securityContext: {runAsNonRoot: true, runAsUser: 10001, seccompP
    ↪ rofile: {type: RuntimeDefault}}

      tolerations: [{key: CriticalAddonsOnly, operator: Exists}]     #
    ↪  runs on the system pool, never on a machine it parks
      nodeSelector: {omni-role: system}
      containers:
        - name: controller
          image: omni-compass-cloud:local
```

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```
      args: ["--give-back-only", "--mode", "nodepool", "--law", "c
↪ ompass", "--dial", "save", "--sensed", "none/none",
             "--active-nodes-only", "--interval", "60", "--floor-i
↪ nterval", "5",
             "--min-nodes", "2", "--max-nodes", "4", "--max-node-s
↪ tep", "1",
             "--node-scale-cmd", "bash /app/scripts/kind_nodepool.
↪ sh {n}",
             "--node-restore-cmd", "bash /app/scripts/kind_nodepoo
↪ l.sh 100000",
             "--latency-file", "/feed/latency.csv", "--slo-ms", "5
↪ 00",
             "--closure", "/app/law/closure.json",
             "--audit", "/var/log/omni/audit.jsonl", "--kill-file"
↪ , "/tmp/omni.kill",
             "--dry-run"]
      env:
        - {name: WORKER_SEL, value: "omni-role=work"}      # the m
↪ achines it may park
        - {name: MIN_NODES, value: "2"}                    # never
↪  fewer in service
      resources: {requests: {cpu: 50m, memory: 128Mi}, limits: {cp
↪ u: 500m, memory: 256Mi}}
      securityContext: {allowPrivilegeEscalation: false, readOnlyR
↪ ootFilesystem: true, capabilities: {drop: [ALL]}}
      volumeMounts: [{name: audit, mountPath: /var/log/omni}, {nam
↪ e: tmp, mountPath: /tmp}, {name: feed, mountPath: /feed}]
    - name: probe                  # the response-time feed (chapt
↪ er 18): real requests to the service, every 5 s
      image: omni-compass-cloud:local
      command: ["python", "/app/scripts/latency_probe.py"]
      args: ["$(TARGET_URL)", "/feed/latency.csv"]
      env:
        - {name: TARGET_URL, value: "http://<service>.<namespace>.
↪ svc.cluster.local/"}
        - {name: INTERVAL, value: "5"}
```

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```
            - {name: N, value: "5"}
            - {name: DURATION, value: "31536000"}
          resources: {requests: {cpu: 10m, memory: 32Mi}, limits: {cpu
    ↪ : 100m, memory: 64Mi}}
          securityContext: {allowPrivilegeEscalation: false, readOnlyR
    ↪ ootFilesystem: true, capabilities: {drop: [ALL]}}

          volumeMounts: [{name: feed, mountPath: /feed}]
        - name: watchdog               # the lease (chapter 20.2): if
    ↪ the governor dies or hangs, it runs the governor's own
          image: omni-compass-cloud:local    # recorded restore (--res
    ↪ tore-only), which wakes every parked machine
          command: ["python", "/app/tools/omni_switch.py", "watchdog",

    ↪  "--every", "10"]
          env:                         # the restore is the governor's
    ↪  own command line: it needs the governor's environment
            - {name: WORKER_SEL, value: "omni-role=work"}
            - {name: MIN_NODES, value: "2"}
          resources: {requests: {cpu: 10m, memory: 64Mi}, limits: {cpu

    ↪ : 500m, memory: 256Mi}}
          securityContext: {allowPrivilegeEscalation: false, readOnlyR
    ↪ ootFilesystem: true, capabilities: {drop: [ALL]}}
          volumeMounts: [{name: audit, mountPath: /var/log/omni}, {nam
    ↪ e: tmp, mountPath: /tmp}]
      volumes: [{name: audit, emptyDir: {}}, {name: tmp, emptyDir: {}}

    ↪ , {name: feed, emptyDir: {}}]
```

## I.4 deploy/rbac-target.yaml

*19 lines.*

```
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```

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```
# All patents, copyrights and trademarks filed in the USA. www.omni-co
    ↪ mpass.com
# Additional write access for --mode target: patch and annotate HPAs o
    ↪ nly. Apply only after an observe period.
apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
kind: ClusterRole

metadata: {name: omni-compass-target}
rules:
  - apiGroups: [autoscaling]
    resources: [horizontalpodautoscalers]
    verbs: [patch, update]
---

apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
kind: ClusterRoleBinding
metadata: {name: omni-compass-target}
roleRef: {apiGroup: rbac.authorization.k8s.io, kind: ClusterRole, name
    ↪ : omni-compass-target}
subjects: [{kind: ServiceAccount, name: omni-compass, namespace: omni-

    ↪ compass}]
```

## I.5 `deploy/Dockerfile`

*19 lines.*

```
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    ↪ mpass.com
# Omni-Compass controller image. kubectl comes from the official Kuber
    ↪ netes image (no package manager, no curl).
FROM registry.k8s.io/kubectl:v1.32.2 AS kubectl
FROM python:3.12-slim
```

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```
COPY --from=kubectl /bin/kubectl /usr/local/bin/kubectl
WORKDIR /app
COPY requirements.txt .
RUN pip install --no-cache-dir -r requirements.txt
COPY omnicompass omnicompass
COPY omni_controller omni_controller

COPY hardware hardware
# the frozen, benchmarked closure-law setting (--closure /app/law/clos
    ↪ ure.json)
COPY tuning/GLOBAL_LEAGUE_PREREGISTRATION.json law/closure.json
USER 10001
ENTRYPOINT ["python", "-m", "omni_controller.controller"]
```

## I.6 deploy/Dockerfile.cloud

*17 lines.*

```
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    ↪ mpass.com
# The cloud mode's image (the Operator's Manual, chapter 19): the ship
    ↪ ped image (deploy/Dockerfile) plus what moving the
# machines alone needs: jq (the machine lever reads the cluster's JSON
    ↪  with it), the machine lever's script, the

# response-time probe or the Prometheus feed adapter, and the switch t
    ↪ ool the in-pod watchdog runs (the lease). Build the shipped imag
    ↪ e first and pass it: --build-arg BASE=<registry>/omni-compass:<v
    ↪ ersion>.
ARG BASE=omni-compass:local
FROM ${BASE}
```

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```
USER root
RUN apt-get update && apt-get install -y --no-install-recommends jq &&
    ↪  rm -rf /var/lib/apt/lists/*
COPY scripts/kind_nodepool.sh /app/scripts/kind_nodepool.sh
COPY scripts/latency_probe.py /app/scripts/latency_probe.py
COPY tools/omni_switch.py /app/tools/omni_switch.py

COPY tools/prom_feed.py /app/tools/prom_feed.py
USER 10001
```

APPENDIX

# Appendix J. The Implementer's Checklists

One checklist a phase (section 14.3). Each line is checked and initialled before the next phase begins, and the sheets are kept with the installation record (section 15.7).

## J.1 Phase 0: the copy

- [ ] `python3 verify.py` ends `VERIFICATION: PASS`; the receipt kept.
- [ ] `python3 tools/omni_version.py` names the engine version; the commit recorded.
- [ ] `python3 tools/seal.py --check` passes.
- [ ] `LICENSE`, `NOTICE` and `DISCLOSURES.md` read by counsel; the license in force for this installation named.

## J.2 Phase 1: the account and the cluster

- [ ] The provider's allowances read for the region and the machine families used; increases granted.
- [ ] A system pool of one machine, tainted `CriticalAddonsOnly=true:NoSchedule`, labelled `omni-role=system`.
- [ ] One or more work pools labelled `omni-role=work`, under the provider's cluster autoscaler, floor at least 2.
- [ ] The autoscaler's profile written down (scale-down timing, scan interval); the same in both arms of every paired run.
- [ ] The autoscaler seen to add a machine and delete one on its own.
- [ ] metrics-server answering (`kubectl top nodes`).

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- [ ] The service's HPA on CPU, with container requests; its target, minimum and maximum written down by the service owner.

## J.3 Phase 2: identity

- [ ] Namespace `omni-compass` and service account `omni-compass` created.
- [ ] The watch role applied (`deploy/install/omni-compass.yaml`).
- [ ] For the cloud mode, the machines role applied (`deploy/install/rbac-machines.yaml`) and nothing else.
- [ ] `kubectl auth can-i` output of section 15.4 matches the table exactly; kept.
- [ ] No cloud credential given to the governor.

## J.4 Phase 3: watch

- [ ] The shipped image built and pushed, tagged with the engine version and commit.
- [ ] The governor running `--mode observe`; its audit shows `decision` records (`nodes_recommended`) and no `write` record.
- [ ] The audit on a persistent volume, shipped to the log store.
- [ ] At least one full cycle of the service's own load watched (a day; a week for a weekly peak).

## J.5 Phase 4: the feed and the line

- [ ] The line written down by the service owner: milliseconds, the percentile, what counts as a failure, where measured.
- [ ] The feed in place (the probe or an adapter), writing `elapsed_seconds,latency_ms,ok`.
- [ ] The feed advancing every 5 seconds or faster; its clock monotonic over a day.
- [ ] A stopped endpoint seen in the audit as blind or breached, every machine held.
- [ ] A stopped feed seen in the audit as blind, nothing given back.

## J.6 Phase 5: the paired run

- [ ] The run's design written before it starts: arms (native, and native with Omni-Compass on top), load, duration, repetitions, the line, the machine family, the autoscaler profile.
- [ ] The run made on one engine version; its commit recorded.
- [ ] The receipt read row by row: every row GAIN, EVEN or LOSS by the rules of chapter 12.
- [ ] Every LOSS explained as wiring and fixed, and the run repeated; none cut.
- [ ] In the cloud mode: HPA replicas equal to native's within the noise; the bill EVEN or GAIN.
- [ ] The receipt signed by the service owner and by finance (the bill rows).

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## J.7 Phase 6: govern

- [ ] The cloud image built (`deploy/Dockerfile.cloud`) and pushed.
- [ ] `deploy/install/omni-compass-cloud.yaml` applied with the image, the service's URL, the line and the pools' top.
- [ ] A day of `--dry-run`: every `write` record marked `"dry_run": true` read; each command asks for a count of machines in service between the floor and the work machines that exist, one machine from the last.
- [ ] `--dry-run` removed; the first parked machine read in the audit with the trial that allowed it.
- [ ] The watchdog running in the governor's pod (the manifest's third container): the pod reads `3/3` ready.
- [ ] The OFF switch drilled by its holder: every machine woken, every record gone, within 60 seconds; the drill recorded.
- [ ] The alarms of section 21.5 wired and each proven by a test.

## J.8 Phase 7: day two, every quarter

- [ ] The OFF switch drilled and recorded.
- [ ] The watchdog's hand-back drilled (the governor's process killed outright in a quiet hour, section 29.2) and recorded.
- [ ] The audit searched for `refused`, `error`, `blind` and an unclosed `proprioception` drift; each explained.
- [ ] The engine version checked against the receipts kept; no receipt read across versions.
- [ ] The installation record complete.

APPENDIX

# Appendix K. The Kubernetes Governor's Settings

Every setting of the Kubernetes governor (`python -m omni_controller.controller`), grouped by who writes it. A setting not given on the command line takes its default. Settings in the last group are the factory tune (section 4.1): they are listed so that a command line can be read in full, and an installation leaves them as shipped; a command line that changes one runs a changed tune, whose receipts are its own (section 4.7).

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## K.1 The settings an installation writes

| Setting | Default | The cloud mode's value | What it is |
|---|---|---|---|
| `--slo-ms` | 0 (no line) | the service's line | the 95th-percentile response time the service must meet, in milliseconds (section 19.1) |
| `--latency-file` | none | `/feed/latency.csv` | the feed: rows `elapsed_seconds,latency_ms,ok` (section 19.2) |
| `--min-nodes` (and `MIN_NODES` in the environment of the governor and the watchdog) | 2 | the operator's floor, at least 2 | machines always kept in service |
| `--max-nodes` | 0 (read live) | the work pools' top | the most machines the machine lever counts on; it never asks for more than exist |
| `--node-scale-cmd` | none | `bash /app/scripts/kind_nodepool.sh {n}` | the command that keeps `{n}` machines in service (section 26.2 for its contract) |
| `--node-restore-cmd` | none | `bash /app/scripts/kind_nodepool.sh 100000` | the command a reset runs: every parked machine woken |
| `WORKER_SEL` (environment) | every machine that is not the control plane | `omni-role=work` | the label selector of the machines that may be parked |
| `NODE_CUSHION` (environment) | 0 | 0 | whole machines the operator holds back from the lever |
| `--sensed` | every HPA | `none/none` | the services whose autoscalers the feed speaks for; `none/none` names none, so no autoscaler is |

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| Setting | Default | The cloud mode's value | What it is |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | moved |
| `--dial` | `max` | `save` | the max, or the tune-down (section 4.2) |
| `--replica-ceiling` | -1 (read live) | not used (no autoscaler is moved) | how far a sensed autoscaler's cap may be raised; 0 keeps the operator's cap |
| `--audit` | `omni_audit.jsonl` | `/var/log/omni/audit.jsonl` | the audit file (section 21.4) |
| `--kill-file` | `/tmp/omni.kill` | `/tmp/omni.kill` | the file whose presence turns the governor OFF (section 21.3) |
| `--dry-run` | off | on for the first day, then removed | decide and record every command, write none |
| `--native` (and `OMNI_NATIVE`) | none | none, or the muscles the site keeps on its own controller | the muscles left where native runs them, never written: `machines`, `replicas`, `cpu`, `clock`, `gpu`, `rollout`, `batch`, `rightsize`, `coldstart`, `contain`, `cooling`; a name that is not one of them stops the start (omni-v14; the control panel's muscle button sets it) |
| `--kubectl` | `kubectl` | `kubectl` | the client the governor reads and writes through |
| `--site-limit-w`, `--power-cmd` | none | absent | a site's power limit and the command that prints its watts (level 7; never in a cloud); the command runs without a shell unless it holds a pipe, a redirect or a variable |

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| Setting | Default | The cloud mode's value | What it is |
|---|---|---|---|
| `--cooling-cmd`, `--cooling-min-c`, `--cooling-max-c`, `--cooling-restore-c` | none; 18, 27, 22 °C | absent | the facility's cooling setpoint command and band (section 8.10) |

## K.2 The settings the cloud mode fixes

| Setting | Default | The cloud mode's value | What it is |
|---|---|---|---|
| `--mode` | `observe` | `nodepool` | `observe` writes nothing; `target` moves autoscaler targets; `nodepool` also moves machines |
| `--law` | `governor` | `compass` | the law the governor holds the service with |
| `--interval` | 15 s | 15 s | the full decision period (section 4.4) |
| `--floor-interval` | 5 s | 5 s | the fast checks' period, between decisions, in `nodepool` mode |
| `--max-node-step` | 2 | 1 | the most machines one decision moves |
| `--active-nodes-only` | off | on | count only machines in service |
| `--closure` | none | `/app/law/closure.json` | the shipped setting file the image carries |
| `--iterations` | 0 (run until stopped) | 0 | decisions before exiting; the paired-run harness sets it |
| `--restore-only` | off | used only by the watchdog | put every setting back from the cluster's own records and exit |
| `--no-api-proxy` | off | off | read through a new client process every time instead of one local API proxy (costs more processor) |

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## K.3 The switches of the other muscles (outside the cloud mode)

These turn on muscles of levels 2 to 7 (section 7.3) on machines already paid for. None of them is used in a cloud.

| Setting | What it turns on |
|---|---|
| `--cap-deployments ns/name[,...]` | conveyance: the idle processor of each machine to the serving pods on it |
| `--rightsize-deployments ns/name[,...]` | each pod's processor request follows its measured use |
| `--coldstart-deployments ns/name[,...]`, `--coldstart-signal ns/configmap` | a service scaled to zero while no work waits and woken when work arrives |
| `--batch` | held Jobs labelled `omnicompass.io/batch=true` admitted when there is room |
| `--batch-pace` | Jobs labelled `omnicompass.io/pausable=true` paused under power or heat stress |
| `--rollout-guard ns/name[,...]` | a rollout paused while a change is not permitted |
| `--contain-namespaces ns[,...]`, `--contain-cpu-m` | an agent namespace held to a processor budget |
| `--security-configmap ns/name` | a security hold read from a ConfigMap key `hold` |
| `--strict-replicas` | level 4: the governor sets replica counts, the HPA kept as the fast reflex upward |
| `--pod-reflex-writes` | the fast pod reflex may raise an HPA's replica floor itself |
| `--rapl-cmd`, `--cpufreq-cmd`, `--cpufreq-policy-root`, `--cpufreq-require-schedutil`, `--cpu-max-khz` | the processor's own frequency governor under its power meter (section 8.9) |
| `--gpu-query-cmd`, `--gpu-power-cmd`, `--gpu-max-w`, `--gpu-temp-limit` | a graphics card's power reading and limit through commands (chapter 22 uses the card governor instead) |
| `--thermal-model` | the heat muscle's state from the harness's heat model (for modelled runs only) |

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| Setting | What it turns on |
|---|---|
| `--give-back-only` | the cloud mode in one flag: every switch above is turned off whatever else is passed, the replica ceiling is 0, the dial is at the tune-down and the node pool is the only knob |

## K.4 The factory tune

`--allow`, `--verdict-samples`, `--verdict-every-s`, `--verdict-recheck-s`, `--verdict-trial-s`, `--compass-tau`, `--compass-center`, `--cruise-after-s`, `--idle-demand`, `--coast-step`, `--min-target-change`, `--headroom`, `--reflex-window-s`, `--strict-window-s`, `--latency-window-s`, `--slo-clear-s`, `--convey-on`, `--convey-off`, `--cap-min`, `--cap-min-change-m`, `--cap-headroom`, `--batch-load-max`, `--batch-power-max`, `--pace-high`, `--pace-low`, `--pace-heat`, `--rightsize-headroom`, `--rightsize-min-m`, `--coldstart-idle-s`, `--convey-every-s`.

Each has its shipped value as its default, and the receipts of an installation are read on those values. Two of them bear on planning and are stated here for that reason only. `--headroom` (half again, by default) is the spare the governor keeps above the processor requests of the pods when it counts the machines they need: it never parks a machine that would leave the pods' requests, plus that spare, without a place (section 25.2). `--allow` (2%) is the most a machine given back on trial may add to the service's response time before the trial takes it back (section 20.1).

Every setting that names a time is stated in seconds (the `-s` settings) and keeps its time at any decision period (`--interval`). The older count forms, `--verdict-every`, `--verdict-recheck`, `--cruise-after`, `--strict-window`, `--slo-clear` and `--coldstart-idle`, are still read, as a number of decisions, and win where they are given. Whatever the period, the node pool gives back at most one machine a minute and adds past the scheduling floor at most one step a minute, the conveyance runs every `--convey-every-s`, and a decision that falls behind its slot is skipped and written in the audit (`behind_s`), never run in a burst: since omni-v16 the period changes only how often the governor looks.

## K.5 The card governors' settings

Two governors run on a graphics card (chapter 22), and neither takes a setting from K.1 to K.4. The **two-wire card governor** (`python3 -m omni_controller.gpu_compass`) reads the card's draw, clocks, utilization and temperature through `nvidia-smi` and writes the clock ceiling and the power limit under the compass law with the verdict; the **one-wire power governor** (`python3 -m omni_controller.gpu_governor`) writes the power limit alone, with the speed lock. Both are factory-tuned: an installation writes the first group and leaves the rest as shipped. The card governors' counts

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(`--verdict-every`, `--verdict-recheck`, `--slo-clear`) are in decisions at their own 2-second period (8 decisions is 16 s; 900 is 30 minutes).

| Setting (both governors) | Default | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| `--mode` | `watch` | `watch` decides and records, writes nothing; `cap` writes |
| `--gpus` | `0` | the card indexes governed, comma separated |
| `--smi` | `nvidia-smi` (or `NVIDIA_SMI` in the environment) | the client the governor reads and writes through |
| `--interval` | 2.0 s | the decision period on a card |
| `--duration` | 0 (until killed) | seconds to run |
| `--audit` | `gpu_compass_audit.jsonl`; `gpu_audit.jsonl` | the audit file (Appendix L.5) |
| `--kill-file` | `/tmp/omni-gpu-kill` | the file whose presence turns the governor OFF (section 22.6) |
| `--latency-file`, `--slo-ms` | none; 0 (no line) | the response-time feed and the line (section 22.2) |
| `--latency-window-s` | 5 s (two-wire); 30 s (one-wire) | seconds of response times the position reads |
| `--floor-w` | 0 (off) | the declared envelope's lowest watts: the power limit never under it |

| Setting (the two-wire governor only) | Default | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| `--dial` | `max` (or `OMNI_DIAL`) | the max: the clock ceiling never stepped below the top while the card serves; `save`: the tune-down (section 4.2) |
| `--race-util` | 0.95 | the utilization at which work is waiting: race, never pace |
| `--learn-samples` | 15 | busy readings of the card on its own before the compass may lower anything |
| `--clock-min-share` | 0 (the card's own lowest supported clock) | the clock ceiling's cover, as a share of the top |

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| Setting (the two-wire governor only) | Default | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| `--allow` | 0.02 | the most a ceiling step may add to the card's own time on a request |
| `--verdict-samples`, `--verdict-every`, `--verdict-recheck` | 30; 8; 900 | requests measured at native and at the trial step; decisions between trials; decisions before a refused step is tried again |
| `--up-gain`, `--down-gain` | 0.10; the law's | share of the top clock moved per unit of force, up and down |
| `--lid-headroom` | 0.10 | the lid above the draw the power limit takes |
| `--min-change-mhz`, `--min-change-w` | 15 MHz; 3 W | the smallest changes written |

| Setting (the one-wire governor only) | Default | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| `--headroom` | 0.3 | the limit never below the draw × (1 + headroom) |
| `--min-share` | 0.70 | the limit never below this share of the start limit (0: off) |
| `--util-gate`, `--util-band` | 0.5; 0.1 | the smoothed utilization at which the start limit returns, and the band below it at which the cap resumes |
| `--baseline-file`, `--speed-gain` | none (the lock off); 0.01 | the speed lock: the baseline from `tools/gpu_baseline.py`, and its line (at least this much faster than the baseline) |
| `--lock-boost`, `--lock-margin`, `--lock-step`, `--lock-hold-s`, `--lock-window-s`, `--lock-floor` | 5; 0.08; 0.02; 10 s; 60 s; 0.5 | the lock's largest step down (a multiple of `--lock-step`); the margin under the line within which watts are spent; the share of the start limit given up a decision; the seconds between two steps down; the response-time window the lock reads; the share of the start limit the lock never holds the limit under |

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| Setting (the one-wire governor only) | Default | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| `--min-change-w` | 5 W | the smallest change written |
| `--temp-limit` | 83 °C | the temperature read as heat 1.0 (section 22.5) |
| `--slo-clear` | 3 | decisions inside the line before a breach is counted clear |

APPENDIX

# Appendix L. The Audit, Record by Record

The audit (`audit.jsonl`, section 21.4) is one JSON object a line. Every object carries `time` (seconds since the Unix epoch, from the governor's clock) and one key that names its kind. The records an implementer reads in the cloud mode are below, in the order a decision writes them; the fields not listed are the engine's own state, recorded for the owner's analysis and not needed to operate the governor.

## L.1 Every decision

| Record (its key) | When | Fields an implementer reads |
|---|---|---|
| `verdict` | when a give-back trial begins, ends or is abandoned | `verdict`: `trial`, `step allowed`, `step refused: the muscle is slower there`, `trial abandoned (service not calm)` or `trial abandoned (too little work)`; `step` (machines given back on trial); `machines_given_back_allowed` (how many may stay given back); `machines_native` (the machines the cluster held when the governor started); on `step allowed` and `step refused`, `reading` (`GAIN`, `EVEN`, `LOSS` or `past the allowance`, the trial's reading against the reference) and `interval_ln` (the 95% intervals behind it, in log units) |

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| Record (its key) | When | Fields an implementer reads |
|---|---|---|
| `cruise` | when work has waited for a place for several decisions, and when it stops | `cruise`: `on` or `off`; `pending` (pods waiting); while cruise is on, every machine is in service and the governor stands back |
| `authority` | every decision | `senses.blind` (each sense, `true` when it is blind), `senses.latency_age_s` (seconds since the feed's newest row), `proprioception` (for the machines, the drift between the count last commanded and the count now in service, as a share of the command: 0 means the command landed), `node_gate.ok` and `node_gate.reason` (whether the release gate would let a machine go, and why not) |
| `decision` | every decision | `nodes_observed` (machines in service), `nodes_recommended` (machines the governor wants in service), `pending` (pods waiting for a place), `latency_p95_ms` (the feed's 95th percentile over its window), `slo_clean` (the line met over the last decisions), `mode`; outside the cloud mode, `hpa_target_recommended` |
| `write` | each command the governor runs | `write` (the command, as its argument list), `why` (`node pool size` from a decision, `scheduling floor (pending pods)` from a fast check, `reset: restore node pool` from a reset), `dry_run` |
| `refused` | each command that exits non-zero | `refused.nodes` (the count asked), `refused.now` (the count in service), `refused.code` (the exit code), `why`, `pool_top` |
| `decision_ms` | after every decision | the decision's own duration in milliseconds |

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## L.2 Other records

| Record | When | Fields |
|---|---|---|
| `error` | a decision or a fast check fails (the API unreachable, a read refused) | `error` (the exception), `stderr` (the client's last output), `consecutive_failures` |
| `decision` with a text value | `killed` (the kill file is present: every setting handed back, nothing written), `restore only: every setting handed back` (the watchdog's restore), `master switch: OFF; every setting handed back; exiting` (`SIGTERM` or the master switch) | the text itself |
| `overhead` | when the governor's process exits | `cpu_s` (processor seconds of the governor and every command it ran), `wall_s`, `cores_mean` (their ratio: the governor's own cost in cores) |
| `idle_floor` | outside the cloud mode, when the service is idle and the pool goes to its floor | `from`, `to`, `demand`, `at_idle` |
| `compass` | every decision | the engine's own reading, for the owner's analysis |

## L.3 Six searches that answer most questions

```
A=/var/log/omni/audit.jsonl
jq -c 'select(.write) | {time, why, cmd: (.write | join(" ")), dry_run
    ↪ }' $A              # every command, with its reason
jq -c 'select(.verdict) | {time, verdict, step, machines_given_back_al
    ↪ lowed}' $A          # every trial and its outcome
jq -c 'select(.authority) | select([.authority.senses.blind[]?] | any)
    ↪  | {time, senses: .authority.senses}' $A   # blind
jq -c 'select(.authority.proprioception.nodes? > 0) | {time, drift: .a
    ↪ uthority.proprioception}' $A          # unlanded
jq -c 'select(.error or .refused)' $A
    ↪                     # failures and refusals
jq -c 'select(.convey or .quota) | {time, convey, quota, machines, hos
```

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```
    ↪ t_busy, p95_ms}' $A   # the processor lever and the quota
```

A drift reading on one decision is normal: the command was given at the end of the last decision, and the machine script takes seconds. A drift that stays above zero across several decisions is the one-writer question of section 21.8.

## L.4 The records of the other muscles

Outside the cloud mode the muscles of levels 2 to 7 (section 7.3) write their own records. Each is one JSON object with `time`, as in L.1; the fields an implementer reads:

| Record | When | Fields |
|---|---|---|
| `quota` | once a conveyance pass, in a namespace whose ResourceQuotas the governor's role cannot read (section 6.5) | `quota`: `no budget known: the raise proceeds, Kubernetes admission is the authority`; `namespace`; `reason` (`quota read unavailable: <the error's class>`) |
| `convey` = `held` | a conveyance pass on a shared host at or over 75% busy, or unread, that would otherwise have raised a limit | `machines` (the nodes held), `host_busy` (the machine's busy share; `null` when unread), `shared_host` |
| `convey` = `engaged` or `released` | conveyance turning on (the 95th percentile at or over `--convey-on` × the line, or the feed blind) or off (under `--convey-off` × the line) | `p95_ms` (`null` while blind), `slo_ms`, `blind` |
| `write` with `why` beginning `convey:` | each pod CPU limit written: `convey: record original CPU limit` (the operator's limit annotated once, before the first raise); `convey: <node> idle CPU to its <n> serving pod(s), limit <m>m in place`; `convey: response time calm, operator's limit <m>m in place` | as `write` in L.1 |
| `error` beginning `convey resize rejected:` | Kubernetes refused a resize (the quota, admission, or the pod gone) | the error's class and its first 400 characters; a refused limit is never counted as given |

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| Record | When | Fields |
|---|---|---|
| `pod_reflex_reading` | each fast check that reads a sensed autoscaler's floor | the deployment and the floor it needs; `replicas` (now); `busy` (the host's busy share) |
| `pod_reflex` | a fast check that raises, or would raise, a floor (`--pod-reflex-writes`) | each deployment's new floor; `busy`; `R_ms` (the response time read); `S_ms` (the floor the line allows) |
| `cpu_pstate_snapshot` | once, at the start, on a machine whose processor ceilings the governor holds (section 8.9) | every frequency policy's ceiling as found |
| `cpu_pstate_write` | each ceiling written | the ceiling written; `why` (`cpu_pstate: ceiling <c> (cap <cap>, envelope [<lo>, <hi>], …)`) |
| `cpu_pstate_restore` | at reset or OFF | the ceilings restored from the snapshot; `why`: `reset: exact pre-Omni CPU ceilings` |
| `error` beginning with a muscle's name | a muscle's read or write failed | the error's class and its text; the decision goes on, the muscle holds |

## L.5 The card governors' records

The card governors (chapter 22; Appendix K.5) keep their own audit files, one JSON object a line with `time`, and are read the same way. The records, in the order a run writes them:

| Record | When | Fields an implementer reads |
|---|---|---|
| `snapshot` | once, at the start, before any write | per card: `limit_w` (the power limit read at start, the limit every reset returns to), `min_limit_w`, `enforced_w` (the limit the card obeys, where the driver reports it), the clock top, the power-management state; `mode`; `engine` (`compass, two wires`); the two-wire governor also writes `law` (its profile), `verdict` (the allowance, the samples, the spacing, the recheck) and `covers` (the clock range and the |

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| Record | When | Fields an implementer reads |
|---|---|---|
| | | power range nothing it computes can leave) |
| `refused` | at the start, in `cap` mode, when the card's power management is not enabled | the text: a written limit would not bind, so no authority is taken and the governor exits |
| `decision` | every decision | per card, the reading and the step: utilization, draw, the position in the band, the ceiling and the lid chosen, the verdict's state and the deepest step allowed; `hold: last write not read back` while a write has not landed |
| `would_write`, `would_clock_write` | in `watch` mode, or after another writer appeared, each write that would have been made | the `nvidia-smi` command as its argument list; `why`; `withheld` when another writer owns the limit |
| `write`, `clock_write` | each power limit, clock ceiling (`-lgc floor,ceiling`) or clock reset (`-rgc`) written in `cap` mode | the command; `why` (the step's reason, `restore`, or `reset: the limit read at start`); for a clock write `rc` and `stderr` |
| `actuator` | after each power-limit write | `gpu`, `requested_w`, `t_requested`, `rc`, `stderr`; on success `readback_w`, `enforced_w`, `t_readback`, `realized` (the read-back equals the request), `override` (the card enforces less than the limit), `delay_s`; on failure `write_failed` (the command) and the run ends with `fatal` |
| `actuator_realized` | a later decision, when a write that had not read back at once has landed | `gpu`, `requested_w`, `readback_w`, `enforced_w`, `delay_s` |
| `foreign_writer` | the limit read differs from what the governor wrote and from what it found: another writer | `gpu`, `reads_w`, `expected_w` (`pending_w` where a write was in flight); `action`: `observe only from now on` and both wires left to the other writer, for the rest of the run |

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| Record | When | Fields an implementer reads |
|---|---|---|
| `verdict` | when a ceiling trial begins, ends or is abandoned (two-wire governor) | as in L.1; `deepest_step` (the deepest ceiling step allowed) |
| `restored` | at the end, after the kill switch, OFF or the duration | per card, the limit read back; `start` (the limit read at the start); `ok` (every card back at its start, or another writer owned the limit); `writes` (how many the governor made); `foreign_writer`; `restore_write_failed` (any restore write the card refused) |
| `fatal` | a write the card refused | `write failed: <the command and its error>`; the arm ends here and never carries on as if watching |
| `error` | a decision that failed for any other reason | the error's class and text; the next decision is taken on schedule |

A card run is read from `snapshot` to `restored`: `ok` true in `restored`, no `foreign_writer`, no `fatal`, is a run in which every setting was handed back; `foreign_writer` true is a run in which the governor stood back from the first foreign reading, and the card's settings from then on are the other writer's.

APPENDIX

# Appendix M. The Three Clouds Side by Side

The same installation on each provider, task by task. The commands are those of chapters 16 to 18 and 27, condensed; the chapters give the context and the choices. Every Kubernetes command (`kubectl ...`) is the same on all three.

## M.1 The cluster

| Task | Azure (AKS) | Google Cloud (GKE) | Amazon Web Services (EKS) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Check the allowance for the machine | `az vm list-usage -l <region> -o` | `gcloud compute regions describe` | Service Quotas console, EC2 "Running |

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| Task | Azure (AKS) | Google Cloud (GKE) | Amazon Web Services (EKS) |
|---|---|---|---|
| family | `table` | `<region>` (quotas) | On-Demand Standard instances" (vCPUs) |
| Create the cluster with its system pool | `az aks create ... --nodepool-name system --nodepool-taints CriticalAddonsOnly=true:NoSchedule --nodepool-labels omni-role=system` | `gcloud container clusters create ... --node-taints CriticalAddonsOnly=true:NoSchedule --node-labels omni-role=system` | `eksctl create cluster -f cluster.yaml` with a `system` managed node group carrying the label and the taint |
| Add a work pool under the autoscaler, labelled | `az aks nodepool add ... --labels omni-role=work --enable-cluster-autoscaler --min-count <n> --max-count <top>` | `gcloud container node-pools create work0 ... --enable-autoscaling --min-nodes <n> --max-nodes <top> --node-labels omni-role=work` | a `work0` managed node group with `labels: {omni-role: work}` and the autoscaler's discovery tags, and the Cluster Autoscaler installed by Helm (or Karpenter with a NodePool carrying the label) |
| The autoscaler's scale-down profile | `az aks update --cluster-autoscaler-profile scale-down-unneeded-time=<t> ...` | `gcloud container clusters update --autoscaling-profile balanced` or `optimize-utilization` | the Cluster Autoscaler's flags (`--scale-down-unneeded-time` and others), or Karpenter's `consolidationPolicy` and `consolidateAfter` |
| Credentials for `kubectl` | `az aks get-credentials -g <rg> -n <cluster>` | `gcloud container clusters get-credentials <cluster> --zone <zone>` | `aws eks update-kubeconfig --name <cluster> --region <region>` (eksctl writes it) |
| metrics-server | built in | built in | installed from its release manifest, placed on the system pool |

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| Task | Azure (AKS) | Google Cloud (GKE) | Amazon Web Services (EKS) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Delete everything | `az group delete -n <rg> --yes` | `gcloud container clusters delete <cluster> --zone <zone>` | `eksctl delete cluster -f cluster.yaml` |

## M.2 The image and the registry

| Task | Azure | Google Cloud | Amazon |
|---|---|---|---|
| The registry | `az acr create -g <rg> -n <acr> --sku Standard`, then `az aks update --attach-acr <acr>` | `gcloud artifacts repositories create omni-compass --repository-format=docker --location=<region>` | `aws ecr create-repository --repository-name omni-compass` (and `omni-compass-cloud`) |
| Build the shipped and the cloud image | `az acr build -t omni-compass:<v> -f deploy/Dockerfile .` and `az acr build -t omni-compass-cloud:<v> -f deploy/Dockerfile.cloud --build-arg BASE=<acr>.azurecr.io/omni-compass:<v> .` | `docker build` and `docker push` of both, the second with `--build-arg BASE=<repo>/omni-compass:<v>` | as Google, with `aws ecr get-login-password ... \| docker login` first |
| Tag immutability | `az acr repository update --write-enabled false` per tag, or the registry's retention and lock settings | immutable tags on the repository | `aws ecr put-image-tag-mutability --image-tag-mutability IMMUTABLE` |
| Signature admission (section 27.3) | Image Integrity (Ratify with Azure Policy) | Binary Authorization | Kyverno `verifyImages` or the Sigstore policy controller |

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## M.3 Identity, network and records

| Task | Azure | Google Cloud | Amazon |
|---|---|---|---|
| The governor's cloud credential | none | none | none |
| The cluster's own credential for making machines | the cluster's managed identity (Azure's) | GKE's own service agent (Google's) | the Cluster Autoscaler's IAM role for service accounts, or Karpenter's role (the operator's, created by eksctl) |
| Network policy enforcement | Azure Network Policy Manager, Calico or Cilium (`--network-policy` at creation) | GKE Dataplane V2 or Calico | the VPC CNI's network policy agent, or Calico |
| A persistent volume for the audit | storage class `managed-csi` | storage class `standard-rwo` | storage class `gp3` through the EBS CSI driver |
| The API server's audit log | diagnostic setting, category `kube-audit-admin`, to Log Analytics | Cloud Audit Logs, Admin Activity, in Cloud Logging | control plane logging, type `audit`, to CloudWatch Logs |
| The governor's audit, shipped | the Azure Monitor agent (Container insights) | Cloud Logging's agent (on by default) | the CloudWatch agent or Fluent Bit |

## M.4 The bill

| Task | Azure | Google Cloud | Amazon |
|---|---|---|---|
| Where machine cost lives | Cost Management, cost analysis or export | the Cloud Billing export to BigQuery | the Cost and Usage Report, Cost Explorer |
| Separating the governed pools | the cluster's node resource group, and a tag on each work pool | GKE cost allocation by namespace and node-pool label | a cost allocation tag on each node group's instances, activated in Billing |
| The paired run from GitHub (Appendices F to H) | the `aks-metered` workflow | the `gke-metered` workflow | the `eks-metered` workflow |

Product names, billing granularity and console paths are the providers' own and change; the provider's current documentation is the authority for each, and an installation's plan (chapter 25) records the terms it used.

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APPENDIX

# Appendix N. The Paired Run from GitHub: Every Input

Phase 5's paired run can be made from the repository's own workflows, on GitHub's runners, against the company's cloud account (Appendices F to H set up the account and the repository secrets). Each workflow builds a fresh cluster for every arm of every repetition, runs native and native with Omni-Compass on top in rotation on the same load, prices the machines that existed every 15 seconds, deletes every cluster it made whatever happens, and writes the receipt to the run's summary and as an artifact. The inputs below are the workflows' own; a run's title names its load and its dial.

## N.1 The inputs every cloud shares

| Input | Default | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| `reps` | 5 | paired repetitions; one runs at a time |
| `arms` | `native compass` | the two arms, in rotation order: native, and native with Omni-Compass on top |
| `duration_s` | 900 | measured seconds per arm |
| `price_per_node_hour` | the family's list price on the day the workflow was written | the price the bill rows use; check the provider's price list on the day |
| `load_steps` | empty (a steady load) | load-generator replicas per step, in order, for a burst or a day-shaped load (for example `1 6 1 8 1 6`) |
| `max_workers` | 4 | the work pool's top; the cloud's autoscaler runs it from 1 to this many |
| `hpa_max` | empty (the manifest's 10) | the service's replica ceiling, the same in both arms; size it with the fleet (nine 200-millicore pods fit a two-processor machine) |

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| Input | Default | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| `organism`, `load_max`, `organism_scale` | empty, 6, 1 | one of the repository's seven organisms (the spine among them) with this cluster inside it, its peak load, and its copies on one clock (1, 10 or 100); empty runs the service alone |
| `dial` | `save` | the dial of Omni-Compass on top: `save`, the tune-down, for every bill result; `max` is never read as a bill result (section 20.2) |

Every cloud workflow runs the governor in the cloud mode (`OMNI_MACHINES_ONLY=1`, which passes `--give-back-only`, chapter 20).

## N.2 The inputs of each cloud

| Workflow | Input | Default | What it is |
|---|---|---|---|
| `aks-metered` | `location` | `eastus` | the Azure region |
| | `vm_size` | `Standard_D2s_v4` | the work machines' size |
| | `tier` | `free` | the clusters' control-plane tier, `free` or `standard` (outside the bill; the way past free-tier capacity refusals) |
| | `worker_pools`, `pool_prices` | empty | several work pools, one machine family each with its own top (`size:max,...`), and each pool's list price (`work0=<price>;work1=<price>;...`): the way past a per-family allowance |
| | `replica_ceiling` | empty | outside the cloud mode only: how far the governor may raise the service's replica cap; the cloud mode moves no autoscaler |
| `gke-metered` | `project` | the `GCP_PROJECT` secret | the Google Cloud project |
| | `zone` | `us-central1-a` | the zone |

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| Workflow | Input | Default | What it is |
|---|---|---|---|
| | `machine` | `e2-standard-2` | the work machines' type |
| `eks-metered` | `region` | `us-east-1` | the AWS region |
| | `instance` | `m5.large` | the work machines' instance type |

The repository's secrets each workflow reads are `AZURE_CREDENTIALS` (Azure), `GCP_CREDENTIALS` and `GCP_PROJECT` (Google Cloud), and `AWS_ACCESS_KEY_ID` and `AWS_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY` (Amazon). They are set once in the repository's settings, never printed, and used only to build and delete the run's own clusters; the governor inside the clusters never sees them (section 15.5).

Before a Google Cloud or Amazon set starts, `cloud-check` runs for that cloud at no cost and stops before anything is built: the stored key's shape (for Google, its length and its missing parts only, never a character of it), the login, the account's plan, the machine type in the zone or region, and every quota a set needs (Google: processors in the region and in all regions, solid-state disk and external addresses; Amazon: the on-demand processor quota, which the check asks Amazon to raise when it is short). The conductor starts a set only after that cloud's newest check passed, and starts a check itself when there is none, the last one failed an hour ago or more, or the last pass is a day old; so a broken key, an account that cannot rent or a short quota spends no set, and what the check prints names what to fix (Appendices G and H).

## N.3 A second Azure workflow, for machines already paid for

`aks-metered-full` runs the same paired design with the governor's full wiring on the service (the pod autoscaler's target, the pods' processor limits and the modelled power sense) instead of the machines alone. It exists to measure the governor's levers beside the cloud's own, not to make a bill result: in a cloud every extra pod is billed, and the cloud mode alone is read for the bill (chapter 20). Its inputs are the shared ones above, with a burst of `1 4 1 6 1 9` and three repetitions of 600 seconds by default.

## N.4 Reading the run

The run's summary carries the receipt, row by row, read by the rules of chapter 12 and section 20.6: GAIN, EVEN or LOSS for each judged row, with its 95% interval, and the shown rows beside them. The artifact `live-reps-aks` (or the cloud's equivalent) holds the same table as Markdown and JSON, with the repository's notice, licence and disclosures attached. A receipt is read only against the engine version of the commit it ran on (`python3 tools/omni_version.py --commit <sha>`, chapter 13), which each repetition's job prints at its start.

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APPENDIX

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    ↪ ulation only; first published 2026); revised
10 October 2026 (the notice in one wording everywhere); revised 11 Oct
    ↪ ober 2026 (definitions, patent license for
evaluation, hosted-service and machine-learning restrictions, results
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```

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    ↪ pass.com
```

APPENDIX

# Appendix P. Licensing: Questions and Answers

Plain answers to the questions buyers, engineers and their lawyers ask. The binding terms are in `LICENSE`; where this page and `LICENSE` differ, `LICENSE` governs. Every declaration is in `DISCLOSURES.md`.

**Is Omni-Compass open source?** No. The source is published so that it can be evaluated, reproduced and audited. It is licensed under the Omni-Compass Evaluation License 1.0 (`LicenseRef-OmniCompass-Evaluation-1.0`), which permits evaluation and simulation only.

**What may I do without a commercial license?** Evaluation and simulation, free of charge (`LICENSE`, sections 1.4, 1.5 and 2): read the code; run `verify.py`, the simulations and the benchmarks; reproduce the published results and publish your own, every row included (`LICENSE`, section 4); run Omni-Compass in watch, dry-run or shadow mode, or in a test environment, on systems you own or control, where it writes to nothing that serves production traffic or real users and to no physical process outside a test bench. A limited patent license comes with it, for evaluation only (`LICENSE`, section 2.2).

**What needs the Omni-Compass Enterprise License?** Every commercialization or monetization of any kind; production use; operating any system beyond evaluation; offering it, or its function, as a hosted, managed or software-as-a-service offering; redistributing it; incorporating it, or any part or derivative of it, into a product, service, appliance or firmware; using it or its results to build or train a competing product (`LICENSE`, sections 3 and 5). The Enterprise License is a written agreement signed by The Omni-Compass LLC and paid for; its standard terms are summarized in `ENTERPRISE_LICENSE.md` (production, hosted service, OEM and embedded, managed service provider, research).

**May I run it as a service for others?** Not without an Enterprise License with a hosted-service rider (`LICENSE`, section 3(c); `ENTERPRISE_LICENSE.md`, section 1).

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**May I connect it to a grid, a plant, a vehicle or a medical device?** Not under the evaluation license: such systems may be studied only in simulation. A live connection to any physical system needs an Enterprise License and a written safety case accepted by the system's owner (`LICENSE`, section 10).

**How is the Enterprise License priced?** Against the measured gain on the customer's own paired receipts (native against Omni-Compass on the same system, the same load and the same clock). Terms are set in each signed agreement; no price stated anywhere in this repository is an offer.

**Are patents involved?** All patents, copyrights and trademarks covering the Omni-Compass engine, its mathematics and its software have been filed in the United States by The Omni-Compass LLC (`PATENTS.md`). The evaluation license grants no patent license beyond evaluation.

**May I use the name or the compass rose?** Only to refer to Omni-Compass accurately (`TRADEMARKS.md`).

**May I contribute?** Contributions require the contributor license agreement (`.github/CLA.md`): every contribution is assigned to The Omni-Compass LLC, with a patent license from the contributor.

**Does Omni-Compass send data anywhere?** No. The software contains no telemetry and makes no network connection of its own except to the systems an operator points it at (a Kubernetes API, `nvidia-smi`, a meter command).

**What do scanners report?** The license is declared in machine-readable form for Black Duck, FOSSA, Snyk and REUSE (`pyproject.toml`, `REUSE.toml`, `.fossa.yml`, `.snyk`, `sbom/`); third-party components are listed in `THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md`.

**Can the terms change?** Yes. The Omni-Compass LLC reserves the right to change the software, its documentation, its results and these terms at any time, without notice; a changed version applies to copies obtained and uses made after it is published (`LICENSE`, section 9). A signed Enterprise License governs its own term.

**Which law governs?** The laws of the State of Delaware and the federal laws of the United States, with exclusive venue in the Delaware state courts and the United States District Court for the District of Delaware (`LICENSE`, section 19). The Omni-Compass LLC is based in Florida.

**Who do I contact?** The Omni-Compass LLC, main office infrastructure, toll-free direct 1-888-339-9551, system route asset 1-888-DEX-YLL-1, landline 321-746-4411 registered in Florida, www.omni-compass.com.

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APPENDIX

# Appendix Q. Third-Party Notices

Omni-Compass uses the following third-party components. Each remains under its own license; nothing in the Omni-Compass Evaluation License changes those terms. Installed versions are those resolved from `requirements.txt`.

| Component | Use | License |
|---|---|---|
| NumPy | numerical arrays | BSD-3-Clause |
| Matplotlib | charts in the reports | Matplotlib License (PSF-based, BSD-compatible) |
| ReportLab (open-source edition) | the printable book and reports | BSD-3-Clause |
| Numba | compiled inner loops of the motion-axis plant | BSD-2-Clause |
| PyTorch (on GPU machines only, not installed by `requirements.txt`) | the GPU workload of the benchmark | BSD-3-Clause |
| `tests/third_party/hpa_independent.py` | an independently written HPA reference used unmodified in tests | its own terms, stated in the file |
| Liberation Serif and Liberation Sans fonts (embedded in the PDF book) | typesetting | SIL Open Font License 1.1 |
| DejaVu Sans and DejaVu Sans Mono fonts (embedded in the PDF book) | typesetting | Bitstream Vera / DejaVu license (free) |
| PlanetLab / CoMon VM CPU traces, March 2011 (`fleet/traces/`, `k8s_controlplane/traces/`; source in their `PROVENANCE.json`) | held-out demand for the modelled fleet | their own terms (public research data); no Omni-Compass copyright is claimed in them |

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| Component | Use | License |
|---|---|---|
| Google cluster-usage traces 2011 (`clusterdata-2011-2`), from which `results/traces/google2011/` is derived (`docs/TRACES_PREREGISTRATION.md`) | the public demand trace on the real cluster | Google's published terms for the traces; no Omni-Compass copyright is claimed in the trace itself |

Kubernetes, kind, `kubectl`, the NVIDIA driver and `nvidia-smi` are not distributed with Omni-Compass; it calls them where an operator has installed them. Their names are the property of their owners (`DISCLOSURES.md`, section 1).

APPENDIX

# Appendix R. The Enterprise License: Standard Terms

This page summarizes the standard terms of the Omni-Compass Enterprise License, the paid license that every production use, commercial use, hosted service, distribution, OEM or embedded use, and every other commercialization or monetization of Omni-Compass requires (`LICENSE`, section 5). It is a summary for evaluation and planning. It is not an offer, and it binds no one: only an Enterprise License signed by The Omni-Compass LLC and the licensee, with its order form, grants any right, and that signed agreement controls over this page in every respect.

## R.1 What can be licensed

| License | What it allows |
|---|---|
| **Production** | The licensee runs Omni-Compass on top of its own systems (clusters, fleets, cards, sites, plants), on premises or in its own cloud accounts, within the scope in the order form |
| **Hosted service** | The licensee offers Omni-Compass's function to its own customers as a hosted, managed or software-as-a-service offering, under a hosted-service rider (per customer, per managed unit or revenue share) |
| **OEM and embedded** | The licensee ships Omni-Compass inside its own product, appliance, firmware or platform, under an OEM rider (per unit or per installed base) |

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| License | What it allows |
|---|---|
| **Managed service provider** | The licensee operates Omni-Compass for named third parties under a managed-service rider |
| **Research** | A university or public laboratory uses Omni-Compass beyond evaluation for non-commercial research and publication, under a research rider |

**Scope** is set in each order form: the licensed systems and their size (machines, cores, cards, sites, muscles or managed units), the fields of use, the territory, the named sites or accounts, and the engine versions covered.

## R.2 Fees

Fees are set in each order form: a subscription, a usage-based fee, a share of the measured value captured, or a combination, with any minimum commitment. Where fees track value, the value is measured on the licensee's own paired receipts (native against Omni-Compass on the same system, the same load and the same clock), by the method the order form names. Payment terms, taxes and late charges are as the order form states. No price, rate or benchmark in this repository is an offer.

## R.3 What the licensee receives

1. The licensed engine at a named, sealed version (its fingerprint, `tools/omni_version.py`), and each later version the subscription covers.
2. The wiring kits and the plug for the licensed systems, the manual and the book, and the receipts tooling.
3. Support and maintenance at the tier in the order form: response targets, named contacts, and corrections of defects that reproduce on the licensed version.
4. Installation through the manual's levels: read-only first, the wire check, a watch arm equal to native, then writing levels one at a time, each with its receipt.

## R.4 Warranties

1. **Conformance.** For the warranty period in the order form, the licensed version performs materially as its documentation describes. The remedy is correction or, failing that, a refund of the fees paid for the nonconforming version for the affected period.
2. **The safeguards.** The kill switch hands every setting back to the value read before Omni-Compass's first write; the shield keeps every write inside the cover the operator granted; Omni-Compass never fights another writer.
3. **No other warranty.** No outcome, saving or result on the licensee's systems is warranted. Published results are evidence about the systems they ran on (`DISCLOSURES.md`, section 2).

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## R.5 Intellectual property

1. The Omni-Compass LLC keeps all right, title and interest in Omni-Compass, the Mechanism and the marks. The licensee receives the rights its order form lists, for its term, and no others.
2. **Patent license.** The Enterprise License includes a license under The Omni-Compass LLC's patent rights in the filed applications, and in any patent issuing from them, for the licensed scope.
3. **Infringement indemnity.** The Omni-Compass LLC defends the licensee against a third-party claim that the licensed version, used as licensed, infringes that party's intellectual property, and pays the damages finally awarded or the settlement it agrees, subject to prompt notice, control of the defense and the usual exclusions (modifications, combinations, unlicensed use, versions superseded by an offered fix). Remedies may include a license, a modification or a refund.
4. **Confidential filings.** The patent application number and other confidential information are disclosed to a licensee under the agreement's confidentiality terms.

## R.6 Limits of liability

Each party's liability is limited to the fees paid or payable in the twelve months before the claim, and neither party is liable for indirect, incidental, special, consequential or punitive damages, except for the exclusions the signed agreement states (for example, breach of confidentiality, the infringement indemnity, and the licensee's breach of the license scope).

## R.7 Confidentiality, data and security

1. **Confidentiality.** Mutual, for the term and a period after it, covering non-public information either party gives the other.
2. **Data.** Omni-Compass contains no telemetry. The licensee's data, readings, settings and receipts stay on the licensee's systems and remain the licensee's. Where the licensee chooses to share data for support, a data-processing agreement applies.
3. **Security.** A software bill of materials ships with every version (`sbom/`); vulnerabilities are handled under `SECURITY.md`; the licensee may run the verifier (`python3 verify.py`) and the seal checks on every delivered version.

## R.8 Safety and operation

1. The licensee remains the operator of its systems. The machines' own controls and protections stay in place; Omni-Compass sets only values they already accept.
2. Any connection to a physical system (grid, plant, vehicle, robot, medical device, facility) requires a written safety case accepted by the system's owner and every review its regulator requires; safety-critical systems are licensed only on those terms.
3. The kill switch stays operable at all times.

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## R.9 Compliance, audit and insurance

1. Each party complies with export-control, sanctions and anti-corruption law.
2. The licensee reports usage against the licensed scope as the order form provides, and The Omni-Compass LLC may verify it on reasonable notice, no more than once a year.
3. Insurance, where the order form requires it, is carried by each party at the limits stated there.

## R.10 Term, renewal and transition

1. Term and renewal are as the order form states.
2. On termination or expiry, the licensee stops use, every setting Omni-Compass changed is handed back to native (the hand-back is built into the engine), and every copy is returned or destroyed; transition assistance is available at the rates in the order form.
3. Source-code escrow for the licensed version is available under a three-party escrow agreement.

## R.11 Governing law and precedence

The signed agreement states its governing law and venue; the standard is the law of the State of Delaware, with venue in the Delaware state courts and the United States District Court for the District of Delaware. Its order of precedence is: the order form, then any rider, then the Enterprise License terms, then the documentation. This page and the evaluation license (`LICENSE`) are superseded by the signed agreement for the licensee and its scope.

## R.12 How to obtain one

The Omni-Compass LLC, main office infrastructure, toll-free direct 1-888-339-9551, system route asset 1-888-DEX-YLL-1, landline 321-746-4411 registered in Florida, www.omni-compass.com. A license starts with an evaluation on the licensee's own systems (`LICENSE`, section 1.4): watch mode, the wire check, and paired receipts on its own load.

APPENDIX

# Appendix S. Patents and Trademarks

## S.1 Patents

**All patents, copyrights and trademarks covering the Omni-Compass engine, its mathematics and its software have been filed in the United States by The Omni-Compass LLC.**

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The filings cover, among other things, the Omni-Compass engine (the six-state closed law and its bounded control command held through the integration step), the compass law (the service position pulled to the middle of its band by a bounded push and pull, with fail-up at the wall), the antagonist up/down wiring of each muscle, the plug contract (one restore point, read-back, the one-writer rule), the two-wire governance of a processor (clock ceiling and power limit), the two-way nervous system that grants and withdraws authority per organ, and one governor over many machines and realms on one clock.

### *S.1.1 What has been filed*

| Application | a nonprovisional utility patent application under 35 U.S.C. 111(a), filed with the United States Patent and Trademark Office |
|---|---|
| Title of the invention | **The Omni-Compass** |
| Inventor | Alan John Dubra, Kissimmee, Florida, United States |
| Drawing sheets | 15 |
| Application data sheet signed | 20 September 2026 (form PTO/AIA/14, 37 CFR 1.76) |
| Publication | normal eighteen-month publication requested |
| Application number | withheld here on purpose; the filing is verifiable with the USPTO and is shown to a licensee under a signed Omni-Compass Enterprise License |

The application data sheet names no assignee; the application stands in the inventor's name. Any assignment to The Omni-Compass LLC is recorded with the USPTO separately (37 CFR part 3).

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## S.2 Trademarks

**All patents, copyrights and trademarks covering the Omni-Compass engine, its mathematics and its software have been filed in the United States by The Omni-Compass LLC.**

### *S.2.1 The marks*

"Omni-Compass", "OmniCompass", the Omni-Compass compass rose with its ring of Greek letters, and the related names, logos and trade dress (the "Marks") are trademarks of The Omni-Compass LLC; trademark applications have been filed in the United States. Neither the evaluation license (`LICENSE`) nor publication of this repository grants any license to the Marks. A license to use them is granted only in a signed Omni-Compass Enterprise License, and only as it states.

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### *S.2.2 What is allowed without a license*

- Referring to Omni-Compass by name, accurately and in plain text, to say what it is, that you evaluated it, or that a result was produced with it, with the engine version and commit (`LICENSE`, section 4).
- Linking to the repository or to www.omni-compass.com.

### *S.2.3 What is not allowed*

- Using any Mark, or anything confusingly similar, in the name of a product, service, company, domain, account, package, repository, fork or derivative.
- Using the logo or the compass rose, or altering any Mark.
- Suggesting endorsement, sponsorship, certification, partnership or affiliation by The Omni-Compass LLC.
- Using a Mark in advertising, comparative claims or sales material without a signed license.

### *S.2.4 Other companies' marks*

Kubernetes is a trademark of The Linux Foundation; NVIDIA is a trademark of NVIDIA Corporation; KEDA and Karpenter are projects of their maintainers; other names belong to their owners. Their mention describes compatibility or a system Omni-Compass was tested with; it states no affiliation, endorsement or certification (`DISCLOSURES.md`, section 1).

### *S.2.5 Reporting misuse*

The Omni-Compass LLC, main office infrastructure, toll-free direct 1-888-339-9551, system route asset 1-888-DEX-YLL-1, landline 321-746-4411 registered in Florida, www.omni-compass.com.

APPENDIX

# Appendix T. Security Policy

## T.1 Reporting a vulnerability

Report a suspected vulnerability privately to The Omni-Compass LLC by telephone at its main office infrastructure (toll-free direct 1-888-339-9551; system route asset 1-888-DEX-YLL-1, landline 321-746-4411 registered in Florida) or through www.omni-compass.com, never in a public issue, pull request or discussion. Include the version and commit, what you saw, how to reproduce it, and its likely impact. We acknowledge reports, keep the reporter informed, and coordinate disclosure: a fix or a mitigation is published before the details are, and the reporter is credited if they wish. Please give us a reasonable time to fix before any

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disclosure, do not access data that is not yours, and do not disrupt any system; good-faith research that follows this policy will not be pursued by us.

## T.2 What is in scope

The engine, the controllers, the plugs and wiring, the harnesses, the workflows and the verifier in this repository. Third-party software Omni-Compass runs on or connects to (Kubernetes, KEDA, Karpenter, NVIDIA drivers, databases) is reported to its own maintainers.

## T.3 How Omni-Compass is built to fail safe

- The governor issues control actions only through the shield (`omnicompass/shield.py`, `cpp/src/shield.cpp`), inside the cover the operator granted, and never fights another writer.
- It snapshots every setting once, before its first write, and the kill switch (`python3 tools/omni_switch.py off`) hands every setting back; a dead-man lease hands them back if the governor stops.
- It runs under least privilege: on Kubernetes, a service account with `kubectl auth can-i` receipts for what it can and cannot do (`deploy/kind/rbac-omni.yaml`).
- The watchdog acts only on registry records its own user wrote that no other user can change, and never signals a process number the system gave to another process (`tools/omni_switch.py`). Put the switch and the registry in a directory only the governors' user can write (`OMNI_MASTER_OFF`, `OMNI_REGISTRY`); `status` warns when they are not.
- It contains no telemetry and makes no network connection of its own except to the systems an operator points it at.
- The threats of misuse, the guards against each and what is still open are set out in `docs/THREAT_MODEL.md`.
- Every release carries a software bill of materials (`sbom/`) and a seal of the engine and its twins (`results/SEAL.json`, `python3 verify.py`).
- The capture script (`fleet/capture/kube_capture.sh`) is read-only; no component writes to a live cluster unless the operator starts it in a writing mode.

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BACK MATTER

# Index

Every term of the glossary where this book defines or discusses it, every muscle family where it is named, every file of the repository and every command-line setting this book names, with the pages they stand on. A plain mention of a common word is not an entry: the index points to where a thing is explained. A term whose pages would run past its line keeps the pages that fit, where it is defined and first used; after those it is throughout the book.

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